

riemann-channel: lab book

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1 Frontmatter, Status Vocabulary, and Scope

1.1 Aim

This lab book records an attempt to formulate the Riemann hypothesis in the language of tensor networks and operational quantum mechanics: channels, Kraus operators, transfer matrices, matrix-product states. The aim is a formulation that captures the mechanisms of the proofs that exist (Weil for curves, Deligne for varieties over finite fields, Ihara–Bass and the Ramanujan property for regular graphs) and connects more directly to quantum mechanics than the Hilbert–Pólya programme does. Nothing here proves anything about the Riemann hypothesis. The Markdown notes under `notes/` are the exploratory record; this book is their distillation, and every statement here is tagged.

1.2 The organising picture

Every zeta function in sight has two sides. Side A is a nonnegative count of closed orbits (prime cycles of a graph, points of a curve, prime powers with weight $\log p$) and its Euler product; it is a product state, the primes do not talk to each other. Side B is a small non-Hermitian operator whose power sums reproduce the counts; its eigenvalues are the zeros. The Riemann hypothesis, in every instance, is the statement that all nontrivial eigenvalues of side B share one modulus. Section 2 fixes the notation and Section 3 the definitions used for both sides throughout.

1.3 Status vocabulary

Every theorem-like environment in this book carries exactly one status tag, printed at its right margin, equal to the status derived by `scripts/labbook_check.py` from `db/claims.tsv`:

- **proved**: a written proof exists under `notes/` and a reviewer other than the author has returned `VERDICT <id>: VALID` in a file under `notes/reviews/`. Both author and reviewers to date are Claude models (single family); no second model family has been used.
- **sketched**: written by the author, not yet attacked.
- **numerical**: established by a script whose output is captured under `outputs/`; never more than numerical evidence.
- **cited**: a statement of the literature, backed by a quote in `db/provenance.tsv` that the gate byte-checks against the arXiv TeX source under `refs/src/`.
- **conjectured**, **open**, **refuted**, **assumed**: as the words say; a claim that depends on any of the first three prints **unsupported**, and one that depends on an assumption prints with the suffix **-conditional**.

Definitions carry no tag; they are **stipulated** (ours) or **quoted** (a source’s, with provenance) in `db/definitions.tsv`. The derived-status table generated from the claims database is reproduced here.

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
<code>prop:bc-residue-state</code>	proposition	sketched	-
<code>prop:bc-no-finite-phase-representation</code>	proposition	sketched	-
<code>prop:bc-symmetry-state-extension</code>	proposition	sketched	-
<code>thm:bc-covariant-gks-cone</code>	theorem	sketched	-

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
thm:bc-critical-cone-dimensions	theorem	sketched	-
prop:bc-weyl-covariance-collapse	proposition	sketched	-
prop:bc-symplectic-odd-counterexample	proposition	sketched	-
prop:bc-compatible-prime-coupling	proposition	sketched	-
num:bc-symmetry-generators	numerical	numerical	-
obs:one-identity	observation	sketched	-
obs:rh-finite-permutation	observation	sketched	-
obs:rh-small-matrix	observation	sketched	-
obs:rh-graph-ramanujan	observation	sketched	-
obs:rh-mps-correlation-length	observation	sketched	-
obs:rh-flow-pairing	observation	sketched	-
obs:hilbert-polya-hermitian	observation	sketched	-
prop:scattering-inner	proposition	sketched	-
num:scattering-symbol	numerical	numerical	-
prop:functional-model-modes	proposition	sketched	-
prop:phase-identity	proposition	sketched	-
prop:ringnorm-trace	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
num:ringnorm-3000	numerical	numerical	-
prop:bc-mpo	proposition	sketched	-
num:bc-mpo	numerical	numerical	-
conj:stinespring-jump-form	conjecture	open	-
num:weil-lps-ramanujan	numerical	numerical	-
num:weil-lps-rh	numerical	numerical	-
prop:weil-lps-exactly-ramanujan	proposition	sketched	-
conj:weil-lps-hecke	conjecture	open	-
prop:as-transfer-matrix	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:normal-basis
prop:as-unitarity	proposition	proved	-
num:artin-schreier-mps	numerical	numerical	-
obs:as-nonquadratic	observation	sketched	-
obs:deligne-ingredients	observation	sketched	-
obs:abelian-obstruction	observation	sketched	-
thm:qihara-general	theorem	proved	-
cor:qihara-kraus	corollary	proved	-
cor:qihara-unitary	corollary	proved	-
cor:qihara-poles	corollary	proved	-
obs:rh-iff-ramanujan-channel	observation	sketched	-
num:qihara-unitary	numerical	numerical	-
num:qihara-general	numerical	numerical	-
cit:mo-extended-ihara	citedfact	cited	-
cit:mo-adjoint-weights	citedfact	cited	-
cit:wf-arbitrary-weights	citedfact	cited	-
cit:bc-nonbacktracking	citedfact	cited	-
cit:harrow-transfer	citedfact	cited	-
cit:iyer-exact-ramanujan	citedfact	cited	-
cit:sunada-attribution	citedfact	cited	-
obs:prior-art-verdict	observation	sketched	-
conj:kraus-ramanujan	conjecture	open	-
conj:assemble-over-p	conjecture	open	-
obs:prime-by-prime-blind	observation	sketched	-
asm:fuchsian-geometry	assumption	assumed	-
asm:laplace-spectrum-compact	assumption	assumed	-
asm:selberg-zeta-entire	assumption	assumed	-

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
asm:heat-semigroup	assumption	assumed	-
asm:zeta-standard	assumption	assumed	-
asm:gamma-standard	assumption	assumed	-
cit:dz-guillemin	citedfact	cited	-
cit:dfg-band	citedfact	cited	-
cit:dz-ruelle-selberg	citedfact	cited	-
cit:marklof-trace	citedfact	cited	-
cit:fgkp-casimir-laplacian	citedfact	cited	-
cit:fjs-scattering-det	citedfact	cited	-
cit:mv-continuous-term	citedfact	cited	-
prop:circle-comb	proposition	proved	-
prop:prime-circles-orbital	proposition	proved	-
prop:finite-euler-spectrum	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:gamma-standard, asm:ze
prop:lindblad-sum-of-squares	proposition	proved	-
prop:casimir-laplacian	proposition	proved	-
prop:quantum-lindblad-tensor	proposition	proved	-
prop:poincare-jacobian	proposition	proved	-
prop:flat-tower	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry
prop:tower-divisor-band	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm
prop:graph-tower-ruelle	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm
prop:cuspidal-prime-comb	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:gamma-standard, asm:ze
prop:damping-identity	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:gamma-standard, asm:ze
num:selberg-lindblad	numerical	numerical	-
obs:continuous-dictionary	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm
conj:quantum-lindblad-gap	conjecture	open	-
obs:spt-protection-is-sign-data	observation	sketched	-
thm:weil-positivity-finite	theorem	proved	-
thm:weil-duality-pairing	theorem	proved	-
prop:weil-orbit-negative	proposition	proved	-
prop:weil-reciprocal-only	proposition	proved	-
prop:kraus-conjugation-symmetry	proposition	proved	-
thm:kraus-inverse-pairing-duality	theorem	proved	-
prop:kraus-both-pairings-unitary	proposition	proved	-
thm:kraus-weil-criterion	theorem	proved	-
prop:kraus-no-duality-example	proposition	proved	-
thm:weil-positivity-continuous	theorem	proved	-
thm:weil-line-duality	theorem	proved	-
thm:cmps-ring-norms	theorem	proved	-
prop:hp-inner-product-discrete	proposition	proved	-
prop:hp-inner-product-continuous	proposition	proved	-
prop:weil-blind-jordan	proposition	proved	-
obs:weil-zeta-dictionary	observation	sketched	-
obs:huang-boundedness	observation	proved	-
obs:kraus-dichotomy	observation	proved	-
num:weil-positivity	numerical	numerical	-
cit:weil-criterion	citedfact	cited	-
cit:li-criterion	citedfact	cited	-
cit:huang-graph-criterion	citedfact	cited	-
cit:hastings-bound	citedfact	cited	-
cit:herglotz-bochner	citedfact	cited	-
cit:suzuki-kernel	citedfact	cited	-
cit:pt-real-spectrum	citedfact	cited	-

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
obs:ringnorm-sign-correction	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
asm:explicit-formula-trace	assumption	assumed	-
asm:zero-count-location	assumption	assumed	-
asm:positive-distributions	assumption	assumed	-
asm:landau-laplace	assumption	assumed	-
asm:lax-phillips-modes	assumption	assumed	-
asm:weil-curves	assumption	assumed	-
cit:lidskii-trace	citedfact	cited	-
cit:landau-dirichlet	citedfact	cited	-
cit:deninger-graded-lefschetz	citedfact	cited	-
cit:connes-absorption	citedfact	cited	-
lem:supertrace-distribution	lemma	proved	-
thm:supertrace-rigidity	theorem	proved	-
cor:forced-net-spectrum	corollary	proved-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
thm:parity-forced-finite	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
prop:parity-infinite-dominated	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
obs:parity-infinite-open	observation	sketched	-
thm:no-ungraded-trace	theorem	proved	-
prop:trace-supertrace-criterion	proposition	proved	-
cor:curve-counts-graded	corollary	proved-conditional	asm:weil-curves
prop:riemann-graded-generator	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
prop:ladder-parity-free	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
obs:phantasm-scope	observation	sketched	-
cit:fmps-supertrace	citedfact	cited	-
cit:fcmps-graded-bond	citedfact	cited	-
cit:cmps-schmidt-fixed-point	citedfact	cited	-
cit:bc-kms-unique	citedfact	cited	-
thm:vacuum-decay-finite	theorem	proved	-
cor:vacuum-decay-traces	corollary	proved	-
prop:absorbing-vacuum-channel	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:lax-phillips-modes
obs:zero-coherences-populations	observation	sketched	-
prop:vacuum-renewal-trivial-entanglement	proposition	proved	-
prop:normal-kms-gibbs	proposition	proved	-
lem:mm1-spectrum	lemma	proved	-
prop:prime-chain-lindbladian	proposition	proved	-
prop:prime-chain-offdiagonal	proposition	proved	-
cor:gibbs-delocalisation	corollary	proved	-
num:riemann-graded-trace	numerical	numerical	-
num:bc-entropy	numerical	numerical	-
obs:gibbs-entanglement-hagedorn	observation	sketched	-
obs:character-sector-grading	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:as-lpolynomial, asm:fr
obs:complementary-halves	observation	sketched	-
obs:phantasm-established-scope	observation	sketched	-
conj:phantasm-both-halves	conjecture	open	-
conj:galois-graded-bond	conjecture	open	-
asm:normal-basis	assumption	assumed	-
asm:as-lpolynomial	assumption	assumed	-
asm:weil-implementer-exact	assumption	assumed	-
asm:frobenius-semisimple	assumption	assumed	-
cit:weil-character-formula	citedfact	cited	-
cit:weil-egorov-uniqueness	citedfact	cited	-
lem:gauss-quadratic-form	lemma	proved	-

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
thm:as-sign-law	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:normal-basis
cor:as-periodic-sign	corollary	proved-conditional	asm:as-lpolynomial, asm:no
prop:as-sign-counterexamples	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:normal-basis
thm:as-frobenius-block	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:as-lpolynomial, asm:no
thm:as-super-transfer	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:as-lpolynomial, asm:fr
thm:as-symplectic-map	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:weil-implementer-exact
cor:as-weil-bound-fixed-space	corollary	proved-conditional	asm:normal-basis, asm:weil
num:artin-schreier-super	numerical	numerical	-
cit:kl-identity	citedfact	cited	-
cit:kl-rh-four-way	citedfact	cited	-
cit:kangyu-alternating	citedfact	cited	-
cit:llp-geodesic-flow	citedfact	cited	-
cit:llp-one-sided-rh	citedfact	cited	-
cit:kamber-lp	citedfact	cited	-
cit:storm-reduction	citedfact	cited	-
cit:bcds-triangulation	citedfact	cited	-
cit:no-general-complex-zeta	citedfact	cited	-
cit:deitmar-alternating	citedfact	cited	-
cit:dz-order-chi	citedfact	cited	-
cit:hashimoto-hprime	citedfact	cited	-
cit:knill-sdet	citedfact	cited	-
cit:mo-dirac	citedfact	cited	-
asm:h-point	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-llp	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-kl	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-ky	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-ky-local	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-kl-table	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-lsv	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-strong	assumption	assumed	-
asm:h-kamber	assumption	assumed	-
thm:ordered-vs-building	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:h-kl, asm:h-llp, asm:h
thm:total-zeta-vertex-l	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:h-kl
thm:cochain-cancellation	theorem	proved	-
thm:pointed-euler-exponent	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:h-ky
thm:universal-bass-schur	theorem	proved	-
cor:bass-every-graph	corollary	proved	-
prop:tetrahedron-obstruction	proposition	proved	-
thm:graded-superdeterminant	theorem	proved	-
prop:vertex-l-no-zeros	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:h-kl
prop:parity-only	proposition	proved	-
prop:three-circles	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:h-kl, asm:h-kl-table
thm:incidence-two-schur	theorem	proved	-
thm:berezinian-total	theorem	proved	-
thm:twisted-bass-schur	theorem	proved	-
thm:kraus-ring-positivity	theorem	proved	-
prop:positivity-no-go-scope	proposition	proved	-
obs:graded-determinant-natural	observation	proved	-
num:small-complex-tests	numerical	numerical	-
prop:pure-gauge-full-complex	proposition	proved	-
thm:artin-voltage-decomposition	theorem	proved	-
thm:euler-block-bookkeeping	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:h-ky, asm:h-ky-local

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
thm:quantum-vertex-transfer	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:h-kl, asm:h-ky, asm:h-
prop:coverage-converse	proposition	proved	-
prop:one-sided-rh-variable	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:h-kamber, asm:h-llp
prop:rank-three-dualities	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:h-kl-table, asm:h-lsv
prop:weil-positivity-blocks	proposition	proved	-
num:a2-complex	numerical	numerical	-
num:a2-vertex-spectrum	numerical	numerical	-
num:a2-identity	numerical	numerical	-
num:a2-flow-operators	numerical	numerical	-
num:a2-block-spectra	numerical	numerical	-
num:a2-quantum-twist	numerical	numerical	-
num:a2-voltage-euler	numerical	numerical	-
conj:vertex-collapse-characterisation	conjecture	conjectured	-
asm:graded-fock	assumption	assumed	-
cit:hcov-overlap-parity	citedfact	cited	-
lem:ordered-contraction	lemma	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
lem:cmps-fock-isometry	lemma	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
lem:dyson-series	lemma	sketched	-
thm:cmps-overlap-parity	theorem	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
prop:cmps-graded-parity	proposition	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
thm:cmps-twisted-supertrace	theorem	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
prop:cmps-twist-translation	proposition	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
thm:cmps-sdet	theorem	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
num:cmps-parity-supertrace	numerical	numerical	-
obs:cmps-supertrace-reading	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
cit:frob-count-formula	citedfact	cited	-
cit:hasse-degree-bound	citedfact	cited	-
cit:serre-tate-lift	citedfact	cited	-
asm:deuring-lift	assumption	assumed	-
cit:degree-norm-index	citedfact	cited	-
cit:toral-lefschetz	citedfact	cited	-
cit:lenstra-structure	citedfact	cited	-
cit:latimer-macduffee	citedfact	cited	-
asm:supersingular-newton	assumption	assumed	-
asm:kraus-hs-setting	assumption	assumed	-
thm:as-quadratic-supersingular	theorem	proved	-
prop:as-finite-order	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:as-lpolynomial, asm:fr
prop:ring-cut-rank	proposition	proved	-
num:cut-rank-binary	numerical	numerical	-
conj:amplitude-locality	conjecture	conjectured	-
thm:toral-frobenius-count	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:deuring-lift
prop:toral-zeta	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:deuring-lift
thm:hodge-doubling-tensor	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:deuring-lift
prop:fourier-shift-flat-trace	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:deuring-lift
thm:elliptic-ph-unitary	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:deuring-lift
prop:integral-marking-gauge	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:deuring-lift
prop:cyclic-digits-carries	proposition	proved	-
prop:carry-automaton-no-count	proposition	proved	-
obs:drafted-hs-bound-false	observation	sketched	-
thm:bosonic-blocks-hs	theorem	proved	-
lem:word-trace-cs	lemma	proved	-
thm:bosonic-genus-bound	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:weil-curves

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
prop:euler-bookkeeping	proposition	proved	-
prop:odd-species-cancellation	proposition	proved	-
thm:infinite-bond-bosonic-nogo	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:kraus-hs-setting, asm:
num:weil-ring-norm-check	numerical	numerical	-
num:ring-norm-tensor	numerical	numerical	-
cit:rosati-positive	citedfact	cited	-
cit:cm-lift-frobenius	citedfact	cited	-
cit:hodge-positive-forms	citedfact	cited	-
asm:cm-hodge-type	assumption	assumed	-
asm:cm-polarised-lift	assumption	assumed	-
lem:genus-two-blocks	lemma	proved	-
prop:vacuum-ansatz-impossible	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:weil-curves
thm:nine-letter-tensor	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:weil-curves
prop:f5-base-change	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:cm-polarised-lift, asm:
prop:three-letter-feasibility	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:cm-polarised-lift
thm:f5-certified-tensor	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:cm-polarised-lift
conj:three-letter-universal	conjecture	conjectured	-
num:ring-norm-certificate	numerical	numerical	-
num:genus-two-cm-diagonal	numerical	numerical	-
cor:genus-two-physical-norm	corollary	sketched-conditional	asm:cm-polarised-lift, asm:
prop:jacobian-curve-projector	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:cm-hodge-type, asm:cm-
thm:rosati-ph-genus-two	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:cm-hodge-type, asm:cm-
prop:cm-type-gauge	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:cm-hodge-type
obs:phantasm-bond-candidate	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:zero-count-location
obs:fermionic-jumps-necessary	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:kraus-hs-setting, asm:
obs:toral-contribution	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:cm-hodge-type, asm:cm-
obs:locality-dichotomy-restricted	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:deuring-lift, asm:weil
prop:example-correlation-lengths	proposition	sketched-conditional	asm:weil-curves
prop:example-block-spectrum	proposition	sketched	-
obs:example-entanglement	observation	sketched	-
prop:example-parent-hamiltonian	proposition	sketched	-
num:ring-norm-examples	numerical	numerical	-
prop:permutation-rings	proposition	sketched	-
prop:permutation-gas	proposition	sketched	-
thm:permutation-induced-zeros	theorem	sketched	-
cor:moebius-fermion-parity	corollary	sketched	-
prop:letters-transfer-invariance	proposition	sketched	-
lem:sector-separating-letters	lemma	sketched	-
prop:letters-word-formula	proposition	sketched	-
prop:parity-jump-uniform-shift	proposition	sketched	-
obs:physical-dimension-principle	observation	sketched	-
obs:jump-operator-guidance	observation	sketched	-
num:graded-permutation	numerical	numerical	-
prop:phase-jumps-shells	proposition	sketched	-
prop:phase-vacuum-generating-functions	proposition	sketched	-
prop:galois-dephasing-rates	proposition	sketched	-
prop:phase-grading-not-invariant	proposition	sketched	-
prop:phase-no-gibbs-no-trace	proposition	sketched	-
prop:parity-closure-not-quotient	proposition	sketched	-
obs:phase-side-verdict	observation	sketched	-
num:phase-side-lindbladian	numerical	numerical	-
obs:zeta-condition-ledger	observation	sketched	-

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
prop:e0-pair-shift	proposition	sketched	-
prop:four-letter-elliptic	proposition	sketched-conditional	asm:weil-curves
prop:fe-rh-mixing-independent	proposition	sketched	-
prop:tiny-l-functions	proposition	sketched	-
prop:cmps-half-and-fe	proposition	sketched	-
obs:factor-by-factor-limits	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:weil-curves
num:zeta-conditions	numerical	numerical	-
prop:graded-weil-hodge	proposition	sketched	-
prop:p-mode	proposition	sketched	-
prop:no-ungraded-zeros	proposition	sketched	-
thm:graded-qihara-bass	theorem	sketched	-
cor:graded-band-circle	corollary	sketched	-
obs:odd-gap-no-alon-boppana	observation	sketched	-
thm:graded-harrow	theorem	sketched	-
num:graded-ramanujan	numerical	numerical	-
prop:qubit-graded-zeta	proposition	sketched	-
prop:graded-continuum-exact	proposition	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
prop:graded-chernoff	proposition	sketched	-
prop:jump-lindblad-band	proposition	sketched	-
obs:divisor-regular-data	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:explicit-formula-trace
obs:continuous-harrow-tempered	observation	sketched	-
obs:graded-continuous-harrow	observation	sketched	-
obs:selberg-grading-choice	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm:
obs:graded-ramanujan-status	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:graded-fock
cit:dfg-horocyclic	citedfact	cited	-
cit:dfg-first-band-pushforward	citedfact	cited	-
asm:dfg-resonance-theory	assumption	assumed	-
asm:selberg-coercivity	assumption	assumed	-
asm:cusp-divisor-theorem	assumption	assumed	-
prop:selberg-letters-laplacian	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:fuchsian-geometry, asm:
thm:selberg-two-term-ring-zeta	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:dfg-resonance-theory,
thm:selberg-first-band-form	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:dfg-resonance-theory,
prop:selberg-ladder-ihara	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:dfg-resonance-theory,
prop:selberg-no-cp-realisation	proposition	sketched-conditional	asm:dfg-resonance-theory,
obs:modular-scattering-sector	observation	sketched-conditional	asm:cusp-divisor-theorem,
thm:hashimoto-lift-metric	theorem	proved	-
prop:ktype-not-flow-grading	proposition	proved	-
thm:letters-derived-selberg	theorem	proved-conditional	asm:dfg-resonance-theory,
thm:letters-derived-finite	theorem	proved	-
num:selberg-letters	numerical	numerical	-
cit:bls-selberg-level-one	citedfact	cited	-
obs>window-is-compression	observation	sketched	-
cit:cf-kernel-circle	citedfact	cited	-
prop:extension-disc	proposition	sketched	-
prop:newton-congruence	proposition	sketched	-
obs:rescaling-and-zeta	observation	sketched	-
num:weil-window-extension	numerical	numerical	-
obs:model-modes-sign	observation	proved	-
lem:exit-one-dimensional	lemma	proved	-
thm:rebound-renewal	theorem	proved	-
asm:zero-reflection-count	assumption	assumed	-
prop:infinite-mean-rebound	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:zero-reflection-count

id	kind	derived status	assumptions
prop:odd-modes-protected	proposition	proved	-
prop:graded-stationary-segment	proposition	proved	-
prop:rebound-persistence-secular	proposition	proved	-
prop:mode-diagonal-rebound-rh	proposition	proved-conditional	asm:zero-reflection-count
thm:rebound-admissibility	theorem	proved	-
thm:flag-spectrum-attainable	theorem	proved	-
prop:gibbs-flag-isometry	proposition	proved	-
obs:rebound-both-halves-scope	observation	sketched	-
num:rebound-state	numerical	numerical	-
prop:cuspid-reflection	proposition	proved	-
prop:cuspid-visible-spectrum	proposition	proved	-
thm:cuspid-resonance-count	theorem	proved	-
prop:pure-cuspid-scattering	proposition	proved	-
cit:childs-strouse-reflection	citedfact	cited	-
cit:childs-strouse-levinson	citedfact	cited	-
cit:apw-resonances	citedfact	cited	-
cit:apw-lax-phillips-open	citedfact	cited	-
cit:apw-elliptic-curves	citedfact	cited	-
cit:apw-weil-circle	citedfact	cited	-
cit:kk-level-constant-term	citedfact	cited	-
thm:cuspid-wave-contraction	theorem	sketched	-
lem:cuspid-gram-exit	lemma	sketched	-
prop:cuspid-walk-power-sums	proposition	proved	-
thm:cuspid-renewal-discrete	theorem	proved	-
prop:cuspid-modal-rh	proposition	proved	-
thm:cuspid-admissible-flags	theorem	proved	-
prop:cuspid-odd-protected	proposition	proved	-
obs:cuspid-no-graph-vacuum	observation	sketched	-
prop:cuspid-ram-rh-independent	proposition	proved	-
prop:cuspid-radius-product	proposition	proved	-
prop:cuspid-rh-criterion	proposition	proved	-
obs:cuspid-krylov-factorisation	observation	sketched	-
num:cuspid-graph	numerical	numerical	-
obs:cuspid-arith-next	observation	sketched	-

1.4 Lockstep rules

The gate (`make check`; `make ci` adds a fresh build) fails unless: every note under `notes/` is named by a shard header and every shard header names an existing note; every evidence script is named by a shard and has a captured output; every theorem-like environment has one label, one claims row, and one status tag equal to the derived status; every definition has one row and appears once; the notation macros are exactly the generated image of `db/notation.tsv` with no duplicate symbols; every provenance quote is found whole and contiguous at its stated locus; and the build has no undefined references or citations.

2 Conventions and Notation

Every symbol below is a macro generated from `db/notation.tsv`; shards may not define macros of their own, and the gate warns whenever a shard writes a reserved control sequence (such as the bare Greek letters) bare instead of through its macro. The table is regenerated by `make regen` and the gate fails if it is stale.

2.1 Standing conventions

1. **Channel normalisation.** A channel Φ is normalised, $\Phi(X) = \frac{1}{D} \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$, so that its leading eigenvalue is 1. The unnormalised sum is $\Sigma = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i = D\Phi$. Every Ihara–Bass statement is written with Σ or $D\Phi$; the notes that wrote Φ without the $1/D$ are read with this convention.
2. **The size parameter q .** One letter, three roles that never co-occur: the field size in Section 28, the LPS prime in Section 27, and $D - 1$ for graphs and channels. In every role the critical modulus is $\sqrt{q}$. For a channel with D Kraus operators, $q := D - 1$ is a standing identification.
3. **Ramanujan units.** Spectral bounds are reported in adjacency units: a channel eigenvalue is multiplied by $D = q + 1$ and compared with $2\sqrt{q}$. Hastings’ bound $\lambda_H = 2\sqrt{D - 1}/D$ is the same statement in channel units.
4. **The zeta variable is u ,** in $\zeta_X(u)$, $\zeta_T(u)$, $Z_C(u)$ and $\det(1 - uT)$. The ring-length variable of the length flow is L , never $u = t/2$.
5. **Zeros.** A nontrivial zero is $\rho = \sigma + i\gamma$ with σ its real part; β is reserved for the inverse temperature of the Bost–Connes system. The Riemann hypothesis reads $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$.
6. **Indices.** n is the matrix size in M_n and, in the ring pictures, the number of sites, which for Artin–Schreier curves is the extension degree of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$. Walk, word and prime-cycle lengths are ℓ . Counts are N_ℓ .
7. **Column stacking.** $\text{Ad}(A) = \bar{A} \otimes A$ as an $n^2 \times n^2$ matrix, so $\text{Tr Ad}(A) = |\text{Tr } A|^2$.
8. **Non-backtracking operator.** $T(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$: the label i names the superoperator applied, and the next label may not be its reversal. Word products are composed right to left, $\mathcal{E}_{i_\ell} \cdots \mathcal{E}_{i_1}$, with the cyclic condition $i_{k+1} \neq \bar{i}_k$ for $k \in \mathbb{Z}/\ell$.
9. **Artin–Schreier sign.** $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$, so that $\mathcal{S}_n = -\sum_i \alpha_i^n$ for all n and $L = \prod_i (1 - \alpha_i u)$, the standard normalisation of the L -function of an exponential sum. The curve count is $N_n = q^n + 1 - \sum_i \alpha_i^n$.
10. **Canonical form.** An MPS is in (left) canonical form when $\sum_k A_k^\dagger A_k = 1$; then the transfer matrix has leading eigenvalue 1. The spectral normalisation used in the translation note (leading eigenvalue 1, rest inside the unit disc) is a consequence, not the definition.
11. **Status vocabulary.** The book uses only the tags of Section 3 (Definition 4.17). The two-value “established / not established” of the notes and the prior-art verdicts (**SAME**, **RELATED**, **NOT**) are read as **sketched/numerical** versus **open**, and as a provenance vocabulary confined to Section 44, respectively.
12. **Trace.** Tr is the operator trace; the field trace is $\text{tr}_{q^n/q}$.

2.2 Clashes found and resolved

The extraction of 2026-09-12 (`notes/extract/notation-and-definitions.md`) found 146 symbols across the seven notes, with these collisions. Each resolution below is what the table enforces.

- ψ carried five meanings: Chebyshev function, additive character, Lévy exponent, digamma, MPS ring state. Now: ψ is Chebyshev; e_q the additive character; κ_σ the Lévy exponent; (Γ'/Γ) the digamma; Ψ_n the ring state.
- T carried five: the non-backtracking operator, the length-flow generator, the curve-zeta variable, the Heisenberg–Weyl operator, the Hecke operator. Now: T is the non-backtracking operator; $\mathcal{G}$ the generator; u the variable; $T(u, v)$ the Heisenberg–Weyl operator (only with two arguments); A_q the Hecke adjacency operator.
- ρ carried three: zero, density matrix, twist. Now: ρ is a zero; X a channel input; ϱ a twisting representation.
- β carried three: real part of a zero, inverse temperature, Deligne weight. Now: σ , β , w .
- ξ was both the completed zeta and the correlation length, within two pages. Now: ξ is the completed zeta; ℓ_k^c the correlation length; ϑ_k the phase.
- S was the scattering symbol, the exponential sum and the start map. Now: S , $\mathcal{S}_n$, $\mathbf{S}$.
- J was the Artin–Schreier range, the reversal operator and a splitting matrix. Now: J (italic), J (sans-serif), $\mathbf{J}$ (bold).
- D was the Kraus count, the dilation unitary, a diagonal degree matrix and the degree operator. Now: D , $\mathbf{D}$, and $\mathcal{D}(u)(u)$; the diagonal degree matrix of a general graph is never needed on a bouquet.
- E was the MPS transfer matrix and the Artin–Schreier transfer matrix (the same concept, kept as E) and the superoperators of a Kraus family (now $\mathcal{E}_i$, a different glyph).
- W, V : the edge and vertex spaces of the non-backtracking construction are $\mathcal{W}, \mathcal{V}$; $W(g)$ and $W_\pm$ are the Weil representation and its blocks; $|V|$ is a vertex count.
- A : the adjacency matrix A ; Kraus operators A_i ; the LPS Hecke adjacency A_q .
- F : the Fourier transform $\mathcal{F}$; Frobenius Fr ; the numerical window sum F ; Weil’s zero-side function F_W .
- M : a generic matrix M ; the chirp $\mathbf{M}$.
- σ : the real part of s ; the reversal involution is now ι . Σ is only ever $\Sigma = D\Phi$.
- α : Frobenius eigenvalues carry a subscript, α_i ; a quaternion is bare α .
- m : the number of Kraus pairs; walk length is ℓ . N : $\dim \mathcal{V}$; counts are N_ℓ .
- μ : an edge eigenvalue; the Bost–Connes isometries are $\mathfrak{m}_n$. G : a group; the window width is G_w . θ : the normal-basis generator θ ; phases are ϑ_k . s : the complex variable; a square root of $q \bmod p$ is s_q .

2.3 Notation table

symbol	meaning	domain	where
ϱ_b	prescribed stationary density in a finite BC bond model	finite BC states	RC-02E
ϱ^{res}	diagonal matrix extension of a finite BC phase marginal	finite BC states	RC-02E
P	local parity operator $x \rightarrow -x$ on $l\{2(F_p)$	finite Weil model	RC-02E
$\mathfrak{C}$	cone of stationary covariant finite GKLS generators	finite channels	RC-02E
C	unnormalised Choi matrix of a linear map	finite channels	RC-02E
$\mathcal{D}$	completely depolarizing channel $D_d(X) = \text{Tr}(X) I/d$	finite channels	RC-02E
Tr	trace	general	RC-01
Ad	adjoint action, $\text{Ad}(A): X \rightarrow A X A^\dagger$	channels	RC-01
Re	real part	general	RC-01
Im	imaginary part	general	RC-01
M_n	$n \times n$ complex matrices with the Hilbert-Schmidt inner product	channels	RC-01
$\mathcal{V}$	vertex space of the non-backtracking construction ($V = M_n$ in the channel case), $N = \dim V$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\mathcal{W}$	edge space $V(x) C\{D$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
T	non-backtracking (Hashimoto) edge operator, classical on directed edges or quantum on the edge space	graphs, quantum Ihara	RC-02
$\mathcal{G}$	generator of the length flow whose trace is the prime measure, eigenvalues 1, ρ , -2, -4, ...	Riemann channel	RC-03
$\mathcal{E}_i$	i -th superoperator of a family ($E_i = \text{Ad}(A_i)$ in the Kraus case)	quantum Ihara	RC-08
A_i	i -th Kraus operator	channels	RC-01
U_i	i -th unitary Kraus operator	channels	RC-01
Σ	unnormalised transfer matrix $\sum_i E_i (= D \Phi$ for a unital channel)	channels, MPS	RC-01
Φ	unital channel $(1/D) \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$, or a general channel	channels	RC-01
D	number of Kraus operators (= degree of the bouquet); $D = 2m$	channels	RC-01
m	number of Kraus pairs, $D = 2m$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
ι	fixed-point-free reversal involution on the index set $[D]$, $\bar{i} = \iota(i)$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\bar{\cdot}$	reversed index $\iota(i)$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
J	backtracking operator $J(v(x) i\rangle) = E_i v(x) \bar{i}\rangle$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
R	propagate-along-edge map $R: W \rightarrow V$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
S	start-any-edge map $S: V \rightarrow W$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\mathcal{A}(u)$	deformed adjacency $u \sum_i E_i (1 - u\{2 E_{\{\bar{i}\}} E_i)\{-1\}$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
$\mathcal{D}(u)$	deformed degree $u\{2 \sum_i E_{\{\bar{i}\}} E_i (1 - u\{2 E_{\{\bar{i}\}} E_i)\{-1\}$	quantum Ihara	RC-08
ζ_T	zeta function $\det(1 - uT)\{-1\}$ of a non-backtracking operator	quantum Ihara	RC-08

symbol	meaning	domain	where
ζ_Φ	quantum Ihara zeta of a unital channel with unitary Kraus operators	quantum Ihara	RC-02
ζ_X	Ihara zeta of a graph X	graphs	RC-02
A	adjacency matrix of a graph	graphs	RC-02
$A.$	adjacency operator of the LPS Cayley graph for norm-q quaternions (Hecke operator)	Weil-LPS	RC-05
q	size parameter: field size (Artin-Schreier), LPS prime (Weil-LPS), and $D - 1 = \text{degree} - 1$ for graphs and channels	all	RC-01
p	a rational prime; the modulus of the Weil representation in RC-05	all	RC-01
λ_2	second largest eigenvalue (or singular value) of a channel or graph, normalised to leading eigenvalue 1	expanders	RC-02
λ_H	Hastings bound $2 \sqrt{(D-1)/D}$	expanders	RC-02
μ	eigenvalue of the edge operator T; pairs $\mu \mu' = q$ with an adjacency eigenvalue λ	graphs	RC-02
ℓ	length of a walk, word or prime cycle	graphs, quantum Ihara	RC-02
$N.$	closed non-backtracking walk count of length ℓ , or point count over F_{q^ℓ}	graphs, curves	RC-02
P	prime cycle of a graph (primitive closed non-backtracking walk up to rotation)	graphs	RC-02
Fr	Frobenius	curves	RC-06
ϱ	representation twisting a zeta (holonomy, Artin-Ihara twist, adjoint representation)	graphs, Deligne	RC-07
X	density matrix or general operator input of a channel	channels	RC-01
ρ	nontrivial zero of zeta, $\rho = \sigma + i \gamma$	number theory	RC-01
σ	real part of s (or of a zero)	number theory	RC-01
$\gamma.$	imaginary part of the n -th zero	number theory	RC-01
ξ	completed zeta $\xi(s) = (1/2) s (s-1) \pi^{\hat{s}/2} \Gamma(s/2) \zeta(s)$	number theory	RC-04
S	Lax-Phillips scattering symbol $S(\tau) = \xi(1 - 2i\tau)/\xi(1 + 2i\tau)$	Riemann channel	RC-04
τ	Mellin variable on the dilation group; dilation by $e^{\hat{t}}$ acts as $e^{\hat{t}}$	Riemann channel	RC-04
K_S	model space $H^{\hat{2}}_2 \text{ minus } S H^{\hat{2}}_2$	Riemann channel	RC-04
$Z(t)$	compressed dilation semigroup $P_{\{K_S\}} e^{\hat{t}}$ restricted to K_S	Riemann channel	RC-04
Λ	von Mangoldt function	number theory	RC-01
ψ	Chebyshev function $\psi(x) = \sum_{n \leq x} \Lambda(n)$	number theory	RC-03
e_q	additive character of F_q composed with the trace	curves	RC-06
$\kappa.$	Bost-Connes Levy exponent $\kappa_\sigma(\tau) = \log \zeta(\sigma - i\tau) - \log \zeta(\sigma)$	Bost-Connes	RC-04
$\nu.$	von Mangoldt jump measure $\nu_\sigma = \sum p^{\hat{k}} \{-k\sigma\} / k \delta_{\{k \log p\}}$	Bost-Connes	RC-04
β	inverse temperature of the Bost-Connes system	Bost-Connes	RC-04
L	ring length variable of the length flow (prime powers sit at $L = \log n$)	Riemann channel	RC-03

symbol	meaning	domain	where
F	windowed zero sum $F(u)$ of the ring-norm test	Riemann channel	RC-04
E	transfer matrix of a matrix product state (the Artin-Schreier transfer matrix is the instance of RC-06)	MPS, curves	RC-02
Ψ	periodic matrix product state on n sites	MPS	RC-02
$\langle \Psi \Psi \rangle$	ring norm of the periodic n -site state, $= \text{Tr } E^{\hat{\cdot}}_n$	MPS	RC-02
ℓ^c	k -th correlation length of a transfer matrix	MPS	RC-03
h	entropy per site (log of the leading eigenvalue)	MPS	RC-03
$\mathbb{F}_q$	finite field with q elements	curves	RC-01
$\mathbb{F}_p$	finite field with p elements	curves, LPS	Weil-RC-01
$\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$	extension of degree n	curves	RC-06
$\mathcal{S}$	exponential sum $S_n(g) = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_{q^n}} e_{-q}(\text{Tr } g(x))$	curves	RC-06
J	range of the quadratic Artin-Schreier polynomial, $\dim E = q^{\frac{1}{2}} J$	curves	RC-06
α	Frobenius eigenvalues (roots of the L -polynomial), $ \alpha = \sqrt{q}$	curves	RC-06
SL_2	special linear group	Weil-LPS	RC-05
PSL_2	projective special linear group	Weil-LPS	RC-05
W	Weil representation $W(g)$ of $SL_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ on $\ell^2_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$W_{\pm}$	even and odd blocks of the Weil representation, dimensions $(p \pm 1)/2$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
Φ	Weil-LPS channel for the LPS prime q (with superscript pm for the block)	Weil-LPS	RC-05
α	integer quaternion of norm q in the LPS normalisation	Weil-LPS	RC-05
g_{α}	image of the quaternion α in $SL_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
Z	clock operator on $\ell^2_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
X	shift operator on $\ell^2_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$\mathcal{F}$	Fourier transform on $\ell^2_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
M	chirp operator $\text{diag } e_p(x^2/2)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
D	dilation unitary on $\ell^2_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
I	splitting matrix $I = ((x, y), (y, -x))$ with $x^2 + y^2 + 1 = 0 \pmod{p}$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
J	splitting matrix $J = ((0, 1), (-1, 0))$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$T(u, v)$	Heisenberg-Weyl operator $X^{\hat{\cdot}}_u Z^{\hat{\cdot}}_v$	Weil-LPS	RC-05
c	pointwise weight scalar of a twisted coefficient system ($ \text{eigenvalue} = c^{\frac{1}{2}}$)	Deligne	RC-07
L	L -function (of a curve with coefficients, or Artin-Ihara)	graphs, curves	RC-02
(Γ'/Γ)	digamma function in the archimedean term of the explicit formula	number theory	RC-04
w	weight of a pure coefficient system ($ \text{Frobenius eigenvalue} = q^{\frac{1}{2}w}$)	Deligne	RC-07
$\text{tr}_{q^n/q}$	field trace from $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ to $\mathbb{F}_q$	curves	RC-06
Z_C	zeta function of a curve C over $\mathbb{F}_q$, $\exp \sum_n N_n u^{\frac{1}{n}} / n$	curves	RC-06

symbol	meaning	domain	where
G_w	Gaussian window width of the ring-norm test	Riemann channel	RC-04
F_W	zero-side function $\sum_{\rho} e^{\frac{1}{2}(\rho - 1/2)u}$ whose positive-definiteness is Weil's criterion	number theory	RC-03
$\vartheta.$	k-th oscillation frequency of a transfer matrix, $\lambda_k = \exp(-1/\ell \hat{c}_k + i \vartheta_k)$	MPS	RC-03
θ	generator of a normal basis of $F_{\{q\}^n}$	curves	RC-06
s_q	a square root of q modulo p	Weil-LPS	RC-05
$m.$	Bost-Connes isometry μ_n	Bost-Connes	RC-04
$U.$	Shor's unitary $x \rightarrow ax \bmod N$, the level-N Galois symmetry of Bost-Connes	Bost-Connes	RC-04
$\hat{g}$	test window in the explicit formula (Fourier transform g)	number theory	RC-04
t	semigroup time in $Z(t)$; dilation by $e^{\hat{t}}$	Riemann channel	RC-04
u	the zeta variable, in $\zeta_X(u)$, $\zeta_T(u)$, $Z_C(u)$, $\det(1 - uT)$	all	RC-01
$\ell^2(\cdot)$	Hilbert space of square-summable functions on a set	general	RC-01
$\mathcal{O}_{Dw}$	Dwork's p-adic transfer operator, multiplication by the splitting function then decimation	curves	RC-06
dec_q	decimation $x^{\hat{m}} \rightarrow x^{\{m/q\}}$ on p-adic power series	curves	RC-06
ℓ -adic	ell-adic (cohomology); this ell is not a walk length	Deligne	RC-06
$\mathcal{X}$	generator of the geodesic flow on $\Gamma \backslash G$, $X = H/2$ through left-invariant fields; $(e^{\hat{t}}\{-tX\}f)(m) = f(\phi_{\{-t\}}m)$	Selberg	RC-09B
H	left-invariant field of $H = \text{diag}(1, -1)$	Selberg	RC-09B
E	left-invariant field of $E = ((0,1), (1,0))$	Selberg	RC-09B
W	left-invariant field of $W = ((0,1), (-1,0))$, the compact direction	Selberg	RC-09B
Ω	Casimir $(1/4)(H^{\hat{2}} + E^{\hat{2}} - W^{\hat{2}})$	Selberg	RC-09B
Δ	positive hyperbolic Laplacian $-y^{\hat{2}}(d_x^{\hat{2}} + d_y^{\hat{2}})$	Selberg	RC-09B
$\lambda.$	j-th Laplace eigenvalue, $\lambda_j = 1/4 + r_j^{\hat{2}}$	Selberg	RC-09B
$r.$	spectral parameter of λ_j ; $r_0 = i/2$ for the constant mode, $r_j = i \nu_j$ for exceptional eigenvalues	Selberg	RC-09B
Z_{Sel}	Selberg zeta $\prod_{\gamma} \prod_{k \geq 0} (1 - e^{\hat{t}}\{-(s+k) \ell_{\gamma}\})$	Selberg	RC-09B
ζ_R	Ruelle zeta $\prod_{\gamma} (1 - e^{\hat{t}}\{-s \ell_{\gamma}\}) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(s)/Z_{\text{Sel}}(s+1)$	Selberg	RC-09B
P_{γ}	linearised Poincare map of the closed geodesic γ	Selberg	RC-09B
Tr^b	Guillemin flat trace	Selberg	RC-09B
ς	Laplace variable of the flat trace (the resonance variable), never the Selberg variable s	Selberg	RC-09B
Λ_{fl}	Laplace transform of the flat trace, $\int_0^{\infty} e^{\hat{t}}\{-\text{varsigma } t\} \text{Tr}\{\text{flat } e^{\hat{t}}\}\{-tX\} dt$	Selberg	RC-09B
D_{tow}	the tower $\prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\text{varsigma} + j)$, the flat dynamical determinant	Selberg	RC-09B

symbol	meaning	domain	where
$\mathcal{B}_0$	nonconstant first band $\{-1/2 + i r_j : j \geq 1\}$	Selberg	RC-09B
φ	scattering determinant of $\text{PSL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, $\sqrt{\pi} \Gamma(s-1/2) \zeta(2s-1) / (\Gamma(s) \zeta(2s))$	modular	RC-09B
m_{sc}	scattering multiplier $-(1/2)(\text{varphi}'/\text{varphi})(1/2 + i r)$	modular	RC-09B
C_{cusp}	inverse Fourier transform of the scattering multiplier	modular	RC-09B
P_+	positive-time prime measure $\sum_n \Lambda(n)/n \delta(t - 2 \log n)$	modular	RC-09B
P_{ch}	prime measure $\sum_n \Lambda(n) n^{\hat{\cdot}} \{-1/2\} \delta(t - 2 \log n)$ of the Riemann-channel note	modular	RC-09B
A_{arch}	archimedean-plus-boundary distribution $1/2 - 1/(4 \sinh(t /2))$ away from zero	modular	RC-09B
S_{triv}	trivial sub-multiset of the spectrum, removed before rescaling	Weil positivity	RC-08B
r	critical radius; $\sqrt{D-1}$ in the unitary Kraus case	Weil positivity	RC-08B
$\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$	retained multiset $\text{spec}(X)$ minus S_{triv} (algebraic multiplicities)	Weil positivity	RC-08B
$n.$	rescaled trace sequence $n_l = r^{\hat{\cdot}} \{-1\} (\text{Tr } X^{\hat{\cdot}} l - \sum \{S_{\text{triv}}\} \mu^{\hat{\cdot}} l)$, $n_{-1} = \text{conj}(n_l)$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
W	Weil (Toeplitz) form $\sum_{l,m} c_l \text{conj}(c_m) \nu_{\{-l-m\}}$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
M	mode-pairing form $\sum_{\mu} f_c(\mu/r) \text{conj}(f_c(J(\mu)/r))$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
J	reflection in the critical circle, $J(\mu) = r^{\hat{\cdot}} \{2/\text{conj}(\mu)\}$; fixed points $ \mu = r$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
$\mathcal{L}$	Lindblad-type generator $K x + x K^{\hat{\cdot}} \dagger + \sum_j R_j x R_j^{\hat{\cdot}} \dagger$ on M_n	Weil positivity	RC-08B
F	rescaled continuous trace $F(t) = e^{\hat{\cdot}} \{-at\} (\text{Tr } e^{\hat{\cdot}} \{tL\} - \text{trivial part})$, $F(-t) = \text{conj}(F(t))$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
a	critical real part, the line $\text{Re } \rho = a$; $a = -1/4$ for the Riemann channel	Weil positivity	RC-08B
$f.$	polynomial $f_c(z) = \sum_l c_l z^{\hat{\cdot}} l$ of a finitely supported coefficient vector c	Weil positivity	RC-08B
$R.$	reflection in the line $\text{Re } \rho = a$, $R_a(\rho) = 2a - \text{conj}(\rho)$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
ϖ	generic eigenvalue (mode) of a continuous transfer generator L	Weil positivity	RC-08C
$\varkappa$	eigenvalue of the unnormalised transfer matrix Σ (the prover's α); pairs with the two roots of $\mu^{\hat{\cdot}} \{2 - \alpha \mu + q\}$	Weil positivity	RC-08B
str	supertrace: trace on the even part minus trace on the odd part of a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded space	graded	RC-04B
comb	prime comb $\sum_{n \geq 2} \Lambda(n) \delta(u - \log n)$ on $(0, \infty)$	number theory	RC-04B
Tr_{dist}	distributional trace of the compressed semigroup, $\sum_{\rho} e^{\hat{\cdot}} \{-\text{conj}(\rho) t/2\}$, a definition by fiat	Riemann channel	RC-04B
ν_{net}	net signed multiplicity $m(\lambda, +) - m(\lambda, -)$ of a graded spectral datum	graded	RC-04B
$\mathfrak{B}$	Riemann graded bond $C_+ (+) (K_S (+) l^{\hat{\cdot}} \{2(N_{\geq 1})\})_-$	Riemann channel	RC-04B

symbol	meaning	domain	where
G	graded generator 0 (+) B (+) diag(-(k+1/2)) on the Riemann graded bond	Riemann channel	RC-04B
B	generator of the compressed semigroup, $Z(t) = e^{\hat{\{tB\}}}$	Riemann channel	RC-04B
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}}$	vacuum-decay Lindbladian on B(C (+) H): no-event part 0 (+) B, jump $ \text{vac}\rangle\langle j $	channels	RC-04C
vac	vacuum vector spanning the even line of the vacuum-decay model	channels	RC-04C
Ω_{vac}	vacuum density $ \text{vac}\rangle\langle\text{vac} $, the stationary state of the vacuum-decay Lindbladian	channels	RC-04C
$\mathcal{L}^{\text{pc}}$	prime-chain detailed-balance Lindbladian at inverse temperature β , jumps μ_p and $\mu_p\hat{\{}}\dagger$	Bost-Connes	RC-04C
ϱ^G	Bost-Connes Gibbs density $N\hat{\{}}\{-\beta\}/\zeta(\beta)$ on $l\hat{\{}}2(N)$	Bost-Connes	RC-04C
$\mathcal{S}_{\text{ent}}$	von Neumann entropy of a bond density (entanglement entropy of the half-line in the cMPS reading)	Bost-Connes	RC-04C
TFD.	thermofield-double purification of the Gibbs density	Bost-Connes	RC-04C
$\mathbb{E}$	super-transfer matrix of an Artin-Schreier curve: even block E_0 (+) (1), odd block the Frobenius blocks	curves	RC-06B
F	corrected Frobenius block of the character sum $S_n(g)$, $L(g, T) = \det(1 - T F_g)$	curves	RC-06B
Q°	ring quadratic form $\sum_j a_j \sum_i x_i x_{\{i+j\}}$ on $F_q\hat{\{}}n$ (indices mod n), matrix $P(S)$	curves	RC-06B
Q^{tr}	trace quadratic form $\text{tr}(g(x))$ in normal-basis coordinates, matrix $C P(S)$	curves	RC-06B
P	symmetrised coefficient Laurent polynomial $P_g(z) = \sum_j (a_j/2)(z^{\hat{\{}}j} + z^{\hat{\{}}\{-j\}})$	curves	RC-06B
S	cyclic shift $(S x)_i = x_{\{i+1\}}$ on $F_q\hat{\{}}n$, the Frobenius in normal-basis coordinates	curves	RC-06B
$\mathcal{R}$	radical $\ker P_g(S)$ of the ring form on $F_q\hat{\{}}n$	curves	RC-06B
δ	radical sign $\det(S \text{ restricted to the radical } R_n)$ in $\{+1, -1\}$	curves	RC-06B
h	period parameter: the smallest power of q strictly greater than the order of vanishing of $z\hat{\{}}J P_g(z)$ at -1	curves	RC-06B
d	rank deficiency of the ring form, $= \dim \ker(M_g\hat{\{}}n - 1)$, $= \log_q(S_n\hat{\{}}2/q\hat{\{}}n)$	curves	RC-06B
M	symplectic matrix in $\text{Sp}(2J, F_q)$ implemented by the transfer unitary $E_g/\sqrt{q}$	curves	RC-06B
X	centred Weyl operator $X_{\{u,v\}} s\rangle = e_q(v.(s + u/2)) s + u\rangle$ on $l\hat{\{}}2(F_q\hat{\{}}J)$	curves	RC-06B
$\mathcal{U}$	transfer unitary $E_g/\sqrt{q}$	curves	RC-06B
Sp	symplectic group	curves	RC-06B
D	transfer determinant $D_g(T) = \det(1 - T E_g)$	curves	RC-06B
$\mathcal{Z}$	graded geodesic determinant (total zeta) of a complex with specified geodesic data	complexes	RC-02D
sdet	superdeterminant (Berezinian) of an even operator on a Z_2 -graded space	graded, complexes	RC-02D

symbol	meaning	domain	where
$\mathfrak{S}$	finite set of particle species of a boson-fermion cMPS	cMPS	RC-02F
$\mathfrak{F}$	graded Fock space over $L\hat{\{ \}}2([0,L))$ for the species set	cMPS	RC-02F
$\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$	Fock vacuum	cMPS	RC-02F
$(-1)^{\hat{F}}$	fermion parity operator on the Fock space	cMPS	RC-02F
$\Delta_{\cdot}^{<}$	open ordered simplex $\{0 < x_1 < \dots < x_n < L\}$	cMPS	RC-02F
$\mathcal{K}_{\cdot}$	ordered amplitude space $L\hat{\{ \}}2(\text{ordered simplex } x \text{ species}\hat{\{ \}}n)$	cMPS	RC-02F
$\mathcal{J}$	isometry from ordered amplitudes into the Fock space	cMPS	RC-04E
$\Psi_{\cdot}^c$	cMPS ring vector with boundary matrix B	cMPS	RC-02F
$c_{\cdot}$	n-particle amplitude $c\hat{\{ \}}B_n$ of a cMPS ring vector	cMPS	RC-02F
$\mathbb{T}$	cMPS transfer generator $Q(x)1 + 1(x)\text{conj } Q + \sum_a s_a R_a(x) \text{conj } R_a$ on the doubled bond (subscript eta: fermionic signs)	cMPS	RC-02F
Γ_b	doubled-bond parity $P(x) \text{conj } P$	cMPS	RC-02F
$\Pi_{\cdot}$	bond parity sector projections $(1 \pm P)/2$	cMPS	RC-02F
$\mathcal{E}_d$	doubled transfer matrix $\sum_s A_s(x) \text{conj } A_s$ of a graded lattice tensor	MPS, graded	RC-02G
$\mathcal{E}_d^{(\cdot)}$	restriction of the doubled transfer to the Γ_b -sector $k = 0$ (even) or 1 (odd)	graded manujan	Ra- RC-02H
r_P	P-mode eigenvalue under parity-twisted unitality: $\sum_s \text{eps}_s A_s A_s^{\dagger} = r_P 1$, $E(P) = r_P P$	graded manujan	Ra- RC-02H
rad	spectral radius of an operator	graded manujan	Ra- RC-02H
v	irreducible constituent of a tensor product of representations (a sector of the doubled bond)	graded manujan	Ra- RC-03C
$U_{\cdot}^h$	horocyclic left-invariant fields $U_+ = (E + W)/2$, $U_- = (E - W)/2$ of Dyatlov-Faure-Guillarmou, $[X, U_{\pm}] = \text{pm } U_{\pm}$, $[U_+, U_-] = 2X$	Selberg	RC-03E
$\text{Res}_{\mathcal{X}}^0$	first-band resonant states $\{u : (X + \lambda)u = 0, U_- u = 0\}$	Selberg	RC-03E
σ_{Δ}	Laplace eigenvalue $\sigma = s(1-s)$ of the surface in the Selberg-letters shard, with multiplicity d_{σ}	Selberg	RC-03E
τ_s	sampling time of the geodesic flow (lattice step) in the Selberg-letters shard	Selberg	RC-03E
Λ^Y	Maass-Selberg truncation of an Eisenstein series at height Y	modular	RC-03F
Ω	rebound density inside the model space (reinsertion state of the renewal generator)	Riemann channel	RC-04H
s	density (state) on the model space in the renewal channel, also the target density of the inverse problem	Riemann channel	RC-04H
v	generic vector of the model space in the exit and orbit-state formulas	Riemann channel	RC-04H

3 Definitions

Each definition appears exactly once in the book. The column `merged_from` of `db/definitions.tsv` lists the notes and sections whose wordings were merged; where the wordings differed in substance, the difference is stated in the definition.

3.1 The two sides

Definition 3.1 (Side A and side B). For a zeta function written as $\exp \sum_{\ell \geq 1} N_\ell u^\ell / \ell$ with nonnegative counts N_ℓ , *side A* is the gas of rings: the counts, their Euler product over primitive closed orbits, and the product state they form. *Side B* is a transfer operator whose power sums reproduce the counts, $N_\ell = \text{Tr } T^\ell$ (or a semigroup $\text{Tr } e^{\text{L}\mathcal{G}}$ in continuous length); its eigenvalues are the poles and zeros.

Definition 3.2 (The one identity). For any matrix M with eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N$, $1/\det(1-uM) = \prod_i (1 - \lambda_i u)^{-1} = \exp \left(\sum_{\ell \geq 1} \text{Tr}(M^\ell) u^\ell / \ell \right)$. The middle term is a bosonic partition function with one mode per eigenvector; the right term a sum over closed walks with the $1/\ell$ of a ring's rotation symmetry.

Definition 3.3 (Small matrix). For a shift or permutation with fixed-point counts $\text{fix}(\ell)$ of its ℓ -th power, a *small matrix* is any matrix M_{small} with $\text{Tr } M_{\text{small}}^\ell = \text{fix}(\ell)$ for all ℓ . It exists exactly when the zeta function is rational, and its eigenvalues are not those of the permutation matrix.

Definition 3.4 (RH analogue, Ramanujan property). A side-B operator with leading eigenvalue $\lambda_{\max}$ (or leading growth q per step) satisfies the *RH analogue* when every other nonzero eigenvalue has modulus $\sqrt{\lambda_{\max}}$ (respectively $\sqrt{q}$). In counting terms the fluctuation of the counts is the square root of the leading term. For graphs this is the Ramanujan property; for the Riemann zeta it is the Riemann hypothesis; for an MPS it is one correlation length equal to $2/h$.

3.2 Graphs

Definition 3.5 (Non-backtracking walk, prime cycle). A walk in a graph is non-backtracking if it never immediately retraces an edge; closed in the strong sense means the last step is not the reverse of the first. A *prime cycle* P is a closed non-backtracking walk that is not a repetition of a shorter one, taken up to choice of starting point; $\ell(P)$ is its length. On a bouquet with $D/2$ loops the directed edges are $[D]$ and a closed non-backtracking walk is a cyclically reduced word.

Definition 3.6 (Ihara zeta). For a finite graph X with N_ℓ closed non-backtracking walks of length ℓ , $\zeta_X(u) = \exp \left(\sum_{\ell} N_\ell u^\ell / \ell \right) = \prod_P (1 - u^{\ell(P)})^{-1}$.

Definition 3.7 (Hashimoto operator). The *Hashimoto* (non-backtracking edge) operator of a graph is the matrix T on directed edges with $T_{ef} = 1$ when f can follow e without backtracking; then $N_\ell = \text{Tr } T^\ell$ and $\zeta_X(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$.

Definition 3.8 (Ihara–Bass formula). For a $(q+1)$ -regular graph with adjacency matrix A on $|V|$ vertices and $|E|$ undirected edges, $\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{|E| - |V|} \det(1 - uA + qu^2)$. Each adjacency eigenvalue λ produces two eigenvalues μ, μ' of T with $\mu\mu' = q$, $\mu + \mu' = \lambda$; the eigenvalue $q+1$ gives $\mu \in \{q, 1\}$.

Definition 3.9 (Ramanujan graph). A $(q+1)$ -regular graph is *Ramanujan* when every adjacency eigenvalue other than $\pm(q+1)$ satisfies $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$, the spectral radius of the universal covering tree. Equivalently all nontrivial μ satisfy $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$, which is the RH analogue for ζ_X .

Definition 3.10 (Artin–Ihara L -function). For a graph with a representation ϱ of its fundamental group assigned to closed walks (a holonomy), $L(u, \varrho) = \prod_P \det(1 - \varrho(P)u^{\ell(P)})^{-1}$, where the product is over prime cycles. For a bouquet the fundamental group is free and ϱ is a choice of one operator per loop.

3.3 Channels and matrix product states

Definition 3.11 (Channel, Kraus operators). A *channel* on M_n is a completely positive trace-preserving map $\Phi(X) = \sum_i A_i X A_i^\dagger$ with $\sum_i A_i^\dagger A_i = 1$; the A_i are its Kraus operators. It is *unital* when $\Phi(1) = 1$ and *mixed-unitary* when $A_i = D^{-1/2} U_i$ with unitary U_i , in which case $\Phi(X) = \frac{1}{D} \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$ and the family is taken closed under adjoint.

Definition 3.12 (Transfer matrix of an MPS). For a matrix product state with local tensors $A_1, \dots, A_d \in M_n$ (physical dimension d , bond dimension n), the *transfer matrix* is $E = \sum_i \text{Ad}(A_i) = \Sigma$, acting on M_n .

Definition 3.13 (Ring norm). The *ring norm* of the periodic n -site state Ψ_n built from the tensors is $\langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle = \text{Tr } E^n$; the zeta function of the state is the generating function $\exp \sum_n \langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle u^n / n = \det(1 - uE)^{-1}$.

Definition 3.14 (Canonical form). An MPS is in (left) canonical form when $\sum_k A_k^\dagger A_k = 1$, i.e. when E is the transfer matrix of a channel; then E has leading eigenvalue 1 and the remaining eigenvalues lie in the closed unit disc.

Definition 3.15 (Correlation length). In canonical form write the subleading eigenvalues as $\lambda_k = e^{-1/\ell_k^c + i\vartheta_k}$; the ℓ_k^c are the correlation lengths and the ϑ_k the phases. The entropy per site is $h = \log \lambda_{\max}$ of the unnormalised transfer matrix.

Definition 3.16 (Quantum expander). A channel with D Kraus operators is a (n, D, λ) *quantum expander* when 1 is its unique fixed point (up to scale) and every other eigenvalue has modulus at most $\lambda < 1$.

Definition 3.17 (Ramanujan quantum expander). A quantum expander is *Ramanujan* when $\lambda_2 \leq \lambda_H$, where, in Hastings' words, $\lambda_H = \frac{2\sqrt{D-1}}{D}$. (provenance `prov:hastings07-bound`); in adjacency units, $D\lambda_2 \leq 2\sqrt{D-1}$.

Definition 3.18 (Quantum Hashimoto operator, quantum Ihara zeta). For superoperators $\mathcal{E}_1, \dots, \mathcal{E}_D$ on $\mathcal{V}$ and a fixed-point-free reversal ι on $[D]$, the *quantum Hashimoto operator* is T on $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$, $T(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \iota i} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$, and $\zeta_T(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$. For a mixed-unitary channel, $\mathcal{E}_i = \text{Ad}(U_i)$ with $U_{\bar{i}} = U_i^\dagger$, and the zeta is written ζ_Φ : the *quantum Ihara zeta* of the channel. It is the Artin–Ihara L -function of the bouquet twisted by $\varrho = \text{Ad} \circ U$.

4 Definitions, Continued

Continuation of Section 3; split for length only.

4.1 The Riemann channel

Definition 4.1 (Scattering symbol). With $\xi(s) = \frac{1}{2}s(s-1)\pi^{-s/2}\Gamma(s/2)\zeta(s)$ and τ the Mellin variable on the dilation group, the *scattering symbol* of the modular surface is $S(\tau) = \xi(1-2i\tau)/\xi(1+2i\tau)$.

Definition 4.2 (Inner function, model space, compressed semigroup). A function analytic and bounded by 1 in the lower half plane with unimodular boundary values is *inner*. For inner S the *model space* is $K_S = H^2 \ominus SH^2$ and the *compressed semigroup* is $Z(t) = P_{K_S} e^{it\tau}|_{K_S}$, $t > 0$.

Definition 4.3 (Riemann channel). The *Riemann channel* is the completely positive semigroup $X \mapsto Z(t)^* X Z(t)$ on $B(K_S)$, whose single Kraus operator is the compressed semigroup of the scattering symbol. Its modes are the zeros of ζ and its distributional trace is the prime measure; the name is also used loosely for the whole side-A/side-B package of the Riemann zeta.

Definition 4.4 (Weil explicit formula). For a test window $\hat{g}$ with transform g , $\sum_{\gamma} \hat{g}(\gamma) = \hat{g}(\frac{i}{2}) + \hat{g}(-\frac{i}{2}) - g(0) \log \pi + \frac{1}{2\pi} \int \hat{g}(r) \operatorname{Re}(\Gamma'/\Gamma)(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{ir}{2}) dr - 2 \sum_n \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} g(\log n)$, the sum on the left over the ordinates of the nontrivial zeros.

Definition 4.5 (Bost–Connes system, Lévy exponent). The *Bost–Connes system* is the C^* -dynamical system generated by the phase operators $e(a/b)$ and the isometries $\mathbf{m}_n$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{N})$, with time evolution scaling $\mathbf{m}_n$ by n^{it} ; its $\operatorname{KMS}_{\beta}$ states for $\beta > 1$ have partition function $\zeta(\beta)$ and $\beta = 1$ is its phase transition. Its *Lévy exponent* at real part σ is $\kappa_{\sigma}(\tau) = \log \zeta(\sigma - i\tau) - \log \zeta(\sigma)$, the cumulant generating function of the zeta distribution, with jump measure ν_{σ} .

Definition 4.6 (Matrix product operator over the prime chain). Writing $\ell^2(\mathbb{N}) = \bigotimes_p$ (oscillator at p), an operator is a *matrix product operator over the prime chain* when it is a contraction of one local tensor per prime with a bond space carried between consecutive primes; for $e(a/b)$ the bond space is $\mathbb{Z}/b$ and the local transfer map is $r \mapsto p^k r$.

Definition 4.7 (Hilbert–Pólya operator). On the subleading sector of the length flow write $\mathcal{G} = -\frac{1}{2} + iH$; H is the *Hilbert–Pólya operator*, with eigenvalues $\gamma_n - i(\sigma_n - \frac{1}{2})$. It is not the entanglement Hamiltonian of any state.

Definition 4.8 (Weil positivity). *Weil’s criterion*: the Riemann hypothesis holds iff $F_W(u) = \sum_{\rho} e^{(\rho-1/2)u}$ is positive-definite on the dilation group, i.e. iff its spectral measure $\sum_{\rho} \delta_{t_{\rho}}$ is a positive measure on the real line.

4.2 Weil–LPS channels

Definition 4.9 (LPS generators). For a prime $q \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$, the *LPS generators* are the $q+1$ integer quaternions $\alpha = a_0 + a_1 i + a_2 j + a_3 k$ of norm q with $a_0 > 0$ odd and a_1, a_2, a_3 even; they generate a $(q+1)$ -regular tree, and their images g_{α} in $\operatorname{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ (for q a square mod p , after division by s_q) are the generators of the LPS Cayley graph.

Definition 4.10 (Weil representation). The *Weil representation* W of $\operatorname{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is the projective unitary representation characterised by $W(g) T(u, v) W(g)^{\dagger} \propto T(g(u, v))$ for the Heisenberg–Weyl operators $T(u, v) = X^u Z^v$; it is generated by $\mathcal{F}$, $\mathbf{M}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ and splits into the blocks $W_{\pm}$ of dimensions $(p \pm 1)/2$ on which -1 acts as a scalar.

Definition 4.11 (Weil–LPS channel). For admissible $(p; q)$ the *Weil–LPS channel* is $\Phi_q^\pm(X) = \frac{1}{q+1} \sum_\alpha W_\pm(g_\alpha) X W_\pm(g_\alpha)^\dagger$ on $M_{(p\pm 1)/2}$: Harrow’s construction with the Weil representation and LPS generators.

Definition 4.12 (Hecke relation). The adjacency operators A_q of the LPS Cayley graph satisfy $A_q^2 - q1 = A_{q^2}$ and $A_{q_1}A_{q_2} = A_{q_1q_2}$, the tree relations “two steps without backtracking” and multiplicativity; the Weil–LPS channels for different q commute.

4.3 Curves

Definition 4.13 (Artin–Schreier curve, exponential sum). For $g \in \mathbb{F}_q[x]$ the *Artin–Schreier curve* is $y^q - y = g(x)$; its affine point count over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ is $N_n = q^n + \sum_{a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times} \mathcal{S}_n(ag)$ with the *exponential sum* $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_{q^n}} e_q(\text{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x))$. The quadratic family is $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$.

Definition 4.14 (Self-dual normal basis). A basis $\{\theta, \theta^q, \dots, \theta^{q^{n-1}}\}$ of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ is *normal*; Frobenius is then the cyclic shift of coordinates. It is *self-dual* when $\text{tr}_{q^n/q}(ab) = \sum_i a_i b_i$; such bases exist for n odd.

Definition 4.15 (Dwork transfer operator). *Dwork’s operator* is $\mathcal{O}_{\text{Dw}} = \text{dec}_q \circ M_F$ on p -adic power series, multiplication by the splitting function M_F followed by the decimation $\text{dec}_q : x^m \mapsto x^{m/q}$; $\mathcal{S}_n^\times = (q^n - 1) \text{Tr } \mathcal{O}_{\text{Dw}}^n$ and L is its Fredholm determinant.

Definition 4.16 (Pure of weight, big monodromy, slicing, the sign). A coefficient system on a curve over $\mathbb{F}_q$ is *pure of weight* w when every eigenvalue of every holonomy of a prime cycle of length ℓ has modulus $q^{w\ell/2}$; it has *big monodromy* when the only invariants of its even tensor powers are the pairwise contractions by the given pairing. *Slicing* writes the middle block of a variety as the interesting block of a base curve with coefficients from hyperplane sections. *The sign* is the minus sign with which the interesting block enters the point count, so that its eigenvalues are zeros, not poles, of Z_C .

Definition 4.17 (Status vocabulary). The tags `proved`, `sketched`, `numerical`, `cited`, `conjectured`, `open`, `refuted`, `assumed`, with the derived forms `unsupported` and `-conditional`, as fixed in Section 2 of the frontmatter; definitions are `stipulated` or `quoted`.

4.4 The continuous dictionary

Definition 4.18 (Geodesic flow on the unit tangent bundle). For $\Gamma < \text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ discrete, torsion-free and cocompact, the unit tangent bundle of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ is $\Gamma \backslash G$ with $G = \text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, and the *geodesic flow* is $\phi_t(\Gamma g) = \Gamma g a_t$, $a_t = \text{diag}(e^{t/2}, e^{-t/2})$. Its generator is $\mathcal{X} = H/2$ through the left-invariant fields H, E, W of the basis H, E, W of $\mathfrak{sl}_2$, and the Koopman operator is $(e^{-t\mathcal{X}} f)(m) = f(\phi_{-t} m)$. Primitive closed geodesics γ have lengths ℓ_γ and opposite orientations are not identified.

Definition 4.19 (Selberg zeta, Ruelle zeta). $Z_{\text{Sel}}(s) = \prod_\gamma \prod_{k \geq 0} (1 - e^{-(s+k)\ell_\gamma})$, in Marklof’s words $Z(s) = \prod_{\{\gamma \in H_*\}} \prod_{m=0}^\infty (1 - e^{-(s+m)\ell_\gamma})$, (provenance `prov:marklof04-selbergzeta`), and the *Ruelle zeta* in the direct-product convention is $\zeta_R(s) = \prod_\gamma (1 - e^{-s\ell_\gamma})$.

Definition 4.20 (Guillemin flat trace). For an Anosov flow with closed orbits γ , primitive periods ℓ_γ and linearised Poincaré maps P_γ , the *flat trace* of the Koopman operator is the distribution on $t > 0$ $\text{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}} = \sum_\gamma \sum_{k \geq 1} \ell_\gamma \delta(t - k\ell_\gamma) / |\det(1 - P_\gamma^k)|$ (Dyatlov–Zworski, provenance `prov:dz13-guillemin`). It is not a trace-class Hilbert-space trace.

Definition 4.21 (Flat dynamical determinant, first band). $A_{\text{fl}}(\varsigma) = \int_0^\infty e^{-\varsigma t} \text{Tr}^\flat e^{-t\mathcal{X}} dt$ for $\text{Re } \varsigma > 0$, and the *tower* $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma) = \prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\varsigma + j)$. *Trace resonances* are the poles of the continued A_{fl} . The *nonconstant first band* is $\mathcal{B}_0 = \{-\frac{1}{2} \pm ir_j : j \geq 1\}$, with $\lambda_j = \frac{1}{4} + r_j^2$ the Laplace eigenvalues and $r_0 = i/2$ for the constant mode excluded.

Definition 4.22 (Scattering determinant of the modular group). $\varphi(s) = \sqrt{\pi} \Gamma(s - \frac{1}{2}) \zeta(2s - 1) / (\Gamma(s) \zeta(2s))$, in the source's words In the case when Γ is the modular group $\text{PSL}(2, \mathbb{Z})$, the scattering determinant is given by $\phi(s) = \sqrt{\pi} \frac{\Gamma(s - 1/2)}{\Gamma(s)} \frac{\zeta(2s - 1)}{\zeta(2s)}$, (provenance prov:fjs16-scatt) the *scattering multiplier* is $m_{\text{sc}}(r) = -\frac{1}{2}(\varphi'/\varphi)(\frac{1}{2} + ir)$ and $C_{\text{cusp}} = \mathcal{F}^{-1} m_{\text{sc}}$ with $\mathcal{F}^{-1} b(t) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int e^{irt} b(r) dr$.

Definition 4.23 (Prime comb measures). $P_+(t) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} \delta(t - 2 \log n)$ and $P_{\text{ch}}(t) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \Lambda(n) n^{-1/2} \delta(t - 2 \log n)$ on $(0, \infty)$, locally finite measures; A_{arch} is the archimedean-plus-boundary distribution of Proposition 46.5, equal to $\frac{1}{2} - 1/(4 \sinh(|t|/2))$ away from $t = 0$.

Definition 4.24 (Trivial set, critical radius, rescaled trace sequence). For a linear operator X on a finite-dimensional complex space, $\text{spec}(X)$ is its spectrum as a multiset with algebraic multiplicities, so $\text{Tr } X^\ell = \sum_{\mu \in \text{spec}(X)} \mu^\ell$. A *trivial set* S_{triv} is a sub-multiset of $\text{spec}(X)$; the *retained multiset* is $\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}} = \text{spec}(X) \setminus S_{\text{triv}}$ (multiplicities subtracted). For a *critical radius* $r > 0$ the *rescaled trace sequence* is $\mathbf{n}_\ell = r^{-\ell} (\text{Tr } X^\ell - \sum_{\mu \in S_{\text{triv}}} \mu^\ell) = \sum_{\mu \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}} (\mu/r)^\ell$ for $\ell \geq 0$ (with $0^0 = 1$), extended by $\mathbf{n}_{-\ell} = \overline{\mathbf{n}_\ell}$. A sequence with this symmetry is *positive definite* if $\sum_{\ell, k=0}^L c_\ell \bar{c}_k \mathbf{n}_{\ell-k} \geq 0$ for every L and every $c \in \mathbb{C}^{L+1}$.

Definition 4.25 (Weil form, reflection, mode-pairing form). With the data of Definition 4.24, the *Weil form* of X is the Toeplitz form $W(c) = \sum_{\ell, k} c_\ell \bar{c}_k \mathbf{n}_{\ell-k}$ on finitely supported coefficient vectors c , and $f_c(z) = \sum_\ell c_\ell z^\ell$. The *reflection in the critical circle* is $J(\mu) = r^2/\bar{\mu}$ on $\mathbb{C}^\times$; its fixed points are the circle $|\mu| = r$. When $0 \notin \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$ the *mode-pairing form* is $M(c) = \sum_{\mu \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}} f_c(\mu/r) \overline{f_c(J(\mu)/r)}$: each mode paired with its reflected partner.

Definition 4.26 (Adjoint pairing and inverse pairing). A family $\mathcal{E}_i = \text{Ad}(B_i)$, $i \in [D]$, with reversal ι is *adjoint-paired* if $B_{\bar{i}} = B_i^\dagger$ and *inverse-paired* if every B_i is invertible and $B_{\bar{i}} = B_i^{-1}$ (so $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} = \mathcal{E}_i^{-1}$, the hypothesis of Corollary 37.3). The Kraus families of Definition 3.18 are the adjoint-paired ones.

Definition 4.27 (Rescaled continuous trace). For a linear operator $\mathcal{L}$ on a finite-dimensional complex space, a trivial set $S_{\text{triv}} \subseteq \text{spec}(\mathcal{L})$ and a real number a , the *rescaled continuous trace* is $F(t) = e^{-at} (\text{Tr } e^{t\mathcal{L}} - \sum_{\varpi \in S_{\text{triv}}} e^{t\varpi}) = \sum_{\varpi \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}} e^{t(\varpi-a)}$ for $t \geq 0$, extended by $F(-t) = \overline{F(t)}$. A function with this symmetry is *positive definite* if $\sum_{j, k} c_j \bar{c}_k F(t_j - t_k) \geq 0$ for all finite families of real times and complex coefficients. The *reflection in the line* $\text{Re } \varpi = a$ is $R_a(\varpi) = 2a - \bar{\varpi}$.

5 Definitions, Continued: the Phantasm Campaign

Continuation of Section 4; split for length only.

Definition 5.1 (Graded spectral datum, supertrace distribution, net multiplicity). A *graded spectral datum* is a countable multiset of pairs (λ, ϵ) , $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$, $\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$ the *parity*, with multiplicities $m(\lambda, \epsilon) \in \mathbb{N}$, such that $\operatorname{Re} \lambda \leq c$ for some real c and $\sum m(\lambda, \epsilon)(1 + |\lambda|)^{-N} < \infty$ for some N . Its *supertrace distribution* is $\operatorname{str} e^{tG} := \sum \epsilon m(\lambda, \epsilon) e^{\lambda t}$ on $(0, \infty)$, and its *net multiplicity* is $\nu_{\text{net}}(\lambda) = m(\lambda, +1) - m(\lambda, -1)$. Two data with the same ν_{net} are *equivalent up to cancelling pairs*. For a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded operator the supertrace is the trace on the even part minus the trace on the odd part.

Definition 5.2 (Distributional trace of the compressed semigroup, prime comb). $\operatorname{Tr}_{\text{dist}} Z(t) := \sum_{\rho} e^{-\bar{\rho}t/2}$, the sum over all nontrivial zeros with multiplicity, is a distribution on $(0, \infty)$ (Lemma 18.3); this is a definition by fiat, not an application of a trace theorem to $Z(t)$. The *prime comb* is $\operatorname{comb}(u) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \Lambda(n) \delta(u - \log n)$, so that $e^{-t/2} \operatorname{comb}(t/2) = 2P_+(t)$.

Definition 5.3 (Riemann graded bond and generator). $\mathfrak{B} = \mathbb{C}_+ \oplus (K_S \oplus \ell^2(\mathbb{N}_{\geq 1}))_-$, the even line spanned by the fixed vector and the odd part the model space together with an *archimedean ladder*; $G = 0 \oplus B \oplus \operatorname{diag}(-(k + \frac{1}{2}))_{k \geq 1}$, where $Z(t) = e^{tB}$ is the compressed semigroup.

Definition 5.4 (Vacuum-decay Lindbladian, absorbing-vacuum channel). For a Hilbert space H , B on H and an exit vector j with $-(B + B^\dagger) = |j\rangle\langle j|$, the *vacuum-decay Lindbladian* on $B(\mathbb{C}\text{vac} \oplus H)$ is $\mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}}(x) = \bar{B}x + x\bar{B}^\dagger + JxJ^\dagger$ with $\bar{B} = 0 \oplus B$ and $J = |\text{vac}\rangle\langle j|$; $\Omega_{\text{vac}} = |\text{vac}\rangle\langle \text{vac}|$. The grading is vac even, H odd. The *absorbing-vacuum channel* of a strongly stable contraction semigroup Z_t is $x \mapsto (1 \oplus Z_t)x(1 \oplus Z_t)^\dagger + \operatorname{Tr}[(1 - Z_t^\dagger Z_t)X] \Omega_{\text{vac}}$, X the H -block of x .

Definition 5.5 (Prime-chain detailed-balance Lindbladian). With $\mathfrak{m}_p|n\rangle = |pn\rangle$ the isometries of the Bost–Connes representation and rates $r_p > 0$,

$$\mathcal{L}_\beta^{\text{pc}}(x) = \sum_p r_p (\mathfrak{m}_p x \mathfrak{m}_p^\dagger - \tfrac{1}{2} \{\mathfrak{m}_p^\dagger \mathfrak{m}_p, x\}) + \sum_p r_p p^\beta (\mathfrak{m}_p^\dagger x \mathfrak{m}_p - \tfrac{1}{2} \{\mathfrak{m}_p \mathfrak{m}_p^\dagger, x\}),$$

in the Schrödinger convention; its diagonal part is the multiplicative birth–death process $n \rightarrow pn$ at rate r_p , $n \rightarrow n/p$ at rate $r_p p^\beta$. The Gibbs density is $\varrho_\beta^G = N^{-\beta}/\zeta(\beta)$.

Definition 5.6 (Entanglement Hamiltonian and entropy of a bond density). For a bond density X (the fixed point of a cMPS transfer generator, which by cited fact 19.3 carries the squared Schmidt coefficients of a bipartition) the *entanglement Hamiltonian* is $-\log X$, its spectrum the *entanglement spectrum*, and the *entanglement entropy* is $\mathcal{S}_{\text{ent}}(X) = -\operatorname{Tr} X \log X$; TFD_β denotes the thermofield-double purification of ϱ_β^G .

Definition 5.7 (Ring form, trace form, radical, radical sign, period parameter). For $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$ over $\mathbb{F}_q$, q an odd prime, on $V = \mathbb{F}_q^n$ with cyclic indices let $\mathbb{S}$ be the shift $(\mathbb{S}x)_i = x_{i+1}$ and $\mathbb{P}_g(z) = \sum_j \frac{a_j}{2} (z^j + z^{-j})$. The *ring form* is $Q_g^\circ(x) = \sum_j a_j \sum_i x_i x_{i+j} = x^t \mathbb{P}_g(\mathbb{S})x$; the *trace form* in the coordinates of a normal basis θ is $Q_g^{\text{tr}}(x) = \operatorname{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x) = x^t C \mathbb{P}_g(\mathbb{S})x$ with $C_{ik} = \operatorname{tr}_{q^n/q}(\theta^{q^i} \theta^{q^k})$ the (symmetric, invertible, circulant) Gram matrix. The *radical* is $\mathcal{R}_n = \ker \mathbb{P}_g(\mathbb{S})$, the *radical sign* $\delta_n = \det(\mathbb{S}|_{\mathcal{R}_n}) \in \{\pm 1\}$ ($= 1$ if $\mathcal{R}_n = 0$), $d_n = \dim \mathcal{R}_n$, and the *period parameter* h is the smallest power of q strictly greater than the order of vanishing of $z^J \mathbb{P}_g(z)$ at $z = -1$.

Definition 5.8 (Super-transfer matrix of an Artin–Schreier curve). $\mathbb{E} = (E_0 \oplus 1)_+ \oplus (\bigoplus_{a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times} F_{ag})_-$, where E_0 is the transfer matrix of the zero polynomial (the de Bruijn adjacency matrix of memory

J , or the scalar q when $J = 0$), the summand 1 is the point at infinity, and F_g is the *Frobenius block* of the character sum: the diagonal $q^J \times q^J$ matrix with $L(g, u) = \det(1 - uF_g)$ (Theorem 29.7). The point count is its supertrace, $N_n = \text{str } \mathbb{E}^n$.

Definition 5.9 (Centred Weyl operators, symplectic transfer map, Weil implementer). On $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_q^J)$ the *centred Weyl operators* are $X_{u,v}|s\rangle = e_q(v \cdot (s + u/2))|s + u\rangle$, $(u, v) \in \mathbb{F}_q^{2J}$. The *transfer unitary* is $\mathcal{U}_g = E_g/\sqrt{q}$; its *symplectic transfer map* $M_g \in \text{Sp}(2J, \mathbb{F}_q)$ is defined by $\mathcal{U}_g X_{u,v} \mathcal{U}_g^{-1} = X_{M_g(u,v)}$ (Theorem 29.13). A *Weil implementer* of $M \in \text{Sp}(2J, \mathbb{F}_q)$ is a unitary $W(M)$ with $W(M)X_{u,v}W(M)^{-1} = X_{M(u,v)}$; it is determined up to a scalar (cited fact 29.10), and $D_g(u) = \det(1 - uE_g)$.

6 Definitions, Continued: Flows on Complexes and their Twists

Continuation of Section 5; split for length only. Throughout, X is a finite abstract simplicial complex of dimension d with face numbers $f_0, \dots, f_d$ and Euler characteristic $\chi(X) = \sum_i (-1)^i f_i$, and $s_k = (-1)^{k+1}$.

Definition 6.1 (Ordered k -cell, ordered geodesic flow). An *ordered k -cell* of X is a tuple $[v_0, \dots, v_k]$ of distinct vertices whose underlying set is a k -simplex of X . Write $\mathcal{O}_k$ for the set of ordered k -cells, so $|\mathcal{O}_k| = (k+1)! f_k$, and $H_k = \mathbb{C}^{\mathcal{O}_k}$. The *ordered geodesic flow* is the operator T_k on H_k , $1 \leq k \leq d$,

$$T_k[v_0, \dots, v_k] = \sum_{\substack{w \notin \{v_0, \dots, v_k\} \\ \{v_1, \dots, v_k, w\} \in X, \{v_0, \dots, v_k, w\} \notin X}} [v_1, \dots, v_k, w] :$$

drop the oldest vertex, append a new one keeping the ordered overlap, and forbid the step that a $(k+1)$ -cell would short-cut. For $d = 1$ this is exactly the Hashimoto operator of Definition 3.7, and the excluded vertex is the immediately previous one.

Definition 6.2 (Pointed facet, opposition successor, algebraic length). Let X be a finite quotient of the Bruhat–Tits building $\mathcal{B}$ of PGL_n over a local field with residue order q , carrying the cyclic type structure of the affine diagram $\tilde{A}_{n-1}$. A *pointed k -facet* is a k -simplex with a distinguished vertex; ordering it cyclically in increasing type from that vertex gives its *ordered type*, a positive composition $(\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_k)$ of n , and its *algebraic step length* is λ_0 . Write P_k for the set of pointed k -facets, so $|P_k| = (k+1)f_k$. A *successor* shifts the ordering and crosses to a vertex *opposite* in the spherical link of the common $(k-1)$ -facet; the *pointed opposition flow* is

$$\mathsf{T}_k(u)[\sigma] = u^{\lambda_0(\sigma)} \sum_{\tau \in \mathrm{Succ}(\sigma)} [\tau] \quad \text{on } \mathbb{C}^{P_k}.$$

Opposition is strictly stronger than the non-cell condition of Definition 6.1, and the exponent u^{λ_0} is a *length*, never a matrix power or a multiplicity.

Definition 6.3 (Graded geodesic determinant, total zeta of a complex). *Geodesic data* $\mathfrak{g}$ on X is, in each degree $1 \leq k \leq d$: a finite state set $\mathcal{S}_k$, a successor relation with incidence multiplicities, a positive integer algebraic length $\ell_k(\sigma)$, and a step transport $U_{\sigma\tau}$ on a finite-dimensional fibre V . Give the whole degree- k space $V \otimes \mathbb{C}^{\mathcal{S}_k}$ parity $k+1$, put $\mathsf{T}_k^U(u)(v \otimes [\sigma]) = \sum_{\sigma \rightsquigarrow \tau} u^{\ell_k(\sigma)} U_{\sigma\tau} v \otimes [\tau]$, and let $W = \bigoplus_{k=1}^d V \otimes \mathbb{C}^{\mathcal{S}_k}$. The *graded geodesic determinant* (the total zeta) is

$$\mathcal{Z}(X, \mathfrak{g}, U; u) = \mathrm{sdet}_W \left(I - \bigoplus_{k=1}^d s_k \mathsf{T}_k^U(u) \right)^{-1} = \prod_{k=1}^d \det(I - s_k \mathsf{T}_k^U(u))^{(-1)^k},$$

with the sign $s_k = (-1)^{k+1}$ inserted once per successor arrow. Odd k (edges) sits in the denominator, even k (chambers) in the numerator. The intrinsic default for an arbitrary complex is $\mathcal{S}_k = \mathcal{O}_k$, unit length, the rule of Definition 6.1 and $V = \mathbb{C}$, written $\mathcal{Z}_{\mathrm{ord}}(X, u)$; the building default is Definition 6.2, written $\mathcal{Z}_{\mathrm{pt}}(X, u)$.

Definition 6.4 (Bruhat–Tits building of PGL_n , colour-shift Hecke operators, Ramanujan complex). The vertices of $\mathcal{B}$ carry a colour (type) function with values in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$, and the *colour-shift Hecke operators* A_k , $1 \leq k \leq n-1$, sum a function over the neighbours of colour shift k : we may look at the $d-1$ colored adjacency operators A_k , $k = 1, \dots, d-1$ on $L^2(\mathcal{B} \setminus \{0\})$, called the Hecke

operators. (math/0406208:main.tex:541-549). They commute, are normal, and satisfy $A_k^* = A_{n-k}$. A finite quotient is a *Ramanujan complex* when its nontrivial joint spectrum lies in the tempered set $\text{Aspec}_n = \{(q^{k(n-k)/2} e_k(z))_k : |z_i| = 1, \prod_i z_i = 1\}$: A finite quotient $\mathbb{X}$ of $\mathbb{B}$ is called a Ramanujan complex if the eigenvalues of every non-trivial simultaneous eigenvector $v \in \bigoplus_{k=0}^n \mathbb{X}_k$, $A_k v = \lambda_k v$, satisfy $(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_{d-1}) \in \text{Aspec}_d$. (math/0406208:main.tex:564-572). The condition is on the *joint* spectrum, which is strictly smaller than the product of the separate spectra.

Definition 6.5 (Cayley complex). For a finite group G with generating set S , the *Cayley complex* is the clique complex of the Cayley graph: The Cayley complex of G with respect to a set of generators S is the simplicial complex whose 1-skeleton is the Cayley graph $\text{Cayley}(G, S)$, where a subset of $i+1$ vertices is an i -cell iff every two vertices comprise an edge. (math/0406217: Lubotzky, Samuels and Vishne give explicit S , graded into colour classes $S_1, \dots, S_{n-1}$ with $|S_k| = \binom{n}{k}_q$ and $S_k^{-1} = S_{n-k}$, for which this complex is a Ramanujan complex covered by $\mathcal{B}$.

Definition 6.6 (Kraus connection on the 1-skeleton; flat, pure gauge, paired). A *connection* on the 1-skeleton of X with fibre V assigns to each directed edge (x, y) an arbitrary $E_{(x,y)} \in \text{End}(V)$; it is a *Kraus connection* when $V = M_n$ and each E_e is completely positive, for instance $E_e = \text{Ad}(B_e)$. Twist Definition 6.1 by anchoring the fibre at the *last* vertex, $T_k^E(v \otimes [\sigma]) = \sum E_{(v_k, w)} v \otimes [\tau]$. The connection is *flat* when $E_{yx} = E_{xy}^{-1}$ and $E_{yz} E_{xy} = E_{xz}$ on every 2-cell, and *pure gauge* when $E_{(x,y)} = F_y F_x^{-1}$ for some invertible F . It is *adjoint-paired* when $E_{\bar{e}} = E_e^\dagger$ and *inverse-paired* when $E_{\bar{e}} = E_e^{-1}$ (Definition 4.26). No positivity, invertibility, pairing or flatness is assumed unless said.

Definition 6.7 (Voltage quotient and Artin block). Let a finite group G act on X preserving the successor and length data and freely on the state set S_k . Choose orbit representatives σ_a and encode each transition $\sigma_a \rightarrow h\sigma_b$ by its *voltage* $h \in G$; this is the *voltage quotient*, a digraph on the orbits with a group label on every arrow. For a unitary ϱ of G , the ϱ -block $\mathsf{T}_{k,\varrho}(u)$ replaces that arrow by $\varrho(h^{-1})$ on the fibre, keeping the length weight. For $R = \pi \otimes \bar{\pi} = \bigoplus_{\varrho} a_{\varrho} \varrho$ the *Artin determinant* is $D_{k,R}(u) = \prod_{\varrho} \det(I - s_k \mathsf{T}_{k,\varrho}(u))^{a_{\varrho}}$. This is not the same object as the connection of Definition 6.6 on the full cover.

Definition 6.8 (Ramanujan quantum expander of type $\tilde{A}_{n-1}$; exceptional space). Let $X = \text{Cay}(G, S)$ have the colour classes of Definition 6.5, let $\pi: G \rightarrow U(N)$ be unitary and $R = \text{Ad } \pi$ on M_n . Put $\Phi_k(X) = |S_k|^{-1} \sum_{s \in S_k} \pi(s) X \pi(s)^\dagger$ and $\hat{A}_k = |S_k| \Phi_k = \sum_{s \in S_k} R(s)$. Let $\mathcal{F}_R$ be the common fixed space and let $\mathcal{E}_R \supseteq \mathcal{F}_R$ be the sum, inside R , of the type-character subrepresentations excluded by the convention of Definition 6.4. The tuple $(\Phi_1, \dots, \Phi_{n-1})$ is *Ramanujan of type $\tilde{A}_{n-1}$ relative to $\mathcal{E}_R$* when its joint spectrum on $\mathcal{E}_R^\perp$ lies in Aspec_n . Only when $\mathcal{E}_R = \mathcal{F}_R$ is this the fixed-point-complement condition; on a partite complex $\mathcal{E}_R$ can be strictly larger.

7 Definitions, Continued: Finite BC States and Covariant Generators

Definition 7.1 (Finite phase marginal and matrix extension). For an odd prime p , the phase algebra generated by $e(k/p)$ is $C(\mathbb{F}_p)$, represented diagonally on $H_p = \ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$. Let w_β be the restriction of the unique BC state for $0 < \beta \leq 1$, or of the Galois average of extremal BC states for $\beta > 1$. Its *diagonal matrix extension* is $\varrho_{p,\beta}^{\text{res}} = \text{diag}(w_\beta(x))$ in $B(H_p)$. A matrix extension is a density with these diagonal entries; its off-diagonal entries are additional data. This does not specify a representation of the full BC algebra on H_p .

Definition 7.2 (Local arithmetic covariance and parity). The centred Weyl operators X_v , $v \in \mathbb{F}_p^2$, are those of Definition 5.9 with one register. Three requirements on a superoperator are distinguished: commuting with $\text{Ad}(U_a)$, $U_a|x\rangle = |ax\rangle$, $a \in \mathbb{F}_p^\times$ (*Galois torus*); commuting with $\text{Ad}(W(g))$, $g \in \text{Sp}(2, \mathbb{F}_p)$ (*linear symplectic covariance*); and commuting with all $\text{Ad}(X_v)$ (*Weyl-translation covariance*). The first action sends (x, y) to $(ax, a^{-1}y)$, and induces the inverse-labelled BC action on the phase generators. Weyl-translation covariance is an extra condition, not a consequence of carrying Weyl operators. Parity is $P|x\rangle = |-x\rangle$; operator parity is $X \mapsto PXP$.

Definition 7.3 (Stationary covariant GKLS cone). For a density ϱ_b on $\mathbb{C}^d$ and a unitary group action U , let $\mathfrak{C}_U(\varrho_b)$ be the cone of Schrödinger generators of CPTP semigroups with $\mathcal{L}(\varrho_b) = 0$ and $[\mathcal{L}, \text{Ad}(U_g)] = 0$ for every g . Its dimension means the real dimension of its linear span, including the overall time scale. The identity is fixed by the dual Heisenberg semigroup; fixing I also in the Schrödinger picture is an additional condition, equivalent to stationarity of the tracial density I/d .

Definition 7.4 (Conditional Choi matrix). For a complex-linear map L on M_d , set

$$\mathbf{C}_L = \sum_{i,j} |i\rangle\langle j| \otimes L(|i\rangle\langle j|), \quad b = d^{-1/2} \sum_i |i, i\rangle, \quad Q = I - |b\rangle\langle b|.$$

The *conditional Choi matrix* is $Q\mathbf{C}_L Q$. The completely depolarizing channel is $\mathcal{D}_d(X) = \text{Tr}(X)I/d$.

8 Definitions, Continued: Boson–Fermion cMPS Rings

Throughout, $L > 0$ is the ring length, $\mathfrak{S}$ a finite set of particle species with parity $p: \mathfrak{S} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$, $\eta_a = (-1)^{p_a}$ and $\eta_{ab} = (-1)^{p_a p_b}$. For a word $a = (a_1, \dots, a_n) \in \mathfrak{S}^n$ put $\eta_a = \eta_{a_1} \cdots \eta_{a_n}$. Bars denote entrywise complex conjugation of matrices, $\otimes$ the Kronecker product, and Tr the trace of a matrix of the size at hand.

Definition 8.1 (Graded Fock space, fermion parity, translations). $\mathfrak{F}$ is the tensor product of the symmetric Fock space over $\bigoplus_{p_a=0} L^2([0, L])$ and the antisymmetric Fock space over $\bigoplus_{p_a=1} L^2([0, L])$, with vacuum $\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$, n -particle subspace $\mathfrak{F}_n$ and finite-particle subspace $\mathfrak{F}_{\text{fin}}$. For $f \in L^2([0, L])$, $a_a^\dagger(f)$ creates a particle of species a in the mode f and $a_a(f)$ is its adjoint on $\mathfrak{F}_{\text{fin}}$. For a family $u = (u_a)_{a \in \mathfrak{S}}$ of unitaries on $L^2([0, L])$, $\Gamma(u)$ is its second quantisation. The *fermion parity* is $(-1)^{\hat{F}} = \Gamma((\eta_a)_a)$. The *periodic translation* by $t \in [0, L]$ is $U_t = \Gamma((u_t)_a)$ with $(u_t f)(x) = f(x - t \bmod L)$; the *antiperiodic translation* U_t^{ap} uses u_t on bosonic species and, on fermionic species, $(u_t^{\text{ap}} f)(x) = f(x - t)$ for $x \geq t$ and $-f(x - t + L)$ for $x < t$. The facts used about these objects are listed in assumption 21.1.

Definition 8.2 (Boson–fermion cMPS ring vector, bond grading). *cMPS data* are a bond dimension D , matrices $Q, R_a \in M_D(\mathbb{C})$ ($a \in \mathfrak{S}$), constant in x , and a *boundary matrix* $B \in M_D(\mathbb{C})$. The open ordered simplex is $\Delta_n^< = \{x \in (0, L)^n : x_1 < \cdots < x_n\}$, $\mathcal{K}_n = L^2(\Delta_n^< \times \mathfrak{S}^n)$ (Lebesgue times counting measure), and the *n-particle amplitude* is

$$c_n^B(x; a) = \text{Tr}[B e^{x_1 Q} R_{a_1} e^{(x_2 - x_1) Q} R_{a_2} \cdots R_{a_n} e^{(L - x_n) Q}], \quad c_0^B = \text{Tr}[B e^{LQ}].$$

The *cMPS ring vector* is $\Psi_B^c = \sum_{n \geq 0} \mathcal{J} c_n^B \in \mathfrak{F}$, where $\mathcal{J}$ is the isometry of Lemma 21.4 and the series converges by Theorem 21.6; this is the state of [39] with the positions increasing from left to right. A *bond grading* is $P \in M_D(\mathbb{C})$ with $P^2 = 1$, $PQP = Q$ and $PR_a P = \eta_a R_a$ for all a ; its sector projections are $\Pi_\pm = \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm P)$. The *untwisted* ring is Ψ_1^c and the *twisted* ring is Ψ_P^c . No regularity (supercommutation) condition and no normalisation of Q is imposed.

Definition 8.3 (Sign-twisted transfer generators, doubled-bond parity, super-invariants). For two cMPS data $(Q, R), (Q', R')$ with the same D and $\mathfrak{S}$, and signs $s \in \{\pm 1\}^{\mathfrak{S}}$, the *sign-twisted transfer generator* on $\mathbb{C}^D \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ is

$$\mathbb{T}_s = Q \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes \bar{Q}' + \sum_{a \in \mathfrak{S}} s_a R_a \otimes \bar{R}'_a.$$

$\mathbb{T}$ is $\mathbb{T}_s$ with all $s_a = 1$ and $\mathbb{T}_\eta$ is $\mathbb{T}_s$ with $s_a = \eta_a$; when the primed data are not named they equal the unprimed ones. Given a bond grading P , the *doubled-bond parity* is $\Gamma_b = P \otimes \bar{P}$; since $\Gamma_b^2 = 1$, $\mathbb{C}^D \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ is the direct sum of its *even* (+1) and *odd* (−1) eigenspaces. Under $|i\rangle \otimes |j\rangle \mapsto |i\rangle \langle j|$ with $P = 1_{D_+} \oplus (-1)_{D_-}$ the even sector is the block-diagonal and the odd sector the block-off-diagonal matrices, of dimensions $D_+^2 + D_-^2$ and $2D_+ D_-$. For an operator M commuting with Γ_b , $\text{str } M = \text{Tr}(\Gamma_b M)$, which is the supertrace of Definition 5.1, and for $z \in \mathbb{C}$ outside the spectrum of M , $\text{sdet}(z - M) = \det(z - M|_{\text{even}}) / \det(z - M|_{\text{odd}})$.

9 Definitions, Continued: Graded Lattice Tensors and Lifted Frobenius

Continuation of Section 8; lattice (discrete-site) versions of the graded cMPS objects, and the arithmetic objects of the ring-norm-tensor campaign (Sections 30 and 33).

Definition 9.1 (Graded lattice tensor, doubled transfer matrix, P -closed ring norm, ring zeta, gauge). A *graded bond* is $V = V_+ \oplus V_- = \mathbb{C}^{m|k}$ with parity $P = 1_m \oplus (-1_k)$. A *graded lattice tensor* is a finite family $A_s \in \text{End}(V)$, s in a finite alphabet (the *letters* or physical species), each homogeneous: *even* ($PA_sP = A_s$, block diagonal, $A_s = a_s \oplus B_s$) or *odd* ($PA_sP = -A_s$, block off-diagonal, $A_s = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & c_s \\ d_s & 0 \end{pmatrix}$). Its *doubled transfer matrix* is $\mathcal{E}_d = \sum_s A_s \otimes \bar{A}_s$ on $V \otimes \bar{V}$ (ordinary Kronecker product, no statistics sign), graded by the doubled parity $\Gamma_b = P \otimes \bar{P}$ of Definition 8.3: the *even sector* is $(+, +) \oplus (-, -)$ and the *odd sector* $(+, -) \oplus (-, +)$; $\mathcal{E}_d$ commutes with Γ_b . The *P -closed ring norm* of length n is $\|\Psi_P(n)\|^2 := \text{str}_{\Gamma_b} \mathcal{E}_d^n = \sum_{s_1 \dots s_n} |\text{Tr}(PA_{s_1} \cdots A_{s_n})|^2$ (the second equality is an unconditional identity, since $\mathcal{E}_d^n = \sum_w A_w \otimes \bar{A}_w$ by Kronecker multiplicativity; its identification with the Fock norm of the physical fermion ring is Theorem 22.2), the *ring zeta* is $\exp(\sum_n \text{str} \mathcal{E}_d^n u^n / n) = 1 / \text{sdet}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d) = \det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d|_{\text{odd}}) / \det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d|_{\text{even}})$, and an *even gauge* is $A_s \mapsto GA_sG^{-1}$ with G even and invertible, which conjugates $\mathcal{E}_d$ by $G \otimes \bar{G}$ and fixes every ring norm. *Net spectrum* means after cancelling common even and odd eigenvalues; eigenvalue 0 and nilpotent blocks are invisible to all positive powers.

Definition 9.2 (Lifted Frobenius of an ordinary elliptic curve; toral endomorphism; Hodge ket bond). Let $E/\mathbb{F}_q$ be an ordinary elliptic curve with Frobenius endomorphism π , trace $a = q + 1 - N_1$, endomorphism order $O = \text{End}(E)$ in the imaginary quadratic field $K = \mathbb{Q}(\pi)$. The *lifted Frobenius* is the pair (Λ, π) of assumption 30.4: a lattice $\Lambda \subset \mathbb{C}$ that is a proper O -ideal, on which π acts by multiplication. Its *integral matrix* $M \in M_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is the matrix of $z \mapsto \pi z$ on a $\mathbb{Z}$ -basis of Λ , and the *toral endomorphism* is the induced map $M: \mathbb{T}^2 = \mathbb{R}^2/\mathbb{Z}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{T}^2$. The *Hodge ket bond* is $V = \Lambda^*(H^{1,0}) = \mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{C} dz = \mathbb{C}^{1|1}$ with $P = (-1)^{\text{deg}}$; its double $V \otimes \bar{V} = \Lambda^*(\mathbb{C} dz \oplus \mathbb{C} d\bar{z}) = H^*(\mathbb{T}^2, \mathbb{C})$ is graded by total form degree.

Definition 9.3 (Elliptic norm tensor). For a unit vector $\phi = \sum_s a_s |s\rangle$, $\sum_s |a_s|^2 = 1$, the *elliptic norm tensor* of E is the all-even graded lattice tensor $A_s = a_s \text{diag}(1, \pi)$ on the Hodge ket bond, with P -closed ring vector $\Psi_P(n) = (1 - \pi^n) \phi^{\otimes n}$. The singleton alphabet $a_0 = 1$ is allowed.

Definition 9.4 (Genus-two bond and block notation). For a genus-two curve $C/\mathbb{F}_q$ with simple ordinary Jacobian J , Frobenius π , quartic CM field $K = \mathbb{Q}(\pi)$, Frobenius eigenvalues $\{\pi_1, \bar{\pi}_1, \pi_2, \bar{\pi}_2\}$ and CM type $\Phi = \{\phi_1, \phi_2\}$ with $\phi_j(\pi) = \pi_j$ (assumption 33.4), the *genus-two bond* is $V = \mathbb{C} \oplus H^{1,0}(\tilde{J}) = \mathbb{C}^{1|2}$, $P = (-1)^{\text{deg}}$, with $D = \text{diag}(\pi_1, \pi_2)$ on $H^{1,0}$. For a graded lattice tensor on $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$ with even letters $a_s \oplus B_s$ and odd letters (c_f, d_f) (c_f a row, d_f a column) the *block notation* is $M = \sum_s a_s \bar{B}_s$, $N = \sum_f \bar{d}_f c_f$, $t = \sum_s |a_s|^2$, $u = \sum_f c_f \otimes \bar{c}_f$, $v = \sum_f d_f \otimes \bar{d}_f$, $W = \sum_s B_s \otimes \bar{B}_s$, in the ordered odd basis $(|0\rangle \otimes |\bar{j}\rangle)_j, (|i\rangle \otimes |\bar{0}\rangle)_i$ and row-major vectorisation of the $(-, -)$ block (Lemma 33.6).

Definition 9.5 (Nine-letter tensor). For $q > 1$ and π_1, π_2 with $|\pi_j|^2 = q$ and $q + 1 \geq 4\sqrt{q}$, put $t = (q + 1)/2$, $w = (q + 1)/4$, $h = (q - 1)/(2\sqrt{2})$, $B_0 = D/\sqrt{t}$, $b_0 = \text{vec } B_0$, $\nu = b_0^* b_0 = 2q/t$, $S = \sqrt{w} 1_4 + \nu^{-1}(\sqrt{w} - \nu - \sqrt{w}) b_0 b_0^*$ (the positive square root of $w 1_4 - b_0 b_0^*$) and $B_\ell = \text{unvec}(S e_\ell)$, $\ell = 1, \dots, 4$. The *nine-letter tensor* on $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$ has even letters $A_0 = \sqrt{t} \oplus B_0$, $A_\ell = 0 \oplus B_\ell$ and odd letters $A_{\uparrow j} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \sqrt{h} e_j^T \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $A_{\downarrow j} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ \sqrt{h} e_j & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $j = 1, 2$ (Theorem 33.8).

10 Definitions, Continued: The Ramanujan Property for Graded Channels

These definitions are used in Section 13. They build on the graded lattice tensor of Definition 9.1, whose doubled transfer $\mathcal{E}_d$ commutes with the doubled parity Γ_b , and on the cMPS generator $\mathbb{T}$ of Definition 8.3. “Even” and “odd” always refer to Γ_b -sectors of the doubled bond: block-diagonal operators (populations of and coherences within each parity block) and block-off-diagonal operators (coherences between the two parity blocks).

Definition 10.1 (Graded transfer channel, sector restrictions, graded divisor, trivial set). A *graded transfer channel* is a graded lattice tensor $(A_s)_s$ on $V = V_+ \oplus V_-$ with parity P , viewed through its doubled transfer $\mathcal{E}_d$ or the channel $X \mapsto \sum_s A_s X A_s^\dagger$. Its *sector restrictions* are $\mathcal{E}_d^{(0)} = \mathcal{E}_d|_{\text{even}}$ and $\mathcal{E}_d^{(1)} = \mathcal{E}_d|_{\text{odd}}$. The two closures give the ring norms $\text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_d^n = \text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_d^{(0)n} + \text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_d^{(1)n}$ (antiperiodic) and $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_d^n = \text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_d^{(0)n} - \text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_d^{(1)n}$ (periodic, Definition 9.1). The *graded divisor* is $\nu(\lambda) = m_0(\lambda) - m_1(\lambda)$, the difference of the algebraic multiplicities of λ in the two sectors: $\nu > 0$ are the poles and $\nu < 0$ the zeros of the ring zeta $1/\text{sdet}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d)$, and $\nu = 0$ is invisible. The *growth* is $q = \text{rad}(\mathcal{E}_d) = \text{rad}(\mathcal{E}_d^{(0)})$, the Perron root; its eigenvector can be taken even (average with its P -conjugate), and no nonzero positive operator is odd, though positive operators need not be even; the channel is *graded primitive* when $\nu(q) = 1$. The *trivial divisor* ν_{triv} is a signed divisor, with multiplicities and parities, designated for structural reasons: q (even, simple), its images ζq under the period of $\mathcal{E}_d$ ($\zeta^k = 1$; period modes can be odd, so their parities are recorded, not assumed), the value 1 as the designated H^0 partner of q (the constant term of a count), the functional-equation partners of these when Definition 10.3 supplies one, and, in the arithmetic cases, the archimedean or topological ladder. The *retained divisor* is $\nu_{\text{ret}} = \nu - \nu_{\text{triv}}$; S_{triv} denotes the support of ν_{triv} . Accidental eigenvalues at a trivial value are retained with their own multiplicity. (Prover correction, ledger L31, L41: a value set of even modes is not the accurate object.) For a cMPS generator $\mathbb{T}$ the same words apply with $\mathcal{E}_d = e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ and a *pair of reference rates* (ω_0, ω_1) in place of $(q, 1)$: the fixed point’s rate and its designated partner’s, whose midpoint is the critical line; in the channel normalisation $\omega_0 = 0$, and ω_1 must be supplied as data, since a trace-preserving spectral bound alone is 0 and does not determine it (ledger L36: amplitude damping has centre $-\gamma/2$ with spectral bound 0).

Definition 10.2 (Parity-twisted unitality, P -mode). A graded transfer channel with letter parities $\epsilon_s = \pm 1$ is *parity-twisted unital* with twisted eigenvalue r_P when $\sum_s \epsilon_s A_s A_s^\dagger = r_P 1$, equivalently $\mathcal{E}_d(P) = r_P P$ in the channel picture (signed unitality in the map convention $X \mapsto \sum_s A_s X A_s^\dagger$; signed trace preservation would use $A_s^\dagger A_s$, ledger L28); the even eigenvector P is then the P -mode. For unital channels with unitary homogeneous letters of weights w_s , $r_P = \sum_s \epsilon_s w_s$, the signed weight of the letters.

Definition 10.3 (Graded RH, functional equation, Ramanujan, manifest form). Let $(V, P, \mathcal{E}_d)$ be a graded transfer channel with growth q , divisor ν and trivial set S_{triv} . The *critical circle* is $|\lambda| = \sqrt{q}$ (counting normalisation; $q^{-1/2}$ for the channel normalisation, the line $\text{Re } z = \omega/2$ for a generator).

(RH) *One-sided (square-root cancellation)*: every point of $\text{supp } \nu_{\text{ret}}$ has $|\lambda| \leq \sqrt{q}$; equivalently the periodic ring norm minus its trivial part is $O(n^c q^{n/2})$ (Cesàro argument on the modes of maximal modulus; it says nothing about cancelled modes).

(FE) *Functional equation*: the divisor form is $\nu_{\text{ret}}(q/\lambda) = \nu_{\text{ret}}(\lambda)$ (continuum: $\nu_{\text{ret}}(\omega_0 + \omega_1 - \lambda) = \nu_{\text{ret}}(\lambda)$); the stronger operator form is an even similarity J (commuting with Γ_b) with

$J\mathcal{E}_d J^{-1} = q\mathcal{E}_d^{-1}$ on specified retained sectors, which also matches Jordan data (ledger L32). For a generator, $J\mathbb{T}J^{-1} = \omega_0 + \omega_1 - \mathbb{T}$.

(Ram) *Ramanujan (two-sided)*: every retained divisor point, even (pole) or odd (zero), lies on the critical circle. Under the reality hypothesis $\nu_{\text{ret}}(\bar{\lambda}) = \nu_{\text{ret}}(\lambda)$ (automatic for graded transfer channels, whose sector spectra are conjugation closed) this is equivalent to (RH) and divisor (FE).

(HP) *Manifest, or Hilbert–Pólya, form*: on specified retained invariant sector subspaces there is a Γ_b -even positive definite form G with $\mathcal{E}_d^\dagger G \mathcal{E}_d = qG$, i.e. the retained parts of $\mathcal{E}_d^{(1)}/\sqrt{q}$ and $\mathcal{E}_d^{(0)}/\sqrt{q}$ are G -unitary; this is equivalent to those operators being diagonalisable with spectrum on the circle (Proposition 39.4 sector by sector), and is a statement about the retained operators, not about the divisor alone (ledger L33). For a generator: $\mathbb{T} = \omega/2 + iH$ on those sectors with H G -self-adjoint, the “ $e^{-t/4}$ rescaling” of the Riemann normalisation ($\omega = 1/2$).

(RH), (FE) and mixing are independent in general (Section 35, Pauli family). The prover lane (notes/ramanujan-graded/astra-proofs.md, “Definitions: verdict”) distinguishes a *graded CP transfer* (this definition) from a *graded spectral transfer*, a graded operator with a divisor but no supplied Kraus realisation: the Artin–Schreier super-transfer of Section 29, the Riemann graded generator of Section 18 and the Selberg flat tower of Section 46 are of the second kind, and only the divisor statements apply to them.

Definition 10.4 (Graded quantum expander). A trace-preserving graded channel Φ (channel normalisation) on $B(V_+ \oplus V_-)$ with a unique fixed point (necessarily even) is a $(D_+|D_-, D, \lambda_0, \lambda_1)$ *graded quantum expander* (*mixing* version) when every even eigenvalue other than the simple stationary one has modulus at most $\lambda_0 < 1$ and every odd eigenvalue has modulus at most $\lambda_1 < 1$; uniqueness of the stationary state excludes odd fixed operators. The *period- k* version records and removes the peripheral modes with their parities (the all-odd examples of Section 13 have the even mode P at -1 and are period two, not mixing as single-step channels). The *odd gap* $-\log \lambda_1$ bounds the asymptotic decay of the parity coherences, with possible Jordan factors; it is not a single-step contraction bound. The expander is *Ramanujan* when $\lambda_0 = \lambda_1 = \lambda_H = 2\sqrt{D-1}/D$ in the Hermitian case (unitary letters closed under adjoint, equal weights; *sector Ramanujan*), or when its divisor satisfies (Ram) of Definition 10.3 in general. The letter degree D is data: repeated letters change the Hastings benchmark without changing the channel.

Definition 10.5 (Graded Hashimoto operator, graded quantum Ihara zeta, balanced grading). For unitary homogeneous letters U_i , $i \in [D]$, with a fixed-point-free reversal ι and $U_{\bar{i}} = U_i^\dagger$ (so U_i and $U_{\bar{i}}$ have the same parity), the *graded Hashimoto operator* is the operator T of Definition 3.18 on $B(V) \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ with $\mathcal{E}_i = \text{Ad}(U_i)$; it commutes with $\Gamma_b \otimes 1$ and has sector restrictions T_0, T_1 . The *graded quantum Ihara zeta* is $1/\text{sdet}(1 - uT) = \det(1 - uT_1)/\det(1 - uT_0)$, the ring zeta of the periodic non-backtracking rings, $\text{str } T^n = \sum_w |\text{Tr}(PU_w)|^2$ over cyclically non-backtracking words. The grading is *balanced* when $D_+ = D_-$.

Definition 10.6 (Index-two grading of a representation channel). Let G be a group with an index-two subgroup G_0 and sign character $\epsilon: G \rightarrow \{\pm 1\}$, $\ker \epsilon = G_0$, and let π be an irreducible unitary representation of G on V whose restriction to G_0 is reducible, $\pi|_{G_0} = \pi_+ \oplus \pi_-$ with $\pi_\pm$ irreducible and conjugate under the odd coset (Clifford theory: $\pi = \text{Ind}_{G_0}^G \pi_+$). The *index-two grading* is $P = +1$ on $V_+ = \pi_+$ and -1 on $V_- = \pi_-$, so that $P\pi(g)P = \epsilon(g)\pi(g)$: elements of G_0 act as even letters and elements of the odd coset as odd letters. For a finite symmetric generating set S of G the *graded representation channel* is $\Phi = |S|^{-1} \sum_{s \in S} \text{Ad } \pi(s)$, with walk element $W_S = |S|^{-1} \sum_{s \in S} s$ in

the group algebra. The examples of Section 13 are $G = \mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p) \supset \mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ with ϵ the Legendre symbol of the determinant, and the Pauli group (not its abelian quotient, whose two-dimensional representation is projective; ledger L09) with G_0 the index-two subgroup generated by iI and Z .

Definition 10.7 (Stable transverse complex of the geodesic flow). For the geodesic flow of Definition 4.18, with the global coframe dual to $(\mathcal{X}, \mathbf{U}_+^h, \mathbf{U}_-^h)$ and the covector η_+ dual to $\mathbf{U}_+^h$ ($\eta_+(\mathbf{U}_+^h) = 1$, $\mathcal{L}\mathcal{X}\eta_+ = -\eta_+$; it annihilates $E_0 \oplus E_u$ and so lies in the bundle Dyatlov–Faure–Guillarmou call E_u^* , “stable” referring to the naming of $\mathbf{U}_+^h$), the *stable transverse complex* is the single-copy graded spectral transfer with even space $\mathcal{D}'(SM)$ and generator $-\mathcal{X}$, odd space $\mathcal{D}'(SM)\eta_+$ and generator $-\mathcal{X} + 1$, connected by $f \mapsto (\mathbf{U}_+^h f)\eta_+$. Its *flat supertrace* is $\mathrm{str}(t) = \mathrm{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}} - \mathrm{Tr}^b e^{-t(\mathcal{X}-1)} = (1 - e^t)F(t)$ with $F = \mathrm{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}}$ the function flat trace, and its *ring zeta* is $\exp \int_0^\infty e^{-st} \mathrm{str}(t) dt/t$, normalised by its convergent orbital exponential. The divisor and the reference pair are as in Definition 10.1, with the relative resonance divisor of observation 14.4; it is not a doubled-bond CP transfer (Section 15).

11 What the Riemann Hypothesis Has Become

Nothing here is new mathematics; it is a translation, written for TJO after the founding session from the ingredients built up there. Its point is one sentence, isolated in observation 11.3 and repeated in every later costume: the Riemann hypothesis says certain counts fluctuate no more than a random sequence would.

11.1 The one identity, and its two readings

Observation 11.1 (The one identity). [sketched] For any matrix M with eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N$,

$$\frac{1}{\det(1 - uM)} = \prod_i \frac{1}{1 - \lambda_i u} = \exp \left(\sum_{\ell \geq 1} \frac{\text{Tr}(M^\ell)}{\ell} u^\ell \right).$$

The middle expression is a bosonic partition function, one mode per eigenvector with Boltzmann factor $\lambda_i u$; the right expression is a sum over closed walks of length ℓ , carrying the $1/\ell$ of a ring's rotation symmetry. One object, two descriptions: a gas of modes and a gas of rings (Definitions 3.1 and 3.2).

The whole subject is the tension between the two sides. For a permutation matrix the ring side is concrete: $\text{Tr}(M^\ell)$ counts the fixed points of the ℓ -th power, the closed walks are the cycles and their repeats, and the identity collapses to $\det(1 - uM)^{-1} = \prod_c (1 - u^{|c|})^{-1}$ over cycles c : a Bose gas with one mode per cycle, energy the cycle length. That product is the Euler product, and the primes will be the cycles.

11.2 A finite permutation: the analogue is free

Observation 11.2 (RH for a finite permutation). [sketched]
A permutation matrix permutes an orthonormal basis, hence is unitary, hence has every eigenvalue on the unit circle. The RH analogue at this level costs nothing.

11.3 An infinite permutation: a statement about a different matrix

For infinitely many cycles the permutation matrix is still unitary and still useless, its spectrum being roots of unity with infinite multiplicity. The count $\text{fix}(\ell) = \sum_{d|\ell} d c_d$ of fixed points of the ℓ -th power, with c_d the number of d -cycles, remains meaningful, and the interesting object is a *small matrix* (Definition 3.3) reproducing them.

Observation 11.3 (RH for the small matrix). [sketched] A small matrix M_{small} with $\text{Tr } M_{\text{small}}^\ell = \text{fix}(\ell)$ for all ℓ exists exactly when the zeta function is rational, and then its eigenvalues are new numbers, off the unit circle. Writing $\text{fix}(\ell) = \lambda_{\text{max}}^\ell + \sum_{i \geq 2} \lambda_i^\ell$, the RH analogue is that every other nonzero λ_i has $|\lambda_i| = \sqrt{\lambda_{\text{max}}}$ (Definition 3.4), so that the fluctuation has size $\sqrt{\lambda_{\text{max}}^\ell}$: the square root of the leading term, which is the fluctuation of a sum of $\lambda_{\text{max}}^\ell$ independent coin tosses. In counting language, RH says the cycle counts fluctuate no more than a random sequence would.

So the RH analogue is here a property some systems have and others do not. The note records two shift examples, both perfectly good infinite permutations.

shift	eigenvalues of the small matrix	RH analogue
4-symbol cyclic rule	$2, 1+i, 1-i, 0$	holds
golden-mean shift	$\phi, -1/\phi$	fails

11.4 A graph: Ramanujan

Observation 11.4 (RH for a graph is the Ramanujan property).

[sketched]

For a $(q+1)$ -regular graph the permutation is the shift on non-backtracking closed walks, the small matrix is the adjacency matrix A , and the Ihara–Bass formula (Definition 3.8) compresses one to the other: each eigenvalue λ of A produces a pair μ, μ' of eigenvalues of the edge operator T through

$$\mu^2 - \lambda\mu + q = 0, \quad \text{so} \quad \mu\mu' = q.$$

The leading $\lambda = q+1$ gives $\mu = q, \mu' = 1$. For the rest, $\lambda^2 < 4q$ forces a complex conjugate pair with $|\mu| = |\mu'| = \sqrt{q}$, on the critical circle, while $\lambda^2 > 4q$ gives a real pair, one factor above $\sqrt{q}$ and one below. Hence RH for ζ_X holds if and only if $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ for every nontrivial λ , i.e. iff the graph is Ramanujan (Definition 3.9), and the closed non-backtracking walk counts are $N_\ell = q^\ell + O(q^{\ell/2})$.

Three remarks carry over to the primes. First, **the pairing comes from a symmetry, the hypothesis from a bound**: $\mu\mu' = q$ is a functional equation pairing eigenvalues symmetrically about $\sqrt{q}$ on a logarithmic scale, and RH is the extra statement that each pair is degenerate in modulus, which happens exactly when it is a conjugate pair. Second, **self-adjointness is not enough**: A is symmetric, so λ is real, which guarantees the pairing but not the bound; the prism graph $C_{16} \times K_2$ is symmetric and fails it. Third, **the bound is geometric**: $[-2\sqrt{q}, 2\sqrt{q}]$ is the spectrum of the infinite tree covering the graph, so RH says the graph has no eigenvalue outside the spectrum of its universal cover; the word is tempered.

11.5 A matrix product state: one correlation length

Let $E = \Sigma$ be the transfer matrix of a matrix product state (Definition 3.12), so that $\text{Tr } E^n = \langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle$ is the ring norm of the periodic state on n sites (Definition 3.13) and the zeta function of observation 11.1 is the generating function of ring norms. In canonical form (Definition 3.14) the leading eigenvalue is 1 and the rest lie inside the unit disc, $\lambda_k = e^{-1/\ell_k^c + i\vartheta_k}$ (Definition 3.15), so $\langle \Psi_n | \Psi_n \rangle = 1 + \sum_k e^{-n/\ell_k^c} e^{in\vartheta_k}$.

Observation 11.5 (RH for an MPS).

[sketched]

Translating observation 11.4, where the leading growth is q per step and the subleading modulus $\sqrt{q}$: in normalised units the subleading modulus is $q^{-1/2}$, so $e^{-1/\ell_k^c} = q^{-1/2}$ and $\ell_k^c = 2/\log q = 2/h$ for every k . The RH analogue for an MPS reads: all correlation lengths are equal, and equal to twice the inverse entropy rate. The phases ϑ_k are unconstrained and there may be infinitely many of them; only the moduli are pinned.

The hierarchy this sits in has three levels, and each has a classical number-theoretic counterpart, anticipating observation 11.6 below.

statement about E (or $\mathcal{G}$)	name	counting meaning	number theory
a unique eigenvalue on the unit circle	primitivity (Perron–Frobenius)	ring norms follow the leading term	$\zeta(1+it) \neq 0$, the prime number theorem
all others inside a smaller circle	spectral gap	fluctuation exponentially smaller than the leading term	the zero-free region, $\psi(x) = x + O(xe^{-c\sqrt{\log x}})$
all others on <i>one</i> circle of radius e^{-1/ℓ_k^c} with $\ell_k^c = 2/h$	Ramanujan / RH	fluctuation is the square root of the leading term	all zeros on $\text{Re } s = \frac{1}{2}$

11.6 The primes: continuous length, and the sign

For the primes the cycle lengths are $\log p$, rationally independent, so the matrix powers become a semigroup $e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$ in a continuous length $\mathbf{L}$ and the ring norms become a measure in $\mathbf{L}$. Start from the Riemann–von Mangoldt formula for ψ , valid for x not a prime power, put $x = e^{\mathbf{L}}$ and differentiate in $\mathbf{L}$: the left side becomes a sum of delta functions, one per prime power, of weight $\log p$, and the right side a sum of exponentials.

Observation 11.6 (The explicit formula as a trace, and the pairing).

[sketched] With

$$\psi(x) = x - \sum_{\rho} x^{\rho}/\rho - \log 2\pi - \frac{1}{2} \log(1 - x^{-2}),$$

$$\sum_n \Lambda(n) \delta(\mathbf{L} - \log n) = e^{\mathbf{L}} - \sum_{\rho} e^{\rho \mathbf{L}} - (e^{-2\mathbf{L}} + e^{-4\mathbf{L}} + \dots),$$

which is $\text{Tr } e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$ for a generator $\mathcal{G}$ whose eigenvalues are 1 (the pole of ζ , the leading term, entropy 1), every zero ρ , and the trivial zeros $-2, -4, \dots$: the trace identity of observation 11.1 with M^{ℓ} replaced by $e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$, ring side the prime powers at lengths $\log n$, mode side the zeros. The functional equation $\xi(s) = \xi(1-s)$ makes ρ and $1-\rho$ both zeros, so after dividing by the leading $e^{\mathbf{L}}$ the normalised decay rates come in pairs $(1-\sigma, \sigma)$ summing to 1, exactly as $\mu\mu' = q$ paired the graph eigenvalues around $\sqrt{q}$. That pairing is a theorem; RH is the extra statement that every pair is degenerate, $\sigma = 1-\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$.

Two features of this trace identity are visible immediately. The first is *the sign*: the zeros enter with a minus sign relative to the leading term, the same minus sign that marks the fermionic H^1 block in the elliptic-curve case (Section 36) and the absorption spectrum in Connes’s language. The total measure stays positive because $\Lambda(n) \geq 0$, but the subleading sector of the bond space contributes negatively, so whatever state this is, its bond space is graded, not plainly bosonic. The second is the pairing just stated. The numerical check against several thousand zeros is recorded in Section 17. Collecting the costumes:

language	the Riemann hypothesis says
counting small matrix MPS	$\psi(x) = x + O(x^{1/2+\epsilon})$: the prime powers fluctuate like coin tosses every subleading mode has modulus the square root of the leading one the state whose rings are the primes has <i>one</i> correlation length, $\ell_k^c = 2$ since $h = 1$, and an infinite tower of frequencies γ_n
channel	the transfer semigroup $e^{\mathbf{L}\mathcal{G}}$ has a single uniform decay rate $\frac{1}{2}$

11.7 The Hilbert space where this is literally true

The channel version is not only an analogy. It is a theorem on a concrete Hilbert space: the model space K_S of the scattering symbol S of the modular surface, on which the compressed dilation semigroup $Z(t)$ has one mode per zero, with decay rate and frequency read off from that zero. This is Lax–Phillips [63], and “RH iff every mode of $Z(t)$ decays at the same rate” is Faddeev–Pavlov [32]. What the founding session added is where S comes from: its phase is the imaginary part of the Bost–Connes Lévy exponent at the critical temperature $\beta = 1$ [12], so the ring gas and the transfer semigroup are one object seen from its two ends, bridged by the critical phase. Construction, normalisations (the factor $\frac{1}{2}$ from the doubled variable) and numerics are in Section 17; Definitions 4.1 to 4.3 fix the objects.

11.8 Why it is still hard, in this language

The graph case is the honest guide. There side B exists, the trace identity holds and the small matrix is symmetric for every graph, and most graphs fail the bound. Being Ramanujan is never a consequence of the structure; it is an extra fact, and in every known case it comes from arithmetic input of Deligne’s type [24]. For Selberg’s surfaces the same statement, no Laplace eigenvalue below $\frac{1}{4}$, is open.

What the translation settles: RH is a statement about the *sizes* of the subleading modes of a transfer semigroup, not about its existence. The semigroup exists, the zeros are its modes, the primes are its rings, the functional equation is the pairing of its rates. What it does not settle: a mechanism forcing the pairs to be degenerate. In positivity form (Definition 4.8), RH holds iff F_W is positive-definite on the dilation group, iff its spectral measure is positive on the real line, which by Bochner is the same as all its atoms being real.

Observation 11.7 (Hermiticity of the Hilbert–Pólya operator).

[sketched]

Write the length-flow generator on the subleading sector as $\mathcal{G} = -\frac{1}{2} + iH$ (Definition 4.7); then H has eigenvalues $\gamma_n - i(\sigma_n - \frac{1}{2})$, and RH says exactly that H is Hermitian, i.e. that the transfer semigroup is a uniform damping times an oscillation with real frequencies. H is the Hilbert–Pólya operator. The non-Hermitian generator carries the complex pairs and the Hermitian operator their symmetric combination, here $\rho(1 - \rho) = \sigma(1 - \sigma) + \gamma^2 + i\gamma(1 - 2\sigma)$, which is real iff $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$; $\mathcal{G}$ is to H what the Hashimoto edge operator T is to the adjacency matrix A of a graph. For graphs the Hermitian object is given and its reality is a theorem; for the primes it is the conjecture.

Proving it would mean exhibiting that state, or a Stinespring form of $Z(t)$ with the prime dilations as Kraus operators, in a way that makes the positivity manifest; that is conjecture 17.10. The graph lesson says the Kraus structure alone will not do it, and that some arithmetic rigidity has to enter, playing the role that weights play for curves (Section 36).

11.9 Erratum on words

An earlier draft, and the founding session, called $-\log E$ the entanglement Hamiltonian. That is wrong: the entanglement Hamiltonian of an MPS is $-\log$ of a reduced density matrix built from the fixed points of E alone, is Hermitian by construction, and does not see the subleading spectrum. The operator whose spectrum contains the zeros is the transfer generator, non-Hermitian in general, whose eigenvalue phases are the oscillation frequencies of the ring norms. observation 11.7 states the correct relation; the route is listed among the dead ones in Section 47.

11.10 Summary

A zeta function is one partition function with two Fock-space descriptions: a gas of rings (cycles, closed walks, prime powers) and a gas of modes (eigenvalues of a small transfer matrix); the trace identity links them. For the primes the rings have lengths $\log n$ and weights $\Lambda(n)$, the modes are the zeros of ζ plus the pole, and the functional equation pairs the modes' decay rates as $(\sigma, 1 - \sigma)$. The Riemann hypothesis says every pair is degenerate at $\frac{1}{2}$: the transfer semigroup has one correlation length, $\ell_k^c = 2$, so the ring counts fluctuate by no more than the square root of their size, so the primes are as regular as coin tosses. That semigroup exists explicitly, its scattering symbol is the phase of the Bost–Connes system at its critical temperature, and RH is the statement that this channel is Ramanujan.

12 Back to Basics: The Graded Permutation and the Choice of Physical Letters

Question (TJO, 2026-09-14, night). Start from a permutation, $\pi = (12)(345)$. The naive MPS has one matrix, the permutation matrix, bond dimension five, and ring norms. The gas of rings of lengths $1, 2, 3, \dots$ should be ℓ^2 of the naturals, the zeta function a pure vector in it with square-root thermal weights, and zeta is also the partition function of two oscillators with energies 2 and 3; so there should be an isomorphism. Then: grade the second cycle odd, and ask whether the right boundary conditions induce zeros; and what principle fixes the number of physical letters, since one letter and five letters both have a reason to be. Everything here is elementary and the notebook's own calculation (`scripts/graded_permutation.py`, author `claude:fable-5.1`, unreviewed).

12.1 The objects

Definition 12.1 (Graded permutation matrix product states). Let π be a permutation of a finite set X with cycles c of lengths ℓ_c , m_ℓ the number of cycles of length ℓ , and $P = \sum_x |\pi x\rangle\langle x|$ its permutation matrix on the bond $\mathbb{C}^X$. A *letter assignment* is a map $\lambda: X \rightarrow S$ to a finite set of physical letters; its letters are $A_s = \sum_{\lambda(x)=s} |\pi x\rangle\langle x|$, so $\sum_s A_s = P$. Three assignments recur: *point letters* ($S = X$, $\lambda = \text{id}$), *one letter* ($|S| = 1$, $A = P$) and *cycle letters* ($\lambda(x) = \text{the cycle of } x$). A *grading* is a choice of odd cycles C_- ; $\Pi = \pm 1$ on the points of even and odd cycles, $\Gamma_b = \Pi \otimes \bar{\Pi}$ on the doubled bond, $\mathcal{E}_d = \sum_s A_s \otimes \bar{A}_s$. A *holonomy* $h = (h_c) \in U(1)^{\text{cycles}}$ multiplies one edge of each cycle by h_c , P_h . The ring of length n with closure B is $\Psi_B = \sum_{w \in S^n} \text{Tr}(B A_{w_n} \cdots A_{w_1}) |w\rangle$; $B = 1$ is the untwisted (Neveu–Schwarz) and $B = \Pi$ the twisted (Ramond) closure. The *von Mangoldt function* of π is $\Lambda_\pi(n) = \sum_{\ell|n} \ell m_\ell$, the zeta function $\zeta_\pi(u) = \exp \sum_n \text{Tr}(P^n) u^n / n$ and the graded zeta function $\zeta_{\pi,h}^{\text{gr}}(u) = \exp \sum_n \text{str}(P_h^n) u^n / n$.

12.2 Rings and the gas

Proposition 12.2 (Point-letter rings count periodic points). *[sketched]* With point letters, $\Psi_1 = \sum_{\pi^n x = x} |x, \pi x, \dots, \pi^{n-1} x\rangle$, a sum of orthonormal terms, so $\|\Psi_1\|^2 = \#\text{Fix}(\pi^n) = \text{Tr } P^n = \Lambda_\pi(n)$; $\zeta_\pi(u) = 1/\det(1 - uP) = \prod_c (1 - u^{\ell_c})^{-1}$, with poles at the eigenvalues of P (all on the unit circle, one pole at $u = 1$ per cycle); and $\log \zeta_\pi(u) = \sum_n \|\Psi_1\|^2 u^n / n$. For $(12)(345)$: $\Lambda_\pi = 0, 2, 3, 2, 0, 5, \dots$ and $\zeta_\pi = 1/((1 - u^2)(1 - u^3))$.

Proof. $\text{Tr}(A_{x_n} \cdots A_{x_1}) = 1$ iff $x_{k+1} = \pi x_k$ for all k cyclically, i.e. iff the word is an orbit of a point of period n listed from its starting point; distinct starting points give distinct words. $\#\text{Fix}(\pi^n) = \sum_{\ell|n} \ell m_\ell$ since a point of an ℓ -cycle has period n iff $\ell \mid n$. The determinant identity is $\exp \sum_n \text{Tr}(P^n) u^n / n = \exp(-\text{Tr} \log(1 - uP))$, and $\det(1 - uP) = \prod_c (1 - u^{\ell_c})$ because an ℓ -cycle has eigenvalues the ℓ -th roots of unity. $\square$

The weight ℓ_c (“log p ”) is the number of starting points on the prime ring; the ring of length n is nonzero only when n is a multiple of a single cycle length (“a prime power”).

Proposition 12.3 (The gas is the oscillator Fock space; the same number from the bond). *[sketched]* Let the gas be $\ell^2(\cdot)$ of the free commutative monoid on the cycles (multisets of prime rings). (i) The map (multiset with a_c copies of c) $\mapsto \bigotimes_c |a_c\rangle$ is a unitary onto $\bigotimes_c \ell^2(\mathbb{N}_0)$; the length operator becomes $H = \sum_c \ell_c N_c$, $\text{Tr } e^{-\beta H} = \zeta_\pi(e^{-\beta})$, and the energy- N eigenspace has dimension $\#\{(a_c) : \sum a_c \ell_c = N\}$. (ii) On the bosonic Fock space over the bond, $\text{Tr}_{\text{Sym}(\mathbb{C}^X)} u^N \Gamma(P) = \sum_k u^k \text{Tr } \text{Sym}^k(P) = 1/\det(1 - uP)$, and $\text{Tr } \text{Sym}^k(P)$ counts the monomials x^m fixed by π , i.e.

exponent vectors constant on cycles, which are the gas configurations of length k . (iii) The vector $v_\beta = \sum_{(a_c)} e^{-\beta \sum a_c \ell_c / 2} \otimes |a_c\rangle$ is a product vector over the cycles with $\|v_\beta\|^2 = \zeta_\pi(e^{-\beta})$; its vector state equals the Gibbs state on the algebra generated by the N_c and differs from it off that algebra. (iv) $\sum_n \|\Psi_1\|^2 e^{-\beta n} = \langle H \rangle_\beta$, the mean length of the gas.

Proof. (i) is unique factorisation in the free monoid; $\text{Tr } e^{-\beta H} = \prod_c (1 - e^{-\beta \ell_c})^{-1}$. (ii) $\text{Sym}^k(P)$ permutes the monomial basis, so its trace is the number of fixed monomials, and x^m is fixed iff $m_{\pi x} = m_x$; the generating function of $\text{Tr } \text{Sym}^k$ is $\prod_\lambda (1 - u\lambda)^{-1}$ over the eigenvalues. (iii) The sum factorises; the diagonal matrix elements of $|v_\beta\rangle\langle v_\beta|/\|v_\beta\|^2$ are the Gibbs weights, while $\langle v_\beta | S_c | v_\beta \rangle \neq 0$ for the shift S_c whereas $\text{Tr}(\varrho_\beta^G S_c) = 0$. (iv) Differentiate $\log \zeta_\pi(e^{-\beta})$ in β using Proposition 12.2. $\square$

The gas configurations are the diagonal of the second-quantised transfer matrix in the monomial basis: side A computes ζ_π as a plain thermal norm over the gas, side B as a trace over the bond with the transfer matrix inserted, and on the gas itself $\Gamma(P)$ acts as the identity. The “naturals” of the toy are the elements $2^a 3^b$ with integer lengths $2a + 3b$, so H is degenerate (2^3 and 3^2 have the same length); in $\ell^2(\mathbb{N})$ the lengths $\log n$ are distinct because $\log 2, \log 3$ are incommensurable. The prime-side creation operators are the shifts $|a\rangle \mapsto |a+1\rangle$ (the Bost–Connes isometries), not $a^\dagger$: the Hilbert space and the Hamiltonian are those of the oscillators, the algebra is Toeplitz.

12.3 Grading one cycle odd

Theorem 12.4 (The twisted closure induces zeros).

[sketched]

Fix a grading and a holonomy. (i) $\text{str } P_h^n = \sum_{c \text{ even}} \ell_c h_c^{n/\ell_c} [\ell_c \mid n] - \sum_{c \text{ odd}} \ell_c h_c^{n/\ell_c} [\ell_c \mid n]$ and $\zeta_{\pi, h}^{\text{gr}}(u) = 1/\text{sdet}(1 - uP_h) = \prod_{c \text{ odd}} (1 - h_c u^{\ell_c}) / \prod_{c \text{ even}} (1 - h_c u^{\ell_c})$: the odd cycles’ eigenvalues, the ℓ_c -th roots of h_c , are zeros. (ii) The untwisted closure gives ζ_π , with no zeros, for every grading. (iii) A zero and a pole cancel exactly when an even and an odd cycle share a root: for $(12)(345)$ with $h = 1$, $\zeta^{\text{gr}} = (1 - u^3)/(1 - u^2) = (1 + u + u^2)/(1 + u)$, zeros at the primitive cube roots, the pole at $u = 1$ eaten by the odd fixed vector; with $h_{(345)} = -1$, $\zeta^{\text{gr}} = (1 - u + u^2)/(1 - u)$, pole at 1 kept, zeros at $e^{\pm i\pi/3}$, pole at -1 eaten. (iv) On the gas side an odd cycle is a fermionic prime: $\text{Str}_{\Lambda(\mathbb{C}^\ell)} u^N \Gamma(h_c P_c) = \det(1 - u h_c P_c) = 1 - h_c u^{\ell_c}$, the occupied top form contributing $(-u)^{\ell_c}$. $h_c \text{sgn}(c) = -h_c u^{\ell_c}$ for every length. The graded zeta is $\text{Str}_{\text{gas}} u^H$, a Witten index with fugacity, and $\zeta^{\text{gr}} = \langle v_\beta | (-1)^{\hat{F}} | v_\beta \rangle$ is an indefinite overlap, not a norm.

Proof. (i) $\text{Tr}(\Pi P_h^n) = \sum_c \pm \text{Tr}(P_{h,c}^n)$ and $P_{h,c}^n = h_c^{n/\ell_c} \cdot 1$ when $\ell_c \mid n$, traceless otherwise; then $\exp \sum_n \text{str}(P_h^n) u^n / n = \exp(-\text{str} \log(1 - uP_h)) = 1/\text{sdet}(1 - uP_h)$ and $\det(1 - u h_c P_c) = 1 - h_c u^{\ell_c}$. (ii) is Proposition 12.2. (iii) is the factorisation. (iv) $\text{Str } u^N \Gamma(M) = \sum_k (-u)^k \text{Tr } \Lambda^k(M) = \det(1 - uM)$; the ℓ -cycle is even or odd as ℓ is odd or even, so $(-1)^\ell \text{sgn} = -1$. $\square$

The three boundary conditions are separate knobs: the grading alone does nothing (ii), the parity insertion produces the numerator (i), and the holonomy places the zeros (i); (iii) is the net-multiplicity (rigidity) phenomenon of Section 18 in miniature: “grade a sector odd” is only half a specification. Every eigenvalue of a permutation has modulus one, so the pole circle and the zero circle coincide; the critical-line separation needs weights $\sqrt{q}$ on the odd cycle (Section 34).

Corollary 12.5 (All primes fermionic: the Möbius function is a fermion parity).

[sketched]

Grading every cycle odd gives $\zeta_\pi^{\text{gr}} = \det(1 - uP) = 1/\zeta_\pi$. In the arithmetic gas, grading every prime odd gives $\prod_p (1 - p^{-s}) = 1/\zeta(s) = \sum_n \text{Möb}(n) n^{-s}$: the squarefree gas with $\text{Möb}(n) = (-1)^{\#\text{primes}}$ its fermion parity; each finite factor $1 - p^{-s}$ vanishes on $\text{Re } s = 0$; this says nothing about the continued product $1/\zeta$, whose poles in the strip are the zeros of ζ (observation 23.8).

Proof. Set C_- = all cycles in Theorem 12.4(i); for the arithmetic case expand the Euler product, each prime occupied at most once with sign -1 (checked exactly for the 13-smooth numbers at $s = 2$). $\square$

12.4 Where the sign can and cannot live: the physical letters

Proposition 12.6 (Ring norms see the letters only through the transfer channel). *[sketched]* For any graded lattice tensor $\{A_s\}_{s \in S}$ and closure B , $\|\Psi_B\|^2 = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B})\mathcal{E}_d^n]$ depends on the letters only through $\mathcal{E}_d$. If $V: \mathbb{C}^S \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^{S'}$ is an isometry and $A'_t = \sum_s V_{ts} A_s$, then $\mathcal{E}'_d = \mathcal{E}_d$ and $\Psi'_B = V^{\otimes n} \Psi_B$; conversely two families with the same $\mathcal{E}_d$ are so related after padding by zero letters (Kraus uniqueness). The minimal number of letters is the rank of the Choi matrix $\sum_s |A_s\rangle\langle A_s|$ (the Kraus rank of the transfer channel), and $\text{Tr}[\Gamma_b \mathcal{E}_d^n]$ is the Ramond amplitude of the one-letter MPS with matrix $\mathcal{E}_d$ on the doubled bond graded by Γ_b .

Proof. $\sum_t A'_t \otimes \bar{A}'_t = \sum_{s,s'} (V^\dagger V)_{s's} A_s \otimes \bar{A}_{s'}$ and $V^\dagger V = 1$; Ψ'_B is the image of Ψ_B under $V^{\otimes n}$ by linearity. The converse and the rank statement are the unitary freedom of Kraus decompositions of a completely positive map. The last claim is the definition of the one-letter amplitude. $\square$

Lemma 12.7 (Sector-separating letters kill the odd sector). *[sketched]* If every letter is supported in a single parity sector, $A_s = \Pi_{\epsilon_s} A_s \Pi_{\epsilon_s}$ with $\epsilon_s \in \{+, -\}$, then $\mathcal{E}_d$ vanishes on the Γ_b -odd doubled subspace, so $\text{Tr}[\Gamma_b \mathcal{E}_d^n] = \text{Tr} \mathcal{E}_d^n$: the twisted and untwisted ring norms coincide, no ring norm carries a sign, and the ring zeta $1/\text{sdet}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d)$ has no zeros.

Proof. On $|x\rangle \otimes |y\rangle$ with x even and y odd, $A_s|x\rangle \neq 0$ forces $\epsilon_s = +$ and $\bar{A}_s|y\rangle \neq 0$ forces $\epsilon_s = -$; so every term of $\mathcal{E}_d$ vanishes there, and likewise on odd $\otimes$ even. The Γ_b -odd subspace is exactly their sum. $\square$

Proposition 12.8 (The word formula and the letter ladder). *[sketched]* For a letter assignment λ of a graded permutation, the Ramond ring amplitude of the word $w \in S^n$ is $\sum_x (-1)^{|x|}$ over the points x of period n whose orbit emits w , and $\|\Psi_\Pi\|^2 = \sum_w |\sum_{x \rightarrow w} (-1)^{|x|}|^2$. Hence: point letters give $\|\Psi_\Pi\|^2 = \text{Tr} P^n$ (Kraus rank $|X|$); cycle letters give $\sum_c (\text{Tr} P_c^n)^2$ (Kraus rank the number of cycles); one letter gives $|\text{str} P^n|^2$ (Kraus rank 1), whose ring zeta is $1/\text{sdet}(1 - uP \otimes \bar{P})$ with the products (even eigenvalue) $\times$ (odd eigenvalue) as zeros. Any λ that separates even from odd points falls under Lemma 12.7. For (12)(345) at $n = 6$ the three norms are 5, 13 and $1 = (2 - 3)^2$; the one-letter ring zeta is $(1 + u^3)^2 / ((1 - u^2)^2(1 - u^3))$.

Proof. $\text{Tr}(\Pi A_{w_n} \cdots A_{w_1}) = \sum_x \Pi_{xx} [\text{orbit of } x \text{ emits } w]$ since each A_s moves x to πx iff $\lambda(x) = s$. Point letters: one orbit per word. Cycle letters: all ℓ_c starting points of a cycle emit the same word with the same sign. One letter: all periodic points emit the same word. The one-letter doubled bond has eigenvalues $\lambda \bar{\lambda}'$ with parity the product of parities. $\square$

For 0/1 letters the two sectors interfere only if they emit literally the same word, which forces one letter; weighted letters $\text{diag}(a_s, c a_s)$ (Section 34, genus one) emit the same word with amplitudes differing by c^n , so several letters coexist with the sign. The weights ($\sqrt{q}$, phases) buy that freedom.

Proposition 12.9 (A parity-measuring jump shifts the odd spectrum uniformly). *[sketched]* (i) Composing the transfer channel with the partial dephasing $X \mapsto (1-p)X + p\Pi X \Pi$ multiplies the Γ_b -odd doubled subspace by $1 - 2p$ and fixes the even one, so $\|\Psi_\Pi\|^2 = \text{Tr}_{\text{even}} \mathcal{E}_d^n - (1 - 2p)^n \text{Tr}_{\text{odd}} \mathcal{E}_d^n$. (ii) For a graded Lindbladian with generator $\mathbb{T}$ on the doubled bond, adding the jump $\sqrt{\gamma} \Pi$ adds exactly $\gamma(\Gamma_b - 1)$: every eigenvalue on the even-odd coherences is shifted by -2γ and every even-sector eigenvalue is unchanged. (iii) For a finite abelian group of unitaries $U_a = \sum_\chi \chi(a) \Pi_\chi$ diagonal in a

character grading, the jumps $\sqrt{\gamma/|G|} U_a$ add $-\gamma$ on every cross-character coherence $|\chi\rangle\langle\chi'|$, $\chi \neq \chi'$, and 0 within a sector; the full group average as a single-step channel is the character measurement and annihilates the cross-character coherences. (iv) Consequently a uniform-rate (Ramanujan) odd spectrum is preserved and translated by parity or character dephasing; if the generator on the even–odd coherences is $\mathbb{T}_0 - 2\gamma$ with $\mathbb{T}_0$ anti-Hermitian, the odd spectrum lies on the line $\text{Re} = -2\gamma$, and $2\gamma = \frac{1}{4}$ is the $e^{-t/4}$ of the Riemann normalisation.

Proof. (i) $\Pi X \Pi = \pm X$ on the Γ_b -even/odd subspaces. (ii) The dissipator of $R = \sqrt{\gamma} \Pi$ is $\gamma(\Pi X \Pi - X)$ since $R^\dagger R = \gamma$; on the doubled bond this is $\gamma(\Gamma_b - 1)$, which commutes with $\mathbb{T}$ and is 0 on the even and -2γ on the odd subspace. (iii) $\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_a \chi(a) \chi'(a) = \delta_{\chi\chi'}$. (iv) is (ii) with the stated form. $\square$

Observation 12.10 (What fixes the physical dimension). [sketched] The zeta function never chooses the physical dimension. From below it is bounded by the Kraus rank of the transfer channel, the minimal choice being canonical up to a unitary on the letters (Proposition 12.6); one letter is the universal description of norms (the channel itself), and the letters are what one adds back to purify. One and five letters for a permutation are not two letterings of one object but two channels, $\text{Ad}(P)$ and the dephased permutation $X \mapsto P \text{diag}(X) P^\dagger$, which agree on the classical (diagonal) sector where the count lives: the physical dimension measures the which-path information the environment records per step (the field species, in Lindblad language the number of jump channels). From above, once a grading is in play, the letters must be coarser than the grading: zeros are eigenvalues of the transfer on the even–odd coherences, and letters that record the bond parity kill them (Lemma 12.7, the ladder 5, 13, 1 of Proposition 12.8); partial parity recording at rate γ does not kill them but shifts them uniformly (Proposition 12.9). The “one letter per prime” choice, natural on the gas side, is the worst one when the grading is by prime.

Observation 12.11 (Reading for the Riemann cMPS: prime jumps versus symmetry jumps). [sketched] TJO asked (2026-09-14) whether the jump operators of the Riemann cMPS should be the prime jumps (on-site physical space with levels labelled by primes) or unitaries from the Bost–Connes symmetry $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}^\times$. What the toy makes readable, as a reading and not a theorem: (a) the ring norms and hence the explicit formula see the jumps only through the Lindbladian (Proposition 12.6); the two proposals generate different dissipators (isometries $\mathfrak{m}_p$ shifting the length by $\log p$ versus unitaries commuting with H), so the question is about $\mathbb{T}$, not about unravellings. (b) Galois jumps are diagonal in the character grading of conjecture 47.4 ($U_a = \sum_\chi \chi(a) \Pi_\chi$); by Proposition 12.9(iii) their dissipator is character dephasing: it sets one uniform rate on every trivial–nontrivial coherence, leaves the trivial (pole) sector alone, and with inversion-symmetric rates produces no frequency (Proposition 23.4); taken as a full average per step it is a character measurement and removes the zeros. They are the natural carrier of the $e^{-t/4}$, i.e. of the rate half of the Ramanujan statement, not of the zeros’ positions. (c) Prime jumps act on every character sector ($\chi \mapsto \chi(p \cdot)$), so they do not separate the sectors, and they carry the lengths: they are the record (the prime comb of the explicit formula is their emission record). Alone they give a Gibbs fixed point with real spectrum and no zeros (Section 19). The grading must be transverse to the primes: grading the primes themselves odd gives $1/\zeta$ and zeros on $\text{Re } s = 0$ (Corollary 12.5). (d) Neither family supplies the frequencies γ_n ; those need a Hamiltonian, or a non-normal even–odd coupling, on the coherences between the pole sector and the nontrivial-character sectors: the Hilbert–Pólya half remains. (e) The ansatz shape this suggests: prime jumps with weights (record, lengths, Gibbs fixed point) + Galois dephasing at $2\gamma = \frac{1}{4}$ (rate) + an even–odd Hamiltonian part (frequencies), with RH the statement that the dissipation on the even–odd coherences is pure dephasing, i.e. uniform. Unreviewed; the finite covariant cones of Section 20 are the place to test (e).

Numerical result 12.12 (The graded permutation, 46 checks). [numerical]
`scripts/graded_permutation.py` (`outputs/graded_permutation.txt`): $\text{Tr } P^n = \Lambda_\pi(n)$ and the point-letter ring as the orbit superposition for $n = 2, 3, 4, 6$; the zeta series against $1/((1-u^2)(1-u^3))$ and the eigenvalues of P ; gas coefficients against $\#\{2a + 3b = N\}$, against fixed monomials of $\text{Sym}^k(P)$ for $k \leq 7$, and against the eigenvalue product; $\|v_\beta\|^2 = \zeta_\pi(e^{-\beta})$, product structure, the mean-length identity, and a coherence $\langle v|S|v \rangle = 0.4966$ absent from the Gibbs state; $\text{str } P^n$, the Ramond and Neveu–Schwarz zeta functions, holonomies $h = -1, i$, the fermionic-cycle identity for $\ell \leq 7$, and the Möbius identity exactly at $s = 2$ on 13-smooth numbers; the letter ladder (Kraus ranks 1, 2, 5; norms $|\text{str } P^n|^2$, $\sum_c (\text{Tr } P_c^n)^2$, $\text{Tr } P^n$), the one-letter ring zeta, invariance under a random unitary mixing and an isometric padding to eight letters, the word formula for all three assignments, and twisted = untwisted for the separating assignments; parity dephasing at $p = 0.3$ and the jump $\sqrt{\gamma}\Pi$ at $\gamma = 1/8$ on a random graded Lindbladian with one even and one odd jump (odd spectrum shifted by exactly $-1/4$, even unchanged).

13 The Ramanujan Property for Graded Transfer Channels

Question (TJO, 2026-09-15). Working from the MPS picture, and given that the graded supertrace is necessary for zeta zeros, what is the correct definition of the Ramanujan property, rigorous and meaningful in the continuum limit, with Harrow expanders as a test case? Do we understand it in the graded case at all, or do we only have quantum expanders for ungraded bonds and antiperiodic closures? *Answer.* The suspicion is right about the literature and about this book up to Section 35: every quantum expander in sight is ungraded, and on an ungraded bond the two closures coincide and the ring zeta has only poles (Proposition 13.3). The definition is Definition 10.3, stated on the divisor of the periodic ring zeta, and it is exactly stable under the continuum limit (Propositions 14.1 and 14.2). Graded quantum expanders exist with a mechanism (Theorem 13.7), the smallest being a qubit with Pauli letters whose graded Ihara zeta is an elliptic curve zeta (Proposition 13.9). Everything in this section is the notebook's own work of one session (author claude:fable-5.1, numerics `scripts/graded_ramanujan.py`, 81 checks), with one codex gpt-6-astra prover lane (`notes/ramanujan-graded/astra-proofs.md`: 4 proved, 9 corrected, 1 refuted, a 41-row correction ledger, 132 further checks) whose corrections are applied below and recorded in the claims database; nothing here has had an independent (second-family) review.

13.1 Positivity and the P -mode

Proposition 13.1 (Graded Weil–Hodge inequality). *[sketched] For every graded transfer channel and $n \geq 1$, $|\mathrm{Tr} \mathcal{E}_d^{(1)^n}| \leq \mathrm{Tr} \mathcal{E}_d^{(0)^n}$; hence $\mathrm{rad}(\mathcal{E}_d^{(1)}) \leq \mathrm{rad}(\mathcal{E}_d^{(0)}) = q$, both sector spectra being conjugation closed. Equal radii do not force a common eigenvalue: the single even letter P on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$ has even spectrum $\{1, 1\}$ and odd $\{-1, -1\}$ (prover, ledger L01).*

Proof. Both closures are ring norms: $\mathrm{Tr} \mathcal{E}_d^n = \sum_w |\mathrm{Tr} A_w|^2 \geq 0$ and $\mathrm{str} \mathcal{E}_d^n = \sum_w |\mathrm{Tr}(PA_w)|^2 \geq 0$ (Definition 9.1), i.e. $\mathrm{Tr} \mathcal{E}_d^{(0)^n} \geq \pm \mathrm{Tr} \mathcal{E}_d^{(1)^n}$; a Perron eigenmatrix $R \geq 0$ averages to the even Perron eigenmatrix $(R + PRP)/2$, so the radius is attained evenly (positive operators need not be even, ledger L02). Proved by the prover lane (D1). This is the finite shadow of the Hodge index inequality of Section 32. $\square$

Proposition 13.2 (The P -mode). *[sketched] $\mathcal{E}_d(P) = P \sum_s \epsilon_s A_s A_s^\dagger$. Under parity-twisted unitality (Definition 10.2) P is an even eigenvector with eigenvalue r_P ; for a graded representation channel $r_P = \epsilon(W_S)$, the sign character evaluated on the walk element. The P -mode is structural but not trivial: for the elliptic tensor of Section 35 $r_P = 1$ (projective) or 0 (affine), the H^0 pole and the functional-equation partner of the fixed point; for the Pauli letters below $r_P = -2$ lies inside the Hastings band and its Ihara–Bass quadratic contributes a pole pair on the critical circle; for all letters odd $r_P = -q - 1$ is the period image of the fixed point (bipartite case). For unitary letters the Ramanujan property therefore imposes the balance condition $|w_{\mathrm{even}} - w_{\mathrm{odd}}| \leq \lambda_H$ unless $r_P \in S_{\mathrm{triv}}$.*

Proof. $PA_s P = \epsilon_s A_s$ gives $A_s P A_s^\dagger = \epsilon_s P A_s A_s^\dagger$; for a representation channel $\pi(s) P \pi(s)^\dagger = \epsilon(s) P$. Proved by the prover lane (D2). Checked on every example of numerical result 13.8, including $\sum_s \epsilon_s A_s A_s^\dagger = 1$ for the 06h tensor. $\square$

13.2 Graded quantum Ihara–Bass and graded quantum expanders

Proposition 13.3 (No zeros without a grading; no unique fixed point with only even letters). *[sketched] (i) For $P = 1$ the two closures coincide and the ring zeta $1/\det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d)$ has no zeros; a quantum expander in the sense of Definition 3.16 (Hastings, Harrow, the Weil–LPS channels of*

Section 27, the complexes of Section 40) is such a channel. (ii) If every letter is even, the bond splits, $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_d^n = \|\Psi_+ - \Psi_-\|^2$, and both 1_+ and 1_- are fixed: no unique fixed point. Zeros with a unique fixed point require odd letters, i.e. letters that anticommute with P . (iii) No nonzero positive operator is odd; odd fixed operators can nevertheless exist when the stationary state is not unique (the identity channel fixes every coherence), and uniqueness excludes them (ledger L29).

Proof. (i) is the definition of the ring zeta; (ii) is the second reading after Theorem 22.2 together with $\mathcal{E}_d(1_\pm) = 1_\pm$ for even unital letters; (iii) $PXP = -X \geq 0$ forces $X = 0$, and a Hermitian fixed operator of a finite CPTP map is a combination of stationary states. Proved by the prover lane (D14). $\square$

Theorem 13.4 (Graded quantum Ihara–Bass). *[sketched]* For the graded Hashimoto operator of Definition 10.5 with $\Sigma_k = D\Phi|_k$, $n_0 = D_+^2 + D_-^2$ and $n_1 = 2D_+D_-$,

$$\det(1 - uT_k) = (1 - u^2)^{n_k(D-2)/2} \det(1 - u\Sigma_k + (D-1)u^2), \quad k = 0, 1,$$

so the graded quantum Ihara zeta is $(1 - u^2)^{-(D-2)(D_+ - D_-)^2/2} \prod_{\lambda \text{ odd}} (1 - \lambda u + qu^2) / \prod_{\lambda \text{ even}} (1 - \lambda u + qu^2)$, $q = D - 1$, and for a balanced grading the $(1 - u^2)$ factors cancel exactly.

Proof. $\Gamma_b \otimes 1$ commutes with T , with $\Sigma \otimes 1$ and with the reversal; the proof of Theorem 37.1 in the unitary case (Corollary 37.3) runs on each invariant subspace with n^2 replaced by its dimension. Proved by the prover lane (D3). Verified to 10^{-9} on all three examples of numerical result 13.8. $\square$

Corollary 13.5 (Band if and only if circle, sector by sector). *[sketched]* For a Hermitian graded channel (unitary letters closed under adjoint, equal weights) each adjacency eigenvalue λ of a sector gives two edge eigenvalues with $\mu_+\mu_- = q$, both of modulus $\sqrt{q}$ iff $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$. Hence: every point of the retained net divisor of the graded quantum Ihara zeta lies on $|u| = q^{-1/2}$ iff $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ for every $\lambda \notin \{\pm(q+1)\}$ with nonzero net multiplicity $m_0(\lambda) - m_1(\lambda)$. A bound on both entire sectors implies the divisor statement; the converse is false without a no-cancellation hypothesis (prover, D4: a primitive degree-14 channel with even $\{14, 10\}$, odd $\{10, 6\}$ has the mode 10 outside the band, cancelled, and reduced zeta $(1 - 6u + 13u^2)/((1-u)(1-13u))$). Zeros are the net-odd quadratics and poles the net-even ones; the trivial factors are $\{1, q\}$ from $\lambda = q + 1$, $\{-1, -q\}$ from $\lambda = -(q + 1)$ when present, and ± 1 from the $(1 - u^2)$ factors; zeta points are the reciprocals of edge eigenvalues.

Proof. Theorem 13.4 and the root analysis of observation 37.7, applied to each sector and then to the net multiplicities; Σ_1 is Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjoint so its eigenvalues are real. Corrected and proved by the prover lane (D4). $\square$

Observation 13.6 (No odd-sector Alon–Boppana bound).

[sketched] The

drafted odd-sector analogue of Hastings’ lower bound, $\text{rad}(\Phi|_1) \geq \lambda_H - o(1)$, is false (prover, D5, refuted): the degree-four channel $\frac{1}{4}(2 \text{Ad } 1 + 2 \text{Ad } P)$ on $\mathbb{C}^{m|m}$ has $\Phi|_1 = 0$ for every m , and there are primitive degree-sixteen families with $\text{rad}(\Phi|_1) = 0$ and unbounded m . Hastings’ argument (prov:hastings07-alon-boppana, 0706.0556:sd10.tex:284-287, $N(0, m) \setminus \text{geq } c \times (2\sqrt{\{D-1\}^m / (m+1)^{\{3/2\}}})$) needs every word trace $|\text{Tr } U_w|^2 \geq 0$; on the odd sector word traces can be negative. The even letter P is exactly the parity jump of Proposition 12.9, which shifts the whole odd spectrum: the odd gap has no universal lower bound, and “Ramanujan” for the odd sector is an upper bound (the band), not an optimality statement.

13.3 Graded Harrow expanders

Theorem 13.7 (Index-two gradings of Harrow channels). *[sketched]* Let Φ be the graded representation channel of Definition 10.6. (i) $\Gamma_b = \text{Ad}(P)$ is a G -intertwiner of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi} = \text{End}(V)$; as G_0 -modules the even sector is $\pi_+ \otimes \bar{\pi}_+ \oplus \pi_- \otimes \bar{\pi}_-$ and the odd sector $\pi_+ \otimes \bar{\pi}_- \oplus \pi_- \otimes \bar{\pi}_+$. (ii) The trivial representation occurs once, in the even sector (the scalars, the fixed point), and the sign representation ϵ once, in the even sector, spanned by P , with $\Phi(P) = \epsilon(W_S)P$. (iii) Every other constituent v of either sector satisfies $|v(W_S)| \leq \lambda_2(\text{Cay}(G, S))$ (cited fact 44.5); if $\text{Cay}(G, S)$ is Ramanujan, Φ is a graded Ramanujan quantum expander and, by Corollary 13.5, the odd sector of its graded Hashimoto operator carries zeros on $|u| = q^{-1/2}$, $q = |S| - 1$. (iv) Character formulas: $\text{Tr } \Phi^n = |S|^{-n} \sum_{|w|=n} |\chi_\pi(w)|^2$ and $\text{str } \Phi^n = |S|^{-n} \sum_{|w|=n} |\chi_+(w) - \chi_-(w)|^2$, where $\chi_\pi = \chi_+ + \chi_-$ on G_0 and $\chi_\pi = 0$ off G_0 ; only words with product in G_0 contribute to either ring norm. (v) Artin factorisation: with $a_{k,v}$ the multiplicity of v in sector k , the graded quantum Ihara zeta is $\prod_v \det(1 - uT_v)^{a_{1,v} - a_{0,v}}$, T_v the Hashimoto operator built from the individual letters $v(s)$ and the reversal (not from the averaged matrix $v(W_S)$ alone), so the L -functions of the graded expander are the v -factors, with net sign by sector.

Proof. (i) $\text{Ad}(P) \text{Ad}(\pi(g)) = \text{Ad}(\epsilon(g)\pi(g)P) = \text{Ad}(\pi(g)) \text{Ad}(P)$. (ii) π irreducible gives $\text{End}_G(V) = \mathbb{C}$; P spans the ϵ -isotypic part since $\text{Ad } \pi(g)P = \epsilon(g)P$, and $\epsilon \neq 1$ so it is not the trivial constituent; both are even. (iii) is Harrow's argument on each sector. (iv) $\text{Tr } \text{Ad}(U) = |\text{Tr } U|^2$ and $\text{str } \text{Ad}(U) = |\text{Tr}(PU)|^2$; $\text{Tr}(P\pi(g)) = \chi_+(g) - \chi_-(g)$ for $g \in G_0$ and 0 for block-off-diagonal $\pi(g)$; the sums run over labelled words with product in G_0 . (v) decompose each sector into G -isotypic components; T commutes with the decomposition. Corrected and proved by the prover lane (D6, ledger L06–L09, L37). $\square$

Numerical result 13.8 (Three graded Ramanujan expanders). *[numerical]*

`scripts/graded_ramanujan.py` (outputs/graded_ramanujan.txt, 81 checks). **(a) Pauli.** $V = \mathbb{C}^{1|1}$, $P = Z$, letters X, X, Y, Y, Z, Z (each self-adjoint letter twice so the reversal is fixed-point-free), $D = 6$, $q = 5$. Even spectrum $\{6, -2\}$, odd $\{-2, -2\}$, all nontrivial in the band $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{5}$ (the direct, non-lifted transfer has $Z_P = (1 + 2u)/(1 - 6u)$ with its zero at -2 , off the circle: the curve appears only after the non-backtracking lift); graded Ihara–Bass on both sectors; odd edge eigenvalues on $|\mu| = \sqrt{5}$; $\text{str } T^n = 8, 32, 104, 640, 3208, 15392 = 1 + 5^n - (\mu^n + \bar{\mu}^n)$ with $\mu = -1 + 2i$, verified against the word sum $\sum_w |\text{Tr}(PU_w)|^2$ for $n \leq 3$; graded quantum Ihara zeta $(1 + 2u + 5u^2)/((1 - u)(1 - 5u))$. **(b) The 06h elliptic tensor** ($q = 5$, $r_P = 1$): $\sum_s \epsilon_s A_s A_s^\dagger = 1$, $\mathcal{E}_d(P) = P$, even $\{5, 1\} = S_{\text{triv}}$, odd $\{\pi, \bar{\pi}\}$ on the circle with $\mathcal{E}_d^{(1)\dagger} \mathcal{E}_d^{(1)} = 5$, graded Weil–Hodge inequality for $n \leq 8$. **(c) Graded Weil–LPS.** $G = \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, π the principal series $I(\chi, \chi^{-1})$ with χ of order 4 (dimension $p + 1$, splitting on PSL_2 into halves of dimension $(p + 1)/2$, P found as the traceless element of the commutant of $\pi(G_0)$ by exact group averaging), S the $q + 1$ LPS quaternions of norm q with $(q/p) = -1$, all in the odd coset; $(p; q) = (5; 13)$ and $(13; 5)$. Cayley graphs on 120 and 2184 vertices, bipartite, Ramanujan (max nontrivial $|\lambda| = 4.00$ and 4.25 against $2\sqrt{q} = 7.21$ and 4.47); both sectors of Φ in the band, P -mode $-(q + 1)$, Harrow containment of both sector spectra in the Cayley spectrum; $\text{str } \Phi^n \geq 0$ with the character formula on words of length ≤ 3 , vanishing for odd n ; graded Ihara–Bass on both sectors of the 504- and 1176-dimensional Hashimoto operators; odd edge eigenvalues 36 and 196 on $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$ (raw counts) and the rest at $|\mu| = 1$; even ones on the circle plus $\{\pm q, \pm 1\}$. The sectors share eigenvalues, and only the net divisor survives: for $(5; 13)$ there are 16 cancelled pairs and the reduced zeta is $(1 - 4u + 13u^2)(1 + 4u + 13u^2)/[(1 - u)(1 - 13u)(1 + u)(1 + 13u)]$ (numerator degree 4, no nontrivial poles); for $(13; 5)$ the reduced numerator and denominator both have degree 144, the denominator carrying 140 nontrivial pole factors on the circle (e.g. $\lambda = 0$ has net even multiplicity

4). My first printout claimed numerator degrees 36 and 196 over four trivial factors; the prover's independent audit (`finite/harrow_audit.py`, 16 checks) corrected it and the script now prints the net divisor. In the (13;5) case the extremal Hecke eigenvalue 4.2497 lives in the odd sector. **(d) Continuum.** The jump Lindbladian of (a) commutes with Γ_b ; even $\{0, -2(g_X + g_Y)\}$, odd $\{-2(g_Z + g_Y), -2(g_Z + g_X)\}$; $\text{str}(1 + \epsilon \mathbb{T})^{L/\epsilon} \rightarrow \text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ at $\epsilon = 10^{-3}$; $\text{str } e^{t\mathbb{T}} \geq 0$.

Proposition 13.9 (The qubit with unitary letters). *[sketched] For D unitary homogeneous letters closed under adjoint on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$, $q = D - 1$, write the even letters $\text{diag}(a_i, d_i)$ and the odd ones with off-diagonal entries a_i, d_i (all of modulus one), and put $r_P = N_{\text{even}} - N_{\text{odd}}$, $x = \sum_{\text{even}} a_i \bar{d}_i \in \mathbb{R}$, $y = \sum_{\text{odd}} a_i \bar{d}_i$. Then $\text{spec } \Sigma_0 = \{D, r_P\}$, $\Sigma_1 = \begin{pmatrix} x & y \\ y & x \end{pmatrix}$ with eigenvalues $\lambda_{\pm} = x \pm |y|$, and*

$$\frac{(1 - \lambda_+ u + qu^2)(1 - \lambda_- u + qu^2)}{(1 - u)(1 - qu)(1 - r_P u + qu^2)}$$

is the graded quantum Ihara zeta. The sector Ramanujan condition is $|r_P|, |\lambda_{\pm}| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ (or, all letters odd, $r_P = -D$, $x = 0$ and $|y| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ after removing the even $\pm D$ modes); the divisor condition tests only uncanceled quadratics. For the Pauli letters $r_P = \lambda_{\pm} = -2$, one odd quadratic cancels the P -mode pole pair, and the result is the zeta function of the elliptic curves $y^2 = x^3 + 4x + b$, $b \in \{0, 1, 4\}$, over $\mathbb{F}_5$ (8 points, $a_5 = -2$): the periodic non-backtracking ring norms of a qubit with Pauli letters count the points of an elliptic curve. The numerator is in general not integral (a Ramanujan example with $N_P(1) = 16/3$), need not be a Weil polynomial, and an integral Weil numerator need not be a curve numerator ($(1 - 3u)^4$ over $\mathbb{F}_9$ would give -2 points); ring norms of unitary letters are weighted squared amplitudes, not word counts, unless the letters are 0/1 or the words are counted with multiplicity as here (prover, D13, ledger L25–L27).

Proof. Theorem 13.4 with $n_0 = n_1 = 2$; the even sector is spanned by 1 and P (Proposition 13.2); the odd block is computed in the basis (E_{01}, E_{10}) . Corrected and proved by the prover lane (D13). The Pauli case is numerical result 13.8(a); it is an ordinary representation of the Pauli group with $G_0 = \langle iI, Z \rangle$, projective on the abelian quotient (ledger L09). $\square$

14 The Graded Ramanujan Property in the Continuum

This section continues Section 13: the definitions are those of Section 10, the drafted statements are the orchestrator's (author claude:fable-5.1, one codex prover lane, `notes/ramanujan-graded/`), and nothing here has had an independent review.

14.1 The continuum limit

Proposition 14.1 (Exactness under the continuum limit).

[sketched-conditional]

For a graded cMPS generator $\mathbb{T}$ (Q even, R_a homogeneous) the lattice channel $\mathcal{E}_{d\epsilon} = e^{\epsilon\mathbb{T}}$ is a graded transfer channel with periodic ring norms $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_{d\epsilon}^n = \text{str } e^{n\epsilon\mathbb{T}}$ for every ϵ , and its divisor is the push-forward $\nu_\epsilon(w) = \sum_{e^\lambda=w} \nu(\lambda)$. Since $|e^{\epsilon\lambda}| = e^{\epsilon c}$ iff $\text{Re } \lambda = c$, a line statement on all retained sector eigenvalues is ϵ -independent; the net-divisor statements (RH), (FE), (Ram) are ϵ -independent for ϵ small enough that no two divisor points alias ($\epsilon(\lambda - \lambda') \notin 2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$) and none aliases a trivial mode; at $\epsilon = 1$ a CP example whose rates all alias to e has a lattice divisor that cancels completely while $\text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ does not vanish between the samples (prover, D7, ledger L10).

Proof. $\text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}} = \sum_\lambda \nu(\lambda) e^{\lambda L}$ (Theorem 22.4); the exponential map pushes forward signed multiplicities and sends vertical lines to circles. Corrected and proved by the prover lane (D7). $\square$

Proposition 14.2 (Graded Chernoff limit: the grading lives in the jumps).

[sketched]

On a fixed finite bond let Φ_ϵ be parity-covariant CPTP maps with $\|\Phi_\epsilon - 1 - \epsilon\mathbb{T}\| = \epsilon\delta(\epsilon)$, $\delta(\epsilon) \rightarrow 0$, in an induced norm. Then $\Phi_\epsilon^{[L/\epsilon]} \rightarrow e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ in norm uniformly on $[0, L_0]$, both ring norms converge, $\mathbb{T}$ commutes with Γ_b , and $\mathbb{T}$ has a GKSL presentation with $[H, P] = 0$ and homogeneous jumps R_a (reached by a canonical change of noise basis, not necessarily by an even unitary remix alone; ledger L38), i.e. $Q = -iH - \frac{1}{2} \sum R_a^\dagger R_a$ is even. For any homogeneous Kraus representation of Φ_ϵ the odd letters satisfy $\sum_{a \text{ odd}} \|A_a(\epsilon)\|_{\text{HS}}^2 = O(\epsilon)$ (Choi odd-block estimate): odd letters are collectively of order $\sqrt{\epsilon}$ and can never be a drift letter close to the identity ($PAP = -A$, $A = 1 + B$ give $\|B\| \geq 1$); individual limits $A_a/\sqrt{\epsilon} \rightarrow R_a$ require a choice of Kraus gauge (ledger L12). In the continuum, parity-changing dynamics is dissipative and there is no Hamiltonian odd letter.

Proof. Chernoff's product estimate on a fixed finite bond; Γ_b -invariance passes to the limit; a Γ_b -commuting GKSL generator has a homogeneous canonical presentation. Checked in numerical result 13.8(d) and by the prover's CPTP Euler family with first-order norm convergence under mesh halving. Corrected and proved by the prover lane (D8, ledger L11–L12, L38). This is why observation 12.11 needed an even-odd Hamiltonian on the doubled bond rather than an odd letter. $\square$

Proposition 14.3 (Jump Lindbladians: the band is affine).

[sketched]

For $\mathbb{T} = \sum_s g_s (\text{Ad } U_s - 1)$ with homogeneous unitaries closed under adjoint, $e^{t\mathbb{T}} = e^{-\gamma t} e^{\gamma t \Phi}$ with $\gamma = \sum_s g_s$ and Φ the weighted channel, so $\text{spec } \mathbb{T} = \gamma(\text{spec } \Phi - 1)$ sector by sector, and the graded Ramanujan band for equal rates is $[-\gamma(1 + \lambda_H), -\gamma(1 - \lambda_H)]$ on both sectors; the non-backtracking lift exists since the words are discrete.

Proof. $\mathbb{T} = \gamma(\Phi - 1)$ with Φ and 1 commuting. Proved by the prover lane (D9). numerical result 13.8(d). $\square$

Observation 14.4 (The divisor when there is no trace).

[sketched-conditional]

For an infinite-dimensional graded bond the ring norms are distributions (Definition 5.2) or correlation functions of regular data. The prover lane (D10) makes this a *relative resonance divisor*: given specified

regular spaces, a meromorphic continuation of the resolvent between them beyond $\operatorname{Re} z = \omega/2$ (an assumption of the kind of assumption 18.5), and finite-rank Riesz projections at its poles, the divisor is the signed count of algebraic multiplicities of those projections, sector by sector; the order of a scalar correlation pole does not measure multiplicity, and a general non-normal generator has no scalar spectral measure, so with continuous spectrum one retains vector-dependent spectral measures or supplies a spectral theorem with weights (ledger L13–L14). The definition is deliberately not the L^2 spectrum of $\mathbb{T}$: for the compressed Riemann semigroup $\|Z(t)\| = 1$ for all t (two readers, 2026-09-14, unreviewed), so no statement on K_S sees the rate $1/4$; (HP) must then be stated on a weighted or anisotropic space with domain and norm-equivalence qualifications, as resonances are for Anosov flows. For the Riemann graded generator of Proposition 18.20 the reference rates are 0 and $-\frac{1}{2}$, the archimedean ladder $-(k + \frac{1}{2})$ must be designated trivial, and the regular nontrivial modes have centre $-\frac{1}{4}$ iff RH; the realisation of that generator as a doubled-bond cMPS is not supplied (it is a graded spectral transfer, Definition 10.3).

14.2 Harrow’s continuum limit, ungraded and graded

Observation 14.5 (Continuous Harrow: Ramanujan is temperedness). [sketched] Replacing the finite group by a Lie group and the letters by $\exp(\pm\sqrt{\epsilon}X_j)$ gives $\Phi_\epsilon = 1 + (\epsilon/2d) \sum_j B_j^2 + O(\epsilon^2)$, the representation Lindbladian of Proposition 45.19 divided by d ; with $\mathbb{T}_* = \frac{1}{2}(B_H^2 + B_E^2) = 2\Omega + \frac{1}{2}B_W^2$ (shard 09b) the equally averaged two-generator walk has generator $\mathbb{T}_*/2$ and threshold $\frac{1}{4}$, and $\mathbb{T}_*$ itself (steps $\exp(\pm\sqrt{d\epsilon}X_j)$) has threshold $\frac{1}{2}$ (ledger L15). For an irreducible tempered π of $\operatorname{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, $\pi \otimes \pi$ is tempered (Fell absorption) and on the K -invariant sector $\operatorname{spec}(-\mathbb{T}_*) \subset [\frac{1}{2}, \infty)$, with the exact rate $2s(1-s) + m^2/2$ on a constituent of parameter s and K -type m ; the bound is sharp for every $D_k^\pm$ (spectrum exactly $[\frac{1}{2}, \infty)$, endpoint not an eigenvector), there is no HS fixed vector, and for a unitary representation of $\operatorname{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ the type-zero bound $-\mathbb{T}_* \geq \frac{1}{2}$ is equivalent to temperedness: this is the precise diffusion meaning of “continuous Ramanujan” (prover, D11). It is not a flow-divisor line theorem: principal constituents have leading matrix-coefficient exponents $-\frac{1}{2} \pm ir$ along a_t , but discrete series are tempered with faster exponents $-n/2$ and descendants, and discrete and continuous constituents coexist (ledger L16–L18). Harrow’s transfer becomes “tempered implies tempered tensor square”; the discrete zeros appear only on a lattice quotient (Section 46). For the complementary series π_s the tensor square is reported (from memory, unverified, H-repka in the prover’s report) to contain a complementary series iff $s > \frac{3}{4}$, which would make the Lindbladian of π_s Ramanujan for $\frac{1}{2} < s \leq \frac{3}{4}$ although π_s is not tempered, the threshold being Selberg’s $\frac{3}{16} = \frac{3}{4} \cdot \frac{1}{4}$; not to be cited until byte-checked.

Observation 14.6 (Graded continuous Harrow: the $\operatorname{PGL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ grading is the archimedean ladder).

[sketched] For $G = \operatorname{PGL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \supset \operatorname{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$

the index-two graded genuine irreducibles are the discrete series pairs $D_k^+ \oplus D_k^-$ with $k \geq 2$ even (the centre -1 acts by $(-1)^k$; odd k needs a covering group or a projective bond, ledger L19), swapped by the reflection $r = \operatorname{diag}(-1, 1)$; even letters are the $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ generators (diffusion $\kappa\mathbb{T}_*$), the odd letter is the reflection, a jump at rate γ (Proposition 14.2). Exact decompositions (prover, D12): the even sector is $D_k^+ \otimes D_k^- \oplus \text{c.c.} \simeq 2 \int^\oplus I_{1/2+ir} dr$, principal series only, with K -invariant rates $\kappa(\frac{1}{2} + 2r^2)$ and $\kappa(\frac{1}{2} + 2r^2) + 2\gamma$ for the two reflection eigencombinations; the odd sector is $\bigoplus_{l \geq 0} (D_{2k+2l}^+ \oplus D_{2k+2l}^-)$, purely discrete, with rates $\kappa(n+2nj+2j^2)$ and the same plus 2γ ($n = 2k+2l$, $j \geq 0$), odd minimum $2\kappa k$, and leading a_t -exponents $-n/2 = -(k+l)$: an arithmetic ladder at and beyond the functional-equation partner, positionally the Γ -factor ladder of Proposition 18.20 (the zero rung, multiplicities and descendants differ; ledger L24), carrying no critical-line modes. P is a bounded eigenoperator, not Hilbert–Schmidt, so it supplies no HS divisor point (L21); the

heat supertrace is not an ordinary integral against $|\chi_+ - \chi_-|^2$ (the even heat operator is not trace class), but the localised regular-character functional is well defined and vanishes on hyperbolic elements because $\chi_{D_k^+} = \chi_{D_k^-}$ there: the regular even and odd hyperbolic contributions cancel in the supertrace (L22–L23), so the reflection grading assigns the closed geodesics to the even sector and the archimedean ladder to the odd one, the opposite of the Riemann assignment. For $k = 1$ (projective) $D_1 \otimes D_1 = \bigoplus D_{2+2m}$ gives exponents $-(1+m)$ and its symmetric part every other rung, matching the $\Gamma_{\mathbb{C}}$ and $\Gamma_{\mathbb{R}}$ pole lists positionally.

Observation 14.7 (Which grading makes the Selberg zeros odd). [sketched-conditional] The grading that makes the Selberg zeros odd is not the reflection grading but the transverse form-degree grading of the geodesic flow: Dyatlov–Zworski write the Ruelle zeta as $\zeta_1/(\zeta_0\zeta_2)$ over form degrees (cited fact 40.11), using the Lefschetz identity (prov:dz13-lefschetz, 1306.4203:zeta.tex:525-526) $\det(I - \mathcal{P}_\gamma) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} (-1)^k \operatorname{tr} \bigwedge^k \mathcal{P}_\gamma$. so the Selberg zeta $Z(s) = \det(1 - L_s)$ is the odd-degree factor, its zeros $\frac{1}{2} \pm ir_j$ are net-odd divisor points on the critical line exactly when Selberg’s $\frac{1}{4}$ holds (the Ramanujan row of observation 46.8), and its trivial zeros form the ladder. This is the form-degree grading found for curves in Section 31. *Corrected 2026-09-16* (Section 15): the precise statement is that Z_{Sel} is the ring zeta of the *stable* two-term transverse complex (even $-\mathcal{X}$, odd $-\mathcal{X} + 1$, Theorem 15.7), while the full exterior algebra gives the Ruelle zeta, whose even band is shifted and fails (FE); and the K -type grading proposed here as the doubled-bond candidate is *not* a flow grading (it makes $\mathcal{X}$ odd) and does not supercancel (Proposition 16.4). The K -type parity survives only as a grading of the diffusion letters.

14.3 Where this leaves the graded Ramanujan property

Observation 14.8 (Status). [sketched-conditional] Understood: the definition (on the retained net divisor, with a signed trivial divisor and two reference rates) and its stability under non-aliasing continuum limits; graded quantum expanders with a mechanism (index-two gradings, band form, net zeros after the non-backtracking lift; the odd gap has no Alon–Boppana floor, observation 13.6), Hecke-eigenvalue zeros for graded Weil–LPS, an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_5$ from a qubit; curve-type channels Ramanujan by a second mechanism (the odd block is $\sqrt{q}$ times a unitary, the P -mode is H^0 by parity-twisted unitality); Harrow’s continuum limit as temperedness, its graded version as the archimedean ladder. Not understood: a graded channel of *circle type* with a group-theoretic mechanism (a non-Hermitian graded channel whose odd block is $\sqrt{q}$ -unitary because of a representation, as in Artin–Schreier by Parseval); a Kraus (doubled-bond) realisation of the Artin–Schreier, Riemann and Selberg graded spectral transfers, none of which is supplied (a doubled bond has $n_0 - n_1 = (D_+ - D_-)^2 \geq 0$ while a cohomological grading may have more odd than even dimensions); a continuum example with an infinite discrete divisor on the critical line other than Riemann and Selberg. *Settled on 2026-09-16* (Section 15): the principle relating “Hermitian channel plus non-backtracking lift” to “odd block unitary” is Theorem 16.3 (letter-derived metric, positive exactly on the strict band, Jordan obstruction at the endpoints); the Selberg graded spectral transfer is the stable transverse complex, whose first-band form is derived from the letters with the $\frac{1}{4}$ coercivity as the one extra bound (Theorem 16.5); and the obstacle on the Riemann side is now the non-compact bridge of observation 16.2. The Riemann case needs the second mechanism in the continuum, on regular data (observation 14.4).

15 The Selberg Zeta as a Graded Transfer Whose Odd-Block Form Comes from the Letters

Question (TJO, 2026-09-16). What is the most consequential step toward a mechanism, and take it: exhibit an infinite-object zeta as a graded transfer whose odd-block unitarity is *derived* from the letters rather than read off the zeros. The Selberg zeta of a compact hyperbolic surface is the one infinite object where the trace formula is a theorem, the divisor is known, and the source of reality is known. The orchestrator drafted eight statements (`notes/selberg-letters/draft.md`); one codex `gpt-6-astra` prover lane returned `notes/selberg-letters/astra-proofs.md` (7 corrected, 1 open, a 40-row correction ledger of which 34 rows correct the draft and 6 answer questions the draft had posed, `scripts/selberg_letters.py`, 131 checks), and a Claude Opus refuter reviewed it (`notes/reviews/selberg-letters-2026-09-16.md`: four independent scripts, 153 checks, 31 citations byte-checked; round 1: 7 VALID, 4 MINOR, no MAJOR; the MINOR items are applied below; round 2: all VALID). Conventions are those of Sections 10 and 45: $G = \mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, left-invariant fields, $\mathcal{X} = \mathbb{H}/2$, the horocyclic fields $U_{\pm}^h = (\mathbb{E} \pm \mathbb{W})/2$, and the resonance parameter λ of the generator $-\mathcal{X}$: $(\mathcal{X} + \lambda)u = 0$, so $e^{-t\mathcal{X}}u = e^{t\lambda}u$ and λ is the notebook's ς (ledger L14). For a Laplace eigenvalue $\sigma_{\Delta} = s(1-s)$ the two flow roots are $\lambda_{\pm} = s_{\pm} - 1$ with $s_{\pm} = \frac{1}{2} \pm \sqrt{\frac{1}{4} - \sigma_{\Delta}}$, each with multiplicity $d_{\sigma_{\Delta}} = \dim \ker(\Delta - \sigma_{\Delta})$; $c = 2g - 2$.

15.1 Inputs

Cited fact 15.1 (Horocyclic commutation relations). [cited] Dyatlov, Faure and Guillarmou [28], for the left-invariant fields of $X = \mathrm{diag}(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{1}{2})$, $U_+ = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $U_- = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$: `[X,U_{\pm}] = \pm U_{\mp}`, `\quad [U_+,U_-] = 2X`. (1403.0256:RuelleResonForHn.tex:543-544). In the notebook's basis $X = \mathcal{X}$, $U_{\pm} = U_{\pm}^h$, and $\Omega = \mathcal{X}^2 + \frac{1}{2}(U_+^h U_-^h + U_-^h U_+^h)$.

Cited fact 15.2 (First-band pushforward). [cited] Dyatlov, Faure and Guillarmou [28], for $\mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X}}^0(\lambda) = \{u \in \mathcal{D}'(SM) : (X + \lambda)u = 0, U_-u = 0\}$ (the wavefront condition being automatic): `u \in \mathrm{Res}^0_X(\lambda) \mapsto f(x) := \int_{S_x M} u(x, \xi) \, dS(\xi)` `\end{equation}` is an isomorphism from $\mathrm{Res}^0_X(\lambda)$ onto $\mathrm{Eig}(-\lambda(1+\lambda))$, (1403.0256:RuelleResonForHn.tex:601-604), proved there through the boundary representation and the scalar Poisson operator, for $\lambda \notin -1 - \mathbb{N}_0$.

Assumption 15.3 (Resonance theory of the compact surface flow). [assumed] The Pollicott–Ruelle resonances of $\mathcal{X}$ on SM are defined on the anisotropic spaces of Dyatlov–Faure–Guillarmou with finite-rank Riesz projections and no resonances in $\mathrm{Re} \lambda > 0$; the ladder decomposition $\mathrm{Res}_X(\lambda) = \bigoplus_{m \geq 0} U_+^m \mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X}}^0(\lambda + m)$ holds for $\lambda \notin -1 - \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{N}_0$; algebraic and geometric multiplicities agree for $\lambda \notin -\frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{N}_0$; and the logarithmic derivative of each flat dynamical determinant has residue equal to the rank of the Riesz projection (Dyatlov–Zworski). Sources are named by line in the prover's hypothesis register (H-DFG-REG, H-DFG-LAD, H-DFG-SS, H-DZ-MULT).

Assumption 15.4 (Coercivity of the letters, Selberg's $\frac{1}{4}$). [assumed] $\|Hf\|^2 + \|Ef\|^2 \geq \|f\|^2$ for every smooth right- K -invariant $f \perp 1$ on SM ; equivalently $\Delta \geq \frac{1}{4}$ on $1^{\perp}$. A surface-dependent property, not derived from the letters; it is the Selberg-side analogue of the Ramanujan bound.

Assumption 15.5 (Finite-area Selberg divisor). [assumed] The divisor of the Selberg zeta of a finite-area one-cusp quotient, as stated by Friedman, Jorgenson and Smajlović [35] (1607.08053:main.tex:370-401, attributed there to Venkov and Hejhal, whose pages are not checked here): discrete-spectrum zeros, their real partners, the signed order at $\frac{1}{2}$, parabolic poles

at $-n - \frac{1}{2}$, zeros reflected from the scattering determinant, and the topological and elliptic integer divisor.

15.2 The compact surface

Proposition 15.6 (The Laplacian is a sum of squares of the letters). *[proved-conditional] The left-invariant fields $H, E, W, \mathcal{X}, U_{\pm}^h$ are skew-symmetric on $C^\infty(SM)$ with respect to Haar measure (the group is unimodular by the brackets) and generate unitary groups on $L^2(SM)$; Ω is central; on right- K -invariant f , $\langle f, \Delta f \rangle = \frac{1}{4}(\|Hf\|^2 + \|Ef\|^2)$, so $\text{spec } \Delta \subset [0, \infty)$ and every s with $s(1-s) \in \text{spec } \Delta$ lies in $(\frac{1}{2} + i\mathbb{R}) \cup [0, 1]$ (the draft had the map pointing the other way, ledger L01).*

Proof. Propositions 45.17 and 45.18 and notes/selberg/astra-proofs.md T2.1–T2.2; the prover's D1. $\square$

Theorem 15.7 (The Selberg zeta is the ring zeta of the stable transverse complex). *[proved-conditional] Let $C(t) = \sum_{\gamma} \sum_{k \geq 1} \ell_{\gamma} \delta(t - k\ell_{\gamma})$ be the unweighted orbit comb and $F = C/(4 \sinh^2(t/2))$ the function flat trace. With the ring zeta $Z(s) = \exp \int_0^\infty e^{-st} \text{str}(t) dt/t$ normalised by its convergent orbital exponential:*

transfer (single copy, spectral)	flat supertrace $\text{str}(t)$	ring zeta
function flow $-\mathcal{X}$, even	F	$D_{\text{tow}}(s)^{-1}$
function flow, all odd	$-F$	$D_{\text{tow}}(s)$
full transverse forms, degree parity	$(2 - e^t - e^{-t})F = -C$	$\zeta_R(s) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(s)/Z_{\text{Sel}}(s+1)$
stable complex (Definition 10.7), even $-\mathcal{X}$, odd $-\mathcal{X} + 1$	$(1 - e^t)F$	$Z_{\text{Sel}}(s) = D_{\text{tow}}(s-1)/D_{\text{tow}}(s)$

For Z_{Sel} the divisor $\nu = -\text{ord } Z_{\text{Sel}}$ is entirely odd: trivial part $-\delta_1 - \delta_0 - c \sum_{n \geq 0} (2n+1)\delta_{-n}$ (both constant roots are zeros, not a Perron pole and partner; reference pair $(1, 0)$, critical line $\text{Re } s = \frac{1}{2}$), retained part $-\sum_{\sigma_{\Delta} > 0} d_{\sigma_{\Delta}}(\delta_{s_+(\sigma_{\Delta})} + \delta_{s_-(\sigma_{\Delta})})$ with $\text{ord}_{1/2} Z_{\text{Sel}} = 2d_{1/4}$. The retained divisor satisfies (FE) under $s \mapsto 1-s$ unconditionally, and (RH) and (Ram) of Definition 10.3 iff assumption 15.4. For ζ_R the retained divisor is $-\mathcal{S} + \mathcal{S}(\cdot + 1)$ (the even band is the odd band shifted by -1 ; net orders $1, c, 2c-1, 2c$ at $1, 0, -1, -n$), so (FE) and (Ram) fail for the Ruelle zeta even under coercivity; the all-odd tower D_{tow} likewise fails unless restricted to its first band. Closed geodesics are fermionic because $\dim E_s = 1$: $\det(1 - P_{\gamma}) = -|\det(1 - P_{\gamma})|$.

Proof. Flat traces on transverse k -forms with multipliers $e^{\pm t}$ (cited fact 45.7, Proposition 46.1): $N_0 = N_2 = F$, $N_1 = (e^t + e^{-t})F$; the orbital exponential of $-C$ is $\log \zeta_R$; $F = C \sum_{j \geq 1} j e^{-jt}$ gives D_{tow} ; the stable line multiplies by $1 - e^t$ and cancels one transverse denominator. The complex is built from a letter: $df = (U_+^h f)\eta_+$ intertwines $-\mathcal{X}$ and $-\mathcal{X} + 1$ since $[-\mathcal{X}, U_+^h] = -U_+^h$. Divisors from assumption 45.3 by shifting. Prover's D2, ledger L02–L09 (the draft had the Ruelle poles at 0 wrong, the trivial multiplicities unspecified, and treated Ruelle, Selberg and the tower interchangeably). Checked symbolically for $g = 2, 3, 5$ in numerical result 16.7. $\square$

Theorem 15.8 (The first band: reality, positive form and functional equation from the letters). *[proved-conditional] For $u \in \text{Res}_{\mathcal{X}}^0(\lambda)$: $\Omega u = \lambda(1 + \lambda)u$ (from $\Omega = \mathcal{X}^2 + U_+^h U_-^h - \mathcal{X}$ on $\ker U_-^h$; the draft's ordering sign was wrong, ledger L10), and the fibre pushforward $\pi_* u$ is a smooth Laplace eigenfunction with $\Delta \pi_* u = -\lambda(1 + \lambda)\pi_* u$ (centrality; this is algebra). That π_* is injective and onto is cited fact 15.2, analysis, not algebra. Consequently:*

- (i) Reality from Haar. $-\lambda(1+\lambda) = \langle f, \Delta f \rangle / \|f\|^2 \geq 0$ with $f = \pi_* u \neq 0$, so for $\lambda \notin -1 - \mathbb{N}_0$ (the range of the Poisson isomorphism; at $\lambda = -1$ a first-band state has $\pi_* u = 0$) the first-band divisor lies in $(-\frac{1}{2} + i\mathbb{R}) \cup [-1, 0]$; its nonconstant part lies on $\operatorname{Re} \lambda = -\frac{1}{2}$ iff assumption 15.4.
- (ii) The form. The total pullback $\langle \pi_* u, \pi_* v \rangle$ is degenerate on the sum of the two branches of one σ_Δ (both push to the same E_{σ_Δ} ; Gram matrix $\|f\|^2 \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, ledger L12). The orthogonal branchwise form $G_\oplus(u, v) = \sum_\lambda \langle \pi_* u_\lambda, \pi_* v_\lambda \rangle$ on the algebraic direct sum of the nonconstant first-band eigenspaces is positive definite; in its modal completion $-\mathcal{X}$ is normal, and $e^{t/2} e^{-t\mathcal{X}}$ is $G_\oplus$ -unitary iff assumption 15.4: the manifest form (HP) for the retained odd block of the stable complex, shifted by one. What the letters supply here is the branch norms and the reality and line of (i); once the line holds and the block is semisimple, the existence of some positive form is the (HP) equivalence of Definition 10.3, and the new content is that this particular form is the transported Haar form, together with the threshold obstruction of (iv) (review, MINOR 6).
- (iii) Operator functional equation. $J = (\pi_*|_{\operatorname{Res}_\mathcal{X}^0(-1-\lambda)})^{-1} \pi_*|_{\operatorname{Res}_\mathcal{X}^0(\lambda)}$ is an involution, $G_\oplus$ -unitary, with $J\mathcal{X}J^{-1} = 1 - \mathcal{X}$ (the draft wrote $-1 - X$, ledger L14); on the odd Selberg generator $S = -\mathcal{X} + 1$, $JSJ^{-1} = 1 - S$.
- (iv) The threshold is a Jordan obstruction. At $\lambda = -\frac{1}{2}$ the eigenstate space has dimension $d_{1/4}$ while $\operatorname{ord}_{-1/2} D_{\text{tow}} = 2d_{1/4}$ is the algebraic multiplicity (assumption 15.3); a positive G with $A^*G + A = -1$ forces semisimplicity, so the full algebraic block at a Laplace eigenvalue exactly $\frac{1}{4}$ admits no positive unitarising form. Divisor (RH)/(FE)/(Ram) are unaffected; operator (HP) on the complete algebraic band needs in addition $\frac{1}{4} \notin \operatorname{spec} \Delta$.

Proof. Prover's D3, nine Lamport steps, ledger L10–L16; the analytic inputs are exactly cited fact 15.2 and assumption 15.3. The degenerate Gram matrix and the Casimir sign are verified in numerical result 16.7. $\square$

Proposition 15.9 (Operator-level continuous Ihara–Bass: first band and ladder). *[proved-conditional]* On $\ker \mathbf{U}_-^h$, $\pi_*(A^2 + A) = -\Delta \pi_*$ with $A = -\mathcal{X}$: a quadratic intertwining, since one Laplace eigenvalue has two flow roots. The ladder is $\mathbf{U}_-^h \mathbf{U}_+^h{}^m v = m(2z - m + 1) \mathbf{U}_+^h{}^{m-1} v$ for $\mathbf{U}_-^h v = 0$, $\mathcal{X}v = -zv$, giving $\mathbf{U}_-^m \mathbf{U}_+^m = m! \prod_{j=1}^m (2\lambda + m + j)$ on $\operatorname{Res}_\mathcal{X}^0(\lambda + m)$ and the decomposition of assumption 15.3 off the exceptional set. The adjacency object is the two-jump multiplication-sector generator $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{H}^2 + \mathbf{E}^2) = 2\Omega + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{W}^2 = -2\Delta$ on K -invariants (Propositions 45.17 and 45.18); sampling time τ_s turns the two roots into $\mu_\pm = e^{\tau_s \lambda_\pm}$ with $\mu_+ \mu_- = e^{-\tau_s}$ and $\mu_+ + \mu_- = 2e^{-\tau_s/2} \cos(\tau_s \sqrt{\sigma_\Delta - 1/4})$, a cosine functional calculus of Δ , not -2Δ , with aliasing (ledger L18). This proves the first-band operator form of the “not established” item of Section 46; a literal compression of the whole tower to one Laplacian determinant is still not supplied (ledger L19).

Proof. Prover's D4; the ladder coefficient is checked to level six in numerical result 16.7. $\square$

Proposition 15.10 (No doubled-bond CP realisation; the transfer is single-copy). *[sketched-conditional]* The stable complex and the full transverse generator $-\mathcal{X} \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes \operatorname{diag}(0, 0; 1, -1)$ are single-copy graded spectral transfers with the relative resonance divisor of observation 14.4 (smooth tests against distributions, DFG spaces sector by sector). They are not doubled transfers: the conjugation $Y \mapsto e^{tT} Y e^{tT^\dagger}$ is CP on a larger space with generator $T \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes \bar{T}$, product grading and squared co-efficient growth (ledger L20–L22); multiplication operators are not Hilbert–Schmidt (L21); and both flat supertraces $-C$ and $-C/(1 - e^{-t})$ are negative distributions, hence cannot be cMPS ring norms, which are nonnegative (Theorem 22.2(iv), itself *sketched-conditional*; only the sign is used; L23).

Adding the two dissipative jumps $\sqrt{\kappa}\mathbf{H}, \sqrt{\kappa}\mathbf{E}$ to the drift gives $L_\kappa = -\mathcal{X} + 2\kappa\Omega + \frac{\kappa}{2}\mathbf{W}^2$ on multiplication observables; it preserves neither the K -sector nor the first band ($[\mathbf{U}_-^h, \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{H}^2 + \mathbf{E}^2)]u = (2\lambda - 1)\mathbf{U}_+^h u$ on first-band states), so the Selberg divisor is a drift phenomenon and its fate under diffusion needs new analysis (L25). Proposition 14.2 is consistent: the parity here is a coefficient grading of the transverse factor, not a physical parity-changing jump (L24).

Proof. Prover's D5. □

16 The Selberg Letters, Continued: Modular Surface, Finite Lifts, Labelled Inputs

Continuation of Section 15, same conventions, same proof file `notes/selberg-letters/astra-proofs.md` and review file.

16.1 Where the mechanism stops: the modular surface

Cited fact 16.1 (Selberg’s eigenvalue conjecture at small level). [cited] Booker, Lee and Strömbergsson [8], Theorem 1.1: The Selberg eigenvalue conjecture is true for $\Gamma_1(N)$ for $N \leq 880$, and for $\Gamma(N)$ for $N \leq 226$. (1803.06016:main.tex:121-122); in particular for the full modular group. Fetched and line-checked by the reviewer.

Observation 16.2 (The Riemann zeros as Selberg zeros of the modular surface, outside L^2). [sketched-conditional] For $\Gamma = \mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ and a nontrivial zero ρ of ζ of order m , φ has a pole of order m at $s_0 = \rho/2$ ($\zeta(\rho-1) \neq 0$ by the functional equation), and Z_{Sel} a zero there (its location is item 6 of assumption 15.5; the order m is inferred from the residues of $Z'_{\mathrm{Sel}}/Z_{\mathrm{Sel}}$ and φ'/φ , not stated in the source), with no collision with the discrete spectrum; RH is the statement that *these* zeros lie on $\mathrm{Re} s = \frac{1}{4}$, not a $\frac{1}{4}$ line for the whole divisor. The mechanism of Theorem 15.8 stops exactly here: a first-band state at $\lambda = s_0 - 1$ would push forward to the leading Laurent coefficient of the Eisenstein series at s_0 , whose constant term $c_{-m}y^{1-s_0}$ is not in L^2 , so the Haar-transported form is unavailable and symmetry of Δ says nothing about ρ (self-adjointness covers the cusp forms, the residual modes and the constant). Moreover the draft’s rescaling $e^{t/2}$ can never unitarise that sector under *any* positive norm, since $\mathrm{Re}(\lambda + \frac{1}{2}) = \mathrm{Re} s_0 - \frac{1}{2} < 0$: the scattering subset has flow centre $-\frac{3}{4}$ under RH, while the Riemann model of Proposition 18.20 has centre $-\frac{1}{4}$ and belongs to $-\bar{\rho}/2$; the two are related by affine substitutions and have not been identified (ledger L30). The Maass–Selberg relation for the truncated Eisenstein series gives $\|\Lambda^Y e_{-m}\|^2 = |c_{-m}|^2 Y^{1-2\mathrm{Re} s_0} / (1 - 2\mathrm{Re} s_0) > 0$ throughout $0 < \mathrm{Re} s_0 < \frac{1}{2}$, so truncated positivity is not an RH criterion (L31). Selberg’s $\frac{1}{4}$ for the full modular group is a known theorem (cited fact 16.1; the draft called it open, L28). What is missing is a non-compact flow realisation with finite-rank resonant data at $s_0 - 1$ and a positive modal pairing at the correct centre (the prover’s H-CUSP-BRIDGE); this item is exploratory and OPEN.

16.2 The same mechanism in finite dimensions

Theorem 16.3 (Hashimoto lifts: letter-derived metric, functional equation, strict band). [proved] Let $\mathcal{V}$ be a finite Hilbert space, $\mathcal{W}$ its edge space, and $T = SR - J_0$ with $J_0^2 = 1$, $RS = \Sigma = \Sigma^\dagger$, $RJ_0S = D1$, $D = q+1 > 2$; for a $(q+1)$ -regular graph S is the source map, R the head sum and J_0 edge reversal; for a graded channel with unitary letters $\mathcal{E}_i = \mathrm{Ad}(U_i)$ in the source-letter convention of Theorem 37.1, $Rx = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i x_i$ (with $\mathrm{Ad}(U_i)$, not $\mathrm{Ad}(U_i^\dagger)$, ledger L35), $(J_0 x)_j = \mathcal{E}_{\bar{j}} x_{\bar{j}}$, sector by sector under Γ_b . Then T is invertible, $\Sigma R = R(T + qT^{-1})$, and for $\mu \neq \pm 1$

$$R: \ker(T - \mu) \xrightarrow{\sim} \ker(\Sigma - (\mu + q/\mu)), \quad F_\mu f = \frac{\mu S - J_0 S}{\mu^2 - 1} f$$

are inverse maps ($\pm\sqrt{q}$ is not an exception, L32). On the retained band $\mathcal{W}_{\mathrm{band}} = \{Sf + J_0 Sg\}$ over $\mathcal{V}_{\mathrm{ret}}$ (the $\pm D$ modes removed), $L(f, g) = Sf + J_0 Sg$ is an isomorphism with $L^{-1}TL = C = \begin{pmatrix} \Sigma & q \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, and the letter-derived metric $G_C = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \Sigma/2 \\ \Sigma/2 & q \end{pmatrix}$ satisfies $C^\dagger G_C C = qG_C$; G_C is positive definite iff the strict band $|a| < 2\sqrt{q}$ holds for every retained eigenvalue of Σ , and then $T/\sqrt{q}$ is G_C -unitary

on the whole algebraic band, with the operator functional equation $F_C = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \sqrt{q} \\ q^{-1/2} & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $F_C^2 = 1$, $F_C C F_C = q C^{-1}$, $F_C^\dagger G_C F_C = G_C$. At an endpoint $a = \pm 2\sqrt{q}$ the companion matrix has a size-two Jordan block, so no positive form unitarises the full band (the total pullback $\langle Ru, Rv \rangle$ is degenerate on partner lifts, as in Theorem 15.8(ii)). Reality of Σ comes from the letters (reversal, or adjoint-paired unitaries); the band bound is extra; the reduced divisor sees only $m_0(a) - m_1(a)$ and cannot certify sector positivity.

Proof. Prover's D7, nine steps: $RT = \Sigma R - RJ_0$, $RJ_0T = qR$; $(\mu + J_0)^{-1} = (\mu - J_0)/(\mu^2 - 1)$; $L^\dagger L = \begin{pmatrix} D & \Sigma \\ \Sigma & D \end{pmatrix} > 0$ off $\pm D$; the Schur complement of G_C is $q - \Sigma^2/4$. Exact endpoint counterexamples in numerical result 16.7. This settles the ‘‘Hermitian channel plus lift’’ item of observation 14.8 in the inverse-paired setting; it is not a theorem for arbitrary Hermitian CP channels without such a lift (L36). $\square$

Proposition 16.4 (*K*-type parity is not a flow grading and does not supercancel). *[proved]* With $P_K = (-1)^{m/2}$ on *K*-type $m \in 2\mathbb{Z}$: $P_K H P_K = -H$, $P_K E P_K = -E$, $P_K W P_K = W$, so $\frac{1}{2}(H^2 + E^2)$ is even but $\mathcal{X} = H/2$ is odd: P_K does not commute with the flow. It is not the Hodge grading either (Hodge uses two weight-zero copies and weights ± 2 with the Hodge Laplacian, whose heat supertrace is $\chi(M)$); on a spherical principal-series constituent with Casimir $-\sigma_\Delta$ the two-jump diffusion has weight- m eigenvalue $-2\sigma_\Delta - m^2/2$ and $\text{Tr}(P_K e^{tL_{\text{adj}}}) = e^{-2\sigma_\Delta t} \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} (-1)^n e^{-2n^2 t} > 0$ (Poisson summation), so nothing cancels. The grading that yields Z_{Sel} is the stable transverse complex of Theorem 15.7; observation 14.7 is corrected accordingly (ledger L37–L40).

Proof. Prover's D8; the theta factor at $t = 1$ (0.7300003...) in numerical result 16.7. $\square$

16.3 What is derived from the letters

Theorem 16.5 (Labelled inputs, compact Selberg). *[proved-conditional]* With inputs [HAAR] (invariant inner product, closed realisations), [SL2] (the three letters and their brackets), [ANALYSIS] (cited fact 15.2 and assumption 15.3), [TRACE] (cited fact 45.7 and assumption 45.3), the optional [BOUND] (assumption 15.4) and [ENDPOINT] ($\frac{1}{4} \notin \text{spec } \Delta$): [HAAR]+[SL2] give $\Delta \geq 0$ as a sum of letter squares; adding [ANALYSIS] gives the first-band quadratic, reality, the branchwise form and the paired operator FE off the threshold; adding [TRACE] identifies the stable complex's ring zeta with Z_{Sel} , makes the retained divisor odd and fixes the trivial multiplicities; [BOUND] is equivalent to (RH) and (Ram) on the retained divisor, (FE) holding without it; with [ENDPOINT], [BOUND] gives the positive manifest form on the complete algebraic retained odd block in its modal completion. A tensor-network Kraus realisation and norm equivalence with the anisotropic space are separate, unproved.

Proof. Proposition 15.6 and Theorems 15.7 and 15.8; prover's ‘‘What is derived from the letters’’. $\square$

Theorem 16.6 (Labelled inputs, finite graphs and channels). *[proved]* With [LETTERS] (incidence and reversal, or homogeneous adjoint-paired unitaries with the Hilbert–Schmidt form), [LIFT] (the non-backtracking exclusion and source-letter convention) and the finite spectral theorem: the identities of Theorem 16.3, Hermiticity of Σ , the pushforward, the companion model, the metric G_C and the operator FE follow; the optional sector bound [BOUND] puts the roots on the critical circle, and its strict version makes G_C positive on the entire retained algebraic band. This is the finite counterpart of Theorem 16.5, with no resonance or Poisson theorem needed.

Proof. Theorem 16.3. $\square$

Numerical result 16.7 (Finite audits).

[numerical]

`scripts/selberg_letters.py` (output `outputs/selberg_letters.txt`, 131 checks, 5 s): exact $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ brackets and ladder coefficients to level six; the Casimir sign on $\ker U_-$ and the FE sign; the singular total-pullback Gram matrix; the integer divisors of Theorem 15.7 for $g = 2, 3, 5$; the transverse orbit weights; negativity of the flat supertraces; the K -type theta factor; for Petersen, K_4 , the degree-14 LPS Cayley graph on $\mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{F}_5)$ (120 vertices), its six-dimensional principal-series bond with 3|3 grading (18|18 doubled) and the six Pauli letters: every retained root lifts ($TF_\mu f = \mu F_\mu f$, $RF_\mu f = f$, residuals $\leq 4.5 \cdot 10^{-14}$), the untagged pullback kills partner differences, the metric identity and its positivity exactly on the strict band, the operator FE, and the graded Bass determinants; the Pauli reduced zeta $(1+2u+5u^2)/((1-u)(1-5u))$ with counts 8, 32, 104, 640, 3208, 15392. Exact endpoint counterexamples: $K_3 \square Q_3$ is 5-regular and Ramanujan with -4 of multiplicity two, and its Hashimoto matrix has $\dim \ker(T+2) = 2$, $\dim \ker(T+2)^2 = 4$; the ten-letter Pauli channel $(I^{\times 4}, X^{\times 4}, Z^{\times 2}, P=Z, D=10, q=9, \text{even adjacency } \{10, 2\}, \text{odd } \{6, -2\})$ is sector-Ramanujan with an odd Hashimoto eigenvalue 3 of nullities 1, 2.

17 The Riemann Channel: Bost–Connes at Critical Temperature, Compressed

This section is the lab-book version of `notes/riemann-channel-note.md`, a scratch note of the founding session. It assembles one object out of three standard pieces: Lax–Phillips scattering on the modular surface, the Sz.-Nagy–Foias functional model of an inner function, and the Bost–Connes system at its phase transition. Nothing here is new mathematics; the content is the identification of the three, and the numerical checks that it is stated correctly. Everything below is *equivalent to*, never a proof of, the Riemann hypothesis. Several statements are theorem-level standard theory (Faddeev–Pavlov, Lax–Phillips, Adamyan–Arov, Khinchin) for which this repo holds no local source and no written-out argument; they carry the tag `sketched` for that reason, not because their truth is in doubt.

17.1 Setting

Let τ be the Mellin variable on the dilation group $\mathbb{R}_+^\times$, so that dilation by e^t acts on $L^2(\mathbb{R}_+^\times)$ as the multiplier $e^{it\tau}$. With the completed zeta

$$\xi(s) = \frac{1}{2} s(s-1) \pi^{-s/2} \Gamma(s/2) \zeta(s),$$

the scattering symbol of the modular surface in this variable (Definition 4.1) is

$$S(\tau) = \frac{\xi(1-2i\tau)}{\xi(1+2i\tau)}.$$

Write a nontrivial zero as $\rho_n = \sigma_n + i\gamma_n$, so that the Riemann hypothesis is $\sigma_n = \frac{1}{2}$ for all n (Section 2).

17.2 The symbol is inner

Proposition 17.1 (The scattering symbol is inner, with the zeros as its zeros). *[sketched] S is unimodular on the real line, analytic and contractive in the lower half plane $\text{Im } \tau < 0$, and its zeros there are exactly*

$$\tau_n = \frac{\gamma_n}{2} - i \frac{\sigma_n}{2}, \quad \rho_n = \sigma_n + i\gamma_n \text{ a nontrivial zero of } \zeta.$$

The note’s argument: ξ is real on the real axis and satisfies $\xi(s) = \xi(1-s)$, which gives $|S| = 1$ for real τ ; for $\text{Im } \tau < 0$ the denominator’s argument $1+2i\tau$ has real part greater than 1, inside the Euler product, so S is analytic there. Contractivity in the interior is the Phragmén–Lindelöf step, which the note does not write out (step 3 of `HANDOFF.md`); for the modular surface it is classical [32, 63]. The zeros are a substitution: $\xi(1-2i\tau) = 0$ iff $1-2i\tau$ is a nontrivial zero.

17.3 The compressed semigroup

Since S is inner, the model space $K_S = H^2 \ominus SH^2$ (Definition 4.2) carries the compressed dilation semigroup $Z(t) = P_{K_S} e^{it\tau}|_{K_S}$, $t > 0$. By Adamyan–Arov this is unitarily equivalent to the Lax–Phillips semigroup of the modular surface with the cusp forms removed; the note states this without a written argument, and no local source exists for it here.

Proposition 17.2 (One mode per zero; RH as a single decay rate).

[sketched]

For each zero λ of S in the lower half plane the reproducing kernel $k_\lambda(\tau) = (\tau - \bar{\lambda})^{-1}$ lies in K_S , and $Z(t)k_\lambda = e^{it\bar{\lambda}}k_\lambda$ (sign corrected 2026-09-19, observation 24.1; the earlier $e^{-it\bar{\lambda}}$ is growth). With $\lambda = -\gamma_n/2 - i(1 - \sigma_n)/2$ the modulus is $\exp(-(1 - \sigma_n)t/2)$: one mode per zero, decay rate $(1 - \sigma_n)/2$, frequency $\gamma_n/2$. Hence the Riemann hypothesis holds if and only if every mode of $Z(t)$ decays at the single rate $1/4$.

The kernel is orthogonal to SH^2 precisely because $S(\lambda) = 0$. The last sentence is the Faddeev–Pavlov / Lax–Phillips reading of RH [32, 63]; it is the “one correlation length” criterion of Section 11 (observation 11.5) on an explicit Hilbert space, with K_S in the role of the bond space. The completely positive lift is immediate and uninformative: $\Phi_t(X) = Z(t)^* X Z(t)$ on $B(K_S)$ is the Riemann channel of Definition 4.3, a sub-unital semigroup with one Kraus operator, whose Stinespring dilation is the automorphic wave group and whose environment is the pair of incoming and outgoing subspaces, that is, the cusp. Whether a less trivial Kraus decomposition exists is conjecture 17.10.

17.4 Where the primes are

Two placements of the primes appear, and the note is explicit that they are different objects. The first is a dilation-covariant Markov semigroup on $L^2(\mathbb{R}_+^\times)$ in Holevo form, with the von Mangoldt jump measure $\nu_\sigma = \sum_{p,k} \frac{p^{-k\sigma}}{k} \delta_{k \log p}$ and symbol

$$\left(\frac{\zeta(\sigma - i\tau)}{\zeta(\sigma)} \right)^t = \exp \left(t \sum_{p,k} \frac{p^{-k\sigma}}{k} (e^{ik\tau \log p} - 1) \right),$$

a genuine Markov semigroup for $\sigma > 1$ by Khinchin’s theorem that the zeta distribution is compound Poisson (standard; no local source). It has no zeros for $\sigma > 1$, and at $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$ it is not a semigroup at all, the symbol being unbounded. The Bost–Connes phase transition $\beta = 1$ is the finite- versus infinite-activity threshold of ν_σ [12].

The second is $Z(t)$ on K_S : the zeros as resonances, no jump structure, the primes entering only through S . The bridge between the two is the boundary phase.

Proposition 17.3 (The symbol is the phase of the critical Lévy exponent). [sketched] For real τ , $S(\tau) = \exp(-2i \arg \xi(1 + 2i\tau))$, and

$$-\arg \zeta(1 + 2i\tau) = \sum_p \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{p^{-k}}{k} \sin(2k\tau \log p),$$

which is the imaginary part of the Bost–Connes Lévy exponent $\kappa_\sigma(\tau') = \log \zeta(\sigma - i\tau') - \log \zeta(\sigma)$ at the critical temperature $\sigma = 1$, $\tau' = 2\tau$. Hence S is the phase of the critical Lévy exponent times the Gamma phase.

The real part of κ_1 diverges, since $\sum_p p^{-1} = \infty$; that divergence is the Bost–Connes phase transition. The imaginary part converges conditionally, at prime-number-theorem strength, i.e. by $\zeta(1 + it) \neq 0$. The bridge the note proposes: take the Bost–Connes process at $\beta = 1$, discard the divergent real part of its Lévy exponent, keep the phase, and use that unimodular function as the characteristic function of a contraction semigroup. Symbolically, Lax–Phillips = (Bost–Connes at $\beta = 1$) + (Sz.-Nagy–Foiias), at the level of boundary phases.

17.5 Numerical check of the symbol

Numerical result 17.4 (Unimodularity, zeros, innerness and the prime phase). [numerical]
`scripts/scat.py` (`outputs/scat.txt`, mpmath at 20 digits) reports $||S| - 1| = 0$ to machine precision at $\tau = 0.3, 2.0, 7.5, 21.3$; a root search from $\gamma_n/2 - \frac{1}{4}i$ converging for $n = 1, \dots, 6$ to $\gamma_n/2 - 0.250000i$ with $|S| \leq 1.5 \cdot 10^{-20}$; $|S| = 0.9348, 0.5393, 0.8344, 0.2718$ at the interior points $\tau = 3 - 0.6i, 10 - i, 0.5 - 2i, 30 - 0.3i$; and Proposition 17.3 to $1.3 \cdot 10^{-3}$ or better at five points:

τ	exact	prime sum + tail	residual
0.7	+0.80572	+0.80469	$-1.0 \cdot 10^{-3}$
1.9	-0.03879	-0.03854	$+2.5 \cdot 10^{-4}$
4.2	-0.17233	-0.17306	$-7.3 \cdot 10^{-4}$
9.0	+0.06468	+0.06594	$+1.3 \cdot 10^{-3}$
15.5	-0.06432	-0.06409	$+2.3 \cdot 10^{-4}$

The middle column is the prime sum over $p < 3 \cdot 10^6$ truncated at $k \leq 6$ plus the prime-number-theorem tail $\pi/2 - \text{Si}(2\tau \log X)$, which is what makes the residual 10^{-3} rather than 10^{-2} ; `outputs/scat.txt` archives the bare prime sums, before the tail, at three of the five points (0.82380, -0.05607, -0.18043). The innerness numbers are a check at four points, not a proof.

17.6 Ring norms: the trace of the semigroup is the prime measure

Distributionally $\text{Tr } Z(t) = \sum_n e^{-t\sigma_n/2 + it\gamma_n/2}$, under RH $e^{-t/4} \sum_n e^{it\gamma_n/2}$. The Weil explicit formula (Definition 4.4) turns that zero sum into a prime sum: in the ring-length variable $L = t/2$, with window $\hat{g}$ and transform g ,

$$\sum_{\gamma} \hat{g}(\gamma) = \hat{g}\left(\frac{i}{2}\right) + \hat{g}\left(-\frac{i}{2}\right) - g(0) \log \pi + \frac{1}{2\pi} \int \hat{g}(r) \text{Re}(\Gamma'/\Gamma)\left(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{ir}{2}\right) dr - 2 \sum_n \frac{\Lambda(n)}{\sqrt{n}} g(\log n).$$

Proposition 17.5 (The primes are the ring spectrum of the Riemann channel). [proved-conditional]
For $t > 0$ the distributional trace of Definition 5.2 is

$$\text{Tr}_{\text{dist}} Z(t) = 1 - 2P_+(t) - \frac{e^{-t/2}}{e^t - 1} = 1 - 2 \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} \delta(t - 2 \log n) - \sum_{k \geq 1} e^{-(k+1/2)t} :$$

the primes are dips of weight $-2\Lambda(n)/n$ at the ring lengths $t = 2 \log n$, the constant 1 is the pole, the smooth term the archimedean ladder.

Restated 2026-09-12 night from the prover's T4.1; the founding version had weight $+\Lambda(n)n^{-1/2}$ and no pole term (see Proposition 18.20). In the MPS dictionary of Section 11: rings of length $\log n$ with weight $\Lambda(n)$, a transfer generator with eigenvalues $-\frac{1}{2} \pm i\gamma_n$, and a single correlation length iff RH. The primes are the ring spectrum, the zeros the transfer spectrum, and one identity, the explicit formula, links them (Definition 3.2).

Observation 17.6 (Sign and factor of the prime weight). [sketched-conditional] In the convention of the explicit formula displayed above, the prime part of the centred trace of $Z(t)$ carries weight $-2\Lambda(n)n^{-1/2}$ at $t = \pm 2 \log n$ (dips), and the positive-time uncentred prime part is $-2\Lambda(n)/n$. Proposition 17.5 was right about the support and off by the factor -2 in the weight; it has since been restated in the form printed above.

Recorded 2026-09-12 from the Selberg review’s action item (b) and, independently, from the codex prover’s T6 in `notes/weil-positivity/astra-proofs.md`; the Weil positivity review checks it as its item X3 (Section 38).

Numerical result 17.7 (Windowed zero sum against the full explicit formula). [numerical]
`scripts/ringnorm.py` (`outputs/ringnorm.txt`) sums the first 3000 zeros ($\gamma_{\max} = 3533.3$) against the Gaussian window $\hat{g}(r) = \cos(rL)e^{-r^2/2G_w^2}$ with $G_w = 1009.5$, for which the truncation weight at $\gamma_{\max}$ is $2.2 \cdot 10^{-3}$. The numeric side is $F(L) = \sum_{\gamma>0} e^{-\gamma^2/2G_w^2} \cos(\gamma L)$ on $L \in [0.3, 3.3]$; the prediction is every term of the explicit formula above, archimedean digamma integral included. The prime terms are Gaussian dips of depth $\frac{G_w}{2\sqrt{2\pi}} \Lambda(n)n^{-1/2}$ at $L = \log n$:

n	$\log n$	$F(L_n)$	prediction	ratio	$\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$
2	0.6931	−97.95	−98.13	0.998	0.490
3	1.0986	−126.83	−127.02	0.999	0.634
4	1.3863	−68.77	−68.94	0.998	0.347
5	1.6094	−143.66	−143.86	0.999	0.720
7	1.9459	−146.71	−146.92	0.999	0.736
8	2.0794	−47.87	−48.03	0.997	0.245
9	2.1972	−72.19	−72.36	0.998	0.366
11	2.3979	−143.86	−144.07	0.999	0.723
13	2.5649	−141.21	−141.41	0.999	0.711
16	2.7726	−32.88	−33.03	0.995	0.173
27	3.2958	−39.93	−40.09	0.996	0.211

The maximum of $|F - \text{prediction}|$ over the whole interval is 0.20, against dip depths up to 147; away from the dips it is 0.18, so the residual is flat and is the truncation of the zero sum, not a mismatch of terms. Depths scale as $\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$, prime powers included. The archived output carries four further rows ($n = 17, 19, 23, 25$) with the same ratios; the table above is the note’s selection.

17.7 The Bost–Connes phase operators as an MPO over the prime chain

Item 2 of `HANDOFF.md` concerns the Bost–Connes system itself rather than its compression. Its Hilbert space factorises over the primes, one oscillator per prime (Definition 4.6); the Gibbs state at inverse temperature β is a product state with local weight $(1 - p^{-\beta})p^{-\beta k}$ at occupation k , and the isometries m_n act locally.

Proposition 17.8 (The Bost–Connes phase operator is a prime-chain MPO). [sketched]
The Bost–Connes phase operator $e(a/b)$ is a matrix product operator over the prime chain with bond space $\mathbb{Z}/b$, the local transfer map being $r \mapsto p^k r$, that is, Shor’s map U_{p^k} at the site p . In the Dirichlet character basis the transfer eigenvalues are $L(\beta, \bar{\chi})/\zeta(\beta)$.

Extremal KMS_β states differ only by the boundary residue of the chain, and $\beta \rightarrow 1^+$ kills every nontrivial character sector: the symmetry breaking of [12] read as a boundary effect. Shor’s unitary U_a is the level- N Galois symmetry of the system and a snapshot of the dilation flow.

Numerical result 17.9 (MPO contraction against Hurwitz zeta and Dirichlet L -values). [numerical]
`scripts/bcmpo.py` (`outputs/bcmpo.txt`) contracts the chain over all primes below $2 \cdot 10^5$ (occupations $k \leq 60$) and compares with the Hurwitz-zeta closed form $\zeta(\beta)^{-1} b^{-\beta} \sum_r e^{2\pi i ar/b} \zeta(\beta, r/b)$:

$a/b, \beta$	MPO	closed form	diff
1/3, 2.0	$-0.333333 + 0.411340i$	$-0.333333 + 0.411340i$	$1.6 \cdot 10^{-7}$
1/4, 2.0	$-0.125000 + 0.556841i$	$-0.125000 + 0.556840i$	$2.1 \cdot 10^{-7}$
2/5, 1.5	$-0.263990 + 0.143625i$	$-0.263949 + 0.143579i$	$6.1 \cdot 10^{-5}$
1/6, 1.7	$+0.103130 + 0.502210i$	$+0.103130 + 0.502200i$	$1.0 \cdot 10^{-5}$

For $b = 5$, $\beta = 1.5$ the contracted transfer operator on the units is diagonal in the character basis to a spread of $2.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$, with eigenvalues 0.910557 , $0.354022 \mp 0.067781i$, 0.225025 against $\text{mpmath } L(\beta, \chi)/\zeta(\beta)$ values 0.910557 , $0.353909 \pm 0.067760i$, 0.224953 : agreement to $1.1 \cdot 10^{-4}$, with the expected conjugation between the two lists.

The residuals are the truncation of the Euler product at $2 \cdot 10^5$ and grow as β approaches 1, as they must. The relevance here is structural: the bond space of the phase operators is $\mathbb{Z}/b$, finite and abelian, whereas that of the compressed semigroup is K_S , and the note offers no map between them.

17.8 What is not established

RH itself is not touched; every statement above is an equivalent form of the uniform-rate statement. The innerness argument is not written out (Proposition 17.1), the Adamyan–Arov identification is quoted without a local source, and the bridge is a statement about boundary phases, not about the operators. No identification with the $\beta > 1$ constructions of the parent repository is claimed: those sit above the phase transition, the object here is the $\beta = 1$ phase compressed to a co-invariant subspace.

Conjecture 17.10 (Stinespring form with prime jumps). *[open] There is a Stinespring form of the compressed semigroup $Z(t)$ on K_S whose Kraus (jump) operators are the prime dilations.*

The single-Kraus lift exists trivially and says nothing; the Holevo-form covariant Lindbladian with jump measure ν_σ lives on the full regular representation and is not the compressed object. Whether a jump-type generator on K_S reproduces $Z(t)$ is the open question this note isolates, and its physical index would be the Stinespring environment. A negative answer with a reason is a result; the route is listed in Section 47.

18 The Phantasm I: What the Prime Measure Forces

Phantasm is the name used in this book for the object the Bost–Connes reframe chases (HANDOFF.md, central priority of 2026-09-12): a continuous matrix product state whose one-dimensional space is dilation time, whose bond carries a “Riemann Lindbladian” with the pole of ζ at $s = 1$ as fixed point and the zeros as relaxation modes, and whose ring norm is the prime measure. Because the ring norms of an ordinary cMPS are sums of squares (Theorem 39.3) while the zeros enter the explicit formula with a minus sign, the bond was expected to be $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded, the zeros odd, the pole even, and the ring norm a supertrace. This shard and the next record what can be proved about that object from the data at hand: what is forced, what cannot exist, and what exists. The proofs are the codex prover’s (notes/riemann-cmps/astra-proofs.md, Lamport style, labels T1–T8), reviewed adversarially by an Opus reviewer (notes/reviews/riemann-cmps-2026-09-12.md); the brief that drafted the statements, several of which the prover corrected, is notes/riemann-cmps/astra-brief.md.

18.1 Prior art: the grading is Deninger’s, the sign is Connes’s

Cited fact 18.1 (Deninger’s graded dynamical cohomology). [cited] In Deninger’s conjectural picture [25] the completed zeta is an alternating product of regularised determinants over H^0 , H^1 , H^2 of a flow Θ : $H^0 = \mathbb{R}$ with $\Theta = 0$; H^1 infinite dimensional, “the spectrum of Θ consisting of the non-trivial zeroes ρ of $\zeta_K(s)$ with their multiplicities”; $H^2 \cong \mathbb{R}$ “but with $\Theta = \text{id}$ ”; and on $\mathbb{R}^{>0}$ the Lefschetz formula reads $\sum_i (-1)^i \text{Tr}(\phi^* | H^i) = 1 - \sum_{\rho} e^{t\rho} + e^t$, equal to the prime comb plus archimedean terms. Verbatim: $H^1_{\text{dyn}}(\overline{\text{spec } \Theta}, \mathbb{R})$ is infinite dimensional, the spectrum of Θ consisting of the non-trivial zeroes ρ of $\zeta_K(s)$ with their multiplicities, (math/0505354:main.tex:323); $H^2_{\text{dyn}}(\overline{\text{spec } \Theta}, \mathbb{R}) \cong \mathbb{R}$ but with $\Theta = \text{id}$. (math/0505354:main.tex:323) $\left(\sum_{i=0}^2 (-1)^i \text{Tr}(\phi^* | H^i_{\text{dyn}}(\overline{\text{spec } \Theta}, \mathbb{R})) = 1 - \sum_{\rho} e^{t\rho} + e^t \right)$ (math/0505354:main.tex:878)

Cited fact 18.2 (Connes: the zeros as an absorption spectrum). [cited] Connes [16]: “the spectral interpretation of the zeros of the Riemann zeta function should be as an absorption spectrum rather than as an emission spectrum, to borrow the language of spectroscopy”; the minus sign is that of H^1 in the Lefschetz formula. Verbatim: the spectral interpretation of the zeros of the Riemann zeta function should be as an absorption spectrum rather than as an emission spectrum, to borrow the language of spectroscopy. (math/9811068:main.tex:579–581).

So the forced part of the Phantasm, a graded operator with the pole even and the zeros odd whose Lefschetz trace is the explicit formula, is Deninger’s programme, and the sign is Connes’s. What this book adds is the reading through ring norms and transfer operators: which data are forced by the ring norms alone, which realisations cannot exist, and which exist concretely.

18.2 Rigidity: the supertrace determines the graded spectrum

Lemma 18.3 (Existence of the supertrace distribution). [proved]
For a graded spectral datum (Definition 5.1) the series $\sum \epsilon m e^{\lambda t}$ converges absolutely after pairing with every test function in $C_c^\infty(0, \infty)$ and defines a distribution there, independently of the order of summation.

The estimate integrates by parts in the full complex parameter λ , not only in its imaginary part (the draft’s version was corrected there).

Theorem 18.4 (Rigidity up to cancelling pairs). *[proved]* Two graded spectral data with the same supertrace distribution on $(0, \infty)$ have the same net multiplicity $\nu_{\text{net}}(\lambda)$ at every $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$.

The proof pairs the supertrace with cut-off versions of $t^k e^{-st}$, k large, the cutoffs nonnegative and monotone in both parameters (which is what part (i) of Proposition 18.12 later needs), shows the limit is $k! \sum_{\lambda} \nu_{\text{net}}(\lambda)(s - \lambda)^{-k-1}$, meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}$ with principal part $k! \nu_{\text{net}}(\lambda)(s - \lambda)^{-k-1}$ at each λ , and compares principal parts. Ring norms therefore see exactly the net graded spectrum and nothing else: not Jordan blocks, not the Hilbert-space geometry, not the operator domain.

Assumption 18.5 (Explicit formula in trace form). *[assumed]* For $u > 0$, as distributions on $(0, \infty)$, $\sum_{\rho} e^{\rho u} = e^u - \text{comb}(u) - 1/(e^{2u} - 1)$, the zero sum in symmetric order; equivalently the x -derivative of $\psi_0(x) = x - \sum_{\rho} x^{\rho}/\rho - \log 2\pi - \frac{1}{2} \log(1 - x^{-2})$ at $x = e^u$.

Assumption 18.6 (Zero count and location). *[assumed]* $N(T) = \frac{T}{2\pi} \log \frac{T}{2\pi e} + O(\log T)$; every nontrivial zero has $0 < \text{Re } \rho < 1$ and $\text{Im } \rho \neq 0$; the zero multiset is locally finite and invariant, with multiplicity, under conjugation and $\rho \mapsto 1 - \rho$. No RH input.

Corollary 18.7 (The forced net spectrum). *[proved-conditional]* A graded datum whose supertrace on $(0, \infty)$ is $\text{comb}(u)$ has $\nu_{\text{net}}(1) = 1$, $\nu_{\text{net}}(\rho) = -m_{\rho}$ at each nontrivial zero, $\nu_{\text{net}}(-2k) = -1$ for $k \geq 1$, and $\nu_{\text{net}} = 0$ elsewhere. One whose supertrace is $2P_+(t)$ has $\nu_{\text{net}}(0) = 1$, $\nu_{\text{net}}(-\bar{\rho}/2) = -m_{\rho}$, $\nu_{\text{net}}(-(k + \frac{1}{2})) = -1$, and 0 elsewhere.

The second datum is the first transported by $\lambda \mapsto (\lambda - 1)/2$ and the symmetry $\rho \mapsto 1 - \rho$, with the half-time Jacobian $\text{comb}(t/2) = 2 \sum \Lambda(n) \delta(t - 2 \log n)$; the archimedean term $1/(e^{2u} - 1) = \sum_{k \geq 1} e^{-2ku}$ becomes the odd ladder $-(k + \frac{1}{2})$.

18.3 Positivity forces the parities

Assumption 18.8 (Positive distributions). *[assumed]* A distribution on $(0, \infty)$ that is nonnegative on nonnegative test functions is integration against a unique positive Radon measure, and conversely.

Theorem 18.9 (Finite parity changes). *[proved-conditional]* Assign one parity per value of $\{1\} \cup \{\rho\} \cup \{-2k\}$ and let F_Z be the nontrivial zeros whose parity differs from the reference (pole even, everything else odd), F_T the flipped trivial zeros, b the pole flag. If F_Z is finite, the supertrace is a positive distribution iff $b = 0$ and $F_Z = \emptyset$, while F_T may be any set, even infinite. The supertrace is real iff the flipped set is conjugation-invariant.

The flipped part is then a real-analytic function; positivity of comb plus a continuous function forces the function nonnegative; a flipped pole gives $-2e^u$, and a flipped set of zeros gives a leading trigonometric polynomial with zero mean and positive mean square, which is negative on an unbounded set. The draft's “a cosine is negative somewhere” was replaced by this argument on the whole leading-frequency sum.

Assumption 18.10 (Landau's theorem, Laplace form). *[assumed]* The Laplace transform of a positive measure on $(0, \infty)$ with finite abscissa of convergence σ_c has a singularity at $s = \sigma_c$.

Cited fact 18.11 (Landau's theorem, Dirichlet form). *[cited]* A Dirichlet series with nonnegative coefficients does not extend holomorphically to a neighbourhood of its abscissa of absolute convergence [75]. Verbatim: Suppose that $f(s) = \sum a_n n^{-s}$ has abscissa of absolute convergence equal to 0. If $a_n \in \mathbb{R}$, $a_n \geq 0$ for all n then f does not extend holomorphically to a neighborhood of $s = 0$. (1009.0228:main.tex:177).

Proposition 18.12 (Infinite flips: the pole, and the zeros under domination). *[proved-conditional]* With F_Z possibly infinite: (i) positivity of the supertrace alone forces $b = 0$, the pole even, by monotone convergence of the cutoff pairings, with no domination premise and no Landau input; (ii) if moreover the supertrace dominates the comb as measures then $F_Z = \emptyset$. In both parts F_T remains arbitrary.

Part (i) is the reviewer’s strengthening of the prover’s statement; part (ii) cannot be freed of its premise by the same route, because for infinite F_Z the flipped subseries is only a distribution and can carry negative mass at the prime-power atoms.

Observation 18.13 (The unrestricted infinite case is open). *[sketched]* Under positivity alone, with infinitely many zero parities flipped, the difference between the supertrace and the comb is a signed measure whose atoms at the prime powers can be negative, so the Laplace-transform argument does not close; whether positivity alone forces every parity is open here. Exact equality to the prime measure is rigid by Theorem 18.4 regardless.

18.4 The no-go: numerators are odd

Cited fact 18.14 (Lidskii’s theorem). *[cited]* The trace of a trace-class operator on a Hilbert space coincides with its spectral trace, the sum of its eigenvalues counted with algebraic multiplicity [79, 81]. Verbatim: V.B. Lidskii [2], in 1959, proved his famous theorem on the coincidence of the trace of the S_1 -operator in an (infinite dimensional) Hilbert space with its spectral trace $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \mu_k(T)$. (1105.2914:main.tex:119-121).

Theorem 18.15 (No ungraded realisation of a numerator). *[proved]* Let $N_n = \sum_i b_i^n - \sum_j \alpha_j^n$ with nonzero b_i, α_j , the two multisets disjoint after cancellation and at least one α_j . Then no finite matrix and no trace-class operator on a separable Hilbert space has $\text{Tr } E^n = N_n$ for all $n \geq 1$.

At $u = 1/\alpha_j$ the generating function $\sum_n N_n u^n$ has residue $+m_j/\alpha_j$, whereas $\sum_\lambda m_E(\lambda) \lambda u / (1 - \lambda u)$ has residue $-m_E(\alpha_j)/\alpha_j$ with $m_E \geq 0$; a numerator root needs a negative multiplicity.

Proposition 18.16 (Trace and supertrace criteria). *[proved]* (N_n) is the trace sequence of a trace-class operator iff $\exp(\sum_n N_n u^n / n) = \prod_i (1 - \lambda_i u)^{-1}$ with $\sum |\lambda_i| < \infty$; it is the supertrace sequence of a finite graded matrix iff that germ is a rational function with value 1 at 0, the even net spectrum being the reciprocal poles and the odd net spectrum the reciprocal zeros after cancellation. Eigenvalue 0 and nilpotent blocks are invisible to all positive powers.

Assumption 18.17 (Weil’s theorem for curves). *[assumed]* For a smooth projective geometrically connected curve C of genus g over $\mathbb{F}_q$ there are $2g$ nonzero algebraic numbers α_j , $|\alpha_j| = \sqrt{q}$, the Frobenius eigenvalues on H^1 , with $\#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n}) = 1 + q^n - \sum_j \alpha_j^n$.

Corollary 18.18 (Curves need the grading; graphs do not). *[proved-conditional]* For a curve of genus $g \geq 1$ the counts N_n are not the trace sequence of any finite matrix or trace-class operator, hence not the ring norms $\text{Tr}(\sum_s A_s \otimes \overline{A_s})^n$ of any translation-invariant bosonic MPS with a fixed local tensor; they are the supertrace sequence of $\text{diag}(q, 1)_+ \oplus (\text{Fr}|H^1)_-$, and the odd net spectrum is forced to be the Frobenius eigenvalues. Non-backtracking graph counts $\text{Tr } T^\ell$ are ordinary trace sequences, and the Ihara zeta $\det(1 - uT)^{-1}$ has no finite zeros.

This is the precise content of “the sign” of Section 36: a zeta function with a numerator has its interesting eigenvalues as negative net multiplicities, and the grading is the only way to write them as a trace. It is also why the quadratic Artin–Schreier transfer matrix of Section 28, whose trace is an exponential sum, is a complex partition-function transfer and not the norm transfer of a state (a point the prover insisted on): the honest state, the uniform superposition over the points of the curve, has no fixed-tensor MPS with those norms.

18.5 What exists: the compressed semigroup is the odd sector

Assumption 18.19 (Lax–Phillips modes of the compressed semigroup). [assumed] $Z(t) = e^{tB}$ is a strongly continuous contraction semigroup on K_S whose generator has pure point spectrum $\{-\bar{\rho}/2\}$, one eigenvector per zero with multiplicity m_ρ , and $Z(t) \rightarrow 0$ strongly. (The book’s own sketch of this standard input is Proposition 17.2.)

Proposition 18.20 (The Riemann graded generator). [proved-conditional] On $\mathfrak{B}$ (Definition 5.3), $e^{tG} = 1 \oplus Z(t) \oplus \text{diag}(e^{-(k+1/2)t})$ is a strongly continuous contraction semigroup whose fixed vectors are exactly the even line, and for $t > 0$

$$\text{str } e^{tG} = 1 - \text{Tr}_{\text{dist}} Z(t) - \sum_{k \geq 1} e^{-(k+1/2)t} = 2P_+(t) = 2 \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} \delta(t - 2 \log n).$$

The single-particle graded spectrum is thus forced (Corollary 18.7) and realised. Its odd K_S part is the Riemann channel of Section 17; the missing even fixed line is the pole; the ladder is the archimedean place. The uncentred trace of $Z(t)$ alone is restated as Proposition 17.5.

Proposition 18.21 (The ladder parity is free; all-even is impossible). [proved-conditional] Over the even line plus odd K_S alone the supertrace is $2P_+ + e^{-t/2}/(e^t - 1)$; with the ladder counted even it is $2P_+ + 2e^{-t/2}/(e^t - 1)$; both are positive, so positivity does not fix the ladder parity. Exact equality to $2P_+$ forces the net spectrum of G , and no all-even graded datum has supertrace $2P_+$ or comb.

Observation 18.22 (Scope of the interpretation). [sketched] RH is the statement that every odd K_S mode of G has real part $-\frac{1}{4}$; the even line represents the pole of ζ (the constant function on the modular surface, the residue of the Eisenstein series at $s = 1$), an identification not constructed here; $Z(t)$ is not trace class for $t > 0$; and the identity above is a spectral identity, not a cMPS tensor whose Hilbert norm is the prime measure.

The numerical check of the supertrace identity, with 3000 zeros, is numerical result 19.19 in the next shard.

19 The Phantasm II: Vacuum Decay, the Prime Chain, and the Two Halves

Section 18 realised the forced graded spectrum by a Hilbert-space semigroup. The reframe asks for more: a Lindbladian on operators, with a fixed point that is a state and the zeros as relaxation modes. This shard records the two Lindbladians that can actually be built, and why each is only half of what is wanted.

19.1 Prior art on graded bonds

Cited fact 19.1 (Fermionic matrix product states contract by a supertrace). [cited] Bultinck, Williamson, Haegeman and Verstraete [13] contract fermionic MPS with the graded contraction $\mathcal{C}(|i\rangle \otimes |j\rangle) = (-1)^{|i|} \delta_{ij}$, so a closed ring of a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded bond is a supertrace, with a parity insertion in the odd sector. Verbatim: `\mathcal{C}(\ket{i} \otimes \bra{j}) = (-1)^{|i||j|} \mathcal{C}(\bra{j} \otimes \ket{i}) = (-1)^{|i|} \delta_{i,j}`. (1610.07849:FermionicMPS.tex)

Cited fact 19.2 (The fermionic cMPS already has the graded bond). [cited] Haegeman, Cirac, Osborne and Verstraete [39] give the fermionic cMPS: a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded bond with block-diagonal Q , block-off-diagonal R for fermionic species, and parity-graded boundary matrices. Verbatim: `R_{\alpha} = \begin{bmatrix} 0_{D^{(+)}} \times D^{(+)} & R_{\alpha}^{(+)} \\ R_{\alpha}^{(-)} & 0_{D^{(-)}} \times D^{(-)} \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{(particle species } \alpha \text{ is fermionic)}`. (1211.3935:calculus.tex:327).

Cited fact 19.3 (The transfer fixed point is the half-line reduced state). [cited] Verstraete and Cirac [90]: the eigenvalues of the fixed point of the cMPS transfer Lindbladian are the squared Schmidt coefficients of a bipartition. Verbatim: the eigenvalues of the matrix $\rho(x)$ would exactly correspond to the squares of the Schmidt coefficients when considering a bipartition at site x (1002.1824:mpsQFT4.tex:81).

So the graded bond with a supertrace ring contraction is not new as a tensor-network construction; the arithmetic reading is what this book proposes.

19.2 Vacuum decay: the zeros as odd coherences, the vacuum as fixed point

Theorem 19.4 (The finite vacuum-decay model). [proved] For finite-dimensional H , B with $-(B + B^\dagger) = |j\rangle\langle j|$ and $e^{tB} \rightarrow 0$, the vacuum-decay Lindbladian $\mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}}$ of Definition 5.4 is a trace-preserving GKLS generator with unique stationary density Ω_{vac} ; in the block decomposition of $B(\mathbb{C} \oplus H)$ it is triangular, the coherence blocks evolve exactly by e^{tB} , and

$$\text{spec } \mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}} = \{0\} \uplus \text{spec } B \uplus \overline{\text{spec } B} \uplus \{b_i + \bar{b}_j\},$$

ordered pairs with multiplicities; the coherences are odd and the populations even.

Explicitly $e^{t\mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}}}$ is conjugation by $1 \oplus e^{tB}$ plus the completely positive feed $X \mapsto \text{Tr}[(1 - e^{tB^\dagger} e^{tB})X] \Omega_{\text{vac}}$.

Corollary 19.5 (Traces of the vacuum-decay semigroup). [proved] $\text{Tr } e^{t\mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}}} = |1 + \text{Tr } e^{tB}|^2$ and $\text{str } e^{t\mathcal{L}_{\text{vac}}} = |1 - \text{Tr } e^{tB}|^2$: the vacuum-decay transfer carries both coherence lists and all pair sums, and is not the single-particle generator $\mathbf{G}$.

Proposition 19.6 (The absorbing-vacuum channel). [proved-conditional] For any strongly continuous contraction semigroup $Z_t \rightarrow 0$ (strongly) on a separable Hilbert space, the

absorbing-vacuum channel of Definition 5.4 is a strongly continuous CPTP semigroup on trace-class operators on $\mathbb{C} \oplus H$ with unique stationary density Ω_{vac} and exact odd coherence evolution by Z_t . For $H = K_S$ it realises the Riemann channel as its odd coherence sector.

Observation 19.7 (Zeros in the coherences, pair sums in the populations). [sketched] For $H = K_S$ each zero appears once as an odd coherence mode $-\bar{\rho}/2$ and once as its conjugate (odd multiplicity $2m_\rho$), the even populations carry the pair sums $-(\bar{\rho}_n + \rho_m)/2$, and their formal trace $|\text{Tr}_{\text{dist}} Z(t)|^2$ is not a defined product of distributions; no pair-correlation statement follows.

Proposition 19.8 (The vacuum is absorbing, and the entanglement is trivial). [proved]
The jump reinserts into the vacuum, but the renewal integral $\int_0^T e^{t\bar{B}} \Omega_{\text{vac}} e^{tB^\dagger} dt = T \Omega_{\text{vac}}$ diverges: the vacuum is absorbing, not a rebound state of finite holding time, so this model does not solve the renewal equation of the SHW picture with a rebound inside K_S . The canonical cMPS selected by the stationary bond density has a single nonzero Schmidt weight: its half-line entanglement is trivial.

This is the first half: side B without side A. The construction has the right relaxation modes and no entanglement.

19.3 The prime chain: the Gibbs fixed point, and no zeros

Cited fact 19.9 (Bost–Connes KMS classification). [cited]

For $0 < \beta \leq 1$ the Bost–Connes system has a unique KMS_β state; for $\beta > 1$ the extremal KMS states are the Gibbs states with partition function $\zeta(\beta)$, labelled by embeddings of $\mathbb{Q}^{\text{ab}}$ [19, 12]. Verbatim: For $0 < \beta \leq 1$ there exists a unique KMS_β state φ_β for the above system. (math/0404128:houcheschapter1final7.tex:1820–182

Proposition 19.10 (Normal KMS states are the Gibbs densities, only above the transition). [proved]
For the dynamics $\text{Ad}(N^{\text{it}})$ on $B(\ell^2(\mathbb{N}))$ a normal KMS_β state exists iff $\beta > 1$, and then it is ϱ_β^{G} ; the spectrum of $-\log \varrho_\beta^{\text{G}}$ is $\{\beta \log n + \log \zeta(\beta)\}$; and TFD_β factorises over the prime sites, with bond dimension one along the prime chain. The unique critical KMS state of the Bost–Connes algebra is not a normal density in this representation.

Lemma 19.11 (M/M/1 spectrum). [proved] *The birth–death generator on $\mathbb{N}_0$ with constant up-rate λ and down-rate $\lambda' > \lambda$, on L^2 of its geometric stationary law, has spectrum $\{0\} \cup [-(\sqrt{\lambda} + \sqrt{\lambda'})^2, -(\sqrt{\lambda} - \sqrt{\lambda'})^2]$, the zero simple.*

Proposition 19.12 (The classical prime-chain dynamics). [proved] *The diagonal part of $\mathcal{L}_\beta^{\text{pc}}$ ($\sum_p r_p < \infty$, $\beta > 1$) is a nonexplosive product of independent birth–death chains, one per prime, with unique stationary law $n^{-\beta}/\zeta(\beta)$; its self-adjoint generator on L^2 of that law has spectrum the closure of $\{0\}$ and the finite Minkowski sums of the bands $[-r_p(p^{\beta/2} + 1)^2, -r_p(p^{\beta/2} - 1)^2]$. It is real, and contains no zero of ζ .*

Proposition 19.13 (Off-diagonal sectors). [proved] *If $\sum_p r_p p^\beta < \infty$, $\mathcal{L}_\beta^{\text{pc}}$ generates a bounded CPTP semigroup with ϱ_β^{G} stationary, and on the weighted Hilbert space with norm $\|\varrho_\beta^{\text{G}-1/4} x \varrho_\beta^{\text{G}-1/4}\|_{\text{HS}}$ it is bounded, self-adjoint and nonpositive, off-diagonal sectors included: its spectrum is real.*

Corollary 19.14 (Delocalisation at the transition). [proved] *As $\beta \downarrow 1$ the Gibbs density has no trace-norm limit and its mass on every finite-rank projection tends to zero; for $0 < \beta \leq 1$ the prime occupation process has no stationary probability on finite-support configurations. This is the precise content available for the Bost–Connes transition; it is not a proof of ergodicity breaking of a Riemann Lindbladian.*

This is the second half: side A without side B. The stationary state is right and the spectrum is blind to the zeros, as every prime-by-prime construction is (observation 47.5).

19.4 Entropy of the bond state and its cutoffs

Numerical result 19.15 (Entropy of the Gibbs density under cutoffs). [numerical]
`scripts/bc_entropy.py` (`outputs/bc_entropy.txt`): $\mathcal{S}_{\text{ent}}(\varrho_\beta^G) = \log \zeta(\beta) - \beta \zeta'(\beta)/\zeta(\beta)$ against the prime-product sum; with the prime cutoff $p \leq P$ at $\beta = 1$ the entropy follows $\log P + \log \log P$ to 10^{-3} at $P = 10^6$, grows like $\beta P^{1-\beta}/(1-\beta)$ for $\beta < 1$ and saturates for $\beta > 1$; with the bond cutoff $n \leq N$ at $\beta = 1$ the ratio $\mathcal{S}_{\text{ent}}/\log N$ falls towards $\frac{1}{2}$ (0.657 at $N = 10^7$) against 1 for $\beta < 1$ and 0 for $\beta > 1$; the number of entanglement levels below E is $\lfloor e^E \rfloor$. Constants fixed by the review: $\mathcal{S}_{\text{ent}} = 1/(\beta - 1) + \log(1/(\beta - 1)) + (1 - \gamma_E) + o(1)$; the prime-cutoff constant is exactly 0, the two Mertens constants cancelling; the bond-cutoff constant is $-\gamma_E/2$.

Observation 19.16 (The entanglement Hamiltonian is free and Hagedorn). [sketched]
 If the Phantasm's bond fixed point is ϱ_β^G , then by cited fact 19.3 its entanglement Hamiltonian is the Bost–Connes Hamiltonian $\beta \log N$, free over the primes with single-particle levels $\log p$; the entanglement entropy is finite for $\beta > 1$, grows like $\log P$ (prime cutoff) or $\frac{1}{2} \log N$ (bond cutoff) at $\beta = 1$, and like a power of the cutoff for $\beta < 1$: gapped, critical, and not a cMPS at all. The level density e^E is Hagedorn growth with $\beta_H = 1$ (Julia's reading of the transition [49]), not Cardy growth, so the finite-entanglement scaling law of critical CFTs does not apply to this state.

19.5 The two halves, and the guiding observation

Observation 19.17 (Complementary halves). [sketched] The vacuum-decay channel has the zeros as odd relaxation modes (each zero twice, as a coherence and its conjugate, plus an even pair-sum sector) but a pure stationary state, hence trivial entanglement. The prime-chain Gibbs Lindbladian, for $\beta > 1$, has ϱ_β^G as stationary state, with entanglement spectrum $\beta \log n + \log \zeta(\beta)$, proportional to the ring lengths $2 \log n$, but a real spectrum with no zeros: unconditionally for its classical part, and on the weighted space of Proposition 19.13 for the full generator when $\sum r_p p^\beta < \infty$. As of 2026-09-14 no construction in this book had both; the renewal channel with a rebound inside K_S has both as a spectral statement, the mixed density living on K_S itself with the cusp flux as its rebound, without the arithmetic identification (observation 24.14), and the Phantasm would need both with it (conjecture 47.3).

Observation 19.18 (The grading is trivial versus nontrivial characters). [sketched-conditional]
 In the Artin–Schreier super-transfer matrix (Theorem 29.9) the even block is the trivial additive-character sector, the de Bruijn count q^n (the pole at $u = 1/q$), together with the point at infinity (the pole at $u = 1$, not a character sector), and the odd block is the direct sum of the corrected Frobenius blocks F_{ag} over the nontrivial characters, which carries the zeros as its net spectrum. By analogy, a Galois-symmetric Riemann bond decomposed under $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}^\times$ would have as even sector the pole of ζ , the trivial Dirichlet character being the only one with a pole, and as odd sector the zeros of every $L(s, \chi)$: the graded object would compute the zeta of the cover, the Dedekind zeta of the cyclotomic field at level N , not ζ alone. This is consistent with the character-basis transfer eigenvalues $L(\beta, \bar{\chi})/\zeta(\beta)$ of Proposition 17.8, which by Proposition 19.12 is nevertheless not that object, and it is where Connes's trace formula lands (all L -functions with Grössencharakter). It is an analogy, not a theorem; its finite-level test is conjecture 47.4.

Numerical result 19.19 (Supertrace, vacuum decay and prime-chain bands, checked). [numerical]
`scripts/riemann_graded_trace.py` (`outputs/riemann_graded_trace.txt`, 42/42 checks): the

windowed supertrace of $\mathbf{G}$ with 3000 zeros against $2P_+$ has ratio $1 - 5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ at twelve prime powers and is positive to within truncation (minimum -0.041 against peaks of 147); both ladder alternatives match and are positive; flipping the first zero pair to even gives -2.88 ; the finite vacuum-decay spectral multiset matches Theorem 19.4 to $7 \cdot 10^{-14}$ for $D = 3, 5, 8$ with CPTP and coherence checks; single-prime birth-death spectra lie in the $M/M/1$ bands and the product gap equals the $p = 2$ gap.

Observation 19.20 (Established scope). [sketched] Established: the forced graded net spectrum and its realisation by a graded contraction semigroup with one even fixed line; the no-go for ungraded trace-class realisations; a genuine absorbing-vacuum channel with the Riemann channel as its odd coherences; the normal-Gibbs classification and the prime-chain spectra. Not established: unrestricted infinite parity rigidity, the analytic realisation of the Lax–Phillips input, a cMPS whose Hilbert norm is the prime measure, and a stationary entangled bond with the critical arithmetic state.

20 The Phantasm III: Stationarity, Symmetry, and Generator Freedom

TJO's specification is an unknown Lindbladian with the BC state stationary, Galois symmetry, and compatible adelic symplectic structure. The no-event generator and the jumps are both unknown. This section completes a finite constraint calculation, not the construction of the adelic bond. Detailed arguments B0–B6 are in `notes/bc-symmetry-generators.md`; source loci are in `notes/extract/bc-symmetry-sources.md`. These arguments have not had an independent review and therefore carry **sketched**, including the statements with complete written derivations. Numerical evidence is separately tagged. No claim of novelty is made for the general GKLS machinery.

20.1 The state on the finite phase algebra

Proposition 20.1 (Residue probabilities).

[sketched] For the state of Definition 7.1,

$$w_\beta(0) = p^{-\beta}, \quad w_\beta(x) = \frac{1 - p^{-\beta}}{p - 1} \quad (x \neq 0).$$

At criticality the phase marginal is uniform at every integer level N , compatible under reduction, and $\varrho_{p,1}^{\text{res}} = I/p$.

This is finite Fourier inversion of the BC KMS formula [19]; for $\beta > 1$ it also follows by averaging the residue-class Gibbs sums over the Galois action. A single extremal state is generally not invariant. Uniform phase probabilities fix the diagonal of a matrix extension, not its off-diagonal entries. The full critical BC state is not a normal density in the standard representation (Proposition 19.10).

Proposition 20.2 (Finite representations collapse the BC phases).

[sketched]

Every finite-dimensional unital $$ -representation of the full BC algebra sends all $e(r)$, $r \in \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$, to I . Consequently it cannot realise the nontrivial critical finite phase marginal.*

Indeed, $\mathbf{m}_n^* \mathbf{m}_n = I$ makes $\mathbf{m}_n$ unitary in finite dimension. The BC relation gives $I = \mathbf{m}_n \mathbf{m}_n^* = n^{-1} \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} e(k/n)$, the spectral projection onto the eigenvalue 1 of $e(1/n)$. Thus $e(1/n) = I$ for every n . This excludes an exact finite representation; it does not exclude restrictions, CP compressions, or asymptotic models.

Proposition 20.3 (Invariant state extensions).

[sketched] A unique stationary density of a

covariant semigroup is invariant under its symmetry group. The diagonal extension $\varrho_{p,\beta}^{\text{res}}$ is Galois invariant, and is Weil invariant iff $\beta = 1$. The same phase marginal has a unique Weil-invariant matrix extension, when it is positive:

$$\varrho_b = aI + (r - a)P, \quad r = p^{-\beta}, \quad a = \frac{1 - r}{p - 1}.$$

Its parity-block eigenvalues are r and $2a - r$, so positivity holds iff $r \leq 2/(p+1)$. Full Weyl invariance forces I/p .

The Weil-invariant operator space is $\text{span}\{I, P\}$: the symplectic group is transitive on the nonzero Weyl labels and $\sum_v X_v = pP$. The diagonal fixes the two coefficients. These coherent extensions are explicit state-extension examples, not an identification with the full BC bond. Above the transition, covariance can instead act on a family of stationary extremal states; uniqueness is the premise of the first assertion.

20.2 The complete finite feasibility problem

Theorem 20.4 (A linear section of the conditional Choi cone). *[sketched]* The cone $\mathfrak{C}_U(\varrho_b)$
consists exactly of complex-linear maps L with

$$\begin{aligned} L(X^*) &= L(X)^*, \quad \text{Tr } L(X) = 0, \quad L(\varrho_b) = 0, \\ [L, \text{Ad}(U_g)] &= 0 \quad \text{for every } g, \quad QC_LQ \geq 0. \end{aligned}$$

Equivalently, in an orthonormal traceless operator basis F_i ,

$$L(X) = -i[H, X] + \sum_{i,j} A_{ij} (F_i X F_j^* - \tfrac{1}{2} \{F_j^* F_i, X\}), \quad A \geq 0, \quad H = H^*.$$

With $\text{Tr } H = 0$, covariance requires H invariant and A commuting with the induced representation on traceless operators. If that representation is $\bigoplus_\lambda V_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{C}^{m_\lambda}$, then $A = \bigoplus_\lambda I_{V_\lambda} \otimes A_\lambda$, $A_\lambda \geq 0$; stationarity supplies further linear equations. Every invariant faithful ϱ_b has an interior feasible generator $X \mapsto \varrho_b \text{Tr } X - X$.

Necessity follows by differentiating a positive channel Choi matrix on the complement of the maximally entangled vector. For sufficiency, the positive matrix QC_LQ supplies the traceless Kraus part; the remainder is the Choi matrix of $KX + XK^*$, and trace annihilation fixes its Hermitian part. This yields the bounded GKLS form recalled in [80]. The reset generator has conditional Choi matrix $Q(I \otimes \varrho_b)Q$, strictly positive on the range of Q .

Theorem 20.5 (Dimensions at the critical tracial extension). *[sketched]* For odd prime p , at stationary density I/p , the real dimensions of the generator cones' linear spans are

<i>commuting actions</i>	<i>dimension, including time scale</i>
<i>Galois torus</i>	$(p-1)(p+1)^2$
<i>full linear Weil action</i>	$2p-2$
<i>Weyl translations and Galois torus</i>	$p+1$
<i>Weyl translations and full Weil action</i>	1.

In Weyl coordinates, trace annihilation and stationarity remove the identity row and column. The first two dimensions count simultaneous group orbits on ordered pairs of nonzero vectors. The torus acts freely; the symplectic orbits are $w = av$ ($a \neq 0$) and $\det(v, w) = b$ ($b \neq 0$), giving $2(p-1)$. Since $-I$ belongs to both groups, Hermiticity makes the orbit coefficients real. The depolarizing generator is an interior point of the conditional Choi cone, so positivity does not reduce these dimensions. Orbit coefficients are not independent nonnegative rates in the first two rows.

Proposition 20.6 (The cost of extra Weyl covariance). *[sketched]*
All Weyl-covariant generators are $L(X) = \sum_{v \neq 0} c_v (X_v X X_v^ - X)$, $c_v \geq 0$. Galois covariance makes the rates constant on the two punctured axes and the $p-1$ sets $xy = b \neq 0$. In particular $c_v = c_{-v}$, making every Weyl eigenvalue real and nonpositive. Full symplectic covariance makes all the rates equal and gives exactly $L = \gamma(\mathcal{D}_p - \text{id})$, $\gamma \geq 0$.*

This extra commuting symmetry removes the oscillatory zero-like modes in this model. It is not a consequence of merely requiring a symplectic representation or an adelic structure.

20.3 Odd spectral freedom and coupling freedom

Proposition 20.7 (A symplectic odd-sector counterexample). *[sketched] Let a be a primitive root modulo p and set $R_a(I) = 0$, $R_a(X_v) = X_{av}$ for $v \neq 0$. Then*

$$L = \mathcal{D}_p - \text{id} + \varepsilon R_a, \quad \varepsilon = \frac{1}{4p^2}$$

is a CPTP generator with unique stationary state I/p and full Weil, Galois and parity covariance. For $p = 7$ its odd eigenvalues are $-1 - \varepsilon$ and $-1 + \varepsilon/2 \pm i\sqrt{3}\varepsilon/2$, each with multiplicity 8. The odd decay rates are unequal.

The map R_a is Hermiticity preserving and equivariant, but need not itself be positive. Its Choi operator norm is bounded by its Frobenius norm $\sqrt{p^2 - 1} < p$, whereas the depolarizer's conditional Choi matrix is Q/p ; the specified perturbation therefore remains strictly positive on the range of Q . At $p = 7$, scalar multiplication has eight cycles of length six, and the odd sector selects the roots whose cube is -1 . Thus the counterexample does not fit any input zero positions.

Proposition 20.8 (Couplings invisible to the one-prime restrictions). *[sketched] For distinct primes p, q , fixed positive rates a, b , and $0 \leq c \leq \min(a, b)$, let*

$$L_c = (a - c)(\mathcal{D}_p - \text{id}) \otimes \text{id} + (b - c)\text{id} \otimes (\mathcal{D}_q - \text{id}) \\ + c(\mathcal{D}_p \otimes \mathcal{D}_q - \text{id}).$$

These CPTP generators have the unique stationary state $I/(pq)$ and full local Weyl/Weil covariance. Their restrictions on the one-prime observable algebras are independent of c , with rates a and b , while the rate on the joint traceless sector is $a + b - c$.

Each summand is a nonnegative multiple of a channel minus the identity. The four tensor sectors give the eigenvalues $0, -a, -b, -a - b + c$ directly. This supplies compatible two-prime residue dynamics under CRT with a variable coupling; it is not an infinite adelic construction.

Numerical result 20.9 (Finite arithmetic symmetry checks). *[numerical] The script `scripts/bc_symmetry_generators.py` passes 427 checks; its output is `outputs/bc_symmetry_generators.txt`. The checks cover $p = 3, 5, 7$: BC residue probabilities against Hurwitz sums, invariant matrix extensions, orbit dimensions against independent Burnside counts, conditional and finite-time Choi positivity, trace preservation, stationarity and uniqueness, covariance, Egorov, odd-sector spectra, and two-prime restrictions. The four cone dimensions are respectively $(32, 4, 4, 1)$, $(144, 8, 6, 1)$, and $(384, 12, 8, 1)$.*

20.4 What is still missing

The finite inverse problem is now a concrete positive-semidefinite cone. The missing input is a representation or CP comparison map connecting the full BC algebra, including its prime isometries, to the scattering bond, with compatible local Weil data. It must select the permitted commuting symmetries and constrain the generator blocks and the inter-prime couplings. The $\Gamma_0(N)$ character/scattering computation of conjecture 47.4 remains open. Prime-power levels, the real place, metaplectic compatibility and the critical operator-algebra limit have not been constructed. A chosen graded transfer spectrum alone does not identify a physical cMPS norm.

The earlier reset test $-(B\rho_b + \rho_b B^*) \geq 0$ is a criterion for a fixed finite no-event generator B and scalar reset, when its exit flux is positive. It is not a no-go criterion for the full cone in Theorem 20.4, where B and all jumps may vary.

21 The Fermion Parity of a Boson–Fermion cMPS Ring

Question (TJO, 2026-09-13). The Phantasm programme reads the ring norm of a graded cMPS as a supertrace (HANDOFF, “forced consequence”). Had that been proved, and what does a direct calculation of the expectation value of $(-1)^F$ in a general boson–fermion cMPS give? *Answer on arrival.* It had not been proved. The book contained the graded contraction of lattice fermionic MPS as a citation (cited fact 19.1), the graded cMPS matrix structure as a citation (cited fact 19.2), and theorems about abstract graded spectral data (Section 18); no cMPS calculation. This section and the next supply it, with the definitions of Section 8.

Result in one paragraph. For arbitrary data, $\langle \Psi_{B'}^c | (-1)^{\hat{F}} | \Psi_B^c \rangle = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') e^{L\mathbb{T}\eta}]$, a signed sum of squares (Theorem 21.6). With a bond grading this collapses: the physical parity only moves B to PBP , so $\langle (-1)^{\hat{F}} \rangle = \pm 1$ for a parity-homogeneous boundary (Proposition 22.1). The supertrace appears instead as the norm of the ring closed with the bond parity, $\|\Psi_P^c\|^2 = \text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}}$, graded by $\Gamma_b = P \otimes \bar{P}$, whose ring-length transform is $1/\text{sdet}(z - \mathbb{T})$ (Theorems 22.2 and 22.4). So the HANDOFF sentence is correct as stated for finite bonds, but the sign is the bond parity of the closure, not the expectation value of the physical $(-1)^F$.

Status. The author of every argument here is `claudé:opus-5`, working alone at TJO’s instruction; no independent review has been performed, so the rows are **sketched**. The numerical row is independent evidence at the level of explicit Jordan–Wigner operators.

21.1 Inputs

Assumption 21.1 (Graded canonical relations). `[assumed]` In $\mathfrak{F}$ (Definition 8.1), for $f, g \in L^2([0, L])$ and $a, b \in \mathfrak{S}$, on $\mathfrak{F}_{\text{fin}}$: (F1) $a_b(g)a_a^\dagger(f) - \eta_{ab}a_a^\dagger(f)a_b(g) = \delta_{ab}\langle g, f \rangle$ and $a_a^\dagger(f)a_b^\dagger(g) = \eta_{ab}a_b^\dagger(g)a_a^\dagger(f)$; (F2) $a_b(g)\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}} = 0$; (F3) $\langle \Upsilon, a_a^\dagger(f)\Upsilon' \rangle = \langle a_a(f)\Upsilon, \Upsilon' \rangle$ for $\Upsilon, \Upsilon' \in \mathfrak{F}_{\text{fin}}$, $a_a^\dagger(f)$ is linear in f and maps $\mathfrak{F}_n$ into $\mathfrak{F}_{n+1}$; (F4) the $\mathfrak{F}_n$ are mutually orthogonal, $\|\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}\| = 1$ and $\mathfrak{F}_0 = \mathbb{C}\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$; (F5) $\Gamma(u)$ is unitary, $\Gamma(u)\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}} = \Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$ and $\Gamma(u)a_a^\dagger(f) = a_a^\dagger(u_a f)\Gamma(u)$. These are the standard properties of the boson and fermion Fock spaces.

Cited fact 21.2 (Overlap, transfer matrix and parity action of cMPS). `[cited]` Haegeman, Cirac, Osborne and Verstraete [39] compute the overlap of two boson–fermion cMPS as $\text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}) \mathcal{P} \exp \int \mathbb{T}]$ with the transfer matrix carrying a plus sign for every species, using the ordered contraction of creation operators formally with delta functions, and state that the parity operator replaces R_α by $\eta_\alpha R_\alpha$. Verbatim: `\voperator {T}(x)=Q(x)\otimes \text{one}_{\{D\}}+\text{one}_{\{D\}}\otimes \overline{\{Q(x)\}} + \sum_{\alpha=1}^N R_{\alpha}(x)\otimes \overline{R_{\alpha}(x)}`. (1211.3935:calculus) and `Since \operator {P}\ket {\Psi [Q,\{R_{\alpha}\}]}=\ket {\Psi [Q,\{\eta_{\alpha} R_{\alpha}\}]}` (1211.3935:calculus.tex:319).

So the overlap formula and the parity action are prior art at a formal level, and Theorem 21.6(ii) below is their combination. What this section adds is a proof from (F1)–(F5) in which the absence of a statistics sign in the norm is a checked step (Lemma 21.3, step (1)3), not a convention.

21.2 Ordered contraction and the Fock embedding

A *grid* is a partition of $[0, L]$ into finitely many nonempty half-open intervals $C_1, \dots, C_M$ listed from left to right, χ_i the indicator of C_i . For a strictly increasing $i = (i_1 < \dots < i_n)$ and $a \in \mathfrak{S}^n$ put $e(i, a) = a_{a_1}^\dagger(\chi_{i_1}) \cdots a_{a_n}^\dagger(\chi_{i_n})\Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$ ($e(\emptyset) = \Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$), and let $\text{box}(i, a) \in \mathcal{K}_n$ be $(x; b) \mapsto \delta_{ab} \prod_k \chi_{i_k}(x_k)$, which is supported in $\Delta_n^< \times \mathfrak{S}^n$ because the cells are ordered.

Lemma 21.3 (Ordered creation vectors contract without sign).

[sketched-conditional]

For strictly increasing i of length n , j of length m on one grid, and words a, b , $\langle e(j, b), e(i, a) \rangle = \delta_{mn} \prod_{k=1}^n \delta_{i_k j_k} \delta_{a_k b_k} |C_{i_k}|$.

Proof. $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. For $g, h_1, \dots, h_n \in L^2$ and $b, a_1, \dots, a_n \in \mathfrak{S}$: $a_b(g) a_{a_1}^\dagger(h_1) \cdots a_{a_n}^\dagger(h_n) \Omega_{\mathfrak{F}} = \sum_{k=1}^n \left(\prod_{l < k} \eta_{ba_l} \right) \delta_{ba_k} \langle g, h_k \rangle$

Proof. Induction on n . For $n = 0$ both sides vanish by (F2). For $n \geq 1$ write the vector as $a_{a_1}^\dagger(h_1)X$ and use (F1): $a_b(g) a_{a_1}^\dagger(h_1)X = \delta_{ba_1} \langle g, h_1 \rangle X + \eta_{ba_1} a_{a_1}^\dagger(h_1) a_b(g)X$; expand $a_b(g)X$ by the induction hypothesis. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 2$. For $m \geq 1$ and $\Upsilon \in \mathfrak{F}_{\text{fin}}$, $\langle e(j, b), \Upsilon \rangle = \langle e(j', b'), a_{b_1}(\chi_{j_1}) \Upsilon \rangle$ with $j' = (j_2, \dots, j_m)$, $b' = (b_2, \dots, b_m)$. *Proof.* $e(j, b) = a_{b_1}^\dagger(\chi_{j_1}) e(j', b')$ and (F3). $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 3$. **The lemma, by induction on m .** If $m = 0$ the claim is $\langle \Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}, e(i, a) \rangle = \delta_{n0}$, true by (F3), (F4). If $m \geq 1$ and $n = 0$, the inner product is $\langle e(j', b'), a_{b_1}(\chi_{j_1}) \Omega_{\mathfrak{F}} \rangle = 0$ by $\langle 1 \rangle 2$ and (F2). Let $m, n \geq 1$. By $\langle 1 \rangle 2$ and $\langle 1 \rangle 1$,

$$\langle e(j, b), e(i, a) \rangle = \sum_{k=1}^n \left(\prod_{l < k} \eta_{b_1 a_l} \right) \delta_{b_1 a_k} \langle \chi_{j_1}, \chi_{i_k} \rangle \langle e(j', b'), e(i^{(k)}, a^{(k)}) \rangle,$$

$i^{(k)}, a^{(k)}$ being i, a with the k -th entry deleted. Since distinct cells are disjoint, $\langle \chi_{j_1}, \chi_{i_k} \rangle = |C_{i_k}| \delta_{j_1 i_k}$. Let $k \geq 2$. If $m = 1$, then j' is empty and $i^{(k)}$ is not, so the last factor is 0 by the induction hypothesis. If $m \geq 2$, the induction hypothesis makes the last factor vanish unless $j' = i^{(k)}$, whose first entry is i_1 ; that would give $j_2 = i_1 < i_k = j_1$, contradicting $j_1 < j_2$. Hence only $k = 1$ survives; its sign product is empty, so $\langle e(j, b), e(i, a) \rangle = \delta_{b_1 a_1} \delta_{j_1 i_1} |C_{i_1}| \langle e(j', b'), e(i^{(1)}, a^{(1)}) \rangle$, and the induction hypothesis finishes. $\square$

The statistics factors $\prod_{l < k} \eta_{b_1 a_l}$ ride only on the terms $k \geq 2$, which vanish: this is the whole reason no sign enters the norm of an ordered state. $\square$

Lemma 21.4 (Isometric embedding of ordered amplitudes).

[sketched-conditional]

There is a unique bounded linear $\mathcal{J}: \bigoplus_n \mathcal{K}_n \rightarrow \mathfrak{F}$ with $\mathcal{J} \text{box}(i, a) = e(i, a)$ for every grid, strictly increasing i and word a . It is isometric, maps $\mathcal{K}_n$ into $\overline{\mathfrak{F}_n}$, and satisfies $(-1)^{\hat{F}} \mathcal{J} = \mathcal{J} \hat{\eta}$ where $(\hat{\eta}c)(x; a) = \eta_a c(x; a)$.

Proof. $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. **One grid.** The box functions of a grid G are pairwise orthogonal in $\mathcal{K}_n$ with $\|\text{box}(i, a)\|^2 = \prod_k |C_{i_k}|$. By Lemma 21.3 the vectors $e(i, a)$ have the same Gram matrix, so the linear extension $\mathcal{J}_G$ to their span S_G is well defined and isometric. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 2$. **Refinement.** If G' refines G then $S_G \subseteq S_{G'}$ and $\mathcal{J}_{G'}|_{S_G} = \mathcal{J}_G$. *Proof.* Each C_{i_k} is a disjoint union of G' -cells, all to the left of those in $C_{i_{k+1}}$, so $\text{box}(i, a) = \sum \text{box}'(i', a)$ over the strictly increasing i' with $C'_{i'_k} \subseteq C_{i_k}$, and $e(i, a) = \sum e'(i', a)$ by linearity of $a^\dagger$ in its argument (F3). $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 3$. Any two grids have a common refinement, so $S = \bigcup_G S_G$ is a linear subspace on which $\mathcal{J}$ is well defined and isometric. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 4$. **Density.** S is dense in $\mathcal{K}_n$. *Proof.* Continuous c with compact support in $\Delta_n^< \times \mathfrak{S}^n$ are dense. On the uniform grid of mesh h let c_h equal c at the left corner of each strictly increasing box and 0 elsewhere. On those boxes $|c - c_h| \leq \text{osc}_c(\sqrt{n}h)$; every other point of $\Delta_n^<$ has two consecutive coordinates in one cell, a set of measure at most $(n-1)hL^{n-1}$. So $\|c - c_h\|^2 \leq |\mathfrak{S}|^n (\text{osc}_c(\sqrt{n}h)^2 L^n + (n-1)hL^{n-1} \sup |c|^2) \rightarrow 0$ by uniform continuity. $\square$

(1)5. **Extension.** $\mathcal{J}$ extends uniquely by continuity to an isometry on each $\mathcal{K}_n$ with range in $\overline{\mathfrak{F}_n}$ (F3); ranges for different n are orthogonal (F4), so the sum over n is isometric. Uniqueness: a bounded map is fixed by its values on the dense set S . $\square$

(1)6. **Parity.** By (F5), $(-1)^{\hat{F}}e(i, a) = \eta_a e(i, a)$. Both $(-1)^{\hat{F}}\mathcal{J}$ and $\mathcal{J}\hat{\eta}$ are bounded and agree on S . $\square$

$\square$

For box amplitudes $\mathcal{J}$ is literally the smeared form of the formal integral $\int c a_{a_1}^\dagger(x_1) \cdots a_{a_n}^\dagger(x_n) \Omega_{\mathfrak{F}}$ of [39]; Lemma 21.4 is its rigorous meaning.

21.3 The overlap and parity theorem

Lemma 21.5 (Dyson series). *[sketched] Let $A, C \in M_N(\mathbb{C})$, $L \geq 0$, $I_0(L) = e^{LA}$ and, for $n \geq 1$, $I_n(L) = \int_{0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n < L} e^{x_1 A} C e^{(x_2 - x_1)A} C \cdots C e^{(L - x_n)A} dx$. Then $\|I_n(L)\| \leq e^{L\|A\|} \|C\|^n L^n / n!$ and $\sum_{n \geq 0} I_n(L) = e^{L(A+C)}$.*

Proof. (1)1. **Bound.** $\|e^{yA}\| \leq e^{y\|A\|}$ and the exponents in each integrand add up to L , so the integrand has norm at most $e^{L\|A\|} \|C\|^n$; the simplex has volume $L^n / n!$. $\square$

(1)2. **Recursion.** $I_n(L) = \int_0^L I_{n-1}(y) C e^{(L-y)A} dy$ for $n \geq 1$. *Proof.* Fubini, integrating first over $0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_{n-1} < y = x_n$. $\square$

(1)3. On $[0, L_0]$ the series $F = \sum_n I_n$ converges uniformly by (1)1, F is continuous, and summing (1)2 termwise gives $F(L) = e^{LA} + \int_0^L F(y) C e^{(L-y)A} dy$. $\square$

(1)4. $G(L) = e^{L(A+C)}$ satisfies the same equation. *Proof.* Put $H(L) = G(L)e^{-LA}$. Then $H' = G(A+C)e^{-LA} - GAe^{-LA} = GCe^{-LA}$ and $H(0) = 1$, so $G(L)e^{-LA} = 1 + \int_0^L G(y) C e^{-yA} dy$; multiply by e^{LA} on the right. $\square$

(1)5. **QED.** $Z = F - G$ is continuous with $Z(L) = \int_0^L Z(y) C e^{(L-y)A} dy$, so $\|Z(L)\| \leq K \int_0^L \|Z(y)\| dy$ with $K = \|C\| e^{L_0\|A\|}$; iterating, $\|Z(L)\| \leq \sup_{[0, L_0]} \|Z\| (KL)^k / k!$ for every k , hence $Z = 0$. $\square$

$\square$

Theorem 21.6 (Overlap and fermion parity of cMPS rings).

[sketched-conditional]

Let (Q, R, B) and (Q', R', B') be cMPS data with the same D and $\mathfrak{S}$, and let $\Psi = \Psi_B^c$, Ψ' the ring vector of (Q', R', B') . The series defining them converge in $\mathfrak{F}$, and

$$(i) \quad \langle \Psi', \Psi \rangle = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') e^{L\mathbb{T}}];$$

$$(ii) \quad \langle \Psi', (-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi \rangle = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') e^{L\mathbb{T}_\eta}];$$

$$(iii) \quad \langle \Psi, (-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi \rangle = \sum_{n \geq 0} \sum_{a \in \mathfrak{S}^n} \eta_a \int_{\Delta_n^c} |c_n^B(x; a)|^2 dx, \text{ and } \|\Psi\|^2 \text{ is the same sum without the signs } \eta_a.$$

No bond grading, regularity condition or normalisation is assumed.

Proof. Write $\epsilon \in \{0, 1\}$, with $\epsilon = 1$ for the parity insertion, and $A = Q \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes \bar{Q}'$, $C_\epsilon = \sum_a \eta_a^\epsilon R_a \otimes \bar{R}'_a$, so that $A + C_0 = \mathbb{T}$ and $A + C_1 = \mathbb{T}_\eta$.

- $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. **Convergence.** With $r = \max_a \|R_a\|$ and the trace norm $\|B\|_1$, $|c_n^B(x; a)| \leq \|B\|_1 e^{L\|Q\|} r^n$, so $\|c_n^B\|_{\mathcal{K}_n}^2 \leq \|B\|_1^2 e^{2L\|Q\|} (|\mathfrak{S}| r^2 L)^n / n!$. The vectors $\mathcal{J} c_n^B$ are mutually orthogonal (Lemma 21.4) with summable squared norms, so $\sum_n \mathcal{J} c_n^B$ converges. $\square$
- $\langle 1 \rangle 2$. $\langle \Psi', ((-1)^{\hat{F}})^\epsilon \Psi \rangle = \sum_n \sum_a \eta_a^\epsilon \int_{\Delta_n^<} \overline{c'_n(x; a)} c_n^B(x; a) dx$, c'_n the amplitude of the primed data. *Proof.* Continuity of the inner product and of $(-1)^{\hat{F}}$, then $(-1)^{\hat{F}} \mathcal{J} = \mathcal{J} \hat{\eta}$, isometry of $\mathcal{J}$ and orthogonality for different n (Lemma 21.4). $\square$
- $\langle 1 \rangle 3$. **Pointwise factorisation.** $\overline{c'_n(x; a)} c_n^B(x; a) = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') e^{x_1 A} (R_{a_1} \otimes \bar{R}'_{a_1}) e^{(x_2 - x_1) A} \dots (R_{a_n} \otimes \bar{R}'_{a_n}) e^{(L - x_n) A}]$. *Proof.* $\overline{\text{Tr } Y} = \text{Tr } \bar{Y}$ and $\overline{e^{yQ'}} = e^{y\bar{Q}'}$; $\text{Tr } X \text{Tr } Y = \text{Tr}(X \otimes Y)$; $(X_1 \otimes Y_1)(X_2 \otimes Y_2) = X_1 X_2 \otimes Y_1 Y_2$; and $e^{yQ} \otimes e^{y\bar{Q}'} = e^{yA}$ because $Q \otimes 1$ and $1 \otimes \bar{Q}'$ commute. $\square$
- $\langle 1 \rangle 4$. $\sum_a \eta_a^\epsilon$ of the matrix in $\langle 1 \rangle 3$ is $e^{x_1 A} C_\epsilon e^{(x_2 - x_1) A} \dots C_\epsilon e^{(L - x_n) A}$. *Proof.* $\eta_a^\epsilon = \prod_k \eta_{a_k}^\epsilon$, and the sum over each a_k acts on the k -th factor alone. $\square$
- $\langle 1 \rangle 5$. **QED.** Integrating $\langle 1 \rangle 4$ over $\Delta_n^<$ gives the Dyson term $I_n(L)$ of (A, C_ϵ) ; the trace is linear and continuous and the sum over n converges absolutely (Lemma 21.5), so $\langle 1 \rangle 2$ equals $\text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') \sum_n I_n(L)] = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') e^{L(A + C_\epsilon)}]$. This is (i) for $\epsilon = 0$ and (ii) for $\epsilon = 1$; (iii) is $\langle 1 \rangle 2$ with primed data equal to unprimed. $\square$

$\square$

So, with no structure at all, the parity expectation is $\langle (-1)^{\hat{F}} \rangle_B = \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}) e^{L\mathbb{T}_\eta}] / \text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}) e^{L\mathbb{T}}]$: the sign sits in the generator, every n -particle term is weighted by η_a , and $\mathbb{T}_\eta$ is in general not the generator of a positive semigroup. It is a trace, not a supertrace. The next section shows what a bond grading does to it.

22 Graded cMPS Rings: Supertrace and Superdeterminant

Throughout this section (Q, R) carry a bond grading P (Definition 8.2), $\mathbb{T}$, $\mathbb{T}_\eta$ and $\Gamma_b = P \otimes \bar{P}$ are as in Definition 8.3, and Ψ_B^c is the ring vector of length L with boundary matrix B .

Proposition 22.1 (With a bond grading the physical parity moves the boundary). *[sketched-conditional]*

(i) $\Gamma_b^2 = 1$ and $\Gamma_b \mathbb{T} = \mathbb{T} \Gamma_b$. (ii) $(P \otimes 1) \mathbb{T} (P \otimes 1) = \mathbb{T}_\eta = (1 \otimes \bar{P}) \mathbb{T} (1 \otimes \bar{P})$. (iii) $(-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_B^c = \Psi_{PBP}^c$ for every B . (iv) If $PB = BP$ then $(-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_B^c = \Psi_B^c$, and if $PB = -BP$ then $(-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_B^c = -\Psi_B^c$; in particular $\langle \Psi_B^c, (-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_B^c \rangle = \pm \|\Psi_B^c\|^2$ for $B \in \{1, P, \Pi_+, \Pi_-\}$ (sign +).

Proof. $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. (i): $\bar{P}^2 = \overline{P^2} = 1$. Conjugating term by term, $(P \otimes \bar{P})(Q \otimes 1)(P \otimes \bar{P}) = PQP \otimes 1 = Q \otimes 1$, likewise for $1 \otimes \bar{Q}$, and $(P \otimes \bar{P})(R_a \otimes \bar{R}_a)(P \otimes \bar{P}) = PR_a P \otimes \bar{P} R_a \bar{P} = \eta_a^2 R_a \otimes \bar{R}_a$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 2$. (ii): $(P \otimes 1)$ fixes $Q \otimes 1$ and $1 \otimes \bar{Q}$ and sends $R_a \otimes \bar{R}_a$ to $\eta_a R_a \otimes \bar{R}_a$; the same for $1 \otimes \bar{P}$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 3$. (iii): $c_n^{PBP}(x; a) = \eta_a c_n^B(x; a)$. *Proof.* By cyclicity $c_n^{PBP} = \text{Tr}[B P X P]$ with $X = e^{x_1 Q} R_{a_1} \cdots R_{a_n} e^{(L-x_n)Q}$. Insert $P^2 = 1$ between all factors: $P e^{yQ} P = e^{yPQP} = e^{yQ}$ and $PR_a P = \eta_a R_a$, so $PXP = \eta_a X$. Hence $\Psi_{PBP}^c = \sum_n \mathcal{J} \hat{\eta} c_n^B = (-1)^{\hat{F}} \sum_n \mathcal{J} c_n^B$ by Lemma 21.4 and continuity of $(-1)^{\hat{F}}$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 4$. (iv): $PB = \pm BP$ gives $PBP = \pm B$; apply $\langle 1 \rangle 3$. The four listed matrices commute with P . $\square$

As a consistency check, Theorem 21.6(ii) and (ii) above give $\text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B})e^{L\mathbb{T}}] = \text{Tr}[(PBP \otimes \bar{B})e^{L\mathbb{T}}] = \langle \Psi_B^c, \Psi_{PBP}^c \rangle$, the same statement as (iii). The direct answer to TJO's question is therefore: in a graded cMPS the expectation value of $(-1)^F$ is identically ± 1 for the natural boundaries and carries no spectral information.

Theorem 22.2 (The twisted ring norm is a supertrace). *[sketched-conditional]* (i) $\|\Psi_1^c\|^2 = \text{Tr} e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ and $\|\Psi_P^c\|^2 = \text{str} e^{L\mathbb{T}} = \text{Tr}(e^{L\mathbb{T}}|_{\text{even}}) - \text{Tr}(e^{L\mathbb{T}}|_{\text{odd}})$. (ii) $\langle \Psi_P^c, (-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_P^c \rangle = \text{str} e^{L\mathbb{T}} = \text{Tr}[\Gamma_b e^{L\mathbb{T}}]$ and $\langle \Psi_1^c, (-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_1^c \rangle = \text{Tr} e^{L\mathbb{T}}$. (iii) $\text{Tr}(e^{L\mathbb{T}}|_{\text{even}}) = \|\Psi_{\Pi_+}^c\|^2 + \|\Psi_{\Pi_-}^c\|^2$ and $\text{Tr}(e^{L\mathbb{T}}|_{\text{odd}}) = 2 \text{Re} \langle \Psi_{\Pi_-}^c, \Psi_{\Pi_+}^c \rangle$. (iv) $\text{str} e^{L\mathbb{T}} = \sum_n \sum_a \int_{\Delta_n^<} |\text{Tr}[P e^{x_1 Q} R_{a_1} \cdots R_{a_n} e^{(L-x_n)Q}]|^2 dx \geq 0$, with equality iff $\Psi_P^c = 0$.

Proof. $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. For M commuting with Γ_b and $E_\pm = \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \Gamma_b)$: $E_\pm$ are complementary idempotents commuting with M , so M is block diagonal for $\text{ran} E_+ \oplus \text{ran} E_-$, $\text{Tr}(E_\pm M) = \text{Tr}(M|_{\text{ran} E_\pm})$ and $\text{Tr}(\Gamma_b M) = \text{Tr}(E_+ M) - \text{Tr}(E_- M)$. $e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ commutes with Γ_b by Proposition 22.1(i). $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 2$. (i): Theorem 21.6(i) with $B = B' = 1$, and with $B = B' = P$, where $P \otimes \bar{P} = \Gamma_b$; then $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 3$. (ii): the first equality is Proposition 22.1(iv) and (i); the second is Theorem 21.6(ii) with $B = B' = P$; the untwisted case likewise. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 4$. (iii): expanding $\Pi_\pm = \frac{1}{2}(1 \pm P)$, $\Pi_+ \otimes \bar{\Pi}_+ + \Pi_- \otimes \bar{\Pi}_- = \frac{1}{2}(1 + \Gamma_b) = E_+$ and $\Pi_+ \otimes \bar{\Pi}_- + \Pi_- \otimes \bar{\Pi}_+ = E_-$. By Theorem 21.6(i), $\|\Psi_{\Pi_\pm}^c\|^2 = \text{Tr}[(\Pi_\pm \otimes \bar{\Pi}_\pm) e^{L\mathbb{T}}]$ and $\langle \Psi_{\Pi_+}^c, \Psi_{\Pi_-}^c \rangle = \text{Tr}[(\Pi_+ \otimes \bar{\Pi}_+) e^{L\mathbb{T}}]$; these two cross terms are complex conjugates. Add and use $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 5$. (iv): Theorem 21.6(iii) without signs for $B = P$, and (i). $\square$

Two elementary readings. First, the minus sign of the supertrace is the minus sign in $\Psi_P^c = \Psi_{\Pi_+}^c - \Psi_{\Pi_-}^c$: the odd sector of the doubled bond is the interference term between the two parity-sector closures, and positivity of the norm is automatic. Second, physical fermions are not needed to have an odd sector: if every species is bosonic and P commutes with Q and all R_a , the bond splits into two decoupled cMPS on the ± 1 eigenspaces and $\text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}} = \|\Psi_+ - \Psi_-\|^2$, the odd sector being their cross-transfer. Fermionic R_a are what couple the two blocks.

Proposition 22.3 (The twisted ring is the periodic fermion ring). *[sketched-conditional]* For every $t \in [0, L)$, $U_t \Psi_P^c = \Psi_P^c$ and $U_t^{\text{ap}} \Psi_1^c = \Psi_1^c$ (Definition 8.1).

Proof. **(1)1. Action on amplitudes.** For $(y; b) \in \Delta_n^< \times \mathfrak{S}^n$ let $w = \#\{k : y_k < t\}$ and define $(T_t c)(y; b) = \varepsilon_w(b) c(y_{w+1}-t, \dots, y_n-t, y_1-t+L, \dots, y_w-t+L; b_{w+1}, \dots, b_n, b_1, \dots, b_w)$ with $\varepsilon_w(b) = \prod_{k \leq w < l} \eta_{b_k b_l}$, and $T_t^{\text{ap}} = (-1)^{w_f} T_t$, w_f the number of fermionic $b_1, \dots, b_w$. These are unitary on $\mathcal{K}_n$, and $U_t \mathcal{J} = \mathcal{J} T_t$, $U_t^{\text{ap}} \mathcal{J} = \mathcal{J} T_t^{\text{ap}}$. *Proof.* On a grid having $L-t$ as a cell boundary, u_t maps cells to the cells of the shifted grid, the w cells beyond $L-t$ landing first; by (F5) $U_t e(i, a)$ is the ordered product with the last w creation operators moved to the front, which by (F1) costs exactly ε_w ; u_t^{ap} adds -1 per wrapped fermion. So the identities hold on box functions of such grids, which are dense (Lemma 21.4, steps (1)2 and (1)4, refining by the point $L-t$); both sides are bounded. $\square$

(1)2. Cyclic shift of the amplitude. With x the argument on the right of (1)1, split $X = e^{x_1 Q} R_{a_1} \dots e^{(L-x_n)Q}$ at the position $L-t$ as $X = X_1 X_2$, X_2 containing the last w factors R . Then $X_2 X_1 = e^{y_1 Q} R_{b_1} e^{(y_2-y_1)Q} \dots R_{b_n} e^{(L-y_n)Q}$, because $e^{(L-x_n)Q} e^{x_1 Q} = e^{(y_{w+1}-y_w)Q}$ and the end pieces become $e^{y_1 Q}$ and $e^{(L-y_n)Q}$. Hence $c_n^1(x; a) = c_n^1(y; b)$ and, moving X_2 past P with $P X_2 = \eta_{b_1} \dots \eta_{b_w} X_2 P$, $c_n^P(x; a) = (-1)^{w_f} c_n^P(y; b)$. $\square$

(1)3. Parity of nonzero amplitudes. If $\eta_b = -1$ then $c_n^1(y; b) = c_n^P(y; b) = 0$. *Proof.* $PXP = -X$ and $PB = BP$ give $\text{Tr}[BX] = \text{Tr}[PBXP] = -\text{Tr}[BX]$. $\square$

(1)4. QED. Let n_f be the (even, by (1)3) number of fermionic letters of b . Then $\varepsilon_w(b) = (-1)^{w_f(n_f-w_f)} = (-1)^{w_f}$. By (1)2, $T_t c_n^P = (-1)^{w_f} (-1)^{w_f} c_n^P = c_n^P$ and $T_t^{\text{ap}} c_n^1 = (-1)^{w_f} (-1)^{w_f} c_n^1 = c_n^1$. Apply (1)1 and sum over n . $\square$

$\square$

So $\|\Psi_P^c\|^2$ is the Ramond (periodic) ring norm and $\|\Psi_1^c\|^2$ the Neveu–Schwarz (antiperiodic) one: the supertrace of the transfer semigroup in the dilation direction is the ordinary norm of the physically periodic fermionic ring, the familiar exchange of a parity insertion in one direction with a boundary condition in the other.

Theorem 22.4 (Ring-length transforms: supertrace resolvent and superdeterminant). *[sketched-conditional]* Let $N_P(L) = \|\Psi_P^c\|^2$ and $N_1(L) = \|\Psi_1^c\|^2$ as functions of the ring length, the data (Q, R, P) fixed; let $m_{\pm}(\lambda)$ be the algebraic multiplicity of λ in $\mathbb{T}|_{\text{even}}$, $\mathbb{T}|_{\text{odd}}$, $\nu(\lambda) = m_+(\lambda) - m_-(\lambda)$, and $\omega = \max \text{Re spec } \mathbb{T}$. (i) $N_P(L) = \sum_{\lambda} \nu(\lambda) e^{\lambda L}$, and N_P determines ν . (ii) For $\text{Re } z > \omega$, $\int_0^{\infty} e^{-zL} N_P(L) dL = \text{str}(z - \mathbb{T})^{-1} = \frac{d}{dz} \log \text{sdet}(z - \mathbb{T}) = \sum_{\lambda} \frac{\nu(\lambda)}{z - \lambda}$. (iii) For $\text{Re } z, \text{Re } z_0 > \omega$,

$$\exp\left(-\int_0^{\infty} (e^{-zL} - e^{-z_0 L}) N_P(L) \frac{dL}{L}\right) = \frac{\text{sdet}(z - \mathbb{T})}{\text{sdet}(z_0 - \mathbb{T})}.$$

(iv) The same holds for N_1 with Tr , $\det$ and $m_+ + m_-$. Hence the ring zeta of the twisted rings is $1/\text{sdet}(z - \mathbb{T}) = \det(z - \mathbb{T}|_{\text{odd}})/\det(z - \mathbb{T}|_{\text{even}}) = \prod_{\lambda} (z - \lambda)^{-\nu(\lambda)}$: poles at net-even and zeros at net-odd eigenvalues.

Proof. $\langle 1 \rangle 1$. For $M \in M_k(\mathbb{C})$ with algebraic multiplicities m : $\text{Tr } e^{LM} = \sum m(\lambda) e^{\lambda L}$, $\text{Tr}(z - M)^{-1} = \sum m(\lambda)/(z - \lambda)$, $\det(z - M) = \prod (z - \lambda)^{m(\lambda)}$. *Proof.* Schur: $M = UTU^\dagger$ with T upper triangular carrying each eigenvalue $m(\lambda)$ times on the diagonal; e^{LT} and $(z - T)^{-1}$ are upper triangular with diagonals $e^{\lambda L}$ and $(z - \lambda)^{-1}$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 2$. (i): Theorem 22.2(i) and $\langle 1 \rangle 1$ on the invariant sectors (Proposition 22.1(i)). Distinct exponentials are linearly independent, so the coefficients $\nu(\lambda)$ are determined. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 3$. (ii): $\int_0^\infty e^{-(z-\lambda)L} dL = (z - \lambda)^{-1}$ for $\text{Re}(z - \lambda) > 0$; sum the finitely many terms and use $\langle 1 \rangle 1$ on each sector; $\text{sdet}(z - \mathbb{T}) = \prod (z - \lambda)^{\nu(\lambda)}$ has logarithmic derivative $\sum \nu(\lambda)/(z - \lambda)$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 4$. **Frullani.** For $\text{Re } \kappa_1, \text{Re } \kappa_2 > 0$, $\int_0^\infty (e^{-\kappa_1 L} - e^{-\kappa_2 L}) \frac{dL}{L} = \text{Log } \kappa_2 - \text{Log } \kappa_1$ (principal branch). *Proof.* $|e^{-\kappa_1 L} - e^{-\kappa_2 L}| \leq |\kappa_1 - \kappa_2| L$ for $L \geq 0$, so the integral converges and, by dominated differentiation on compact subsets of the right half plane, is holomorphic in κ_1 with derivative $-\int_0^\infty e^{-\kappa_1 L} dL = -1/\kappa_1$; it vanishes at $\kappa_1 = \kappa_2$, as does $\text{Log } \kappa_2 - \text{Log } \kappa_1$, which has the same derivative on the connected half plane. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 5$. (iii): by (i) and $\langle 1 \rangle 4$ with $\kappa_1 = z - \lambda$, $\kappa_2 = z_0 - \lambda$, the exponent equals $-\sum \nu(\lambda)[\text{Log}(z_0 - \lambda) - \text{Log}(z - \lambda)]$; exponentiating the integer multiples gives $\prod (z - \lambda)^{\nu(\lambda)} / \prod (z_0 - \lambda)^{\nu(\lambda)}$. $\square$

$\langle 1 \rangle 6$. (iv): identical, with $m_+ + m_-$ in place of ν ; the zeta statement is $\langle 1 \rangle 3$. $\square$

Numerical result 22.5 (Parity, overlap, supertrace and sdet against explicit Fock vectors). [numerical] `scripts/cms_parity_supertrace.py` (`outputs/cms_parity_supertrace.txt`, 89 checks). Lattice, exact at fixed spacing: 6 sites with one hard-core boson and two fermion species, Jordan–Wigner creation operators whose graded relations and parity action are checked first, bond $2 + 2$, random data. For ungraded data the Fock inner products $\langle \Psi' | \Psi \rangle$ and $\langle \Psi' | (-1)^{\hat{F}} | \Psi \rangle$ match $\text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') E^N]$ and $\text{Tr}[(B \otimes \bar{B}') E_\eta^N]$ to 10^{-10} , and $\langle (-1)^{\hat{F}} \rangle = +0.0107$ is nontrivial. For graded data: $(-1)^{\hat{F}} \Psi_B^c = \Psi_{PBP}^c$ as vectors, $\langle (-1)^{\hat{F}} \rangle = 1$ for $B = 1, P$, $\|\Psi_P^c\|^2 = \text{str } E^N$, the odd trace equals $2 \text{Re} \langle \Psi_{\Pi_-}^c, \Psi_{\Pi_+}^c \rangle$, Ψ_P^c has only even fermion number, and Ψ_P^c (Ψ_1^c) is invariant under the periodic (antiperiodic) lattice translation and not under the other. Continuum, bond $2 + 1$: the Dyson series against `expm`; lattice $\text{str } E^N \rightarrow \text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}}$ at first order; the Laplace transform of N_P equals $\text{str}(z - \mathbb{T})^{-1}$ to 10^{-8} and the Frullani exponential equals the sdet ratio (0.6002951682 both).

Observation 22.6 (What this does and does not give the Phantasm). [sketched-conditional] For a finite graded bond the HANDOFF reading “the ring norm is a supertrace, the ordinary norm of a fermionic ring with its parity insertion” is a theorem, with three sharpenings. (a) The sign is not the expectation value of the physical $(-1)^{\hat{F}}$, which is ± 1 (Proposition 22.1); it is the bond parity inserted in the closure, i.e. the periodic fermion boundary condition (Proposition 22.3). (b) The grading is $\Gamma_b = P \otimes \bar{P}$ on the doubled bond, whose odd sector is the block-off-diagonal operators: if zeros are to appear as the odd part of such a ring zeta, they are relaxation rates of $\mathbb{T}$ on coherences between the two parity blocks, which agrees with the vacuum-decay picture of observation 19.7; the supertrace over the bond itself in the graded realisation of Section 18 is a different operator and its relation to a $\mathbb{T}$ is not established. (c) Positivity $\text{str } e^{L\mathbb{T}} = \|\Psi_P^c\|^2 \geq 0$ is automatic, and the ring zeta is exactly $1/\text{sdet}$, consistent with the rigidity of Theorem 18.4. Not established: anything for an infinite-dimensional bond (trace class, regularisation of the Laplace transforms), and any identification of $\mathbb{T}$ with a Riemann Lindbladian.

23 The Phase-Side Lindbladian Guess: A Clean Negative and What Survived

Question (TJO, 2026-09-14, night). “Can we yolo guess the right Lindblad given the circumstantial info we have found in this project so far?” and then “dispatch two super smart codex astra xhighs to investigate this”. The orchestrator’s guess (Fable, discussion) and the two lanes’ briefs are in `notes/yolo-lindblad/astra-brief-A.md` (structure: prove or correct eight drafted statements S1–S8) and `astra-brief-B.md` (finite model, zero hunt); the reports are `astra-structure.md` (896 lines, correction ledger of 58 rows) and `astra-finite-model.md` (1351 checks, scripts under `notes/yolo-lindblad/finite/`). The orchestrator re-ran both suites (1351 and 492 checks) and re-derived the decisive facts in `scripts/phase_side_lindbladian.py`. Everything here is unreviewed by a second model family (both lanes are codex; the orchestrator is Claude), hence **sketched**.

Definition 23.1 (The phase-side guess). $\hat{\mathbb{Z}} = \prod_l \mathbb{Z}_l$ with Haar probability measure; $L^2(\hat{\mathbb{Z}})$ with the orthonormal Fourier basis $e_r(x) = e^{2\pi i r x}$, $r \in \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$; the vacuum $v = e_0$. Prime jump $(V_p f)(x) = \sqrt{p} f(x/p) 1_{p\hat{\mathbb{Z}}}(x)$; Galois unitaries $(U_a f)(x) = f(a^{-1}x)$, $a \in \hat{\mathbb{Z}}^\times$. Ramanujan sums $c_b = \sum_{a \in (\mathbb{Z}/b)^\times} e_{a/b}$, shells $|b\rangle = c_b / \sqrt{\phi(b)}$, $\mathcal{G} = \overline{\text{span}}\{|b\rangle\}$. Grading $\Pi = +1$ on $\mathbb{C}v$, -1 on $v^\perp$; $\Gamma_b = \Pi \otimes \bar{\Pi}$. The guess: jumps $R_p = \sqrt{\lambda_p} V_p \otimes T_{\log p}$ on $L^2(\hat{\mathbb{Z}}) \otimes L^2(\mathbb{R}_+^*)$ with $\lambda_p = 1/p$, a Gamma-factor ladder and a dilation Hamiltonian on the archimedean line, Galois dephasing at rate $\frac{1}{4}$ on vacuum-odd coherences; the physical cMPS along the archimedean coordinate with the primes as letters. Finite model: shells $b \leq B_{\max}$, primes $p \leq P$, $T = \sum_p \lambda_p (V_p \otimes \bar{V}_p - 1)$, $K(s) = \sum_p \lambda_p p^{-s} V_p \otimes \bar{V}_p$.

23.1 What holds

Proposition 23.2 (Prime jumps, Galois covariance, Ramanujan shells). *[sketched] (i) V_p is an isometry, $V_p^* e_r = p^{-1/2} e_{pr}$, $V_p e_r = p^{-1/2} \sum_{ps=r} e_s$ (p preimages), $V_p V_q = V_q V_p$, $V_p U_a = U_a V_p$; on $\hat{\mathbb{Z}} = \prod \mathbb{Z}_l$ multiplication by p is a unit at every $l \neq p$ and the valuation shift at p ; on a level b coprime to p , $\sqrt{p} V_p^*$ restricted to that level is the Shor permutation $r \mapsto pr$, while V_p itself leaves the level. (ii) $\mathcal{G}$ is the Galois-trivial sector and reduces every V_p, V_p^* , with $V_p |b\rangle = p^{-1/2}(|b\rangle + \sqrt{p-1} |pb\rangle)$ for $p \nmid b$, $V_p |b\rangle = |pb\rangle$ for $p \mid b$, $V_p^* |b\rangle = p^{-1/2} |b\rangle$ for $p \nmid b$, $V_p^* |b\rangle = \sqrt{\phi(b)/(p\phi(b/p))} |b/p\rangle$ for $p \mid b$; in particular $V_p v = p^{-1/2}(v + \sqrt{p-1} |p\rangle)$, the vacuum is not invariant. (iii) For a Gauss vector $g_\chi = \sum_a \chi(a) e_{a/b}$ and $p \nmid b$: $V_p^* g_\chi = p^{-1/2} \bar{\chi}(p) g_\chi$; for $p \mid b$ the image is zero or a lower-level Gauss vector. (iv) $\langle c_b \rangle_\beta = \sum_{d|b} \text{Möb}(b/d) d^{1-\beta} = b^{1-\beta} \prod_{p|b} (1 - p^{\beta-1}) \rightarrow 0$ as $\beta \rightarrow 1^+$ iff $b > 1$; the Haar state is the vector state of v but is mixed on $C(\hat{\mathbb{Z}})$.*

Proof. Lane A §1–§4 (PROVED rows of the ledger), verified on $L^2(\mathbb{Z}/N)$, $N = 360$, by lane B and by `scripts/phase_side_lindbladian.py` §1. $\square$

Proposition 23.3 (An exact reciprocal-zeta matrix element, and the actual generating functions).

[sketched] (i) For $\text{Re } w > 1$, $\mathcal{A}(w) = \sum_n n^{-w} V_n = \prod_p (1 - p^{-w} V_p)^{-1}$ converges in operator norm, $\mathcal{A}(w)^{-1} = \sum_n \text{Möb}(n) n^{-w} V_n$, and $\langle v, \mathcal{A}(w)^{-1} v \rangle = 1/\zeta(w + \frac{1}{2})$, $\langle v, \mathcal{A}(w) v \rangle = \zeta(w + \frac{1}{2})$: an exact operator statement derived from the jumps, with zeta in the denominator, but of a specified sum over one copy of each integer, not a resolvent of the generator. (ii) The finite-cutoff objects are instead exact and shifted: the ordered vacuum resolvent is $\langle 1, 1 | (1 - K(s))^{-1} | 1, 1 \rangle = 1/(1 - \sum_{p \leq P} p^{-(s+\beta+1)})$, the multiset version is $\zeta_P(s + \beta + 1)$, the vacuum-to-shell overlaps are $\sqrt{\phi(b)} b^{-(s+\beta+1)} \zeta_P(s + \beta + 1)$ (zeta in the numerator), and the continuous-time resolvent is $1/(z + \sum_{p \leq P} \lambda_p - \sum_p \lambda_p p^{-s-1})$; word

sums retain the multinomial multiplicities $(\sum_p k_p)! / \prod_p k_p!$ despite commutation, and neither the shell stay term nor the parity closure divides them out. (iii) On $\text{Re } s \in [0.3, 1.2]$ at $\beta \geq 1$ these have no pole at any finite cutoff, uniformly in P (the diagonal of K is bounded by $\sum_{n \geq 2} n^{-2.3} < 1$); no tested shell overlap has a zero there. The zeros of ζ appear only through the meromorphic continuation of the scalar $\zeta(s + \beta + 1)$, at $s = \rho - \beta - 1$.

Proof. Lane A (5.7)–(5.14); lane B §N4 (formulas checked against sparse doubled solves to $2 \cdot 10^{-16}$, argument-principle windings zero at two refinements, pole bound analytic); orchestrator script §3–§4. $\square$

Proposition 23.4 (Galois dephasing, symmetric and asymmetric rates). *[sketched]* For a finite abelian group of character-diagonal unitaries with rates λ_a , the dissipator acts on $|\chi\rangle\langle\chi'|$ as the scalar $\sum_a \lambda_a \chi(a) \bar{\chi}'(a) - \sum_a \lambda_a$: zero for $\chi = \chi'$; for uniform rates $-\gamma$ on every cross-character coherence, real; for rates symmetric under $a \mapsto a^{-1}$ real; for asymmetric rates it acquires an imaginary part, a frequency. Verified on $L^2(\mathbb{Z}/120)$ with all $770 + 13630$ coherences (lane B) and on $(\mathbb{Z}/5)^\times$ (orchestrator).

Proof. Orthogonality of characters; the imaginary part is $\sum_a \lambda_a \text{Im}(\chi \bar{\chi}')(a)$ for $\chi \bar{\chi}'$, which vanishes iff the odd part of λ under inversion pairs to zero. $\square$

23.2 What fails

Proposition 23.5 (The grading is not preserved and the coherences are not modes). *[sketched]* $\mathcal{L}_{\{p\}}(|v\rangle\langle v|) = \lambda_p[-\frac{p-1}{p}|1\rangle\langle 1| + \frac{p-1}{p}|p\rangle\langle p| + \frac{\sqrt{p-1}}{p}(|1\rangle\langle p| + |p\rangle\langle 1|)]$: a Γ_b -even input acquires odd terms, so $[\mathcal{L}, \Gamma_b] \neq 0$ for every nonempty positive-rate prime set, and no restriction to “the even-odd coherences” is defined. The vacuum-character coherence $|v\rangle\langle g_\chi|$ is not an eigenoperator (explicit modulo-3, prime-2 counterexample; Hilbert–Schmidt residual 0.61 at $P = 47$); its projection back onto itself has coefficient $\sum_p p^{-\beta}(\bar{\chi}(p)/p-1)$, with an extra $1/p$ against the drafted $\sum_p p^{-\beta}(\bar{\chi}(p)-1)$. Vacuum coherences leak out of the odd block and retain the conserved lower bound $\|e^{t\mathcal{L}}|1\rangle\langle b|\|_1 \geq \sqrt{\phi(b)/b}$.

Proof. Lane A (2.4), §3.2, (8.13)–(8.17); lane B §N2, N5; orchestrator script §2. $\square$

Proposition 23.6 (No Gibbs fixed point, no normal critical semigroup, no ring trace). *[sketched]* (i) With forward jumps V_p at rate λ_p and reverse jumps V_p^* at rate $\lambda_p p^{-\beta}$, the shell weights $b^{-\beta}$ are not stationary: exact counterexample on shells $\{1, 2\}$, $\beta = 2$, $\lambda_2 = \frac{1}{2}$, $\mathcal{L}(\text{diag}(\frac{4}{5}, \frac{1}{5})) = \begin{pmatrix} -3/16 & 27/160 \\ 27/160 & 3/16 \end{pmatrix}$; population balance needs the ratio down/up $= p^\beta$, and even then the vacuum stay term creates coherences. Resolving each edge into its own jump $|pb\rangle\langle b|$ restores a Gibbs fixed point but changes the model. (ii) At $\lambda_p = 1/p$ the no-jump quadratic form $\sum R_p^* R_p = (\sum 1/p) 1$ is infinite; the finite-prime semigroups applied to $|v\rangle\langle v|$ have no trace-norm limit at any positive time (vacuum survival $\exp[-t \sum_{p \leq P} (1 - 1/p)/p] \rightarrow 0$, every shell diagonal $\rightarrow 0$). (iii) Even at a finite prime cutoff the doubled-bond exponential is invertible, hence not compact, so $\text{Tr}[\Gamma_b e^{t\mathcal{L}}]$ is not an ordinary trace: a prime cutoff is not a bond cutoff. (iv) A single forward prime has Hilbert–Schmidt spectrum the full disc $\lambda_p(z - 1)$, $|z| \leq 1$, not isolated real modes.

Proof. Lane A §0.1, §5.4–5.6, §8.1–8.3; lane B §N6 (SymPy rationals) and truncation table; orchestrator script §5. $\square$

Proposition 23.7 (A parity closure is not a quotient by $\mathbb{Q}^\times$). *[sketched]* Multiplication by $q \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$ is unitary on $L^2(\mathbb{A}_\mathbb{Q})$ by the product formula $|q|_\mathbb{A} = 1$ and acts as the identity on functions

of classes in $\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{Q}}/\mathbb{Q}^{\times}$; the periods $\log p$ arise from the stabiliser of $x^{(p)}$ and the norm-kernel quotient $\mathbb{R}_+/p^{\mathbb{Z}}$. Closing a ring with Π changes the boundary functional $\text{Tr } A_w \mapsto \text{Tr}(\Pi A_w)$ and imposes nothing of this: with $W_p = \text{diag}(1, e^{i\vartheta})$ and $\Pi = \text{diag}(1, -1)$ the parity-closed norm of the word W_p is $|1 - e^{i\vartheta}|^2$ while that of the identity is 0. The identification of the guess's ring norm with an adelic periodic-orbit trace needs a quotient, an intertwiner and a regularised trace, none of which the guess supplies; Connes' 1999 paper proves local and finite-place cutoff trace formulas and does not supply them either.

Proof. Lane A §6.1–6.5 (source scope of Connes verified from the arXiv PDF by the lane); orchestrator script §6. □

Observation 23.8 (Verdict on the guess, and the orchestrator's corrections). [sketched] The phase-side prime jumps reproduce side A: their vacuum generating functions are the Euler product, shifted, and nothing else; the reciprocal zeta of the Ramanujan sums is an arithmetic evaluation, not a dynamical overlap (the overlaps are positive divisor sums with zeta in the numerator). The guess supplies neither the pole at 1 nor the critical-line modes, and its three structural premises fail: the grading is not invariant, the rates $1/p$ define no normal semigroup, the parity closure is not the rational quotient. What survives is the exact kinematics (Proposition 23.2), the inverse multiset element $1/\zeta(w + \frac{1}{2})$, and uniform Galois dephasing. Two claims of Section 12 are corrected: Galois-diagonal jumps produce no frequency only for inversion-symmetric rates (Proposition 23.4); and “fermionic primes give zeros on $\text{Re } s = 0$ ” is a statement about each finite factor $1 - p^{-s}$, not about the continued product $1/\zeta$, whose poles inside the strip are exactly the zeros of ζ with their orders. The open item 0b' (identify K_S with a Bost–Connes bond) is unchanged; the negative rules out the Ramanujan-sum sector with prime jumps alone as that identification.

Numerical result 23.9 (Two lanes, three suites). [numerical] Lane B: 1351 checks (`notes/yolo-lindblad/finite/run_all.py`, seed 20260914, re-run by the orchestrator: all pass); lane A: 492 exact finite checks (`structure_checks.py`, re-run: pass); orchestrator: `scripts/phase_side_lindbladian.py` (`outputs/phase_side_lindbladian.txt`), 30 checks: shell formulas from $L^2(\mathbb{Z}/360)$, the Shor permutation at level 15, the odd part of $\mathcal{L}_p(|v\rangle\langle v|)$, the shifted vacuum generating functions at three complex s against sparse doubled solves, the pole bound, $1/\zeta_P(w + \frac{1}{2})$, the exact 2×2 Gibbs counterexample, the parity-closure counterexample, and the symmetric/asymmetric Galois rates.

24 The Phantasm IV: a Rebound State Inside the Model Space

Question (TJO, 2026-09-19, chosen from the ideation ledger). Conjecture 47.3 asks for one graded Lindbladian with a mixed stationary state of prescribed entanglement spectrum and the zeros as odd relaxation modes. The vacuum-decay Lindbladian has the zeros and a pure absorbing stationary state (Proposition 19.8). The Siemon–Holevo–Werner picture [80] says that a standard generator with a given no-event semigroup is fixed by one rebound state. What happens when the rebound state lives *inside* the model space? One codex `gpt-6-astra` prover lane (`notes/rebound-state/astra-proofs.md`, brief `astra-brief.md`, 32-row correction ledger), one Opus numerics lane run blind from the brief (`numerics.md`, `scripts/rebound_state.py`, 150 checks), one Opus refutation review (`notes/reviews/rebound-st`, Worklog 2026-09-19).

24.1 Conventions, and the sign of the modes

Work in the upper half plane: $\Theta(\tau) = S(-\tau) = \xi(1 + 2i\tau)/\xi(1 - 2i\tau)$ is inner in $\mathbb{C}_+$ with zeros $w_\rho = \gamma/2 + i(1 - \sigma)/2$, one per nontrivial zero $\rho = \sigma + i\gamma$, all on $\text{Im } w = \frac{1}{4}$ iff RH. The model space is $K_S = H^2(\mathbb{C}_+) \ominus \Theta H^2$, the compressed semigroup $Z(t) = P_{K_S} e^{it\tau}|_{K_S}$, and the *no-event semigroup* of this section is $C_t = Z(t)^*$, so that the Riemann channel of Definition 4.3 is $\mathbf{s} \mapsto C_t \mathbf{s} C_t^*$. Under the Paley–Wiener map $F: H^2 \rightarrow L^2(0, \infty)$ the semigroup C_t is the backward translation $g(x) \mapsto g(x + t)$ restricted to the invariant subspace FK_S , and $Fk_w = -i\sqrt{2\pi} e^{-i\bar{w}x}$ for the kernel $k_w(\tau) = (\tau - \bar{w})^{-1}$. Densities are written $\mathbf{s}$ (never ρ , which is a zero), the rebound density Ω , the exit functional j , the generator $C_t = e^{tB^*}$.

Observation 24.1 (The sign in Proposition 17.2). [proved] With Θ inner in $\mathbb{C}_+$ and $\Theta(w) = 0$, $k_w \in K_S$ and $C_t k_w = e^{-it\bar{w}} k_w$, of modulus $e^{-t \text{Im } w}$: decay at rate $(1 - \sigma)/2$, which is $\frac{1}{4}$ for every mode iff RH. The statement printed in Proposition 17.2, with the kernel in the lower half plane and eigenvalue $e^{-it\bar{\lambda}}$, has modulus $e^{+t \text{Im } \lambda}$ and is growth; the corrected form, with $Z(t)k_\lambda = e^{it\bar{\lambda}} k_\lambda$ in the lower-half-plane picture, is equivalent to the one here; the kernels are eigenvectors of the *adjoint* of the compression, which is where the sign was lost. The conclusion of Proposition 17.2 (RH iff one rate) is unaffected.

Lemma 24.2 (The exit is the cusp, one-dimensional, and no zero mode is dark). [proved]
On the domain $D(B^) = K_S \cap H^1$ the exit form of [80] is $-(\langle B^* \mathbf{v}, \phi \rangle + \langle \mathbf{v}, B^* \phi \rangle) = \overline{j\mathbf{v}} j\phi$ with $j\mathbf{v} = (F\mathbf{v})(0)$: the exit space is $\mathbb{C}$, and $J\mathbf{v}(t) = jC_t \mathbf{v}$ is an isometry $K_S \rightarrow L^2(\mathbb{R}_+)$, the outgoing translation representation. $C_t \rightarrow 0$ strongly, and $j k_w = -i\sqrt{2\pi} \neq 0$ for every zero: no mode is decoupled from the exit. Nothing here needs uniform exponential stability; the unreviewed claim $\|C_t\| = 1$ is neither used nor contradicted.*

24.2 The renewal channel

Definition 24.3 (Renewal generator with a rebound inside the model space; admissible densities). For a density Ω on K_S , the *renewal generator* is $\mathcal{L}_\Omega(\mathbf{s}) = B^* \mathbf{s} + \mathbf{s} B + \text{fl}(\mathbf{s}) \Omega$, $\text{fl}(\mathbf{s}) = \text{Tr}(|j\rangle\langle j| \mathbf{s})$ read as the exit flux, with the minimal semigroup of [80] (reinsertion map $\mathbf{s} \mapsto \text{Tr}(\mathbf{s}) \Omega$, jump operators $\Omega^{1/2}$ -columns times j). The *holding-time law* is $m_\Omega(t) = -\frac{d}{dt} \text{Tr}(C_t \Omega C_t^*)$, its Laplace transform $\hat{m}_\Omega$, its mean $\bar{t}_\Omega = \int_0^\infty \text{Tr}(C_t \Omega C_t^*) dt$. The *graded renewal generator* is the same construction on $\mathbb{C}\text{vac} \oplus K_S$ (vac even, K_S odd) with the exit from K_S reinserted at a density $\tilde{\Omega}$ on the whole space; $\tilde{\Omega} = \Omega_{\text{vac}}$ is the vacuum-decay Lindbladian of Definition 5.4. A density $\mathbf{s}$ on K_S is *admissible* if $\mathbf{s} \in D(\mathcal{L}_0)$, $\mathcal{L}_0(\mathbf{s}) = B^* \mathbf{s} + \mathbf{s} B$, and the *loss* $Q_\mathbf{s} = -\mathcal{L}_0(\mathbf{s})$ is a positive trace-class operator.

Theorem 24.4 (Conservativity, stationary state, renewal theorem). *[proved] (i) For every density Ω on K_S the minimal semigroup of $\mathcal{L}_\Omega$ is trace preserving, with $D(\mathcal{L}_\Omega) = D(\mathcal{L}_0)$ and holding times i.i.d. with law m_Ω , a probability density on $(0, \infty)$; the renewal process does not explode. (ii) There is a stationary density iff $\bar{t}_\Omega < \infty$, and then it is unique, $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \bar{t}_\Omega^{-1} \int_0^\infty C_t \Omega C_t^* dt$, every initial density converges to it in trace norm, and it is mixed whenever Ω is. (iii) If Ω is supported on the span of finitely many modes k_{w_n} then $\bar{t}_\Omega < \infty$, and for $\Omega = \sum_n p_n |e_n\rangle\langle e_n|$ with normalised modes e_n one has $\bar{t} = \sum_n p_n / (2 \operatorname{Im} w_n)$ and $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \bar{t}^{-1} \sum_n p_n (2 \operatorname{Im} w_n)^{-1} |e_n\rangle\langle e_n|$; for a general finitely supported Ω the integral is the entrywise (Schur) product of the coefficient matrix of Ω with the Cauchy matrix $i/(w_n - \bar{w}_m)$.*

Assumption 24.5 (Zero symmetry and zero count). *[assumed] The multiset of nontrivial zeros is invariant, with multiplicity, under $\rho \mapsto 1 - \bar{\rho}$ and under conjugation, and the number of zeros with $0 < \gamma \leq T$ satisfies $N_+(T)/T \rightarrow \infty$ (a weak form of the Riemann–von Mangoldt count). Standard; no local source.*

Proposition 24.6 (A rebound of infinite mean exists). *[proved-conditional] For normalised Takenaka–Malmquist vectors f_N built from a list $z_1, \dots, z_N$ of zeros of Θ the mean holding time is $\int_0^\infty t |F f_N(t)|^2 dt = (2 \operatorname{Im} z_N)^{-1} + \sum_{k < N} 2(\operatorname{Im} z_N + \operatorname{Im} z_k) / ((\operatorname{Re} z_N - \operatorname{Re} z_k)^2 + (\operatorname{Im} z_N + \operatorname{Im} z_k)^2)$. Under assumption 24.5 there are zero lists of arbitrary length in a real interval of length one inside $\frac{1}{4} \leq \operatorname{Im} z < \frac{1}{2}$, each summand is then at least $\frac{1}{2}$, and $\Omega_\infty = \sum_r 2^{-r} |f_r\rangle\langle f_r|$ with lists of length $N_r \geq 2 \cdot 4^r + 1$ is a density on K_S with $\bar{t}_{\Omega_\infty} = \infty$: no stationary density. This holds with or without RH. The vacuum of Proposition 19.8 is not this case: its holding law is defective (an atom at infinity) and its no-event semigroup is not strongly stable, so it is an absorbing boundary case, not a recurrent rebound of infinite mean.*

24.3 The graded space: the zeros are protected, the vacuum is not unique

Proposition 24.7 (Odd coherences carry the zeros for every rebound). *[proved] On $\mathbb{C}\text{vac} \oplus K_S$, for every density $\tilde{\Omega}$ (even or not), the odd operators $|k_w\rangle\langle \text{vac}|$ and $|\text{vac}\rangle\langle k_w|$ are eigen-operators of the graded renewal generator with eigenvalues $-i\bar{w}$ and iw (decay rate $\operatorname{Im} w$, so $\frac{1}{4}$ under RH), because the exit flux vanishes on every odd operator; with multiplicity, repeated zeros give derivative-kernel chains. The generator preserves parity iff $\tilde{\Omega}$ is even; an odd component of $\tilde{\Omega}$ feeds odd outputs from even inputs but leaves odd inputs autonomous.*

Proposition 24.8 (Stationary states on the graded space). *[proved] The vacuum is stationary for every rebound. If $\tilde{\Omega} = 0 \oplus \Omega$ with $\bar{t}_\Omega < \infty$ the stationary densities are exactly the segment $q\Omega_{\text{vac}} + (1 - q)(0 \oplus \mathbf{s}_\infty)$, $0 \leq q \leq 1$, the vacuum mass being conserved; if $\bar{t}_\Omega = \infty$ only the vacuum is stationary, and states on K_S do not converge to it. If $\tilde{\Omega}$ has vacuum weight $q > 0$ the vacuum is the unique stationary density and attracts every state. So a unique mixed stationary state on the graded space needs an exit from the vacuum as well; the uncoupled even line of Definition 5.4 is not the last word.*

24.4 The even sector: persistence and the secular equation

Proposition 24.9 (Rank-one perturbation, persistence, secular roots). *[proved] $\mathcal{L}_\Omega = \mathcal{L}_0 + |\Omega\rangle\langle \mathbf{f}|$ is a rank-one perturbation. On the span of finitely many modes, with the biorthogonal system of $\mathcal{L}_0$ whose eigen-operators $|e_n\rangle\langle e_m|$ have eigenvalues $-i\bar{w}_n + iw_m$ (rate $\operatorname{Im} w_n + \operatorname{Im} w_m$): a simple eigenvalue persists iff $\mathbf{f}(X) \operatorname{dual}_X(\Omega) = 0$, where dual_X is the dual functional (the eigen-operator itself persists iff $\mathbf{f}(X) = 0$, which never happens for the mode operators since $\mathbf{f}(|e_n\rangle\langle e_m|) \neq 0$;*

collisions of pair eigenvalues occur even for simple zeros and are handled by multiplicities), and every other eigenvalue is a root of $1 = \hat{m}_\Omega(z)$, with $\det(z - \mathcal{L}_\Omega) = \det(z - \mathcal{L}_0)(1 - \hat{m}_\Omega(z))$ on the finite restriction. Explicitly $\hat{m}_\Omega(z) = \sum_{n,m} \Omega_{nm} G_{mn} (-i\bar{w}_n + iw_m)^{-1} \dots$ in the Gram matrix $G_{nm} = i/(w_n - \bar{w}_m)$; the shape $1 = \sum_{n,m} c_{nm}/(z + i\bar{w}_n - iw_m)$ is that of a Connes–Consani–Moscovici secular equation, but only the universal rank-one determinant identity is established, no identification.

Proposition 24.10 (Mode-diagonal rebounds: a renewal reformulation of RH; the Gram spectrum).

[proved-conditional] (i) For a family

of distinct zeros, $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \Omega$ for every finitely supported mode-diagonal Ω on the family iff all widths $\text{Im } w_n$ in the family coincide; with the quantifier over all zeros and assumption 24.5 the common width must be $\frac{1}{4}$, so RH iff the stationary state equals the rebound for every finite modal mixture. A singleton gives no test; this is a renewal-channel form of the equal-rate criterion of Proposition 17.2, not a new mechanism. (ii) Under RH every mode-diagonal Ω has $\bar{t}_\Omega = 2$, the secular function is $\hat{m}(z) = \frac{1}{2}/(z + \frac{1}{2})$ for every weight vector, the only new eigenvalue is 0, every other even eigenvalue has real part exactly $-\frac{1}{2}$, and $-\frac{1}{2}$ keeps multiplicity $N - 1$. (iii) The density spectrum of $\mathbf{s}_\infty$ is not the weight list $\{p_n(2 \text{Im } w_n)^{-1}/\bar{t}\}$: distinct modes are never orthogonal, $G_{nm} \neq 0$, and the spectrum is that of $G^{1/2} \text{diag}(p_n(2 \text{Im } w_n)^{-1}/(\bar{t}G_{nn}))G^{1/2}$; for $N = 2$ it is $\frac{1}{2}(1 \pm \sqrt{(p_1 - p_2)^2 + 4p_1p_2|o|^2})$ with o the normalised overlap. Under RH the spectrum of $\mathbf{s}_\infty$ equals that of Ω , not $\{p_n\}$.

24.5 The inverse problem: every finite spectrum, and the Gibbs spectra

Theorem 24.11 (Admissible densities are exactly the stationary states). [proved] A density $\mathbf{s}$ on K_S is the stationary state of $\mathcal{L}_\Omega$ for some density Ω iff it is admissible (Definition 24.3); then the flux $\mathfrak{f}(\mathbf{s}) = \text{Tr } Q_\mathbf{s}$ is finite and strictly positive and the rebound is unique, $\Omega = Q_\mathbf{s}/\text{Tr } Q_\mathbf{s}$. Equivalently $\mathbf{s}$ lies in the cone of orbit states $\int_0^\infty |C_t \mathbf{v}\rangle \langle C_t \mathbf{v}| dt$ with convergent input flux. On the span of finitely many modes, with $\mathbf{s} = \sum \mathbf{s}_{nm} |e_n\rangle \langle e_m|$, admissibility is the Schur-product condition $(\mathbf{s}_{nm}(a_n + \bar{a}_m))_{nm} \geq 0$ with $a_n = i\bar{w}_n$, a rank-two indefinite factor for distinct pairs; under RH $a_n + \bar{a}_m = \frac{1}{2} + i(\gamma_n - \gamma_m)/2$. Mode-diagonal densities are admissible; a density commuting with the Hamiltonian part of B with non-degenerate spectrum never is; Gibbs-like spectra on Haar-random eigenvectors fail positivity in every trial of numerical result 24.15.

Theorem 24.12 (Invariant flags realise every finite density spectrum, for any one-exit no-event semigroup).

[proved] Let $C_t = e^{tB^*}$ be any strongly stable one-exit no-event semigroup, $-(B^* + B) = |j\rangle \langle j|$ as forms, and $V_1 \subset \dots \subset V_N$ a flag spanned by generator eigenvectors, P_k its projections, $u_1, \dots, u_N$ the Gram–Schmidt basis of the flag. Then $Q_k = -(B^* P_k + P_k B) = j_k^* j_k \geq 0$, and for any $p_1 \geq \dots \geq p_N > 0$ with $\sum p_i = 1$, $\mathbf{s} = \sum_i p_i |u_i\rangle \langle u_i| = \sum_k (p_k - p_{k+1}) P_k$ has loss $Q_\mathbf{s} = \sum_k (p_k - p_{k+1}) Q_k \geq 0$: admissible with exactly the prescribed spectrum, rebound $Q_\mathbf{s}/\text{Tr } Q_\mathbf{s}$. Nothing about ζ is used (the reviewer’s point M1: this is a statement about one-exit semigroups, verified for generic and off-line modes). For the Riemann channel with distinct zero modes, $\text{Tr } Q_k = 2 \sum_{n \leq k} \text{Im } w_n$ and the rebound is $Q_\mathbf{s}/(2 \sum_n p_n \text{Im } w_n)$; no RH and no orthogonality of the modes is used. The rebound need not be mixed: for the flat density P_N/N it is the pure state $Q_N/\text{Tr } Q_N$, because the exit is one-dimensional.

Proposition 24.13 (Gibbs spectra for $\beta > 1$ from an infinite flag). [proved] For an isometry $U: \ell^2(\mathbb{N}) \rightarrow K_S$ the density $U \varrho_\beta^G U^*$ is admissible iff it lies in $D(\mathcal{L}_0)$ with $-\mathcal{L}_0(U \varrho_\beta^G U^*) \geq 0$. Taking $U e_n = u_n$ along an infinite flag of distinct modes, for every decreasing probability sequence (d_n) the sums $\mathbf{s} = \sum_k (d_k - d_{k+1}) P_k$ and $Q = \sum_k (d_k - d_{k+1}) Q_k$ converge in trace norm, $\text{Tr } Q = 2 \sum_n d_n \text{Im } w_n \in (0, 1)$, and $\mathbf{s}$ is admissible with spectrum (d_n) ; for $d_n = n^{-\beta}/\zeta(\beta)$ this is the

Gibbs entanglement spectrum of observation 19.17. Under RH every such flag has $\text{Tr } Q = \frac{1}{2}$ and $\bar{t}_\Omega = 2$ for every $\beta > 1$. At $\beta = 1$ the candidate is not trace class (Proposition 19.10): the critical obstruction is trace normalisation, not a diverging holding time and not a failure of positivity. Open: a distinguished U carrying the Bost–Connes observables, the prime action and detailed balance.

Observation 24.14 (What this buys for conjecture 47.3, and what it does not). [sketched]

Rebounding inside K_S gives a conservative renewal Lindbladian with a unique, attracting, mixed stationary density of any prescribed finite spectrum, or of the Gibbs spectrum for $\beta > 1$, while the odd coherences of the graded extension keep the zeros as relaxation modes once each plus conjugates. So the literal clause of observation 19.17, “no construction in this book has both”, is no longer true as a purely spectral statement; a direct sum of the vacuum-decay and prime-chain generators would already falsify it trivially (reviewer’s point M2), and the content here is that the mixed density lives on K_S itself, fed by the same cusp flux that carries the zeros, with rebound $Q/\text{Tr } Q$. What is not supplied: any arithmetic reason for Ω (the spectrum is put in by hand through a freely chosen flag), the identification of K_S with the Bost–Connes bond, a critical ($\beta = 1$) non-normal state, and a unique mixed stationary state on the graded space, which needs an exit from the vacuum. The even sector’s non-stationary spectrum is pair differences with new secular roots, not zeros.

Numerical result 24.15 (Finite Gram model of the renewal channel). [numerical]
`scripts/rebound_state.py`, 150 checks, blind to the prover. Gram constant $G_{nm} = i/(w_n - \bar{w}_m)$ for the $(2\pi)^{-1}dx$ inner product (quadrature to $8 \cdot 10^{-6}$); exit $j = -i\mathbf{1}^\top$ in the mode basis with $-(D^*G + GD) = \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top$ exactly and $\langle j, k_n \rangle = -i$ for every mode. Trace preservation, CPTP of $e^{t\mathcal{L}_\Omega}$, and $\int m_\Omega = 1$ for eight (model, Ω) pairs; $\mathbf{s}_\infty$ by four routes to 10^{-14} ; under RH $\bar{t} = 2$ for every mode-diagonal Ω ; odd coherences exact eigen-operators to 10^{-14} for every $\tilde{\Omega}$, Ω_{vac} reproducing Theorem 19.4 to $2 \cdot 10^{-14}$, and $\dim \ker = 2$ on the graded space for internal rebounds; the determinant identity to $5 \cdot 10^{-14}$; $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \Omega$ on-line to 10^{-15} and $\|\mathbf{s}_\infty - \Omega\|_1 \in [0.11, 0.15]$ off-line; the weight list is not the spectrum (on-line, $N = 5$, $p = (.40, .30, .15, .10, .05)$: spectrum $(.4256, .2957, .1441, .0973, .0374)$, discrepancy 6.4%) while the Gram formula holds to 10^{-15} ; admissibility cone equals the orbit cone; Gibbs-like spectra on Haar-random eigenvectors fail positivity 400/400 at $\beta = 1.5, 2$; the necessary bound $|H_{ab}| \geq \frac{1}{2}|j_a||j_b||\sqrt{\lambda_a} - \sqrt{\lambda_b}|/(\sqrt{\lambda_a} + \sqrt{\lambda_b})$ and the corollary that a density commuting with H with non-degenerate spectrum is never admissible. Two prose claims of the numerics report are superseded by the review: the vacuum is not the $\text{Im } w \rightarrow 0$ end of the mean, and the persistence criterion in the form “ $\Omega_{nm} = 0$ ” holds only at simple eigenvalues.

25 The Phantasm V: a Finite Graph with a Cusp I. Scattering and the One-Exit Contraction

Question (TJO, 2026-09-20). Section 24 showed that any one-exit no-event semigroup admits a conservative renewal completion, with the zeros protected as odd modes; the reviewer's verdict was that nothing about ζ is used and the zeros are put in by hand. The simplest object where the arithmetic supplies the exit is a finite graph with a cusp: an infinite ray attached with the weights of the quotient of the $(q+1)$ -regular tree by a cusp stabiliser. This shard sets the toy up with a general finite core and no arithmetic. One codex `gpt-6-astra` prover lane (`notes/cusp-graph/astra-proofs.md`, brief `astra-brief.md`, 34-row correction ledger), one Opus numerics lane blind from the brief (`numerics.md`, `scripts/cusp_graph.py`, 569 checks, 19-row ledger), two literature lanes (`sources.md`, `childs-lead.md`), one Opus refutation review (`notes/reviews/cusp-graph-2026-09-20.md`). Worklog 2026-09-20.

25.1 The diagram, its normalisation, and the spectral parameter

Definition 25.1 (Finite core with one cusp; resonances, bound states, cusp forms, thresholds). A *core* is a real symmetric $n \times n$ matrix T_X (a weighted finite graph, loops allowed) with a distinguished vertex v_0 , $P_0 = |v_0\rangle\langle v_0|$, and a coupling $c > 0$. The *diagram* Y is the bounded self-adjoint operator on $\mathbb{C}^n \oplus L^2(\{1, 2, \dots\})$

$$T = T_X \oplus T_{\text{ray}} + c(|v_0\rangle\langle r_1| + |r_1\rangle\langle v_0|), \quad (T_{\text{ray}}g)_1 = g_2, \quad (T_{\text{ray}}g)_k = g_{k-1} + g_{k+1} \quad (k \geq 2).$$

The spectral parameter is $\lambda = z+1/z$, and $z = q^{s-1/2}$ maps the critical line $\text{Re } s = \frac{1}{2}$ to the unit circle and $\text{Re } s < \frac{1}{2}$ to the open disc. With $G(\lambda) = \langle v_0 | (\lambda - T_X)^{-1} | v_0 \rangle$ the *reflection coefficient* is defined by the generalised eigenfunctions $g(r_k) = z^{-k} + R(z)z^k$, $k \geq 1$. Put $p(z) = \det((1+z^2)I - zT_X - c^2P_0)$ and $\tilde{p}(z) = z^{2n}p(1/z)$. A *cusp form* is an eigenvector of T_X vanishing at v_0 . A *visible bound state* is an L^2 eigenfunction of T with nonzero ray component (it decays as ϑ^k , $\vartheta \in (-1, 1)$). A *threshold root* is a common root of $p, \tilde{p}$ at $z = \pm 1$. The *resonances* are the zeros of the reduced R in $|z| < 1$, with multiplicity. $\text{RAM}(Y)$: every L^2 eigenvalue of T other than the Perron eigenvalue and its bipartite twin lies in $[-2, 2]$. $\text{RH}(Y)$: all resonances share one modulus r .

The normalisation is that of the tree quotient. On the Nagao ray $L_0, L_1, \dots$ of $\text{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q[T]) \backslash \mathcal{T}$ (Serre, *Trees*, II.1.6; restated in [2]) the adjacency operator acts by $(Af)(L_n) = f(L_{n+1}) + qf(L_{n-1})$ for $n \geq 1$ and $(Af)(L_0) = (q+1)f(L_1)$; self-adjointness on $L^2(Y, m)$ forces $m_0 = 1$, $m_n = (q+1)q^{-n}$ ($n \geq 1$), and $g = m^{1/2}f$ followed by division by $\sqrt{q}$ gives exactly T_{ray} with $c^2 = q+1$ (the orchestrator's $m_n \sim q^{-n}$ for all n was not self-adjoint at the junction: prover ledger 1, numerics D2). The Eisenstein-type solutions $q^{sn}, q^{(1-s)n}$ become z^n, z^{-n} .

25.2 What scattering sees

Proposition 25.2 (The reflection coefficient).

[proved] Substituting the ansatz gives

$c g(v_0) = 1 + R$, $g_X = c(z^{-1} + Rz)(\lambda - T_X)^{-1}|v_0\rangle$, and

$$R(z) = \frac{1 - c^2 G(\lambda) z^{-1}}{c^2 G(\lambda) z - 1} = - \frac{\det(\lambda - T_X - c^2 z^{-1} P_0)}{\det(\lambda - T_X - c^2 z P_0)} = - \frac{p(z)}{\tilde{p}(z)},$$

with a minus sign and no extra power of z (the brief's determinant form lacked the sign; prover ledger 3, numerics D1). p is monic of degree $2n$ with $p(0) = 1 - c^2$ and $\tilde{p}(0) = 1$; R has real coefficients, $R(z)R(1/z) = 1$ and $|R| = 1$ on the circle. The ray self-energy at v_0 is $c^2 z$ on the physical (decaying, Catalan-series) branch and c^2/z on its second-sheet continuation.

Proposition 25.3 (Visible bound states, invisible cusp forms, threshold cancellation). *[proved]* Let X_b be the Krylov space of (T_X, v_0) , $d = \dim X_b$, and $X_c = X_b^\perp$ the span of the cusp forms, with eigenvalue multiplicities $m_c(t)$. Then $p = D_c p_b$, $\tilde{p} = D_c \tilde{p}_b$ with $D_c(z) = \prod_t (1 - tz + z^2)^{m_c(t)}$. (i) The poles of the reduced R in $|z| < 1$ are simple, real, nonzero, and in bijection with the visible bound states: $(\lambda - T_X - c^2 \vartheta P_0)x = 0$, $g_k = cx_0 \vartheta^k$, $\lambda = \vartheta + \vartheta^{-1}$ outside $[-2, 2]$; cusp forms outside the band are L^2 eigenfunctions but are cancelled in R (numerics D4). (ii) R has no non-real pole in the disc. (iii) Up to a constant $\gcd(p, \tilde{p}) = D_c H$ with $H(z) = \prod_{\epsilon \in E_{\text{th}}} (z - \epsilon)$, $E_{\text{th}} = \{\epsilon = \pm 1 : p_b(\epsilon) = 0\}$, $n_{\text{th}} = |E_{\text{th}}|$: common factors are the cusp forms and the threshold roots, which are simple and correspond to non- L^2 constant or alternating tails (Childs–Strouse’s half-bound states; numerics D5).

Theorem 25.4 (Resonances and their number). *[proved]* The resonances $z_i \neq 0$ are exactly the non-cancelled solutions of $(T_X + c^2 z_i^{-1} P_0)x = (z_i + z_i^{-1})x$, the self-consistent eigenvalues of the effective operator with the outgoing self-energy; the continued tail $cx_0 z_i^{-k}$ grows in space and is outgoing in time. Non-real resonances come in conjugate pairs, and the exterior roots of p_b are exactly the reciprocals ϑ^{-1} of the visible bound parameters. With b visible bound states,

$$N = 2d - b - n_{\text{th}} = 2n - 2 \sum_t m_c(t) - b - n_{\text{th}},$$

counting a possible zero root (a delay mode, present iff $c = 1$). The rational degree of R is $2d - n_{\text{th}}$.

Proposition 25.5 (The pure cusp). *[proved]* For $T_X = [0]$, $c^2 = q + 1$: $R(z) = (z^2 - q)/(qz^2 - 1)$, poles $\pm q^{-1/2}$ (the constant function on the quotient, $g = \sqrt{m}$, and its alternating twin, eigenvalues $\pm(q + 1)/\sqrt{q}$), zeros $\pm q^{1/2}$, no resonances. With $\zeta_K(s) = ((1 - q^{-s})(1 - q^{1-s}))^{-1}$ and $z = q^{s-1/2}$,

$$q \frac{\zeta_K(2s - 1)}{\zeta_K(2s)} = \frac{qz^2 - 1}{z^2 - q} = \frac{1}{R(z)},$$

so the modular scattering matrix $\phi(s) = \xi(2s - 1)/\xi(2s)$ of Section 17 corresponds to $\phi = 1/R$: the poles of ϕ in $\text{Re } s < \frac{1}{2}$ are the zeros of R in the disc, the resonances; the pole at $s = 1$ and the zero at $s = 0$ recur with period $\pi i / \log q$. The pure cusp is all cusp and no interior.

25.3 Prior art

The prover’s file cites neither source below (reviewer finding 1); Propositions 25.2, 25.3 and 25.5 and Theorem 25.4 are therefore re-derivations, registered with the citations here. The reviewer verified that Childs–Strouse’s R reduces to Proposition 25.2 on 21 cores and that the Arends–Peterson–Weich resonance determinant equals $(-1)^n (2z)^{-n} p(z)$ in our variable (their parameter is written μ).

Cited fact 25.6 (Childs–Strouse: the reflection coefficient of a graph with a tail). *[cited]* Childs and Strouse [15] scatter a continuous-time quantum walk on a weighted finite graph with one semi-infinite path attached and extend the reflection coefficient to the plane as $R(z) \stackrel{\text{defeq}}{=} \frac{Q(z^{-1})}{Q(z)}$ with $Q(z) \stackrel{\text{defeq}}{=} 1 - z(a + C(z))$, $C(z) = b^\dagger(z + z^{-1} - D)^{-1}b$ (1103.5077:main.tex:192-197). With $a = 0$, $b = c|v_0\rangle$, $D = T_X$ this is Proposition 25.2 verbatim, sign included; the cusp weight $c^2 = q + 1$ is a special case of their weighted b , not a new ingredient at the formula level.

Cited fact 25.7 (Childs–Strouse: Levinson’s theorem for graphs). *[cited]* For m internal vertices, n_c confined (cusp-form), n_h half-bound (threshold) and n_b evanescent bound states, and $a \neq 0$ or $\|b\| \neq 1$, the winding of the phase of R around the circle is $w_\Gamma(R) = 2$

$(m - n_b - n_c - \smfrac{1}{2}n_h)$. (1103.5077:main.tex:275-278); half-bound states are the $k = 0, \pi$ threshold states (:232). Equivalently $w_\Gamma(R) = N - n_b$, which reproduces the count of Theorem 25.4. The sequel [14] drops the hypothesis and treats several tails.

Cited fact 25.8 (Arends–Peterson–Weich: resonances on geometrically finite graphs). [cited] [2] define resonances of the adjacency operator on $(q+1)$ -regular graphs of groups with cusps and funnels by meromorphic continuation of the resolvent: “In contrast to the hyperbolic surfaces setting, geometrically finite graphs have only finitely many resonances, and these resonances may be computed explicitly” (2603.26443:final_draft.tex:50). Their resonance matrix is a rank-one perturbation of the core adjacency by the cusp weight, and its determinant is p up to a power of z and normalisation (their parameter, written μ , is our z); their resonances outside the disc are the reciprocals of the visible bound parameters, their unit-circle factors are cusp forms, their “topological” resonances at ± 1 are the threshold roots.

Cited fact 25.9 (Arends–Peterson–Weich: the wave equation is left open). [cited] “In follow-up work, we plan to connect the theory of resonances on geometrically finite graphs developed in this paper with the wave equation on regular trees and graphs” (2603.26443:final_draft.tex:138). The wave group, the radiation spaces and the one-exit contraction of Theorem 25.13 are therefore not in that source.

Cited fact 25.10 (Arends–Peterson–Weich: elliptic-curve quotients). [cited] For the quotient of the tree by PGL_2 of the coordinate ring of $y^2 + y = x^3 + x + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_2$ the resonance determinant is $(\mu^2 + 1)^2 (\mu^2 - 2) (2\mu^4 - 2\mu^2 + 1)$. (2603.26443:final_draft.tex:2008), and for $y^2 = x^3 + x + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_3$ it is $(\mu^2 + 1)^2 (\mu - 1)^2 (\mu + 1)^2 (\mu^2 - 3) (3\mu^4 + 1)$. (:2056), their parameter written μ , our z . The last factor is the Hasse–Weil numerator at $T = z^2$; the factor $z^2 - q$ is the Perron pair; the $(z^2 + 1)^2$ are L^2 eigenvalues on the circle (cusp forms); the $(z \mp 1)^2$ are non- L^2 threshold resonances.

Cited fact 25.11 (Arends–Peterson–Weich: the Weil circle). [cited] “Resonances on the circle of radius $\frac{1}{q^{\frac{1}{4}}}$ corresponding to square roots of zeros of the Hasse–Weil zeta function of C .” (2603.26443:final_draft.tex:2092); the circle is Weil’s theorem, and the mechanism named is the Eisenstein series. This is the curve version of $\mathrm{RH}(Y)$ with $r = q^{-1/4}$.

Cited fact 25.12 (Kaneko–Koyama: the level- A constant term over $\mathbb{F}_q[T]$). [cited] For $\Gamma_0(A) < \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q[T])$, A monic irreducible of degree a , the constant-term sum equals $\frac{q^{a(1-2s)}}{1-q^{-2as}} \frac{\zeta_{\mathbb{F}_q[T]}(2s-1)}{\zeta_{\mathbb{F}_q[T]}(2s)}$ ([51], 2303.09327:main.tex:390): the level generalisation of Proposition 25.5. No source found states that the poles of the $\Gamma_0(N)$ scattering matrix are Dirichlet L -zeros; that remains the hypothesis H-ARITH of observation 26.12.

25.4 The wave group and the one-exit contraction

Theorem 25.13 (Discrete Lax–Phillips on the diagram). *[sketched] Let $u_{m+1} = Tu_m - u_{m-1}$, $W(u, v) = (Tu - v, u)$, $E(u, v) = \|u\|^2 + \|v\|^2 - \mathrm{Re}\langle u, Tv \rangle$. (a) E is W -invariant; on the ray the equation has the exact d’Alembert solutions $u_m(k) = F(k+m) + B(k-m)$ (speed one). The local outgoing space is forward invariant and the local incoming space backward invariant, each a shift of multiplicity one, and E -orthogonality of the two forces the outgoing profile to start at $k \geq 2$ (numerics D8). (b) On the E -orthocomplement of all L^2 eigen-data (bound states and cusp forms) E is positive and W is E -unitary; on each bound-state block E is indefinite with both wave eigen-data E -null (time multipliers $\vartheta^{\pm 1}$, not 1). (c) Deleting bound-state data does not preserve the orthogonality of the projected local radiation spaces: on the pure $q = 2$ cusp two E -orthogonal local*

data acquire projected cross energy $3/32$. The repair is $D_- = \mathcal{O}_-$ and $D_+ = \mathcal{O}_+ \cap \mathcal{O}_+^\perp$, which in the incoming translation representation reads $UD_+ = RH^2 \cap H^2 = \Theta H^2$ with $\Theta = \eta R B_{\text{bd}} = \prod_{i=1}^N b_{z_i}$, the pole-removed inner part of R (B_{bd} the Blaschke product of the visible bound parameters, $|\eta| = 1$). Hence $K = H_E \ominus (D_+ \oplus D_-)$ is carried to $K_\Theta = H^2 \ominus \Theta H^2$, $\dim K = N$, $Z = P_{K_\Theta} M_w|_{K_\Theta}$ has spectrum exactly the resonances (not their reflections; numerics D11), $Z^m \rightarrow 0$, and with $C = Z^*$ the defects are rank one, $I - C^*C = jj^*$ with $j = P_K 1$ the compression of the first normalised translation coordinate, $I - CC^* = j'j'^*$ with $j' = (\Theta(w) - \Theta(0))/w$. (d) The standard theorem used is the scalar Sz.-Nagy–Foias model theorem; the mirror choice $D_- = \mathcal{O}_- \cap \mathcal{O}_+^\perp$ and the Lax–Phillips route that keeps the indefinite bound-state block are unexamined, and the unitary equivalence of the wave compression with Z is asserted, not proved (reviewer finding 2; hence sketched); neither R nor $1/R$ is the characteristic function when bound states are present (numerics D13).

Lemma 25.14 (The Gram identity and the exit). [sketched] Under H -SIMPLE,
 $k_i(w) = (1 - z_i w)^{-1} \in K_\Theta$, $Ck_i = z_i k_i$, $G_{ij} = \langle k_i, k_j \rangle = (1 - \bar{z}_i z_j)^{-1}$, $\langle j, k_i \rangle = 1$; in coordinates $G - D^*GD = \mathbf{11}^*$ with $D = \text{diag}(z_i)$. In general $\langle k_n, k_m \rangle (1 - \bar{z}_n z_m) = \bar{a}_n a_m$ with $a_n = \langle j | k_n \rangle$, so no eigenvector is dark: a zero exit amplitude would force $\|Cv\| = \|v\|$ with $|z| < 1$ (numerics D12). Repeated resonances use derivative kernels.

Proposition 25.15 (Walk expansions and the cusp term). [proved] Under H -REG ($T_X = A_X/\sqrt{q}$, X $(q+1)$ -regular) and $u = z/\sqrt{q}$, $\det(I - uA_X + qu^2) = \det(I - zT_X + z^2)$ is the vertex factor of the Bass determinant, and $p, \tilde{p}$ are its rank-one perturbations: $\log p = \log \det H_0 + \log(1 - c^2 h)$, $\log \tilde{p} = \log \det H_0 + \log(1 - c^2 z^2 h)$ with $H_0 = I - zT_X + z^2$, $h = \langle v_0 | H_0^{-1} | v_0 \rangle$. The power sums of the resonances are

$$\sum_{i=1}^N z_i^m = -m[w^m] \log \tilde{p}(w) - \sum_t m_c(t) (a_t^m + a_t^{-m}) - \sum_{\epsilon \in E_{\text{th}}} \epsilon^m - \sum_{\vartheta} \vartheta^{-m},$$

the expansion of $\log p$ at zero giving inverse powers instead (ledger 18). The logarithmic derivative $-R'/R = -p'/p + \tilde{p}'/\tilde{p}$ is a finite rational cusp contribution $-\sum_i ((z - z_i)^{-1} + \bar{z}_i(1 - \bar{z}_i z)^{-1}) + \sum_{\vartheta} ((z - \vartheta)^{-1} + \vartheta(1 - \vartheta z)^{-1})$, not a prime comb; the physical self-energy $c^2 z$ resums the Catalan-weighted returning ray excursions of length $2r+2$, and c^2/z is their second-sheet continuation. The arithmetic comb of Proposition 46.5 has no counterpart at finite core.

26 The Phantasm V: a Finite Graph with a Cusp II. The Renewal Channel, Ramanujan versus RH, and the Arithmetic Round

Same lanes and files as Section 25. Throughout, C is the no-event contraction of Theorem 25.13 on the model space K of dimension N , $I - C^*C = jj^*$, $C^m \rightarrow 0$; H-CONTRACTION means only this, so everything in this section holds for every finite stable contraction with a rank-one defect.

26.1 The renewal channel in discrete time

Definition 26.1 (Renewal channel of a diagram). For a density Ω on K , $\mathcal{E}_\Omega(\mathbf{s}) = C\mathbf{s}C^* + \langle j|\mathbf{s}|j\rangle \Omega$; its *holding law* is $m_\Omega(m) = \langle j|C^{m-1}\Omega C^{*(m-1)}|j\rangle$, $m \geq 1$, with generating function $\hat{m}_\Omega(u) = \sum_m m_\Omega(m)u^m$ and mean $\bar{t}_\Omega$. The *graded channel* is the same map on $\mathbb{C}\text{vac} \oplus K$ with vac even and K odd. A density $\mathbf{s}$ is *admissible* if it is stationary for some $\mathcal{E}_\Omega$; its *loss* is $Q_\mathbf{s} = \mathbf{s} - C\mathbf{s}C^*$.

Theorem 26.2 (Renewal channel: CPTP, holding law, stationary density, secular equation). *[proved]* (a) $\mathcal{E}_\Omega$ is CPTP with Kraus operators C and $\sqrt{p_i}|\omega_i\rangle\langle j|$ for $\Omega = \sum_i p_i|\omega_i\rangle\langle\omega_i|$. (b) m_Ω is a probability law with mean $\bar{t}_\Omega = \sum_{m \geq 0} \text{Tr}(C^m \Omega C^{*m}) < \infty$: in finite dimension the infinite-mean phenomenon of Proposition 24.6 cannot occur. (c) $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \bar{t}_\Omega^{-1} \sum_{m \geq 0} C^m \Omega C^{*m}$ is stationary; it is the unique stationary density unconditionally, and it attracts every density iff the holding law is aperiodic; the peripheral eigenvalues of $\mathcal{E}_\Omega$ are exactly the d -th roots of unity, $d = \gcd\{m : m_\Omega(m) > 0\}$, each simple. Aperiodicity holds iff 0 is not a resonance, i.e. $c \neq 1$, whenever the range of Ω contains an eigenvector of C ; it can fail with nonreal resonances: $C = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -r^2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$, eigenvalues $\pm ir$, $\Omega = |e_2\rangle\langle e_2|$ has m supported on even times and $\mathcal{E}_\Omega$ has the eigenvalue -1 . (d) $\mathbf{s}_\infty$ is pure iff Ω is a pure state on an eigenvector of C , and then $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \Omega$. (e) $\det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_\Omega) = \det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_0)(1 - \hat{m}_\Omega(u))$ with $\mathcal{E}_0(\mathbf{s}) = C\mathbf{s}C^*$; a simple product eigenvalue $z_a \bar{z}_b$ persists iff the residue criterion of Proposition 24.9 holds, with residues at collisions.

Proposition 26.3 (Mode-diagonal rebounds: the common-modulus criterion and the Gram spectrum). *[proved]* Under H-SIMPLE, for $\Omega = \sum_i p_i|e_i\rangle\langle e_i|$ on normalised eigenvectors, $\bar{t}_\Omega = \sum_i p_i/(1 - |z_i|^2)$ and $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \bar{t}_\Omega^{-1} \sum_i p_i(1 - |z_i|^2)^{-1}|e_i\rangle\langle e_i|$; $\mathbf{s}_\infty = \Omega$ for every probability vector on a family of distinct resonances iff all $|z_i|$ in the family coincide (the discrete Proposition 24.10). Under RH(Y) with radius r , $\bar{t}_\Omega = (1 - r^2)^{-1}$ independent of the weights $((1 - q^{-1/2})^{-1}$ at $r = q^{-1/4}$; the continuous $\bar{t} = 2$ of Proposition 24.10 is a different time convention, not the same number). The spectrum of $\mathbf{s}_\infty$ is the Gram spectrum $\text{spec}(O^{1/2}\text{diag}(w)O^{1/2})$, $O_{ij} = \langle e_i, e_j \rangle$, not the weight list.

Theorem 26.4 (Admissible densities and invariant flags). *[proved]* $\mathbf{s}$ is admissible iff $Q_\mathbf{s} \geq 0$; then $\Omega = Q_\mathbf{s}/\text{Tr } Q_\mathbf{s}$ is unique and $\text{Tr } Q_\mathbf{s} = \langle j|\mathbf{s}|j\rangle$. For any C -invariant flag $V_1 \subset \dots \subset V_N$ with projections P_k , $Q_k = P_k - CP_kC^* \geq 0$, and $\mathbf{s} = \sum_k (p_k - p_{k+1})P_k$ is admissible with the prescribed spectrum $p_1 \geq \dots \geq p_N$ (the discrete Theorem 24.12); this uses only H-CONTRACTION with arbitrary defect rank, nothing about the graph. Under H-SIMPLE the condition reads, in the resonance basis with Gram matrix G , $(\mathbf{s}_{nm}(1 - \bar{z}_n z_m)) \circ G^{-1}$ -conjugated Schur form as in Theorem 24.11.

Proposition 26.5 (Odd modes are protected). *[proved]* On $\mathbb{C}\text{vac} \oplus K$, for every rebound density on the graded space, the odd operators $|k_i\rangle\langle\text{vac}|$ and $|\text{vac}\rangle\langle k_i|$ are eigen-operators of the graded renewal channel with eigenvalues z_i and $\bar{z}_i$, because the exit functional vanishes on odd operators; odd inputs stay autonomous for any rebound (the discrete Proposition 24.7).

Observation 26.6 (A graph bound state is not a stationary even vacuum). *[sketched]* The visible bound states of the diagram, the discrete analogue of the constant function of the modular surface

and of the pole at $s = 1$, have wave eigen-data with time multipliers $\vartheta^{\pm 1} \neq 1$ on an E -indefinite block with no positive W -invariant form; declaring one stationary changes the dynamics. With the $1 \oplus C$ construction the vacuum is always stationary and never leaks, so a unique mixed graded stationary state still needs an even exit, exactly as in Proposition 24.8; the graph does not supply it.

26.2 Ramanujan versus RH for a diagram

Proposition 26.7 (RAM and RH are independent). *[proved]* *For the one-vertex core $T_X = [a]$, $p = z^2 - az + 1 - c^2$. With $a = 29/20$, $c^2 = 1/2$ both roots $(29 \pm \sqrt{41})/40$ are resonances of unequal modulus, no bound states: RAM holds, RH fails. The connected nonnegative two-vertex core $T_X = \begin{pmatrix} 2/5 & \sqrt{51}/5 \\ \sqrt{51}/5 & 1/10 \end{pmatrix}$, $c^2 = 5/2$, has $p = (z^2 + \frac{1}{2})(z - 2)(z + \frac{3}{2})$: resonances $\pm i/\sqrt{2}$ (RH), visible bound eigenvalues $5/2$ (Perron) and $-13/6$ outside the band and not an exempt twin (RAM fails). A one-vertex core can never fail both (numerics D19); all four combinations occur nonvacuously among random two- and three-vertex cores. Non-real resonances for $n = 1$ need $c^2 < 1$, so with the arithmetic $c^2 = q + 1$ a one-vertex core has only real resonances (numerics D18). Regular cores with $q = 2$, $c^2 = 3$: K_4 has resonances $0.442513 \pm 0.608338i$, RH holds; the 3-cube and the Petersen graph fail RH (moduli 0.882647, 0.900780 and 0.828751, 0.900342); none hits $q^{-1/4} = 0.840896$.*

Proposition 26.8 (The product identity fixes the radius). *[proved]* *The product of all $2n$ roots of the monic p is exactly $1 - c^2$, and after removing cusp, exterior and threshold roots $\prod_i z_i = (1 - c^2) \prod_{\vartheta} \vartheta / \prod_{\epsilon} \epsilon$. Under RH(Y) with $N > 0$ and $c \neq 1$, $r^N = |1 - c^2| \prod_{\vartheta} |\vartheta|$: the radius is determined by the coupling and the visible bound states, never universally $q^{-1/4}$. Consequence: with $c^2 = q + 1$ and the Perron pair $\pm q^{-1/2}$ as the only visible bound states, $\prod |z_i| = 1$, so there are no resonances; any arithmetic quotient with resonances must have L^2 spectrum outside the band beyond the Perron pair, or more than one cusp, or a smaller junction weight.*

Proposition 26.9 (Checkable criteria for RH of a diagram). *[proved]* *Let $Q(z) = \prod_i (z - z_i)$ be the reduced resonance polynomial with $Q(0) \neq 0$, $r = |Q(0)|^{1/N}$, $F(w) = r^{-N} Q(rw)$. Necessary: $F(w) = F(0)w^N \overline{F(1/\bar{w})}$ with $|F(0)| = 1$ (scaled self-reciprocity). It is not sufficient $((w - 2)(w - \frac{1}{2}))$. Necessary and sufficient: self-reciprocity plus real-rootedness of the Cayley transform $H(x) = \kappa(x + i)^N F((x - i)/(x + i))$; under H-SIMPLE, equivalently a positive H with $M_Q^* H M_Q = r^2 H$ for the companion matrix. The smallest core with a non-real resonance pair is $n = 1$ with $c^2 < 1$ and $a^2 < 4(1 - c^2)$, modulus $\sqrt{1 - c^2}$, RH automatic.*

Observation 26.10 (The cusp sees only the Krylov space). *[sketched]* $p = p_{\text{red}} \prod_{\text{cusp}} (z^2 - \lambda z + 1)$ with $\deg p_{\text{red}} = 2 \dim \text{Kry}(T_X, v_0)$; resonances and visible bound states are properties of the Krylov compression $(T_X|_{\text{Kry}}, v_0, c)$ alone, and after the reduction $p_{\text{red}}, \tilde{p}_{\text{red}}$ share only the threshold roots. This is what makes the Petersen core (cusp-form multiplicity 7) tractable. Numerics lane; consistent with the X_b decomposition of Proposition 25.3.

Numerical result 26.11 (Blind numerics on the diagram). *[numerical]* `scripts/cusp_graph.py`, 569 checks, 10 s, seed 20260920: R from a direct ray solve at $L = 40$ and 200 (dev 10^{-13}), the sign $R = -p/\tilde{p}$, unimodularity and the functional equation; the junction measure $m_n = (q + 1)q^{-n}$ and $c^2 = q + 1$; classification of roots on 19 cores (one-vertex loop scans, random 3-5 vertex cores, K_4 , 3-cube, Petersen, a core with a cusp form at $\lambda = 3$, a band-edge core), the count $2(n - m_c) - t_{nc} - n_{\text{th}}$, the product identity to 10^{-8} ; the pure cusp at $q = 2, 3, 5, 7$ and $\phi = 1/R$ to 10^{-15} ; the energy signature $(1 - \lambda/2, 1 + \lambda/2)$, E -null bound-state data ($3 \cdot 10^{-16}$), the L^2 deficit $\dim K_c = \# \text{res} - t_{nc} + n_{\text{th}} - 2$ at two ray cuts; Z from the functional model, rank-one defect

(10^{-13}), Gram identity (10^{-14}); renewal channel on four models: CPTP, holding law to one, s_∞ by two routes, determinant identity, modal mean holding times, admissibility and flags, odd-mode protection; the periodic $c = 1$ example; RAM/RH tables over 90 one-vertex and 1200 random cores; the self-reciprocity test on 15 cores.

26.3 What the arithmetic round must supply

Observation 26.12 (H-ARITH and the target).

[sketched]

Generic for every finite core and every number h of cusps, after the matrix generalisation: the self-adjoint scattering with Schur self-energies, rational reflection, the separation of invisible modes and thresholds, energy conservation and the positive wave space, the renewal channel and flags (with h distinct rebounds the scalar renewal law is replaced by a matrix one). Already published, not open (reviewer finding 3): the $h \times h$ scattering matrix and the matrix Levinson count [14], and the curve-direction resonance divisor with its $q^{-1/4}$ circle (cited fact 25.11). Not supplied, hypothesis H-ARITH: for $\Gamma_0(N) < \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q[T])$ the identification of the $h \times h$ scattering matrix with Dirichlet L -functions over $\mathbb{F}_q[T]$ (cited fact 25.12 gives the level- A constant term at one cusp only), the resonances as L -zeros at $|z| = q^{-1/4}$, the diamond action as the level- N grading, and a cusp comb over monic irreducibles. The concrete alternative target is the curve version already computed in cited fact 25.10: the $\mathrm{PGL}_2(R)$ quotient of the affine elliptic curve $y^2 + y = x^3 + x + 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_2$, whose resonances are the square roots of the Hasse–Weil zeros on $|z| = 2^{-1/4}$ with the Perron pair $\pm\sqrt{2}^{\pm 1}$ and cusp forms at $\pm i$; by Proposition 26.8 its junction data cannot be a single full-weight cusp on a core with only the Perron pair. Running the renewal channel of Theorem 26.2 on that diagram, with the rebound chosen from the arithmetic (Hecke-invariant or Bost–Connes-type over the function field), is the next round.

27 Weil–LPS Channels: Exactly Ramanujan Quantum Expanders

This is the finite model of the Riemann channel of Section 17 with every ingredient present and every claim checkable: commuting dilations indexed by primes, an arithmetic quotient supplying the expansion, and the Weil representation as the Hilbert space. The construction was proposed in the founding session’s handoff and computed on 2026-09-11; everything below was computed, and every construction step carries its own numerical check. The object itself is Definition 4.11, its ingredients Definition 4.9 and Definition 4.10.

27.1 The object

Fix an odd prime p and an LPS parameter $q \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$ with q a square mod p . The Weil intertwiner exists only for symplectic (determinant one) matrices, and q being a square is what lets the norm- q quaternions land in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ after scaling. The admissible pairs computed are these.

p	q	$ \mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p) $	Weil blocks $M_{(p+1)/2}, M_{(p-1)/2}$
5	29	60	M_3, M_2
7	29	168	M_4, M_3
11	5	660	M_6, M_5
13	17, 29	1092	M_7, M_6
17	13	2448	M_9, M_8
19	5, 17	3420	M_{10}, M_9
29	5, 13	12180	M_{15}, M_{14}

Step 1, generators. The $q+1$ integer quaternions $\alpha = a_0 + a_1i + a_2j + a_3k$ of norm q with $a_0 > 0$ odd and a_1, a_2, a_3 even. Jacobi’s four-square theorem gives exactly $q+1$ of them; the enumeration was checked against the divisor sum $\sum_{d|n} d$ for the norms q, q^2 and q_1q_2 used below. The same $p=5$ quaternions appear in Appendix C of [47].

Step 2, images in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$. Split the Hamilton quaternions over $\mathbb{F}_p$ by

$$\mathbf{I} = \begin{pmatrix} x & y \\ y & -x \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{J} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad x^2 + y^2 + 1 \equiv 0 \pmod{p}.$$

Then $\alpha \mapsto a_0 + a_1\mathbf{I} + a_2\mathbf{J} + a_3\mathbf{IJ}$ is a ring homomorphism whose determinant is the quaternion norm. Dividing by a square root s_q of q mod p gives $g_\alpha \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$. Checked: $\det g_\alpha = 1$, $g_{\bar{\alpha}} = g_\alpha^{-1}$, and all $q+1$ images distinct.

Step 3, the Weil representation, built and checked numerically. On $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ take the clock and shift operators Z, X and the Heisenberg–Weyl operators $T(u, v) = X^u Z^v$. The Fourier transform $\mathcal{F}$, the chirp M and a dilation D each satisfy an intertwining relation of the form

$$W(g) T(u, v) W(g)^\dagger \propto T(g(u, v)),$$

with a symplectic g that the code *reads off* rather than assumes. A breadth-first search over $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ in these three generators assigns a unitary $W(g)$ to every group element, projectively; for $p=13$ the table has the expected $p(p^2-1) = 2184$ entries. The relation above was then verified directly for each LPS generator g_α , with error at most $4 \cdot 10^{-14}$ in every case ($7.2 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(p, q) = (13, 17)$, $7.0 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(13, 29)$). Since only $\mathrm{Ad} W$ enters the channel, the projective phases are irrelevant.

Step 4, the two irreducible blocks. $W(-1)$ is the parity operator, so W splits into even and odd functions, of dimensions $(p \pm 1)/2$. Each block $W_{\pm}$ is irreducible and -1 acts on it as a scalar, so it is a representation of $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ up to phase. This matters: on the full M_p the parity operator would be a second fixed point of the channel, and Harrow’s theorem needs irreducibility. The channels are

$$\Phi_q^{\pm}(X) = \frac{1}{q+1} \sum_{\alpha} W_{\pm}(g_{\alpha}) X W_{\pm}(g_{\alpha})^{\dagger} \quad \text{on } M_{(p \pm 1)/2},$$

that is, $D = q + 1$ unitary Kraus operators in the normalisation of Section 2. Block unitarity and Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjointness of the superoperator were checked at 10^{-14} (for (13, 17): deviations $2.7 \cdot 10^{-15}$ and $1.8 \cdot 10^{-15}$).

27.2 Exact Ramanujan behaviour

Proposition 27.1 (Weil–LPS channels are exactly Ramanujan). *[sketched]* For every admissible pair $(p; q)$, each block channel $\Phi_q^{\pm}$ is a Ramanujan quantum expander in the sense of Definition 3.17: $\lambda_2(\Phi_q^{\pm}) \leq \lambda_H$, equivalently $(q+1)\lambda_2 \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ in adjacency units.

The argument is two lines. Harrow’s transfer inequality (cited fact 44.5, [40]) says that for the channel built from an irreducible representation of a group and a symmetric generating set, the second singular value of the channel is at most the second singular value of the transition matrix of the Cayley graph on that generating set. Here the group is $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, the generating set is the $q+1$ images g_{α} of Definition 4.9, and the representation is $W_{\pm}$, irreducible by Step 4; so $(q+1)\lambda_2(\Phi_q^{\pm})$ is bounded by the largest modulus of a nontrivial eigenvalue of the LPS Cayley graph A_q . That graph is Ramanujan, $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$, by Lubotzky, Phillips and Sarnak [68], and $2\sqrt{q} = 2\sqrt{D-1}$ is exactly Hastings’ bound λ_H in adjacency units [42]. The status is *sketched* rather than *proved* because the Lubotzky–Phillips–Sarnak theorem has no byte-verified local source in **refs**/, and because the irreducibility of $W_{\pm}$ and the projective-phase bookkeeping of Step 4 are verified numerically here rather than cited. Iyer, Jain, Jordan and Somma [47] state the $\text{SU}(2)$ version of the same mechanism and call explicit Ramanujan quantum expanders a longstanding open problem; see Section 44.

Numerical result 27.2 (Ramanujan, Harrow containment, Hecke, commutation). *[numerical]*
For $(p; q)$ in $\{(5; 29), (7; 29), (11; 5), (13; 17, 29), (17; 13), (19; 5, 17), (29; 5, 13)\}$ the channels $\Phi_q^{\pm}$ on the even and odd Weil blocks satisfy the Ramanujan bound of Definition 3.17 and have a unique fixed point; Harrow containment, the Hecke relation of Definition 4.12 and commutation across q hold to 10^{-14} .

Every entry of the table below is on the correct side of the bound $2\sqrt{q}$, in adjacency units.

p	q	Cayley A_q		Φ_q^{+}		Φ_q^{-}		$2\sqrt{q}$
		λ_2	$\lambda_{\min}$	$(q+1)\lambda_2$	$(q+1)\lambda_{\min}$	$(q+1)\lambda_2$	$(q+1)\lambda_{\min}$	
5	29	6.000	−8.000	6.000	−2.000	2.000	2.000	10.770
7	29	8.000	−6.000	6.000	−6.000	2.000	−6.000	10.770
11	5	4.372	−4.024	3.562	−4.024	3.406	−4.024	4.472
13	17	6.928	−7.851	6.000	−6.685	5.555	−5.555	8.246
13	29	9.932	−9.208	9.000	−9.000	9.000	−9.000	10.770
17	13	6.106	−7.090	6.000	−6.828	6.000	−6.828	7.211
19	5	4.275	−4.274	4.243	−4.000	4.243	−4.000	4.472
19	17	7.671	−7.638	7.128	−7.638	7.128	−7.638	8.246
29	5	4.442	−4.411	4.442	−4.049	4.442	−4.049	4.472
29	13	6.765	−6.949	6.765	−6.912	6.579	−6.912	7.211

The further checks, all passed in every case, are these.

- **Harrow containment.** Every channel eigenvalue, times $q + 1$, lies in the spectrum of the $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ Cayley graph to $5 \cdot 10^{-7}$ (for $(13, 17)$: maximum distance $4.4 \cdot 10^{-7}$ on the even block, $3.1 \cdot 10^{-7}$ on the odd). The graph spectrum was computed in double precision on up to 3420 vertices; for $p = 29$ only the extreme eigenvalues were computed, by Lanczos, which is why this is a containment check and not an equality check.
- **Unique fixed point.** The eigenvalue 1 of each block channel has multiplicity one, so the channels are quantum expanders in the sense of Definition 3.16 and not merely bounded.
- **Hecke relation.** $A_q^2 - q \mathbf{1} = A_{q^2}$ on $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, with A_{q^2} built from the $q^2 + q + 1$ normalised quaternions of norm q^2 (307 for $q = 17$, 871 for $q = 29$). Residual exactly 0. This is the tree relation “two steps without backtracking”.
- **Commutation across q .** For $(p; q_1, q_2) = (13; 17, 29), (19; 5, 17), (29; 5, 13)$ the commutator $\|[\Phi_{q_1}^\pm, \Phi_{q_2}^\pm]\|$ is at most $3 \cdot 10^{-15}$ (for $p = 13$: $5.4 \cdot 10^{-16}$ even, $4.5 \cdot 10^{-16}$ odd), and $A_{q_1} A_{q_2} = A_{q_1 q_2}$ exactly, with the $(q_1 + 1)(q_2 + 1) = 540$ quaternions of norm $q_1 q_2$.

27.3 The quantum Ihara zeta of these channels

Numerical result 27.3 (Edge spectrum and Ihara–Bass for $(p, q) = (13, 17)$). [numerical] For $(13, 17)$, odd block, the non-backtracking edge superoperator T on $M_6 \otimes \mathbb{C}^{18}$, of dimension 648, has $|\mu|$ in $\{17, \sqrt{17}, 1\}$ with multiplicities 1, 70, 577, and satisfies the Ihara–Bass identity to 10^{-14} .

The edge superoperator of Definition 3.18 was built directly, and the Ihara–Bass factorisation of Definition 3.8,

$$\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{n^2(D-2)/2} \det(1 - u D \Phi_q^- + q u^2), \quad n = 6, D = 18,$$

holds with relative residuals $2.8 \cdot 10^{-15}$ at $u = 0.11$, $2.3 \cdot 10^{-15}$ at $u = 0.2 + 0.07i$ and $1.5 \cdot 10^{-14}$ at $u = -0.23$. The multiplicities $1 + 70 + 577 = 648$ exhaust the edge space, and $\sqrt{q} = 4.12311$. So the quantum Ihara zeta ζ_Φ of this channel satisfies the RH analogue of Definition 3.4 on the nose: every nontrivial pole sits on the critical circle (the ungraded quantum Ihara zeta has poles only; wording corrected 2026-09-15 after the prover lane of Section 13). For every other case the same conclusion follows from the channel spectrum through the quadratic relation $\mu^2 - \lambda \mu + q = 0$ that links an edge eigenvalue to an adjacency eigenvalue λ , without building T .

27.4 What the joint spectrum looks like

For $(13; 17, 29)$ the even block has 19 distinct joint eigenvalue pairs (a_{17}, a_{29}) of the commuting pair Φ_{17}^+, Φ_{29}^+ . Examples, in adjacency units.

(a_{17}, a_{29})	multiplicity	remark
$(18, 30)$	1	trivial: $q + 1$
$(6, 2)$	2	integers
$(3, -1), (3, 3), (3, 9)$	3, 3, 2	integers
$(-5, -5)$	6	integers
$(\frac{3+\sqrt{17}}{2}, -1 - \sqrt{17})$	3	quadratic, field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{17})$
$(5.6847, -2), (5.5549, -0.3344), (1.7730, 5.1119), \dots$	3 each	higher degree

That the eigenvalues are algebraic integers is not a test: the Cayley adjacency matrix A_q is an integer matrix by construction. What is visible is the structure a Hecke identification would predict, namely joint eigenvalue pairs, small-degree algebraic integers, multiplicities equal to the multiplicity of the corresponding irreducible representation of $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ in $W_\pm \otimes \overline{W}_\pm$, and every pair inside the box $[-2\sqrt{q_1}, 2\sqrt{q_1}] \times [-2\sqrt{q_2}, 2\sqrt{q_2}]$.

Conjecture 27.4 (Hecke identification of the Weil–LPS spectra). *[open] The joint spectra of the commuting Weil–LPS channels $\Phi_q^\pm$ are Hecke eigenvalues $a_q(f)$ of weight-2 forms attached to the quaternion algebra ramified at $\{2, \infty\}$, with level determined by p , via Jacquet–Langlands.*

The identification was *not* done here; it needs LMFDB and the Jacquet–Langlands bookkeeping.

27.5 Reading

Riemann channel	Weil–LPS channel at p
commuting dilations by primes	commuting Hecke channels Φ_q , one per LPS prime q
arithmetic quotient supplying expansion	$\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ as quotient of the $(q+1)$ -regular tree
Weil representation	$W_\pm$ on $\ell^2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, even and odd
joint spectrum = zeros	joint spectrum = Hecke eigenvalues
RH: all modes at $\mathrm{Re} = 1/2$	Ramanujan: all modes at $ \mu = \sqrt{q}$
source of the bound: unknown	source of the bound: Deligne, via LPS

The last row is the honest one. These channels are exactly Ramanujan because Deligne proved the Weil conjectures (Section 36), not because they are channels. What the computation establishes is that the object proposed in the founding session’s handoff exists, is cheap to build, is self-checking at every step, and lands on the parent campaign’s Hilbert space with the parent campaign’s representation.

27.6 Not established

- The identification of the joint spectrum with specific modular forms in LMFDB (conjecture 27.4).
- Any statement about $p \rightarrow \infty$, or about assembling the Φ_q over all p into an object whose rings are the primes; that is the parent repository’s global question in a new guise, recorded as conjecture 47.2 in Section 47.
- Anything about the Riemann hypothesis itself.

28 A Matrix-Product Formulation of the Weil Conjectures for Quadratic Artin–Schreier Curves

The question the founding session put to this family is narrow and answerable: is there an honest matrix product state behind the Weil conjectures for curves, meaning a *fixed* local tensor whose n -site ring contraction is the point count N_n ? In the vocabulary of this book the ingredients line up: $N_n = \#C(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ is a ring norm, the Frobenius eigenvalues α_i appearing in $Z_C(u)$ are a transfer spectrum, and the Riemann hypothesis for the curve is the RH analogue of Definition 3.4. What is at issue is only whether the defining equation of the curve is a *local* constraint on the ring. For the quadratic Artin–Schreier family the answer is yes, and the answer stops exactly at degree three.

28.1 The shift picture

By Definition 4.14 the field $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ carries a normal basis $\{\theta, \theta^q, \dots, \theta^{q^{n-1}}\}$ in which Frobenius $x \mapsto x^q$ is the cyclic shift of coordinates. An element of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ is then a ring of n sites with alphabet $\mathbb{F}_q$, Frobenius is translation by one site, and points over $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ are ring configurations. This is the matrix-product setting of Definition 3.12 with no further choices to make.

For the Artin–Schreier curve $y^q - y = g(x)$ of Definition 4.13, Hilbert 90 reduces the affine count to exponential sums,

$$N_n = q^n + \sum_{a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times} \mathcal{S}_n(ag), \quad \mathcal{S}_n(g) = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_{q^n}} e_q(\text{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x)), \quad (1)$$

so everything is carried by the $\mathcal{S}_n$. Writing the exponent m of a monomial x^m in base q , $m = \sum_j m_j q^j$, one has $x^m = \prod_j (x^{q^j})^{m_j}$: a product of shifted copies of x , whose range is the number of base- q digits. In a self-dual normal basis, which exists for n odd, the trace form is the dot product, and so for the quadratic family $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$,

$$\text{tr}_{q^n/q} g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j \sum_i x_i x_{i+j}, \quad (2)$$

a translation-invariant quadratic spin model of range J on the ring. Its partition function is $\text{Tr } E^n$ for the transfer matrix

$$E_{(s_1, \dots, s_J) \rightarrow (s_2, \dots, s_J, x)} = e_q \left(a_0 x^2 + \sum_{j=1}^J a_j s_{J+1-j} x \right), \quad (3)$$

of size q^J , with physical index $\mathbb{F}_q$ and bond dimension q^J . The spins s_i are the J most recent site values; the map reads in the newest value x and forgets the oldest spin s_1 .

Proposition 28.1 (Transfer matrix for the quadratic family: the two forms). [*proved-conditional*] For $g(x) = \sum_{j=0}^J a_j x^{1+q^j}$ and every $n \geq 1$, including $n \leq J$: $\text{Tr } E_g^n = \sum_{x \in \mathbb{F}_q^n} e_q(Q_g^\circ(x))$ with Q_g° the ring form of matrix $P_g(\mathbb{S})$, and $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = \sum_x e_q(Q_g^{\text{tr}}(x))$ with Q_g^{tr} the trace form of matrix $CP_g(\mathbb{S})$ in normal-basis coordinates (Definition 5.7). The two forms have the same radical $\mathcal{R}_n$, so $|\mathcal{S}_n(g)| = |\text{Tr } E_g^n|$ and $\log_q(|\mathcal{S}_n|^2/q^n) = d_n$ is a nonnegative integer.

Two remarks on the statement, both corrected on 2026-09-12 night. First, the founding session’s reading of the even- n sign flip as the normalisation $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$, “uniformly in n ”, is false in general: it holds exactly when $P_g(-1) \neq 0$, and the exact law $\mathcal{S}_n = (-1)^{n-1} \delta_n \text{Tr } E_g^n$ with the radical sign

δ_n is Theorem 29.3 of Section 29, where the corrected Frobenius block is built. Second, a self-dual normal basis exists only for odd n ; in a general normal basis the trace form is $C P_g(\mathbb{S})$, not $P_g(\mathbb{S})$, and the discrepancy between the two Gauss sums is precisely the discriminant of C on the complement of the radical, which is Stickelberger’s sign $(-1)^{n-1}$ corrected on the radical.

28.2 What was computed

The script brute-forces $\mathcal{S}_n$ in $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ in a polynomial basis, with the modulus verified irreducible, and compares with $\text{Tr } E^n$.

q	$a = (a_0, \dots, a_J)$	$\dim E$	n tested	$\mathcal{S}_n$ against $\text{Tr } E^n$
3	(0, 1)	3	2–7	equal for odd n , sign flip for even n
3	(1, 1)	3	3, 5, 7	equal
5	(0, 1)	5	2–5	equal for odd n , sign flip for even n
3	(0, 1, 1)	9	3, 5, 7	equal
3	(0, 0, 1)	9	3, 5, 7	equal

Numerical result 28.2 (Transfer identity and unitarity, checked). [numerical] For the five (q, a) of the table above and all n listed, the brute-force exponential sum agrees with $\text{Tr } E^n$ up to the sign convention $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$. For eight (q, a) with $q \in \{3, 5, 7\}$ and $\dim E$ up to 49, every eigenvalue of E has modulus $\sqrt{q}$ and $\|EE^\dagger - qI\| \leq 5.2 \times 10^{-15}$.

The ratios $|\mathcal{S}_n|/q^{n/2}$ are 1 at every tested n except $n = 4$, where they are 3 for $q = 3$ and 5 for $q = 5$: the sums saturate the Weil bound $|\mathcal{S}_n| \leq (\deg g - 1) q^{n/2}$, the maximal-curve phenomenon. The degree of L is $q^J = \deg g - 1$, matching Weil’s count.

28.3 RH is unitarity

Proposition 28.3 (Scaled unitarity of the transfer matrix). [proved] If $a_J \neq 0$ then $EE^\dagger = qI$ on the q^J -dimensional bond (the scalar quadratic Gauss sum when $J = 0$). Hence $E/\sqrt{q}$ is unitary, every eigenvalue of E is nonzero, semisimple and of modulus $\sqrt{q}$, and, through the corrected Frobenius block of Theorem 29.7, the Weil bound $|\alpha_i| = \sqrt{q}$ holds for the whole quadratic Artin–Schreier family.

The note’s argument is one line. In $(EE^\dagger)_{s's''}$ the oldest spin s_1 , which is the index summed over, appears only through the linear term $a_J s_1(x' - x'')$ of (3); provided $a_J \neq 0$ the sum over s_1 is therefore $q \delta_{x'x''}$. The hypothesis $a_J \neq 0$ is not cosmetic: it is what makes J the true range, and without it the same argument applies at the largest j with $a_j \neq 0$ and a smaller transfer matrix. This is the mechanism already seen for a finite permutation in observation 11.2: the RH analogue is manifest because the transfer matrix is a scaled unitary. In the same terms, rationality of $Z_C(u)$ holds because E is finite, and the note records that the functional equation is the involution $E \mapsto q E^{-\dagger}$, which scaled unitarity makes trivial. The proof with the output-row index bookkeeping of (3) made explicit is the prover’s T7.6 (Section 29); the even- n sign is settled there as well.

28.4 Where it stops, and why that is the right place

Take a non-quadratic exponent, say $g(x) = x^3$ over $\mathbb{F}_q$ with $q \geq 5$. The base- q expansion of 3 has a single digit, so x^3 is an on-site cubic; but in normal-basis coordinates $\text{tr}_{q^n/q}(x^3) = \sum_{ijk} c_{ijk} x_i x_j x_k$, with the multiplication structure constants c_{ijk} of the basis, which are non-local and depend on n . A self-dual normal basis makes the *bilinear* trace form local; it says nothing about the trilinear one.

g	locality in the shift basis	transfer matrix	RH
quadratic, $\sum_j a_j x^{1+q^j}$	local, range J	$q^J \times q^J$, $\sqrt{q}$ -unitary	manifest
degree ≥ 3 in any digit	non-local, n -dependent	none of fixed size in this basis	Weil / Deligne

Observation 28.4 (The non-quadratic case and Dwork’s operator).

[sketched]

For non-quadratic g the trace form in the shift basis is non-local and depends on n , so no fixed local tensor represents the ring model. The uniform transfer operator that does exist is Dwork’s p -adic operator (Definition 4.15, [27]), which delivers rationality and, through Dwork’s duality, the functional equation, but which sees the p -adic sizes of its eigenvalues and not their complex absolute values.

Dwork’s operator has exactly the form of a coarse-graining tensor-network step, “local weight, then decimate by q ”: multiplication by a splitting function followed by $x^m \mapsto x^{m/q}$, with infinite but nuclear bond dimension, and L as a Fredholm determinant. What it cannot deliver is the RH analogue, because the Newton polygon it computes is a statement about p -adic valuations. That is the structural reason Deligne’s proof [24] lives in ℓ -adic cohomology, and the Weil/Deligne divide is taken up in Section 36. The sums that fall on the far side of the table, cubic Gauss sums and Kloosterman-type sums, are precisely the ones that needed algebraic geometry.

28.5 Not established

The note is explicit about what was not shown. No matrix product state with a fixed local tensor is known here for a non-quadratic Artin–Schreier curve, or for any curve of genus ≥ 1 that is not of this maximal type. Whether a *different* basis of $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$, uniform in n , makes cubic traces local was neither settled nor searched: no candidate was found. And the unitarity argument of Proposition 28.3 is now proved, and the transfer unitary is identified as a Weil-representation operator in Section 29.

The boundary itself is the result worth keeping, and it is the same boundary met for graphs and for the Riemann channel: the Ramanujan bound is either manifest, because the transfer matrix is a scaled unitary, or it comes from arithmetic input that sits outside the transfer structure altogether.

29 Artin–Schreier II: the Sign Law, the Super-Transfer Matrix, and the Weil Representation

Section 28 recorded that $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = \text{Tr } E_g^n$ for odd n and guessed that the even- n sign flip was the normalisation $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E_g)$. That guess is false in general. The numerics lane found the failures, the orchestrator’s replacement (a conjugated law) failed in two further cases, and the codex prover found and proved the exact law; the numerics lane then confirmed it in 624 further checks. This shard is the corrected account, with the prototype now carrying, explicitly, every feature the Phantasm is supposed to have: a graded bond, a supertrace count, a fermionic sign that is a permutation sign, and a transfer unitary from a Weil representation. Throughout q is an odd prime and the notation is that of Definition 5.7.

29.1 The two quadratic forms and the exact sign law

Lemma 29.1 (Gauss sums of quadratic forms). *[proved] For a quadratic form Q on $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ of rank r with nondegenerate part Q_{nd} , $\sum_x e_q(Q(x)) = q^{n-r} \eta(\det Q_{\text{nd}}) \mathfrak{g}^r$ with $\mathfrak{g} = \sum_c e_q(c^2)$, $\mathfrak{g}^2 = \eta(-1)q$ and $\bar{\mathfrak{g}} = \eta(-1)\mathfrak{g}$; every such sum is nonzero, has $|\cdot|^2 = q^{n+(n-r)}$, and its conjugate is $\eta(-1)^r$ times itself.*

Assumption 29.2 (Normal bases). *[assumed] $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ has a normal basis over $\mathbb{F}_q$; for n odd it can be chosen self-dual [66, 64].*

Theorem 29.3 (The sign law). *[proved-conditional] For every $n \geq 1$, including $q \mid n$,*

$$\mathcal{S}_n(g) = (-1)^{n-1} \delta_n \text{Tr } E_g^n, \quad \delta_n = \det(\mathbb{S}|_{\mathcal{R}_n}) \in \{\pm 1\},$$

equivalently $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = (-1)^{n-1} \delta_n \eta(-1)^{n-d_n} \text{Tr } E_{-g}^n$.

The proof builds a square root of the Gram matrix over $\overline{\mathbb{F}_q}$: the conjugate-embedding matrix $A_{ri} = \theta^{q^{r+i}}$ satisfies $A^t = A$, $A^2 = C$, $A^{[q]} = \mathbb{S}A$, so $\eta(\det(C|_R)) = \det(\mathbb{S}|_R)$ for every $\mathbb{S}$ -invariant subspace R on which the identities restrict. Applied to the whole space this is Stickelberger’s theorem, $\eta(\text{disc}) = (-1)^{n-1}$, the sign of the n -cycle by which Frobenius permutes the conjugates; applied to the radical it gives the correction δ_n . Both Gauss sums have the same rank and the same power of $\mathfrak{g}$; only the discriminants of their nondegenerate parts differ, by $\det C / \det(C|_{\mathcal{R}_n})$.

Assumption 29.4 (Polynomiality of the character L -function). *[assumed] For $\deg g = q^J + 1$ and every $a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times$, $L(ag, u) = \exp(\sum_n \mathcal{S}_n(ag) u^n / n)$ is a polynomial of degree exactly q^J with constant term 1. Root sizes are not assumed.*

Corollary 29.5 (The periodic sign and the endpoint criteria). *[proved-conditional] With $f(z) = z^J \mathcal{P}_g(z)$, v_- its order of vanishing at -1 (always even) and $\mathfrak{h}$ the period parameter: $\delta_n = 1$ for n odd and $(-1)^{\min(v_-, q^{v_q(n)})}$ for n even, so*

$$\mathcal{S}_n(g) = (1 - 2 \cdot \mathbf{1}_{2\mathfrak{h}|n}) \text{Tr } E_g^n.$$

The claim $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E_g)$ of Section 28 holds for all n iff $\mathcal{P}_g(-1) \neq 0$; the conjugated law $\mathcal{S}_n = -(-\eta(-1))^n \overline{\text{Tr } E_g^n}$ holds for all n iff $\mathcal{P}_g(-\eta(-1)) \neq 0$.

Proposition 29.6 (Both drafted laws fail). *[proved-conditional] For $q = 3$, $g = 2x^2 + x^4$, $n = 1$: $\mathcal{S}_1 = \text{Tr } E_g = 3$, while the conjugated law predicts -3 ($\mathcal{P}_g(1) = 0$). For $q = 5$, $g = x^2 + x^6$, $n = 2$: $\mathcal{S}_2 = \text{Tr } E_g^2 = 5\sqrt{5}$, while both laws predict $-5\sqrt{5}$ ($\mathcal{P}_g(-1) = 0$). The failures occur at n prime to q .*

q	a	$P_g(1)$	$P_g(-1)$	v_-	h	$\alpha = -\lambda(E)$	conjugated law
3	(0, 1)	1	2	0	1	holds	holds
3	(1, 1)	2	0	2	3	fails	holds
3	(0, 1, 1)	2	0	4	9	fails	holds
3	(2, 1)	0	1	0	1	holds	fails
5	(1, 2)	3	4	0	1	holds	holds
5	(0, 1, 1)	2	0	2	5	fails	fails
7	(1, 1)	2	0	2	7	fails	holds

29.2 The Frobenius block and the super-transfer matrix

Theorem 29.7 (The corrected Frobenius block).

[proved-conditional]

$L(g, u)^h = \prod_{\omega^{2h}=1} D_g(\omega u) / D_g(u)^h$; the reciprocal-root multiplicity of $L(g, u)$ at z is $m_F(z) = \frac{1}{h} \sum_{\omega^{2h}=1} m_E(\omega^{-1}z) - m_E(z)$, a nonnegative integer, and the diagonal $q^J \times q^J$ matrix F_g with these multiplicities satisfies $F_g F_g^\dagger = q$, $L(g, u) = \det(1 - u F_g)$ and $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = -\text{Tr } F_g^n$ for all n . If $P_g(-1) \neq 0$ one may take $F_g = -E_g$; if $P_g(-\eta(-1)) \neq 0$, $F_g = -\eta(-1)E_{-g}$.

Assumption 29.8 (Frobenius semisimplicity).

[assumed] The Frobenius action on H^1 of a

smooth projective curve over a finite field is semisimple over an algebraic closure of the coefficient field. Used only for operator similarity, never for net spectra.

Theorem 29.9 (The point count is a supertrace).

[proved-conditional] The projective

curve $y^q - y = g(x)$ has one point at infinity; $N_n = 1 + q^n + \sum_{a \neq 0} \mathcal{S}_n(ag)$ (additive Hilbert 90); $\text{Tr } E_0^n = q^n$; and the super-transfer matrix $\mathbb{E}$ of Definition 5.8 satisfies $N_n = \text{str } \mathbb{E}^n$ for all $n \geq 1$. Its odd block F has $FF^\dagger = q$, and its multiset is the $2g = (q-1)q^J$ Frobenius eigenvalues with no even-odd cancellation; under assumption 29.8 it is similar to Frobenius on H^1 . The simpler odd block $-\eta(-1) \bigoplus_a E_{ag}$ is correct iff $P_g(-\eta(-1)) \neq 0$: for $q = 3$, $g = 2x^2 + x^4$ it gives -2 against $N_1 = 10$.

The even block is the trivial-character sector and the odd block the nontrivial characters: this is the grading observation of observation 19.18. The count is a supertrace because, by Corollary 18.18, it cannot be a trace.

29.3 The transfer unitary is a Weil-representation operator

Cited fact 29.10 (Uniqueness of Weil implementers).

[cited] Gurevich and Hadani [38]: the

intertwiner of the Heisenberg representation with its twist by $g \in \text{Sp}$ “is determined up to scalar” by the Egorov relation. Verbatim: satisfies and in fact is determined up to scalar by the following equation (math/0610818:main.tex:422); $\rho(g)\pi(h)\rho(g)^{-1} = \pi(g \cdot h)$, \label {Egorov2} (math/0610818:main.tex:425).

Cited fact 29.11 (Character of the Weil representation).

[cited] Thomas [89]: for a finite

field F the trace of the Weil representation at $g \in \text{Sp}(V)$ is $|F|^{\frac{1}{2} \dim \ker(g-1)}$ times a product of Weil-index phases; in particular its modulus squared is $|F|^{\dim \ker(g-1)}$ (Howe [44]). Verbatim: $\text{Tr } \rho(g) = |F|^{\frac{1}{2} \dim \ker(g-1)} \gamma(1)^{\dim V - \dim \ker(g-1)} \gamma(\det \sigma_g)$. (math/0610644:ArxivThomasWeil3.tex:196).

Assumption 29.12 (Exact centred Weil implementers exist).

[assumed] There is a genuine

unitary representation W of $\text{Sp}(2J, \mathbb{F}_q)$, q odd, with $W(M)X_{u,v}W(M)^{-1} = X_{M(u,v)}$ exactly for the centred Weyl operators.

Theorem 29.13 (The symplectic transfer map). *[proved-conditional] $\mathcal{U}_g = E_g/\sqrt{q}$ factors as the Fourier transform on the retiring register (scaled by a_J), then the quadratic phases, then the cyclic relabelling, and $\mathcal{U}_g X_{u,v} \mathcal{U}_g^{-1} = X_{M_g(u,v)}$ exactly, where*

$$u'_k = u_{k+1}, \quad u'_J = -v_1/a_J, \quad v'_k = v_{k+1} + a_{J-k}u'_J \quad (k < J), \quad v'_J = a_J u_1 + \sum_{k \geq 2} a_{J+1-k} u_k + 2a_0 u'_J,$$

a symplectic map. Hence $\mathcal{U}_g = e^{i\vartheta_g} W(M_g)$.

Corollary 29.14 (Fixed spaces, the Weil bound, and the permutation sign). *[proved-conditional] $|\text{Tr } E_g^n|^2 = q^{n+\dim \ker(M_g^n - 1)}$ (from $\text{Tr Ad}(\mathcal{U}_g^n) = \text{the number of fixed Weyl labels}$), so $d_n = \dim \ker(M_g^n - 1) \leq 2J$; $|\mathcal{S}_n(g)| \leq q^J q^{n/2}$ with equality iff $M_g^n = 1$; and when $d_n = 0$, $\mathcal{S}_n(g) = (-1)^{n-1} \text{Tr } E_g^n$, the sign of the Frobenius n -cycle. For $q = 3$, $g = x^4$: $M_g = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ of order 4, $d_2 = 0$, $d_4 = 2$.*

So the maximal-curve phenomenon of Section 28 ($|\mathcal{S}_4|/q^2 = q$ for $g = x^4$) is the statement $M_g^4 = 1$, and the Weil bound for the whole quadratic family is Howe's character bound for the Weil representation. The fermionic sign of the count on a ring of n sites is the sign of the Frobenius permutation, corrected on the fixed space of M_g^n by the radical sign.

Numerical result 29.15 (The corrected account, checked). [numerical]
`scripts/artin_schreier_super.py` (`outputs/artin_schreier_super.txt`; 1969 checks, of which the 24 failures are exactly the refutation of the two drafted laws): eleven (q, g) over $\mathbb{F}_3, \mathbb{F}_5, \mathbb{F}_7$, $n \leq 9$; the exact sign law and its periodic form and endpoint criteria (624/624); the corrected Frobenius blocks and $\text{str } \mathbb{E}^n = N_n$ against direct point counts in every case; the Clifford property of $E_g/\sqrt{q}$ with symplectic matrices matching the explicit formula matrix for matrix (orders 4, 3, 30); the character formula in 258/258 cases; and Prony on the genus-3 counts recovering the Frobenius eigenvalues with coefficient -1 .

30 Curve Counts as Twisted Ring Norms I: Inputs and the Supersingular Boundary

Question (TJO, 2026-09-14). The previous session realised the elliptic-curve count $N_n = 1 + q^n - \pi^n - \bar{\pi}^n$ as the P -closed ring norm of a bosonic tensor on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$ with π put in by hand. Wanted: for the absolute simplest variety without an *obvious* Polya–Hilbert (PH) Hamiltonian, (1) a natural tensor determined by the variety, (2) the graded decomposition of the bond and why, (3) a theorem that the ring norms are the counts, (4) the PH operator, (5) the Ramanujan property, all modulo gauge. In this notebook the obvious PH Hamiltonian is the quadratic Artin–Schreier transfer matrix (Section 29); Theorem 30.11 shows that family is supersingular, so the first ordinary variety is an elliptic curve. Genus one is Section 31, the bosonic no-go Section 32, genus two Section 33. Proofs by the codex prover (notes/ring-norm-tensor/astra-proofs.md, sections T0–T5), Opus REFUTE review (notes/reviews/ring-norm-tensor-2026-09-14.md: 0 INVALID, 3 MINOR, 2 MAJOR, all applied in these shards; the prover’s file is kept as written). The finite-bond input “the P -closed ring norm is $\text{str} \mathcal{E}_d^n$ ” is used in two halves (review MAJ-2): the algebraic identity $\text{str}_{\Gamma_b} \mathcal{E}_d^n = \sum_w |\text{Tr}(PA_w)|^2$, which is a two-line theorem for any letters (Kronecker multiplicativity) and is built into Definition 9.1, and the identification with the Fock norm of the physical fermion ring, which is Theorem 22.2 (sketched) and enters only Corollary 33.15; independent numerics in two scripts; sources byte-cited in notes/ring-norm-tensor/sources.md. Definitions in Section 9.

30.1 Inputs

Cited fact 30.1 (Point counts and the Frobenius quadratic, without the root sizes). [cited] Milne [76]: for a curve of genus g , $N_n = 1 + q^n - \sum_{j \leq 2g} \alpha_j^n$ with the α_j nonzero algebraic; Sutherland [86]: for an elliptic curve the Frobenius satisfies $\pi^2 - t\pi + q = 0$ with $t = q + 1 - \#E(\mathbb{F}_q)$. Verbatim: $N_{\{n\}} = 1 + q^{\{n\}} - (a_{\{1\}}^{\{n\}} + \dots + a_{\{2g\}}^{\{n\}})$. (1509.00797:prh.tex:176); and π_E satisfies the characteristic equation $\pi_E^2 - t\pi_E + q = 0$. (1208.5370:IsogenyVolcanoes.tex:35).

Cited fact 30.2 (Degree is a nonnegative quadratic form; $\deg \pi = q$; Hasse’s bound). [cited] Milne [76]: the degree of $m - n\alpha$ is nonnegative, so the discriminant of the Frobenius quadratic is ≤ 0 ; $d = \deg \pi = q$; $|\#E(k) - q - 1| \leq 2q^{1/2}$. Verbatim: The right hand side is the degree of the map $m - n\alpha$, which is always nonnegative, and so the discriminant $c^2 - 4d \leq 0$, i.e., $c^2 \leq 4d$. (1509.00797:prh.tex:241–242); Then $d = \deg(\pi) = q$, and $c^2 \leq 4d = 4q$. (1509.00797:prh.tex:248–249).

Cited fact 30.3 (Serre–Tate canonical lift and the lifted Frobenius on H_1). [cited] Goresky and Tai [37]: an ordinary abelian variety over $\mathbb{F}_q$ has a canonical lift over $W(k)$, hence a complex variety, and the Frobenius lifts to an endomorphism of $T = H_1(A_{\mathbb{C}}, \mathbb{Z})$. Verbatim: The geometric action of F on A lifts to an automorphism F_A on $[T = T_A = H_1(A_{\mathbb{C}}, \mathbb{Z})]$ (1701.07742:main).

Assumption 30.4 (Deuring lifting). [assumed] For $E/\mathbb{F}_q$ ordinary with Frobenius π and $\text{End}(E) = O$ there is an elliptic curve over a number field with good reduction to E at a prime above p , endomorphism ring O , reduction map an isomorphism on endomorphisms taking $\tilde{\pi}$ to π ; over $\mathbb{C}$ it is $\mathbb{C}/\Lambda$ with Λ a proper O -ideal and $\tilde{\pi}$ multiplication by the complex number π (Deuring 1941; the Serre–Tate form is cited fact 30.3).

Cited fact 30.5 (Degree of an ideal isogeny is the norm, i.e. the lattice index). [cited] Sutherland [86]. Verbatim: we have $\deg \varphi = N(\mathfrak{f}) = [\mathbb{Q}(\mathfrak{f}) : \mathbb{Q}]$. (1208.5370:IsogenyVolcanoes.tex:2).

Cited fact 30.6 (Toral Lefschetz count and dynamical zeta). [cited] Baake, Lau and Paskunas [3]: for $M \in \text{Mat}(d, \mathbb{Z})$ the number of isolated fixed points of M^m on $\mathbb{T}^d$ is $|\det(1 - M^m)|$ and the dynamical

ζ is the alternating product of $\det(1 - z\Lambda^k M)$. Verbatim: $a^{\{-\}_{\{m\}} = \lvert \det (\one - M^m) \rvert$. (0810.1855:main.tex:98); $\widetilde{\zeta}^{\{-\}_{\{M\}}(z) = \prod_{k=0}^d \det \bigl(\one - z \ep^k(M) \bigr)^{(-1)^{k+1}}$. (0810.1855:main.tex:199–200).

Cited fact 30.7 (Lenstra’s structure theorem). [cited] Springer [82], quoting Lenstra 1996, Theorem 1(a): for $\pi \notin \mathbb{Z}$, $R = \text{End}_{\mathbb{F}_q}(E)$ has rank 2 and $E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n}) \cong R/(\pi^n - 1)R$ as R -modules. Verbatim: $E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n}) \cong R/(\pi^n - 1)R$. (2006.00637:main.tex:103).

Cited fact 30.8 (Latimer–MacDuffee; Waterhouse’s torsor). [cited] Knight and Stasinski [57]: $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{Z})$ -similarity classes of integer matrices with irreducible characteristic polynomial f are in bijection with the ideal classes of $\mathbb{Z}[x]/(f)$. Sutherland [86]: the j -invariants of curves with $\text{End} \cong O$ form a torsor for $\text{cl}(O)$. Verbatim: and the ideal classes of the order $\mathbb{Z}[x]/(f(x))$. (2205.02094:main.tex:97); Provided it is non-empty, the set $\text{Ell}_{\emptyset}(k)$ is thus a principal homogeneous space, a *torsor*, for the group $\text{cl}(\emptyset)$. (1208.5370:IsogenyVolc).

Assumption 30.9 (Spectral versus Newton supersingularity). [assumed] An abelian variety over a finite field has all Newton slopes $\frac{1}{2}$ iff all its Frobenius eigenvalues are $\sqrt{q}$ times roots of unity; a curve is supersingular when its Jacobian is.

Assumption 30.10 (Analytic setting for the infinite-bond obstruction). [assumed] $H_{\pm}$ separable Hilbert spaces; at each $t > 0$ a normal completely positive map on $B(H_+ \oplus H_-)$ with a countable bounded block-diagonal Kraus family $K_s = a_s \oplus B_s$ and weakly convergent expansion, whose blocks on Hilbert–Schmidt operators extend to bounded $S_{\pm}(t)$, $M(t)$ with $S_{\pm}$ trace class; compression to finite bond subspaces agrees with compression of the Kraus expansion; the odd semigroup has the zeros as eigenmodes with multiplicity. Not established for any Riemann cMPS.

30.2 Where the obvious Polya–Hilbert Hamiltonian lives, and why it stops

Theorem 30.11 (The quadratic Artin–Schreier family is supersingular). [proved] For $q = p^r$, $J \geq 0$, $a_J \neq 0$, $g = \sum_{j \leq J} a_j x^{1+q^j}$, every Frobenius eigenvalue of the smooth model of $y^q - y = g(x)$ is $\sqrt{q}$ times a root of unity, for every p including $p = 2$; for $J = 0$ likewise in odd characteristic, while in characteristic two the $J = 0$ curve has genus zero.

Proof. Sketch (T0.2). $\text{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_{q^n}/\mathbb{F}_p}(bg(x))$ is a quadratic form on $\mathbb{F}_p^{rn}$ whose polar radical has dimension $\leq 2rJ$ (its kernel is the root set of a fixed q -linearised polynomial of degree q^{2J} , using that $b, a_j \in \mathbb{F}_q$ are fixed by $x \mapsto x^q$; review items m2, m3). Quadratic Gauss sums are 0 or of modulus $p^{(m+d)/2}$ with a phase in $\{\pm 1, \pm i\}$, so $S_{b,n}/q^{n/2}$ ranges over a finite set independent of n ; by Hilbert 90 so do the normalised Frobenius power sums, which then satisfy a linear recurrence with finitely many state vectors, hence are eventually periodic; a Vandermonde argument gives $(\alpha_j/\sqrt{q})^h = 1$. No root size is assumed. $\square$

Proposition 30.12 (Finite order of the quadratic transfer unitary). [proved-conditional] For q an odd prime, $E_g/\sqrt{q}$ has finite order: its Fourier factor has determinant a fourth root of unity, the phases and the register permutation have root-of-unity determinants, $W(M_g)^h = 1$ for M_g in the finite group $\text{Sp}(2J, \mathbb{F}_q)$, so the scalar c_g in $E_g/\sqrt{q} = c_g W(M_g)$ is a root of unity. Hence all eigenvalues of E_g are $\sqrt{q}$ times roots of unity (the orchestrator’s drafted argument “the entries are roots of unity” was insufficient: zero entries and the normalisation).

Proposition 30.13 (Cut rank of a ring amplitude). [proved] For $A_s \in M_D(\mathbb{C})$ the flattening rank of $\text{Tr}(A_{s_1} \cdots A_{s_n})$ across two contiguous arcs is at most D^2 , sharply (matrix units at $n = 2$), and at most D^b across a bipartition cutting b virtual edges; the drafted bound D is the open-chain bound.

Numerical result 30.14 (Binary cut ranks; supersingularity of the tested family; basis dependence).

[numerical] `scripts/ring_norm_tensor.py` (`outputs/ring_norm_tensor.txt`, N4; the prover's kernel is reproduced in `notes/ring-norm-tensor/scratch/t04_cutrank.py`). For all eleven (q, a) cases of Section 29 every eigenvalue of $E_g/\sqrt{q}$ is a root of unity. Over $\mathbb{F}_2$, $x^3 = x^{1+2}$ is a quadratic Frobenius form: in a self-dual normal basis (n odd) its cut rank stays ≤ 4 while the cubic $\text{Tr}(x^{1+2+4})$ has ranks 2, 4, 8, 16 at $n = 3, 5, 7, 9$ (over $\mathbb{F}_3$: ≤ 9 versus 1, 9, 27); in a plain normal basis even the quadratic amplitude grows (16 at $n = 10$). The prover's table with an n -dependent basis prescription reaches 16 at $n = 8$ for the quadratic form and left boundedness open; the reviewer closed it (MAJ-1): in a self-dual normal basis $\text{Tr}(x^3) = \text{Tr}(x \cdot x^2) = \sum_i x_i x_{i-1}$ is a cyclic nearest-neighbour form, so the contiguous-cut rank is at most $4 = D^2$ for every n (checked for $n = 3, 5, 6, 7, 9, 10, 11$; no self-dual normal basis exists over $\mathbb{F}_2$ for $n = 4, 8$). Cut rank is basis dependent.

Conjecture 30.15 (Restricted amplitude locality). *[conjectured] With a self-dual normal-basis prescription for every n and trace-invisible Artin–Schreier coboundaries quotiented out, a fixed finite lattice tensor with amplitudes $\psi(\text{Tr } g(x))$ for all n exists only when the trace function has quadratic degree over the prime field. This is a necessity conjecture about equation-local amplitudes; it says nothing against the finite ordinary norm tensors below, and the broad slogan “finite tensors give only supersingular zetas” is false (observation 33.22).*

31 Curve Counts as Twisted Ring Norms II: the Ordinary Elliptic Curve

Tier A of the campaign of Section 30; notation of Definitions 9.2 and 9.3; proofs in notes/ring-norm-tensor/astra-T1–T2.

31.1 Tier A: the ordinary elliptic curve

Theorem 31.1 (Frobenius on the lifted torus; the count is a ring norm). [proved-conditional]
With M the integral matrix of Definition 9.2, $\chi_M(X) = X^2 - aX + q$ and for every $n \geq 1$ the total endomorphism M^n has exactly $\det(1 - M^n) = |1 - \pi^n|^2 = N_{K/\mathbb{Q}}(1 - \pi^n) = N_n$ fixed points, all nondegenerate of index +1, so that $N_n = 1 - \text{Tr } M^n + \det M^n$ is the Lefschetz number; moreover $N_n = |O/(\pi^n - 1)O|$, the index of the principal ideal $(1 - \pi^n)$ in the ring O , which under cited fact 30.7 is the point group $E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ itself as an O -module.

Proof. Sketch (T1.1). π preserves Λ , so M is integral with eigenvalues $\pi, \bar{\pi}$, determinant $|\pi|^2 = q$ by cited facts 30.2 and 30.5 and trace a by cited fact 30.1. The fixed points of M^n form $\mathbb{Z}^2/(M^n - 1)\mathbb{Z}^2$ of order $|\det(M^n - 1)|$; $\det(1 - M^n) = (1 - \pi^n)(1 - \bar{\pi}^n) > 0$ gives the index. Lefschetz (cited fact 30.6) with the actions $1, M^T, q$ in degrees 0, 1, 2 gives the count. $\square$

Proposition 31.2 (Dynamical zeta equals Hasse–Weil zeta). [proved-conditional]
 $\exp(\sum_n \# \text{Fix}(M^n) u^n / n) = (1 - au + qu^2) / ((1 - u)(1 - qu)) = Z(E, u)$; by Möbius inversion the primitive periodic orbits of M on $\mathbb{T}^2$ of each length are equinumerous with the closed points of E of each degree, so the gas side and the transfer side are both carried by the dynamical system $(\mathbb{T}^2, M)$; the bijection is noncanonical.

Theorem 31.3 (Hodge doubling and the elliptic norm tensor). [proved-conditional] *On $\mathbb{C}/\Lambda$, $M^*dz = \pi dz$ and $M^*d\bar{z} = \bar{\pi}d\bar{z}$. The double of the Hodge ket bond is $H^*(\mathbb{T}^2, \mathbb{C})$ graded by form degree, with transfer $\mathcal{E}_d = \text{diag}(1, \bar{\pi}, \pi, q)$ in the basis $(1, d\bar{z}, dz, dz \wedge d\bar{z})$ and $\Gamma_b = \text{diag}(1, -1, -1, 1)$: $(+, +) = H^0$, the mixed lines are $H^{0,1}, H^{1,0}$, and $(-, -) = H^2$ with eigenvalue $\pi\bar{\pi} = q$, the degree. The elliptic norm tensor (Definition 9.3) is all-even, $\Psi_P(n) = (1 - \pi^n)\phi^{\otimes n}$, $\|\Psi_P(n)\|^2 = N_n$, the untwisted norm is $|1 + \pi^n|^2$, and the ring zeta is $Z(E, u)$. The fermionic modes are the odd-degree forms; the physical letters are bosonic; the physical state has Schmidt rank one and its configurations do not enumerate points.*

Proposition 31.4 (Fourier pullback is an injection with one finite orbit; the flat supertrace). [proved-conditional]
The pullback $U = M^$ on $L^2(\mathbb{T}^2) \otimes \Lambda^*(\mathbb{C}^2)$ sends $e_k \otimes \omega$ to $e_{M^T k} \otimes \Lambda^*(M^T)\omega$; $k \mapsto M^T k$ is injective of index q on $\mathbb{Z}^2$ (not a permutation), its only finite orbit is $\{0\}$, and the Fourier-diagonal flat supertrace $\sum_{M^n T k = k} \text{str } \Lambda^*(M^n) = \det(1 - M^n) = N_n$ is contributed by $k = 0$ alone. The infinite-label tensor $\mathbf{A}_k = |M^T k\rangle\langle k| \otimes \text{diag}(1, \pi)$ has P -closed ring vector $(1 - \pi^n)|0, \dots, 0\rangle$: an honest but redundant physical index; every closed ring except the vacuum mode vanishes.*

Theorem 31.5 (The Polya–Hilbert unitary and the ordinary Hasse bound). [proved-conditional]
On the flat torus the Hodge (L^2) metric on harmonic one-forms is scaled by $|\pi|^2$ under M^ on both $H^{1,0}$ and $H^{0,1}$, so $U_{\text{PH}} = q^{-1/2}M^*|_{H^1}$ is unitary iff $|\pi|^2 = q$, which is derived, not assumed: the lifted Frobenius is a conformal similarity whose oriented area ratio is its covering degree $[\Lambda : \pi\Lambda] = |\pi|^2$ (cited fact 30.5), and degree is preserved under good reduction with $\deg \text{Fr} = q$ (the clause $d = \deg(\pi) = q$ of cited fact 30.2, not its inequality; review m1). Hence the two nontrivial eigenvalues of $\mathcal{E}_d$ have modulus $\sqrt{q}$ (the Ramanujan property here) and $a^2 < 4q$, from the positive*

definite degree form $\deg(m + n\pi) = m^2 + amn + qn^2$; no root-size input is used. The real PH model $K \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{R} \cong \mathbb{C}$ with $\operatorname{Re}(x\bar{y})$ (the Rosati trace form up to the factor 2) is the real form of $H^1(\mathbb{T}^2, \mathbb{R})$, not the complex H^1 ; a self-adjoint logarithm needs a phase branch the curve does not specify.

Proposition 31.6 (Integral markings versus MPS gauge). *[proved-conditional] The integral matrix M changes by $\operatorname{GL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ conjugacy under a change of lattice basis; its class is an ideal-lattice class of $\mathbb{Z}[\pi]$ (cited fact 30.8, all full ideal lattices, not only invertible ones) whose multiplier order is the endomorphism order, and the ordinary classification is recovered as Waterhouse’s torsor (indexed by j -invariants, up to quadratic twist; review m4). Complex spectral data forget these classes: all matrices in the isogeny class are $\operatorname{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ -conjugate, the cohomology matrix is M^T on the dual lattice, and the unitary gauge is the Hodge basis. The even ket gauge $G \in \operatorname{GL}(1|1)$ acts on $\mathcal{E}_{\mathbf{d}}$ by $G \otimes \bar{G}$ and fixes all ring norms; exchanging the two Hodge embeddings is not an even gauge.*

31.2 Digits in base π

Proposition 31.7 (Ordinary digit expansions, cyclic fibres, bounded carries). *[proved] With D a residue system of $O/\pi O$ ($|D| = q$), every class of $O/\pi^n O$ has a unique expansion $\sum_{i < n} d_i \pi^i$. The cyclic map $D^n \rightarrow O/(\pi^n - 1)O$ need not be onto (for $O = \mathbb{Z}[i]$, $\pi = 1 + 2i$, $D = \{0, \pm 1, \pm 2\}$ the target $O/(2i)$ has four classes and the digits hit two; $|1 - \pi^2|^2 = 32 > 25$ excludes surjectivity at $n = 2$ for any five digits; this is $y^2 = x^3 + x$ over $\mathbb{F}_5$). Two words have the same image iff they admit integral cyclic carries $d_i - e_i = \pi c_{i+1} - c_i$, $c_n = c_0$, which are unique and bounded by $|c_i| \leq \max_{d,e} |d - e|/(\sqrt{q} - 1)$: the cyclic equivalence relation has a finite carry automaton.*

Proposition 31.8 (What finite carries do not count). *[proved] No finite weighted adjacency matrix and no trace-class operator has power traces N_n (Theorem 18.15), so no automaton with nonnegative transition counts counts the classes of $O/(\pi^n - 1)$ by its unweighted rings; the carry automaton recognises equality of represented words and does not count classes with weight one. A graded signed transfer (diag(1, q) even, M odd) has supertrace N_n but is not by itself a doubled-Kraus factorisation; the elliptic norm tensor supplies that. The drafted “carries must be unbounded” was wrong: cyclic carries are bounded here.*

32 Curve Counts as Twisted Ring Norms III: the Bosonic No-Go

Notation of Definition 9.1; proofs in notes/ring-norm-tensor/astra-proofs.md T3.

32.1 The bosonic no-go and its bookkeeping

Observation 32.1 (The orchestrator's drafted bound was false). [sketched] The 2026-09-14 morning draft claimed $\sum_{\text{odd}} |\mu|^2 \leq 2 \text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_{d++} \text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_{d--}$ for bosonic tensors, and its script computed $\sum_s \|a_s\|_{\text{HS}}^2$ while calling it a trace. Since $\text{Tr}(A \otimes \bar{A}) = |\text{Tr } A|^2$, one even letter $a = B = \text{diag}(1, -1)$ on $\mathbb{C}^{2|2}$ has both traces zero and odd squared eigenvalue sum 8; the prover and the numerics lane found the error independently (173 of 400 random instances violate it). The genus bound survives by Theorem 32.4.

Theorem 32.2 (Block structure and the correct Hilbert–Schmidt bounds). [proved] For all-even tensors $A_s = a_s \oplus B_s$ on $\mathbb{C}^{m|k}$: $\mathcal{E}_{\text{deven}} = S_+ \oplus S_-$ with $S_+ = \sum a_s \otimes \bar{a}_s$, $S_- = \sum B_s \otimes \bar{B}_s$, and $\mathcal{E}_{\text{dodd}} = M \oplus \bar{M}$ with $M = \sum_s a_s \otimes \bar{B}_s$. Then $\sum_{\text{odd}} |\mu|^2 = 2 \sum_{\text{spec } M} |\mu|^2 \leq 2 \|M\|_{\text{HS}}^2 \leq 2(\sum_s \|a_s\|_{\text{HS}}^2)(\sum_s \|B_s\|_{\text{HS}}^2)$ and $\|M\|_{\text{HS}}^2 \leq \|S_+\|_{\text{HS}} \|S_-\|_{\text{HS}}$ (Gram-matrix Cauchy–Schwarz); $\text{Tr } S_{\pm} = \sum_s |\text{Tr } a_s|^2, \sum_s |\text{Tr } B_s|^2$. Schur's inequality is proved from triangularisation.

Lemma 32.3 (All-power word-trace inequality). [proved] With $s_{\pm}(n) = \text{Tr } S_{\pm}^n = \sum_w |\text{Tr } a_w|^2, \sum_w |\text{Tr } B_w|^2$ over words w of length n and $\text{Tr } M^n = \sum_w \text{Tr } a_w \text{Tr } \bar{B}_w$: $s_{\pm}(n) \geq 0$ and $|\text{Tr } M^n|^2 \leq s_+(n)s_-(n)$ for every n , with equality iff the two word-trace vectors are proportional.

Theorem 32.4 (Bosonic species cannot pass genus one). [proved-conditional] If the nonzero even spectrum is exactly $\{1, q\}$ with no even–odd cancellation and the odd spectrum is $2g$ values of modulus $\sqrt{q}$, $g \geq 1$, then $g \leq 1$ and $\{\text{Tr } S_+, \text{Tr } S_-\} = \{1, q\}$. For $m = k = 1$ and $g = 1$ the two coefficient vectors are proportional, giving Definition 9.3; for larger m, k literal matrix proportionality and normality are false (nilpotent transients, nonunitary gauges).

Proof. Sketch (T3.3). A block with no nonzero eigenvalue has $s_{\pm}(n) = 0$ for all n , so Lemma 32.3 makes $\text{Tr } M^n = 0$ for all n and M nilpotent, contradicting the nonempty odd spectrum; so each block carries one of $1, q$ and $s_+(n)s_-(n) = q^n$. Writing the g eigenvalues of M as $\sqrt{q}\beta_j$, $|\beta_j| = 1$, the inequality reads $|\sum_j \beta_j^n|^2 \leq 1$; the Cesàro mean of the left side over $n \leq N$ tends to $\sum_i m_i^2 \geq g$, so $g \leq 1$. $\square$

Proposition 32.5 (Euler characteristic bookkeeping and the minimal bond). [proved] If a graded tensor on $\mathbb{C}^{m|k}$ has $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_{\text{d}}^n = N_n$ for all n with net spectrum $\{1, q\}_+ - \{\alpha_{1..2g}\}_-$, and z_e, z_o count zero eigenvalues, then $(m - k)^2 - (z_e - z_o) = 2 - 2g$; necessarily $mk \geq g$; if the odd dimension is exactly $2g$ then $mk = g$, no odd zero modes, no cancellation, and $m^2 + k^2 - 2$ nilpotent even modes ($g^2 - 1$ on $\mathbb{C}^{1|g}$). The minimal bond dimension is $\min\{m + k : mk \geq g\}$, not generally $g + 1$; at genus two it is three.

Proposition 32.6 (Odd species and cancellation evade the bound). [proved] Odd letters add blocks $\sum_f c_f \otimes \bar{c}_f, \sum_f d_f \otimes \bar{d}_f$ between $(+, +)$ and $(-, -)$ (zero trace at length one, nonzero in higher powers) and $\sum_f c_f \otimes \bar{d}_f$ between the mixed sectors, so $\mathcal{E}_{\text{dodd}}$ is no longer $M \oplus \bar{M}$. With all-even letters and a cancelling multiset X : $s_+(n) + s_-(n) = 1 + q^n + \sum_X x^n$ and $|\sum_j \alpha_j^n + \sum_X x^n| \leq 2\sqrt{s_+(n)s_-(n)}$, which bounds nothing independent of X . Fermionic letters are therefore necessary on the minimal genus-two bond $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$ (no room to cancel), not on every larger bond; the failed bosonic $\mathbb{C}^{2|2}$ search is no certificate.

Theorem 32.7 (Infinite bond: bosonic species cannot carry the zeros). [proved-conditional]
Under assumption 30.10 and assumption 18.6, if the odd eigenmodes at time t include $e^{t\mu_\rho}$ over the nontrivial zeros (with $\mu_\rho = \rho$ or $-\bar{\rho}/2$), then $\sum_\rho e^{2t\operatorname{Re}\mu_\rho} \leq \|\mathcal{E}_{\text{odd}}(t)\|_{\text{HS}}^2 \leq 2\|S_+(t)\|_{\text{HS}}\|S_-(t)\|_{\text{HS}} < \infty$, which is impossible because the left side diverges; hence such a purely bosonic Kraus realisation does not exist and fermionic jumps are necessary in that setting. The trace version $2\operatorname{Tr} S_+ \operatorname{Tr} S_-$ needs $S_\pm$ positive on the Hilbert–Schmidt spaces, which complete positivity alone does not give.

Numerical result 32.8 (Ring norms of real curves; the false bound; the repaired chain). [numerical]
scripts/weil_ring_norm_check.py (**outputs/weil_ring_norm_check.txt**, 135 checks, author claude:fable-5.1): brute-force counts of four elliptic curves over $\mathbb{F}_5, \mathbb{F}_7, \mathbb{F}_{11}$ against $|1 - \pi^n|^2$, $\operatorname{str} \mathcal{E}_d^n$, the explicit vector $\Psi_P = \Psi_+ - \Psi_-$ with $\Psi_- = \pi^n \Psi_+$ (Schmidt rank one), the untwisted $|1 + \pi^n|^2$; the decoupled-block Cauchy–Schwarz statement; the Hilbert–Schmidt chain of Theorem 32.2 on random $\mathbb{C}^{m|k}$ (its printed labels are the Hilbert–Schmidt sums, see the docstring); the genus-two searches of Section 33; the $y^3 - y = x^2$ indicator state matching the count only at odd n .

Numerical result 32.9 (Toral Frobenius, Lenstra structure, gauge and dichotomy). [numerical]
scripts/ring_norm_tensor.py (**outputs/ring_norm_tensor.txt**, 193 checks, author claude:opus-5, 562 s): for four ordinary curves, $N_n = |\det(M^n - 1)| = 1 - \operatorname{Tr} M^n + \det M^n$, the fixed points enumerated by Smith normal form all of index +1, $k \mapsto M^T k$ with no periodic point but 0 in $[-50, 50]^2$ up to period 12, the dynamical zeta to order u^8 , $|\pi|^2 = q$ and $M^\dagger G M = qG$ in the Hodge basis; the group structure of $E(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ by brute force against the invariant factors of $O_K/(\pi^n - 1)$ for $n \leq 3$; the refutation of the drafted trace bound and the validity of the Hilbert–Schmidt chain on 400 random instances; the genus-two items of numerical result 33.14; the supersingularity and cut-rank items of numerical result 30.14.

33 Curve Counts as Twisted Ring Norms IV: Genus Two

Tier B of the campaign of Section 30: the first case where fermionic letters are forced (Proposition 32.6). Notation of Definitions 9.4 and 9.5; proofs in notes/ring-norm-tensor/astra-proofs.md T4–T5.

33.1 Inputs

Cited fact 33.1 (Rosati positivity and $\pi\pi^\dagger = q$). [cited]
Milne [76], Theorem: the Rosati involution on $\text{End}^0(A)$ is positive, $(\alpha, \beta) \mapsto \text{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{Q}}(\alpha \circ \beta^\dagger)$ positive definite; and $\pi \circ \pi^\dagger = q_A$. Verbatim: `\={\rm End}^{\sim\{0\}}(A)$ is positive, i.e., the pairing (1509.00797:prh.tex:1559); This will follow from (\ref{r39}) once we show that $\pi \circ \pi^\dagger = q_A$. This can be proved by a direct calculation, but it is more (1509.00797:prh.tex:1647-1648).`

Cited fact 33.2 (CM lift: eigenvalues of modulus $\sqrt{q}$, CM type with positivity; $\mathbb{Q}(\pi)$ is CM). [cited] Goresky and

Tai [37]: the lifted Frobenius is semisimple with eigenvalues of magnitude $\sqrt{q}$, and the lift carries a CM type Φ on $\mathbb{Q}[F]$ with a positivity condition; Dupuy, Kedlaya, Roe and Vincent [26]: $\mathbb{Q}(\pi)$ is a CM field. Verbatim: `\item The mapping F is semisimple and all of its eigenvalues in $\mathbb{C}$ have magnitude (1701.07742:main.tex:565); and where Φ is a CM type on $\mathbb{Q}[F]$ such that the following {\em positivity condition} holds: (1701.07742:main.tex:604-605), \item $\mathbb{Q}(\pi)$ is a CM-field with maximal totally real subfield $\mathbb{Q}(\beta)$, and π has no real embeddings; (2003.05380:weil.tex:332).`

Cited fact 33.3 (Positivity of the Hodge form on holomorphic one-forms). [cited] Lesfari [65]: for a holomorphic one-form $\omega = f dz$ on a compact Riemann surface, $\omega \wedge \bar{\omega} = -2i|f|^2 dx \wedge dy$ and $i \int \omega \wedge \bar{\omega} > 0$ for $\omega \neq 0$. Verbatim: `$$\omega \wedge \overline{\omega} = -2i|f|^2 dx \wedge dy.$$ (0903.2156:main.tex:1254); &=&\int_X |f|^2 dx \wedge dy > 0, \quad \omega \neq 0, \nonumber (0903.2156:main.tex:1262).`

Assumption 33.4 (CM type and the Hodge decomposition of the canonical lift). [assumed]

For a simple ordinary abelian variety $A/\mathbb{F}_q$ of dimension g with Frobenius π , $K = \mathbb{Q}(\pi)$ is a CM field of degree $2g$, $\text{End}(A) \otimes \mathbb{Q} = K$, and $H^1(\tilde{A}(\mathbb{C}), \mathbb{C}) = \bigoplus_{\phi: K \rightarrow \mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C}_\phi$ with $H^{1,0} = \bigoplus_{\phi \in \Phi} \mathbb{C}_\phi$ for a CM type Φ , $\tilde{\pi}$ acting on $\mathbb{C}_\phi$ by $\phi(\pi)$ (Shimura–Taniyama; the eigenspace statement is not quotable from the fetched TeX, cf. cited fact 33.2).

Assumption 33.5 (Polarised lift, Hodge adjunction, Jacobian comparison; abelian cohomology; real closed transfer; functoriality). [assumed]

(i) A polarisation lifts along the canonical lift and identifies Rosati adjunction with adjunction for the positive Hodge form on $H^{1,0}$; for $i: C \hookrightarrow J$, $i^*: H^1(J) \rightarrow H^1(C)$ is an isomorphism, $[C]$ is the principal polarisation in dimension two, $\int_C i^* \xi = \int_J \xi \smile [C]$ and $\int_J \theta^2 = 2$. (ii) $H^*(A) = \Lambda^* H^1(A)$ with Frobenius acting by exterior powers and $\#A(\mathbb{F}_{q^n}) = \det(1 - F^n | H^1)$. (iii) A finite system of real polynomial equalities and inequalities over the real algebraic numbers with a real solution has a real algebraic solution. (iv) Frobenius characteristic polynomials are multiplicative in exact sequences of abelian varieties; ordinarity is preserved by finite base extension.

33.2 The block equations and two impossibilities

Lemma 33.6 (Block equations on $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$). [proved] In the notation of Definition 9.4, $\mathcal{E}_{\text{dodd}} = \begin{pmatrix} M & N \\ N & M \end{pmatrix}$ and $\mathcal{E}_{\text{even}} = \begin{pmatrix} t & u \\ v & w \end{pmatrix}$; equivalently the complete positive

map is $x \oplus X \mapsto (tx + \sum_f c_f X c_f^*) \oplus (\sum_f d_f x d_f^* + \sum_s B_s X B_s^*)$ on even operators, with no Koszul sign.

Proposition 33.7 (The literal placement and the vacuum ansatz are impossible). *[proved-conditional]* If the odd spectrum is the four Frobenius values and the even spectrum $\{1, q, 0, 0, 0\}$, then the pure trace line $0 \oplus 1_2$ is not a q -eigenvector and the vacuum line is not invariant (either would force all $c_f = 0$ or all $d_f = 0$, delete the odd letters without changing the spectra, and contradict Theorem 32.4); both coupling directions must occur. The drafted ansatz $a_1 = 1, B_1 = 0, a_2 = 0, B_2 = B$ makes $M = 0$, so one odd letter gives $\text{rank} \leq 2$ and any number gives a spectrum symmetric under $z \mapsto -z$ with zero trace; it fails for every curve with $e_1 \neq 0$.

33.3 Existence

Theorem 33.8 (The nine-letter tensor for $q + 1 \geq 4\sqrt{q}$). *[proved-conditional]* For $|\pi_j|^2 = q$ and $q + 1 \geq 4\sqrt{q}$ (every prime power $q \geq 16$) the nine-letter tensor of Definition 9.5 has $\text{spec } \mathcal{E}_{\text{even}} = \{1, q, 0, 0, 0\}$ with the three zero modes the traceless 2×2 operators killed in one step, $\mathcal{E}_{\text{odd}} = \text{diag}(\bar{D}, D)$, a normal transfer in an orthonormal doubled basis, and $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_{\text{d}}^n = 1 + q^n - \sum_j (\pi_j^n + \bar{\pi}_j^n) = N_n(C)$ for every n , ring zeta $Z(C, u)$. The even letters realise the depolarising map $\sum_\ell B_\ell X B_\ell^* = w \text{Tr}(X) 1_2$, the odd letters couple vacuum and trace, and on $\text{span}(\text{vac}, 1_2/\sqrt{2})$ the even block is $\begin{pmatrix} (q+1)/2 & (q-1)/2 \\ (q-1)/2 & (q+1)/2 \end{pmatrix}$ with eigenvalues $q, 1$ and eigenvectors $(\pm\sqrt{2}, 1_2)$: neither is the pure vacuum nor the pure polarisation line. On $\mathbb{C}^{1|g}$ the same works with $w = (q + 1)/(2g)$, $h = (q - 1)/(2\sqrt{g})$ whenever $q + 1 \geq 2g\sqrt{q}$. Entries are algebraic over $\mathbb{Q}(\pi_1, \pi_2)$; the letters have no equation-local meaning and their number is not claimed minimal.

Proposition 33.9 (Base change of the $\mathbb{F}_5$ curve to $\mathbb{F}_{25}$). *[proved-conditional]* For $C: y^2 = x^5 + x^3 + x^2 - 2$ over $\mathbb{F}_5$, $\chi_F = z^4 - 3z^3 + 7z^2 - 15z + 25$ (matching the counts 3, 31, 117, 619); over $\mathbb{F}_{25}$, $\chi_{F^2} = z^4 + 5z^3 + 9z^2 + 125z + 625$, the nine-letter tensor applies, and the first six norms are 31, 619, 15991, 390739, 9759526, 244128859. Both quartics are irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}$ (reduction mod 2), so both Jacobians are simple over their fields; ordinarity is preserved.

Proposition 33.10 (The three-letter problem is a finite real feasibility problem). *[proved-conditional]* Two even and one odd letter on $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$ realise $N_n(C)$ for all n iff $\det(z - \mathcal{E}_{\text{even}}) = z^3(z - 1)(z - q)$ and $\det(z - \mathcal{E}_{\text{odd}}) = \chi_F(z)$ (28 real unknowns; Proposition 32.5 forbids cancellation on this bond), and then an algebraic solution exists. Least-squares residuals and four-digit printouts certify nothing; only Theorem 33.11 does.

Theorem 33.11 (A certified two-even, one-odd tensor for the $\mathbb{F}_5$ curve). *[proved-conditional]* There are two even and one odd letter on $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$ with $\chi_e = z^3(z - 1)(z - 5)$ and $\chi_o = z^4 - 3z^3 + 7z^2 - 15z + 25$, hence P -closed ring norm $N_n(C)$ for every $n \geq 1$. The entries are the unique zero, in the box $\|y - y_0\|_\infty \leq 10^{-30}$ around a rational centre y_0 (nine free real coordinates, the other nineteen frozen rationals), of the nine power-trace equations $f(y) = (\text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_{\text{even}}^n - (1 + 5^n))_{n \leq 5}, (\text{Tr } \mathcal{E}_{\text{odd}}^n - p_n)_{n \leq 4}$; a rational approximate inverse B of $Df(y_0)$ satisfies, by exact rational comparison, $\|B\|_\infty < 2$, $\|Bf(y_0)\|_\infty < 10^{-70}$, $\|1 - BDf(y_0)\|_\infty < 10^{-50}$, and with the uniform Hessian bound 10^{16} the map $y \mapsto y - Bf(y)$ contracts the box into itself. Newton's identities turn the nine traces into the two characteristic polynomials. The entries are algebraic (unique real point of a rational semialgebraic set). This is a computer-assisted existence proof for one curve, not a formula.

Conjecture 33.12 (Universal three-letter tensor). *[conjectured]* For every ordinary simple genus-two curve the feasibility problem of Proposition 33.10 has a solution;

and some solution is selected naturally by the equation or the polarised CM data. Both parts are open; failed smaller-alphabet searches prove no lower bound on the number of letters.

Numerical result 33.13 (Certificate, nine-letter tensor, Fock-vector norms). [numerical]
`scripts/ring_norm_certificate.py` (`outputs/ring_norm_certificate.txt`, 65 checks): the rational certificate of Theorem 33.11 re-run in exact arithmetic ($\|B\|_\infty = 1.499$, residual 1.0×10^{-90} , inverse defect 3.5×10^{-58} , $\kappa = 1.2 \times 10^{-12}$); the certified centre in floating point gives χ_e, χ_o to 10^{-9} , $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_d^n = N_n$ for $n \leq 12$, and the explicit Jordan–Wigner Fock vector has norm N_n and periodic-translation invariance for $n = 2, \dots, 5$; the nine-letter tensor at $q = 25$ (the base change), 17, 16 has even spectrum $\{1, q, 0, 0, 0\}$, odd spectrum the four inputs, normality 10^{-15} , $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_d^n = N_n$ to 10^{-15} for $n \leq 8$, and fails at $q = 13$ exactly as $q + 1 < 4\sqrt{q}$.

Numerical result 33.14 (Structured genus-two solutions: the CM-diagonal ansatz). [numerical]
`scripts/ring_norm_tensor.py`, N3: on the $\mathbb{F}_5$ curve, two even and one odd letter reach residual 10^{-24} (the seed of Theorem 33.11); a vacuum letter with one odd letter never converges (every search stalls at $t \rightarrow q$, $\text{spec } M \rightarrow \{\bar{\pi}_j\}$); a vacuum letter with two odd letters, and the CM-diagonal ansatz $A_s = \text{diag}(a_s, b_{s,1}, b_{s,2})$ (all even letters simultaneously diagonal, the direct lift of Definition 9.3) with two odd letters, both solve it to 10^{-25} with even spectrum $\{1, 5, 0, 0, 0\}$; in every solution $M \neq \text{diag}(\bar{\pi}_j)$ and $|m_i|^2 \neq q$, and the solution set is positive dimensional ($t = \sum |a_s|^2$ varies between restarts; only $t + \text{Tr } W = 1 + q$ and $2 \text{Re Tr } M = e_1$ are pinned). The three nilpotent modes appear numerically at $|z| \sim 10^{-4}$, the cube root of the residual. The Jacobian identity and the curve subspace of Proposition 33.16 check for $n \leq 6$.

Corollary 33.15 (The genus-two ring norms are Hilbert norms of fermionic ring states). [sketched-conditional]
By Theorem 22.2 on the lattice, the supertraces of Theorems 33.8 and 33.11 are the squared norms of the physical periodic-fermion rings built from the letters; the explicit Jordan–Wigner check of numerical result 33.13 confirms this for $n \leq 5$. The count of a genus-two curve is therefore literally the norm of a graded matrix product state with a three-dimensional bond and a fermionic letter.

33.4 Jacobian, Rosati metric, gauge

Proposition 33.16 (Jacobian product states and the curve projector). [proved-conditional] *The tensor product of two elliptic norm tensors $\text{diag}(1, \pi_j)$ on the ket $V_J = \Lambda^* H^{1,0} = \mathbb{C}^{2|2}$ has P -closed ring norm $\prod_j |1 - \pi_j^n| = \#J(\mathbb{F}_{q^n})$ and double $H^*(J) = \Lambda^* H^1(J)$. Inside it the Frobenius-invariant graded subspace $\mathcal{S} = \mathbb{C}1 \oplus H^1(J) \oplus \mathbb{C}\omega$, $\omega = e_1 \wedge f_1 + e_2 \wedge f_2$ a polarisation class with $F\omega = q\omega$, has $\text{str } F^n|_{\mathcal{S}} = N_n(C)$; the principal class restricts to $2[\text{pt}]$ on C . The projector onto $\mathcal{S}$ (rank six) is not of the form $B \otimes \bar{B}'$ (a product range would have dimension ≥ 9): extracting the curve from the Jacobian ring needs a non-product boundary, which the single fermionic rings above avoid. This does not say every boundary with the same scalar counts is that projector.*

Theorem 33.17 (Rosati positivity gives the moduli and the Polyá–Hilbert metric). [proved-conditional]
For a simple ordinary polarised abelian variety, the Rosati involution acts as complex conjugation on each factor of $K \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{R} \cong \prod_{j \leq g} \mathbb{C}$ (a primitive idempotent sent elsewhere or ie_j fixed would contradict $\text{Tr}(xx^\dagger) > 0$), so $\pi\pi^\dagger = q$ gives $|\phi_j(\pi)|^2 = q$ at every place and $q^{-1/2}\bar{\pi}^$ is unitary on $H^{1,0}$ and on $H^1(\tilde{J}, \mathbb{C})$ with their Hodge metrics: the ordinary simple instance of the root sizes from positivity, with no use of assumption 18.17. The PH models $H^1(\tilde{J}, \mathbb{R})$, $K \otimes \mathbb{R}$ with the Rosati trace form, and the realification of $H^{1,0}$ agree up to positive weights and the CM type. In Theorem 33.8 the odd block is $\sqrt{q}$ times a unitary by construction, so RH is manifest only after the moduli are supplied; the arithmetic proof of those moduli is Rosati (Hodge index on $C \times C$), not complete positivity of a transfer. For the certified tensor the distinct odd roots give complex similarity to $\sqrt{5}$ times a unitary;*

whether that similarity is an even ket gauge carrying the arithmetic Hodge metric is not determined by the count equations.

Proposition 33.18 (Gauge and the CM-type marking). [proved-conditional] *The even gauge $G = \text{diag}(g_0, H)$, $H \in \text{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})$, acts by $B_s \mapsto HB_sH^{-1}$, $c_f \mapsto g_0c_fH^{-1}$, $d_f \mapsto Hd_fg_0^{-1}$ and fixes all ring norms; same-parity unitary rotations of the letters fix $\mathcal{E}_d$ itself. The CM type is a marking: replacing a selected π_j by $\bar{\pi}_j$ changes the mixed-sector eigenvalues of Theorem 33.8 and is not an even gauge; a coupled solution with $N \neq 0$ mixes the two coherences and its counts do not recover a marked half. The unitary gauge is an orthonormal Hodge basis.*

33.5 Assessment for the Phantasm (observations, not theorems)

Observation 33.19 (Candidate bond; conjugation is not the functional equation). [sketched-conditional]
A plausible ket is $\mathbb{C} \oplus H_{>0}$ with one odd mode per positive-height zero, the bra supplying conjugates; its $(-, -)$ sector is far larger than the pole sector and what kills or regularises those modes is unspecified. Ket/bra exchange is complex conjugation; the functional equation also involves $\rho \mapsto 1 - \rho$, which coincides with conjugation on each pair only on the critical line, so reading the functional equation as ket/bra exchange would assume RH.

Observation 33.20 (Fermionic jumps are necessary in the stated setting; sufficiency open). [sketched-conditional]
Theorem 32.7 excludes the all-even Kraus class under assumption 30.10. It does not follow that odd jumps suffice, that finitely many do, or that a distributional regularisation is a Hilbert norm; Theorem 22.2 is a finite-bond statement.

Observation 33.21 (What the toral example contributes and where the analogy breaks). [sketched-conditional]
For an ordinary elliptic curve the lifted Frobenius is an injective Fourier shift whose only finite cycle is the zero label and the flat Lefschetz supertrace sits in that fibre; the physical state is one configuration. This is no principle that every variety's tensor is a permutation: the shift is not surjective, and for an abelian surface the torus counts the Jacobian, not the curve. No lifted Riemann dynamics, positive Hodge/Rosati metric or physical-label construction is established; that missing dynamics and positivity is the substantive break.

Observation 33.22 (The locality dichotomy must be restricted). [sketched-conditional] “Fixed finite lattice tensors give only supersingular zetas” is false: Theorem 31.3 and Theorem 33.8 are finite ordinary norm tensors. Only the equation-local amplitude question survives as conjecture 30.15. Infinitely many zeros and dilation time motivate an infinite-bond cMPS, but supply none of the domains, regularised trace, tensor factorisation or positivity it would need.

34 Curve Counts as Twisted Ring Norms V: Explicit Examples, Entanglement, Parent Hamiltonians

Question (TJO, 2026-09-14, evening). How hard is it to describe a specific example of each genus and write down the actual matrices of the corresponding MPS; and what are their usual entanglement properties and parent Hamiltonians? *Answer.* Genus 0 and 1 are one-liners, genus 2 is the closed form of Theorem 33.8 for $q \geq 16$ and the certified decimals of Theorem 33.11 below that, and every genus g is the same closed form on $\mathbb{C}^{1|g}$ once $q + 1 \geq 2g\sqrt{q}$; the only input at every genus is the L -polynomial (brute-force counts $N_1, \dots, N_g$, Newton's identities, the functional equation). Everything below is the notebook's own calculation (`scripts/ring_norm_examples.py`, author claudes:fable-5.1, unreviewed); the contraction is the Kronecker one of Definition 9.1, with the fermionic reading checked against explicit Jordan–Wigner vectors.

34.1 The five states

Definition 34.1 (The example states). All rings are P -closed unless stated. (0) $\mathbb{P}^1/\mathbb{F}_5$: bond $\mathbb{C}^2$ ungraded, letters $\{\infty\} \cup \mathbb{F}_5$, $A_\infty = e_{11}$, $A_s = e_{22}$ for $s \in \mathbb{F}_5$; $\Psi = |\infty\rangle^{\otimes n} + \sum_{s \in \mathbb{F}_5^n} |s\rangle$, $\|\Psi\|^2 = 1 + 5^n$; the configurations are the points. (1) $y^2 = x^3 + x + 1/\mathbb{F}_5$: $N_1 = 9$, $a = -3$, $\pi = (-3 + i\sqrt{11})/2$; bond $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$, letters $A_s = \phi_s \text{diag}(1, \pi)$ with $\phi = (1, 1)/\sqrt{2}$, $P = \text{diag}(1, -1)$; the same Frobenius as the toral endomorphism $M = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -5 \\ 1 & -3 \end{pmatrix}$. (2a) $y^2 = x^5 + x^3 + x^2 - 2/\mathbb{F}_5$: the certified letters of Theorem 33.11, two even, one odd, bond $\mathbb{C}^{1|2}$. (2b) the same curve over $\mathbb{F}_{25}$ (eigenvalues π_j^2): the nine-letter tensor with $t = 13$, $w = 13/2$, $h = 6\sqrt{2}$. (3) $y^2 = x^7 + x + 1/\mathbb{F}_{37}$: counts 41, 1455, 50915, six Frobenius eigenvalues of modulus $\sqrt{37}$; the closed form on $\mathbb{C}^{1|3}$ with ten even and six odd 4×4 letters, $t = 19$, $w = 19/3$, $h = 6\sqrt{3}$; $\mathbb{F}_{37}$ is the smallest prime field with $q + 1 \geq 6\sqrt{q}$.

Proposition 34.2 (Correlation lengths: RH as a single odd correlation length). *[sketched-conditional]* For every graded tensor whose doubled transfer has net even spectrum $\{1, q\}$ and odd spectrum the Frobenius eigenvalues, the dominant eigenvalue is q , the even correlation length is $1/\log q$, and the correlation length of an odd mode α_j is $1/\log(q/|\alpha_j|)$; hence RH for the curve is the statement that every odd (fermionic) mode has the same correlation length $2/\log q$, twice the even one. In the five examples this holds to 10^{-6} (numerical result 34.6).

Proof. Immediate from the spectra; the modulus $|\alpha_j| = \sqrt{q}$ is assumption 18.17. $\square$

34.2 Entanglement

Proposition 34.3 (Block Schmidt spectrum of a twisted ring from the doubled bond). *[sketched]* For a graded tensor on a bond of dimension D with Kronecker contraction, the reduced state of a contiguous block of l sites in the P -closed ring of length n has at most D^2 nonzero Schmidt weights, equal to the spectrum of the $D^2 \times D^2$ matrix $K G_X^T$ with $G_X[(ab), (a'b')] = (\mathcal{E}_d^l)_{(aa'), (bb')}$ and $K[(ab), (a'b')] = (\mathcal{E}_d^{n-l} \Gamma_b)_{(bb'), (aa')}$, normalised by the ring norm; hence the block entanglement entropy is at most $2 \log D$. For a contiguous block starting at the first site the fermionic (Jordan–Wigner) reduced state has the same spectrum, because the string acting on the block is a parity sign, a unitary on the block.

Proof. Write $\Psi_P = \sum_{ab} X_{ab} \otimes Y_{ba}$ with $X_{ab} = \sum_w (A_w)_{ab} |w\rangle$ over the block and $Y_{ba} = \sum_{w'} (A_{w'} P)_{ba} |w'\rangle$ over the rest; then $\rho_{\text{block}} = \sum K_{\alpha\beta} |X_\alpha\rangle \langle X_\beta|$ with K the Gram matrix of the Y , and on coefficient vectors ρ acts as $K G_X^T$. The Gram matrices are the stated entries of $\mathcal{E}_d^l$ and $\mathcal{E}_d^{n-l}(P \otimes \bar{P})$. Checked against explicit vectors in numerical result 34.6. $\square$

Observation 34.4 (What the entanglement looks like at each genus).

[sketched]

Genus 0: the state is a cat state of two orthogonal product states with weights 1 and 5^n , so every block has Schmidt rank two and entropy $H(1/(1+5^n))$, which vanishes exponentially; the parent Hamiltonian is two-fold degenerate (both branches), as for a GHZ state. Genus 1: $\Psi_P = (1-\pi^n)\phi^{\otimes n}$ is a product state; the two bond lines carry the same physical vector, so the count is entirely in the normalisation and the entanglement is zero. Genus 2 (certified letters over $\mathbb{F}_5$): Schmidt rank $9 = D^2$ for every half-ring, entropy saturating at 1.6636 for $n \geq 20$ (bound $2 \log 3 = 2.197$), largest weights 0.380, 0.199, 0.199, 0.105. Genus 2 (nine letters over $\mathbb{F}_{25}$): the half-ring spectrum is exactly $\{\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{8}^{\times 4}, \frac{1}{16}^{\times 4}\}$ already at $n = 10$, entropy $\log 8 = 2.0794$; genus 3 (sixteen letters over $\mathbb{F}_{37}$): weights $\{\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{12}^{\times 6}, \frac{1}{36}^{\times 9}\}$, entropy $\log 12 = 2.4849$, in both cases $\frac{1}{4}$ on the vacuum line and a flat spectrum on the rest, the signature of the depolarising even letters of Theorem 33.8. The odd sector contributes to the entanglement only through the doubled bond: the physical letters of the certified tensor carry one fermion, those of the closed form $2g$.

34.3 Parent Hamiltonians

Proposition 34.5 (Parent Hamiltonians and the two boundary conditions).

[sketched] *Let*

S_k be the span of the k -site block vectors X_{ab} and $h = 1 - \Pi_{S_k}$; the parent Hamiltonian on the ring is $H = \sum_i h_i$ (translates, wrapping around). Every ring Ψ_B with B commuting with the letters is annihilated by all non-wrapping terms; the term wrapping the closure sees B . For an all-even tensor both Ψ_1 and Ψ_P are ground states. When odd letters are present, $A_s P A_t = \eta_s P A_s A_t$, so Ψ_P is a ground state exactly of the Hamiltonian whose wrapping terms are conjugated by the site parities of the wrapped sites (the Jordan–Wigner image of the periodic fermion ring), and Ψ_1 (antiperiodic) of the untwisted one; the fermionic parent Hamiltonian is one local Hamiltonian with these two boundary conditions.

Proof. Sketch. The block at sites $i..i+k-1$ of Ψ_B has components $\sum_{ab} (A_w)_{ab} (\cdots B \cdots)_{ba}$, in S_k ; for the wrapped block the word is $A_{w_1} B A_{w_2}$, and for $B = P$ moving P to the left multiplies the wrapped letters by their parities, i.e. applies $\prod Z$ on the wrapped sites, which is undone by conjugating the term. Checked numerically in numerical result 34.6: for the fermionic examples Ψ_P lies in the kernel of the twisted and not of the untwisted Hamiltonian, and conversely for Ψ_1 . $\square$

Numerical result 34.6 (The five examples: spectra, entanglement, injectivity, parent Hamiltonians).

[numerical] `scripts/ring_norm_examples.py` (`outputs/ring_norm_examples.txt`). For each of the five states: the counts $\text{str } \mathcal{E}_d^n = N_n$ for $n \leq 4$; the even and odd spectra and the correlation lengths ($1/\log q$ even, $2/\log q$ for every odd mode); the injectivity ranks $\dim \text{span}\{A_w : |w| = k\}$ for $k \leq 4$: genus 0 gives $2 < 4$ (two blocks), genus 1 gives 1 (product state), the certified genus-two letters reach $9 = D^2$ at $k = 2$, the closed forms are injective at $k = 1$; the block Schmidt spectra from Proposition 34.3 against explicit vectors for $n \leq 7$ (genus 2) and against explicit Jordan–Wigner Fock vectors for $n \leq 5$; the half-ring entropies of observation 34.4; the parent Hamiltonians ($k = 2$ for genus 0, $k = 1$ for genus 1, $k = 3$ for the certified letters, $k = 2$ for the nine letters) with ring ground-space dimensions, gaps, and the membership of Ψ_1 and Ψ_P in the kernels of the untwisted and parity-twisted Hamiltonians as in Proposition 34.5; genus 3 has sixteen letters and its parent Hamiltonian is not diagonalised. Results: genus 0, ring $n = 5$, ground space of dimension 2 (the two branches), gap 2; genus 1, $n = 6$, unique ground state, gap 1; certified genus-two letters, $n = 6$, unique ground state for each boundary condition, gaps 0.239 (untwisted, Ψ_1) and 0.232 (twisted, Ψ_P); nine letters over $\mathbb{F}_{25}$, $n = 4$, unique ground state for each, gaps 0.639 and 0.636. 80 checks.

35 The Zeta Conditions Factor by Factor: Ledger and Catalogue

Question (TJO, 2026-09-14, night). Line up all the conditions we want a zeta to obey (functional equation, RH/Ramanujan, unique fixed point, ...) and impose them factor by factor on the cMPS ring norm, including tiny L -functions; the deliverable is completely concrete MPS/cMPS that any practitioner would understand. One codex `gpt-6-astra` lane (`notes/zeta-conditions/astra-brief.md`, report `astra-constructions.md`, 1882 lines, 13 scripts under `notes/zeta-conditions/finite/`, 461 checks re-run by the orchestrator); the orchestrator re-derived the central constructions in `scripts/zeta_conditions.py` (26 checks). Unreviewed by a second family; all rows `sketched/numerical`. Conventions as in Definition 9.1 and Section 12: letters A_s on $\mathbb{C}^{D_+|D_-}$, $\mathcal{E}_d$, Γ_b , Ramond norm $N_n = \text{Tr}[\Gamma_b \mathcal{E}_d^n]$, $Z(u) = \exp \sum N_n u^n / n = \det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d|_-) / \det(1 - u\mathcal{E}_d|_+)$; cMPS (Q, R) , $\mathbb{T}$, $N(L) = \text{Tr}[\Gamma_b e^{L\mathbb{T}}]$, ring zeta $\det(z - \mathbb{T}_-) / \det(z - \mathbb{T}_+)$.

35.1 The ledger

Observation 35.1 (Ten conditions, their exact forms, and their status). [sketched] (C1)
 $N_n = \sum_w |\text{Tr}(\Pi A_w)|^2 \geq 0$ is automatic; integrality is a separate arithmetic constraint; for cMPS $N(L) \geq 0$ is automatic and integrality is void. (C2) Genuine gas: $a_d = \frac{1}{d} \sum_{e|d} \text{Möb}(d/e) N_e \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, not automatic (the single letter $\text{diag}(1, -1)$ has $N = 4, 0, 4, 0, \dots$ and $a_2 = -2$); no intrinsic a_d exists for continuous L , and no finite constant cMPS has an atomic prime comb. (C3) Rationality is automatic; poles are net even, zeros net odd multiplicities; in cMPS a zero eigenvalue is not invisible (it contributes a constant to $N(L)$), and the degree difference is $(D_+ - D_-)^2 = N(0)$. (C4) FE: parity-preserving invariance of the reduced spectrum under $\lambda \mapsto q/\lambda$, giving $Z(1/(qu)) = \pm q^{\chi/2} u^\chi Z(u)$; a sufficient visible mechanism is $J\Gamma_b = \Gamma_b J$, $J\mathcal{E}_d J^{-1} = q\mathcal{E}_d^{-1}$ on the support; for cMPS the symmetry is additive, $\lambda \mapsto \kappa - \lambda$. Correction to the reading of Section 38: inverse-closed letters do *not* give the FE for the raw doubled transfer ($B = \text{diag}(1, 2)$, B^{-1} : even $\{2, 17/4\}$, odd $\{5/2, 5/2\}$); the reciprocal quadratics arise in the non-backtracking construction after the Bass factors are removed. (C5) RH: $|\lambda|^2 = q$ on the retained odd spectrum; a sufficient mechanism is a positive metric M with $\mathcal{E}_d|_-^\dagger M \mathcal{E}_d|_- = qM$, necessary if semisimple; Weil positivity of the rescaled trace sequence gives $|\lambda| \leq \sqrt{q}$ and reciprocity the equality; for cMPS $\text{Re } \lambda = \kappa/2$. (C6) Three separate requirements: a simple uncanceled Perron root q ; a strictly positive even h with $\mathcal{E}^\dagger(h) = qh$ (a trace-preserving gauge on the whole bond); a one-dimensional fixed space spanned by a density with every other eigenvalue inside the unit circle (mixing; uniqueness alone allows periodic modes). The product tensor $\text{diag}(1, \pi)$ of Section 34 has a rank-one Perron eigenmatrix and no whole-bond gauge; the four-letter tensors below fix this without changing Z . (C7) A unitary G -action commuting with Π and permuting letters splits $\mathcal{E}_d = \oplus_\chi 1 \otimes E_\chi$, $N_n = \sum_\chi \dim \chi N_n^\chi$, $Z = \prod L(u, \chi)^{\dim \chi}$; calling a factor an Artin L -function needs an actual cover with Frobenius weights on primitive orbits; “even = trivial, odd = nontrivial” is geometric input (curves), not a theorem about group actions (the Ihara cover below has every mode even). (C8) automatic once the parity closure is fixed: the minus sign lives in the $(+, -)$ coherences. (C9) Choi positivity per parity block plus parity covariance gives homogeneous Kraus letters; a literal count state needs $\text{Tr}(\Pi A_w) \in \{0, 1\}$; the curve tensors are weighted norms, not point enumerations; cMPS kinetic regularity ($R_a R_b = \pm R_b R_a$, $R_f^2 = 0$) is a further condition. (C10) Exact embedding of a lattice channel in a cMPS needs $\mathcal{E}_d = e^{h\mathbb{T}}$ with Choi conditional positivity; singular $\mathcal{E}_d$ (the affine tensor) has none; Poissonisation $Q = -c/2$, $R_s = A_s$ always exists but changes FE/RH.

35.2 The catalogue

Proposition 35.2 (E0: remove a full subshift).

[sketched]

Letters $A_{(a,b)} = \text{diag}(1, [a=b])$ on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$, $a, b \in \{1, \dots, m\}$. The Ramond ring is the indicator of the words with at least one off-diagonal pair, $N_n = m^{2n} - m^n$, $Z = (1 - mu)/(1 - m^2u)$: one pole at $1/m^2$, one zero at $1/m = q^{-1/2}$ (RH by half entropy), a genuine gas (primitive diagonal necklaces are a subset of primitive pair necklaces; $a_d = 2, 5, 18, 57, 198, 661$ for $m = 2$), no FE, no whole-bond channel gauge. For $m = 2$ it equals $Z(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{F}_4)/Z(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{F}_2)$ in an identified degree variable; the swap is a symmetry with fixed letters, not an Artin cover.

Proof. $\text{Tr}(\Pi A_w) = 1 - \prod_i [a_i = b_i]$; the words are orthonormal. Orbit inclusion gives $a_d \geq 0$. $\square$

Proposition 35.3 (Four-letter trace-preserving elliptic tensors on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$). [sketched-conditional]

Let $E/\mathbb{F}_q$ have trace a and Frobenius π , $\pi\bar{\pi} = q$; put $r \in \{0, 1\}$ (affine, projective), $t = (q + r)/2$, $h = (q - r)/2$, and $A_0 = \text{diag}(\sqrt{t}, \pi/\sqrt{t})$, $A_1 = \text{diag}(0, \sqrt{t - q/t})$, $A_2 = \sqrt{h} |0\rangle\langle 1|$, $A_3 = \sqrt{h} |1\rangle\langle 0|$. Then $\sum A_s^\dagger A_s = q1$ (a trace-preserving channel after $/\sqrt{q}$ on the whole bond), the even spectrum is $\{q, r\}$, the odd spectrum $\{\pi, \bar{\pi}\}$, and the Ramond norm is $r + q^n - \pi^n - \bar{\pi}^n$: the point count of the affine ($r = 0$) or projective ($r = 1$) curve. For $r = 1$: FE by the duality $J = \text{diag}(1, -1)_{\text{even}} \oplus \text{swap}_{\text{odd}}$ with $J\mathcal{E}_d J^{-1} = q\mathcal{E}_d^{-1}$; RH because $\mathcal{E}_d|_+ \mathcal{E}_d|_- = q$; the normalised channel is mixing with the maximally mixed state as its unique fixed point; the H^0 eigenvalue 1 is a decaying population-difference mode, not a decoupled block. Example $y^2 = x^3 + x + 1/\mathbb{F}_5$: $a = -3$, $\pi = (-3 + i\sqrt{11})/2$, $N_n = 9, 27, 108, 675, 3069, 15552$. Example $y^2 + y = x^3/\mathbb{F}_4$: $a = -4$, $\pi = -2$, $P = (1 + 2u)^2$, a real double zero at $u = -1/2$, FE and RH hold, the Artin-Schreier involution is $U = \Pi$.

Proof. Direct: the even block of $\mathcal{E}_d$ is $t1 + hX$ with eigenvalues $t \pm h = q, r$; the odd block is $\text{diag}(\bar{\pi}, \pi)$; $3 \cdot 1 + 2X \mapsto 3 \cdot 1 - 2X$ under Z -conjugation gives the duality. Verified in `scripts/zeta_conditions.py` (explicit words for $n \leq 3$) and lane script `curve_projective.py` (46 checks). $\square$

Proposition 35.4 (FE, RH and mixing are mutually independent). [sketched] With Pauli letters $\sqrt{c_0}1, \sqrt{c_1}Z, \sqrt{c_2}X, \sqrt{c_3}Y$ on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$, $c = \frac{1}{4}(16 + r + x + y, 16 + r - x - y, 16 - r + x - y, 16 - r - x + y)$, the even spectrum is $\{16, r\}$ and the odd $\{x, y\}$, the family is trace preserving after $/4$, and every a_d is a nonnegative integer. $(r; x, y) = (1; 4, 4), (1; 8, 2), (0; 4, 4), (1; 3, 3)$ realise (FE, RH, mixing) $= (Y, Y, Y), (Y, N, Y), (N, Y, Y), (N, N, Y)$; tensoring with an idle even qubit keeps FE and RH and destroys uniqueness. The one excluded combination is $(FE = N, RH = Y)$ with the exact projective pair $\{1, q\}$, since RH already makes the odd multiset reciprocal. Positivity of norms plus FE does not force RH.

Proof. The channel action of Pauli letters on $1, X, Y, Z$ is diagonal with the stated eigenvalues; orbit embeddings give $a_d \geq 0$. `independence.py` (131 checks), orchestrator script. $\square$

Proposition 35.5 (Tiny L -functions as MPS: Horner Dirichlet, Gauss, Kloosterman, a graph cover). [sketched]

(i) Horner MPS: bond $\mathbb{F}_q[x]/M$, letters H_c , $f \mapsto xf + c$ ($c \in \mathbb{F}_q$), initial vector the residue 1, closing row $(\chi(f))_f$; the open-chain amplitude $b_n = \chi^\top(\sum_c H_c)^n |1\rangle$ gives $L(u, \chi) = \sum b_n u^n$. Over $\mathbb{F}_2$, $M = x^3 + x + 1$, $\chi(x) = w = e^{2\pi i/7}$: $L = 1 + (w + w^3)u - (1 + w + w^3)u^2 = (1 - u)(1 - \lambda u)$, $|\lambda|^2 = 2$. Over $\mathbb{F}_3$, $M = x^2 + 1$, $\chi(1 + x) = e^{2\pi i/8}$: $L = 1 - \lambda u$, $\lambda = -\sqrt{2} + i$, $|\lambda|^2 = 3$, for the odd characters. These are amplitudes, not norms (C1, C2 fail for an individual factor); the physical open norm counts monics coprime to M ; the ring presentation is the Euler product over prime polynomials with $\chi(P)^k$ on repetitions, not the closed Horner automaton (closing H_c into a trace imposes a return condition and is wrong); the completed factor obeys the dual-character FE

$L^*(1/(qu), \chi) = -(\lambda/qu)L^*(u, \bar{\chi})$. (ii) Gauss: for the quadratic character over $\mathbb{F}_3$ the standard convention gives $1 + Gu$, $G = i\sqrt{3}$; a single Gauss factor is not a norm. (iii) Kloosterman over $\mathbb{F}_4$: $S_n = \sum_{x \neq 0} (-1)^{\text{tr}(x+x^{-1})}$, $S_1 = 3$, $L = 1 + 3u + 4u^2 = (1 - \pi u)(1 - \bar{\pi} u)$, $\pi = (-3 + i\sqrt{7})/2$; the norm $4^n + S_n$ on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$ is the affine count of $y^2 + xy = x^3 + 1$, with the sign fixed by the raw-sum convention. (iv) Graph cover: the rose with two loops and $\mathbb{Z}/2$ voltages 0, 1; eight row letters on bond dimension 8 form a count MPS; $L_1 = 1/((1-u^2)(1-u)(1-3u))$, $L_{\text{sgn}} = 1/((1-u^2)(1+3u^2))$, every root a pole, the reduced Bass quadratics $1 - 4u + 3u^2$ and $1 + 3u^2$ reciprocal at $q = 3$ (the actual inverse-pairing mechanism); the ratio of reduced determinants $(1 + 3u^2)/((1-u)(1-3u))$ has a graded $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$ norm realisation. The correct tiny $\mathbb{Z}/2$ Artin example is a directed voltage cover with $L(u, 1) = 1/(1-3u)$, $L(u, \text{sgn}) = 1/(1+u)$, not the drafted square root for the pair shift.

Proof. Lane scripts `dirichlet_f2.py`, `dirichlet_f3.py`, `gauss.py`, `kloosterman.py`, `graph_artin.py`, `z2_shift_cover.py`; the $\mathbb{F}_2$ Horner MPS re-derived by the orchestrator. $\square$

Proposition 35.6 (Two cMPS on $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$). *[sketched]* (i) Half entropy: $Q = \frac{1}{2}1$, $R = \text{diag}(1, 0)$ give $\mathbb{T} = \text{diag}(2, 1, 1, 1)$, $N(L) = e^{2L} - e^L$, ring zeta $(z-1)/(z-2)$; a normalised finite-norm alternative ($R_f = |0\rangle\langle 1|$, $R_b = \text{diag}(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{1}{2})$, $Q = \text{diag}(-\frac{1}{8}, -\frac{5}{8})$) has $N(L) = 1 - e^{-L}$ but fails kinetic regularity; on homogeneous regular $\mathbb{C}^{1|1}$ data, regularity, Lindblad normalisation, uniqueness and the exact half difference cannot all hold. (ii) Functional equation: one lowering fermion $R = \sqrt{2}|0\rangle\langle 1|$, $H = \text{diag}(0, 1)$, $Q = -iH - \frac{1}{2}R^\dagger R$: normalised spectrum even $\{0, -2\}$, odd $\{-1 \pm i\}$, unique pure vacuum fixed point; in the growth convention $N(L) = |1 - e^{(1+i)L}|^2 = 1 + e^{2L} - 2e^L \cos L$ and ring zeta $((z-1)^2 + 1)/(z(z-2))$ with the additive FE $\mathcal{Z}(2-z) = \mathcal{Z}(z)$ and both zeros on $\text{Re } z = 1$: FE, RH and the unique fixed point by one visible mechanism (odd damping is half the population decay, the frequency comes from H). The ring vector has only its vacuum amplitude: the zeta data sit in the length-dependent vacuum normalisation, and no nontrivial entanglement spectrum is produced.

Proof. Direct diagonalisation of $\mathbb{T}$; `cmps_half.py`, `cmps_fe.py`, orchestrator script. $\square$

Observation 35.7 (What factor by factor reaches, and what a finite bond cannot). *[sketched-conditional]* A practitioner can build tonight: E0 (a zero from destructive interference with a subshift), the four-letter elliptic channels (RH, then FE on completion, with a unique mixing fixed point), the Pauli family (break RH keeping FE and mixing; add an idle qubit to break uniqueness without moving any divisor point), the Horner tensors (tiny Dirichlet polynomials), the graph cover (an Artin decomposition whose nontrivial factors have poles), the damping cMPS (additive FE, uniform odd rate, unique vacuum). A finite bond can have infinitely many Euler primes (E0 does) but cannot produce a nonrational Z , an atomic prime comb, or infinitely many distinct divisor points: $u = q^{-s}$ gives periodic copies of finitely many points, not Riemann's zeros. The no-go of Section 32 concerns plain power traces; graded norms evade it by negative net coherence multiplicities. A single simple pole at $1/q$ is incompatible with the uncompleted self-reciprocal FE: the completion must be declared. Factor by factor constructs and tests local spectra, characters, primes, normalisations and dualities; it does not make an infinite product converge, supply the continuation or the archimedean factor, select an entanglement spectrum, or prove RH for an unidentified infinite object. The corrections to the orchestrator's drafts are in the lane's ledger (D1–D8): inverse pairing alone gives no FE; the swap L -function was not an Artin factor; unique stationarity, gauge and mixing are three conditions; the affine rung needs its own tensor.

Numerical result 35.8 (Zeta conditions: one lane, two suites). *[numerical]* Lane: 461 checks over 13 scripts (`notes/zeta-conditions/finite/run_all.py`, re-run by the orchestrator, all pass; every matrix printed in the report's generated catalogue). Orchestrator: `scripts/zeta_conditions.py` (`outputs/zeta_conditions.txt`), 26 checks: E0 counts, gas and zeta; the $\mathbb{F}_5$ curve count, the

four-letter TP tensor, its spectra, Ramond norm by explicit words, the duality J , the unitary odd block, the unique mixing fixed point; the four Pauli families with their FE/RH/gas verdicts; the FE cMPS spectrum, $N(L)$ at six lengths, and the additive FE; the $\mathbb{F}_2$ Horner L -function and $|\lambda|^2 = 2$; the $\mathbb{F}_4$ supersingular count.

36 Deligne's Proof, Told Through Regular Graphs

Expository. Nothing here is new; the point is to isolate what is actually hard in the proof of the Riemann hypothesis over finite fields [24], using the Ihara zeta [46] of a regular graph as the running model, and to read off which ingredients this project has and which it does not.

36.1 One graph, two sides

Fix a finite connected $(q+1)$ -regular graph X . The objects are those of Section 3: non-backtracking walks and prime cycles (Definition 3.5), the count $N_\ell \geq 0$ of closed non-backtracking walks of length ℓ , the Ihara zeta with its Euler product (Definition 3.6), the Hashimoto operator with $N_\ell = \text{Tr } T^\ell$ and $\zeta_X(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$ (Definition 3.7), and its compression to the adjacency matrix A by Ihara–Bass (Definition 3.8, [4]). Side A is the orbit side, side B the small matrix (Definition 3.1); passing between them is bookkeeping.

Call ± 1 and the pair $\mu \in \{q, 1\}$ from the adjacency eigenvalue $\lambda = q+1$ the *trivial* eigenvalues of T , everything else nontrivial. Then

$$N_\ell = q^\ell + 1 + \sum_{\mu \text{ nontrivial}} \mu^\ell + (|E| - |V|)(1 + (-1)^\ell),$$

with extra terms if X is bipartite: the leading term is the growth rate of the $(q+1)$ -regular tree, and the nontrivial eigenvalues are the error. Since $\mu\mu' = q$, a pair either has both members of modulus $\sqrt{q}$ (when $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$, where they are complex conjugates) or is real with one member larger. So all nontrivial $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$ iff all nontrivial $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$ iff the error in N_ℓ is $O(q^{\ell/2})$: the Ramanujan property (Definition 3.9) and the RH analogue (Definition 3.4) are the same statement, that closed walks spread as evenly as they possibly could.

Two examples from the founding session. K_4 has $q = 2$, adjacency spectrum $3, -1, -1, -1$, hence $\mu = (-1 \pm i\sqrt{7})/2$ with $|\mu|^2 = 2$: Ramanujan, with $N_3 = 8 + 1 + 6 \cdot \frac{5}{2} = 24$, the oriented pointed triangles. The prism $C_{16} \times K_2$ has an eigenvalue $2 \cos(\pi/8) + 1 \approx 2.848 > 2\sqrt{2}$: a real pole inside the circle and an error growing faster than $2^{\ell/2}$. A long thin graph always fails: a bottleneck gives a real μ near q , and walks pile up on one side of it.

36.2 The same statement for a curve, with one sign changed

A curve C over $\mathbb{F}_q$ has N_ℓ points over $\mathbb{F}_{q^\ell}$: again a nonnegative count, again a generating function $Z_C(u)$ with an Euler product, now over closed points, the orbits of Frobenius Fr on the points over the algebraic closure. Side A is identical in form; side B gives a $2g \times 2g$ matrix (g the genus) with

$$N_\ell = q^\ell + 1 - \text{Tr } \text{Fr}^\ell = q^\ell + 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{2g} \alpha_i^\ell, \quad Z_C(u) = \frac{\det(1 - u\text{Fr})}{(1-u)(1-qu)}.$$

	graph	curve
count	closed non-backtracking walks	points over $\mathbb{F}_{q^\ell}$
leading term	$q^\ell + 1$	$q^\ell + 1$
error term	$+\sum \mu^\ell$	$-\sum \alpha_i^\ell$
pairing	$\mu \leftrightarrow q/\mu$	$\alpha_i \leftrightarrow q/\alpha_i$
interesting eigenvalues are	poles of ζ_X	zeros of Z_C
RH	$ \mu = \sqrt{q}$	$ \alpha_i = \sqrt{q}$

Everything matches except the sign of the error term, hence whether the interesting eigenvalues are poles or zeros. For the graph ζ_X is the reciprocal of a polynomial and every eigenvalue is a pole; for the curve the trivial eigenvalues 1 and q are poles and the interesting ones are zeros. This is the sign fixed in Section 2, $\mathcal{S}_n = -\sum_i \alpha_i^n$, and the sign of the explicit formula. For a variety of dimension n the pattern repeats as an alternating sum over $n + 1$ blocks, block i of modulus $q^{i/2}$; the one that matters is the middle, $i = n$.

36.3 What is cheap and what is not

ingredient	graph	variety
side B exists	T plus Ihara–Bass	Grothendieck’s trace formula
the pairing	$\mu\mu' = q$ from Ihara–Bass	Poincaré duality
trivial bound	Perron: $ \mu \leq q$	$ \alpha_i \leq q$
the bound $\sqrt{q}$	<i>false in general</i>	Deligne’s theorem

The first three rows are cheap. Rationality of the zeta function is the first row and nothing more; the trace formula is heavy technology but the same move, that the count is the trace of a power of a finite matrix. The pairing turns the one-sided bound into equality, so the whole problem is one-sided; and the trivial bound is just convergence of the Euler product for $|u| < 1/q$. The gap between q and $\sqrt{q}$ is the entire content.

The last row is where graph and variety part. There is no theorem that a $(q + 1)$ -regular graph is Ramanujan; most are not, the prism is a counterexample, and each Ramanujan construction carries its own proof: arithmetic (Lubotzky–Phillips–Sarnak [68], through RH for a modular curve), probabilistic (Friedman), or interlacing (Marcus–Spielman–Srivastava). So the right question is not how one proves the bound but what varieties have that graphs lack, which makes every one of them Ramanujan. Three things: varieties can be *multiplied*, *sliced* over a curve, and their interesting eigenvalues enter the count with a *minus sign*. A graph has none of the three.

36.4 The engine: power up, dominate, take roots

The trick the proof is built on, in its purest graph form: why the Ramanujan bound is $2\sqrt{q}$. On the infinite $(q + 1)$ -regular tree let c_{2k} count closed ordinary walks of length $2k$ from a root, so the spectral radius of the tree’s adjacency operator is $\lim_k c_{2k}^{1/2k}$. Such a walk is a Dyck path (about 4^k , up to a polynomial factor) together with a fresh neighbour at each of the k outward steps (q choices, $q + 1$ at the root), so $c_{2k} = 4^k q^k$ times a bounded factor times a polynomial in k , and $c_{2k}^{1/2k} \rightarrow 2\sqrt{q}$. Three moves: a nonnegative count dominates a power of an eigenvalue, $c_{2k} = \langle \delta_{\text{root}}, A^{2k} \delta_{\text{root}} \rangle$; the count is known up to a loss that does not grow exponentially in k ; and the $2k$ -th root as $k \rightarrow \infty$ kills every fixed loss. This computation is the tree side of the Ramanujan comparison. Deligne makes the same three moves twice; the nontrivial content is entirely in the second.

36.5 The pointwise theorem, in twisted-graph language

Deligne’s core theorem is not about a variety but about a curve carrying matrix-valued coefficients. A *twist* on a base graph B assigns to each directed edge e an invertible $d \times d$ matrix $\varrho(e)$ with $\varrho(\bar{e}) = \varrho(e)^{-1}$; a closed walk w has holonomy $\varrho(w)$, the ordered product along it, and the twisted zeta is the Artin–Ihara L -function of Definition 3.10,

$$L(u, \varrho) = \prod_P \det(1 - u^{\ell(P)} \varrho(P))^{-1} = \exp\left(\sum_w \frac{1}{\ell(w)} \text{Tr } \varrho(w) u^{\ell(w)}\right) = \det(1 - uT_\varrho)^{-1}.$$

The quantum Ihara zeta of Section 37 is this with B a bouquet of D loops and $\varrho = \text{Ad}(U_i)$ on the i -th loop; a quantum expander is a Ramanujan twist of a bouquet. Two kinds of eigenvalue now live on side B: the *global* ones, the eigenvalues of T_ϱ and poles of L , analogues of the μ ; and the *pointwise* ones, the eigenvalues of each $\varrho(P)$. The twist is *pure with constant* c when every eigenvalue of every $\varrho(P)$ has modulus $c^{\ell(P)}$: a unitary twist is pure with $c = 1$, Deligne's coefficient systems with $c = q^{w/2}$ for an integer weight w (Definition 4.16).

Deligne's pointwise theorem (his Theorem 3.2, in this language): if (a) all traces $\text{Tr } \varrho(w)$ are real, in fact rational; (b) ϱ preserves an alternating pairing up to the scalar $c^{2\ell(w)}$, so eigenvalues of $\varrho(P)$ come in pairs α_i and $c^{2\ell(P)}/\alpha_i$; and (c) the holonomies generate a group as large as (b) permits; then ϱ is pure with constant c .

The note argues in four steps, for a fixed prime cycle P and eigenvalue α_1 of $\varrho(P)$, the target being $|\alpha_1| \leq c^{\ell(P)}$ with (b) supplying equality. *Power up*: replace ϱ by $\varrho^{\otimes 2k}$, so traces become $(\text{Tr } \varrho(w))^{2k}$ and α_1^{2k} is an eigenvalue at P . *Dominate*: by (a) those traces are nonnegative, so every Euler factor of $L_{2k} := L(u, \varrho^{\otimes 2k})$ has nonnegative coefficients and constant term 1, the product dominates any single factor coefficientwise, and the factor at P has a pole at $|u| = |\alpha_1|^{-2k/\ell(P)}$ which a dominated series cannot outrun. *The known pole*: suppose the only poles of L_{2k} were the trivial ones, at $|u| = 1/(q c^{2k})$; then

$$|\alpha_1|^{-2k/\ell(P)} \geq 1/(q c^{2k}) \iff |\alpha_1| \leq c^{\ell(P)} q^{\ell(P)/2k}.$$

Take roots: as $k \rightarrow \infty$ the loss $q^{\ell(P)/2k}$ vanishes. The fixed loss is the single factor q in the trivial pole, paid once by the base curve however large k is.

A graph breaks the third step, and must, since the theorem is false for graphs. Take B a bouquet of two loops with $\varrho(a) = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $\varrho(b) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$: traces are integers, so (a); determinants are 1, so (b) with $c = 1$; and the two generate a group as large as $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ permits, so (c). Yet $\varrho(a)$ has eigenvalue $(3+\sqrt{5})/2 > 1$, so the twist is not pure: $L_{2k} = \det(1 - uT_{\varrho^{\otimes 2k}})^{-1}$ has a pole at $|u| = ((3+\sqrt{5})/2)^{-2k}$, far inside $1/q$, from a nontrivial eigenvalue of the twisted edge operator. For a graph every side-B eigenvalue is a pole, so nothing forces the poles to the trivial place. What makes the third step true for a curve is one hypothesis and one structural fact.

36.6 Big monodromy, and the abelian failure

The trivial poles of L_{2k} come from invariant vectors: a vector in the d^{2k} -dimensional coefficient space fixed by every holonomy. On such a vector the twist acts like no twist, so L_{2k} acquires a copy of the untwisted zeta with its pole at $1/q$, rescaled by the scalar the twist puts on the vector; if that scalar is known, so is the pole. The pairing (b) supplies invariants for free, by contracting the $2k$ tensor slots in pairs, each contraction giving a pole at exactly $1/(q c^{2k})$. Hypothesis (c), *big monodromy*, says these are the only invariants: if the holonomies fill out the whole group preserving the pairing, invariant theory makes every invariant of $\varrho^{\otimes 2k}$ a combination of pairwise contractions, so no other trivial pole appears.

Observation 36.1 (The abelian obstruction is inside Deligne's proof). [sketched] Commuting holonomies produce uncontrolled invariants in tensor powers, exactly as commuting Kraus unitaries never give an expander: commuting $\varrho(w)$ have common eigenvectors, and a common eigenvector with eigenvalue $\chi(w)$ becomes invariant in $\varrho^{\otimes N}$ as soon as $\chi^N = 1$, carrying an unknown χ -dependent scalar, so the trivial poles sit where the argument cannot control them. Any Ramanujan lift of the prime dilations must break the commutativity by a quotient, as [68] does with the arithmetic lattice and as Deligne does with the shears of a generic slicing.

In Deligne's setting the commuting case is a coefficient system with abelian monodromy, which can have arbitrary pointwise weights; (c) excludes it. In this project it is the observation of the

founding session that commuting Kraus unitaries never give an expander, the adjoint action of an abelian group having as many invariants as it has joint eigenprojectors: the same obstruction on both sides of the dictionary. Geometrically, big monodromy is verified through shears. The holonomy around each bad slice is the identity plus a rank-one nilpotent along one vector, those vectors are carried to one another by the holonomy group, and a theorem of Kazhdan and Margulis says a group generated by one conjugacy class of shears and acting without invariant subspaces is automatically as large as the pairing allows. Big monodromy is the statement that the bad slices are all alike, which holds because they are generic.

36.7 The sign

For a graph, side B is the one matrix T_ϱ and every eigenvalue is a pole. For a curve with coefficients the trace formula has two blocks of opposite sign,

$$\sum_{w: \ell(w)=\ell} \text{Tr } \varrho(w) = \text{Tr}(\text{Fr}^\ell \mid \text{invariant}) - \text{Tr}(\text{Fr}^\ell \mid \text{interesting}), \quad L(u, \varrho) = \frac{\det(1 - u\text{Fr} \mid \text{interesting})}{\det(1 - u\text{Fr} \mid \text{invariant})}.$$

The invariant block is the one big monodromy computes, and it produces the poles; the interesting block produces zeros, and zeros do not obstruct convergence, so the radius of convergence of L_{2k} is set by the invariant block alone. That is the third step, and it is the minus sign of the table above: positivity of counts is available on both sides, but on the graph side it constrains the sum of everything, which is the Perron bound and no more, while on the curve side the interesting eigenvalues are subtracted, so positivity bounds them above by the trivial ones and even tensor powers squeeze the bound to equality. The two-loop bouquet is not a curve because its walk counts cannot be written with the interesting part subtracted.

36.8 From pointwise to global: slice, bound, multiply

Slice. Take a one-parameter family of hyperplane sections of a variety X of dimension n ; the parameter runs over a curve and all but finitely many slices are smooth of dimension $n - 1$. Up to pieces already understood, the middle block of X is the interesting block of that base curve with coefficients, the coefficient at a parameter value being the middle block of the slice there. In graph terms this is the Artin–Ihara factorisation (Definition 3.10) used in Section 37, with the fibre replaced by a variety of one dimension less. The coefficients satisfy (a), (b), (c): the pairing is Poincaré duality on the slice, big monodromy is the shear argument, and the traces are rational because the zeta of a slice is rational with rational coefficients, off which the blocks known by induction are peeled. So they are pure with $c = q^{(n-1)/2}$.

Bound. With pure coefficients the Euler product over the base converges absolutely for $|u| < 1/(qc)$, there being about q^ℓ/ℓ prime cycles of length ℓ each with holonomy of norm c^ℓ . So the interesting block has no eigenvalue larger than $qc = q^{(n+1)/2}$, where RH wants $q^{n/2}$: a loss of one factor $\sqrt{q}$, paid by the base being a curve, independent of n .

Multiply. The product X^k has dimension nk and its middle block contains the k -fold tensor products of the middle block of X , so the products $\alpha_1 \cdots \alpha_k$ are among its eigenvalues. The bound applied to X^k still loses one factor $\sqrt{q}$, because the base of a slicing is always a curve, whence

$$|\alpha_i|^k \leq q^{(nk+1)/2} \implies |\alpha_i| \leq q^{n/2} q^{1/2k} \xrightarrow{k \rightarrow \infty} q^{n/2},$$

with duality giving the reverse inequality: the engine a second time, count, fixed loss, roots. The pointwise theorem is what makes the last move legitimate, since the slices of X^k have dimension

$nk - 1$, far above anything the induction on dimension knows, so their purity must come from rationality and big monodromy alone. That is why the core theorem is stated for coefficients on a curve: it certifies coefficients in any dimension at the price of one curve. Even for a curve C the argument passes through C^k for all k ; the surface $C \times C$ is where Weil’s proof lived, and the products are the mechanism. The blocks $i \neq n$ follow by induction from lower-dimensional sections and from duality.

36.9 What the proof does not do

It never exhibits a Hermitian structure. Weil’s proof for curves does: by the Hodge index theorem the intersection form on $C \times C$ is definite on the relevant part, which makes $\text{Fr}/\sqrt{q}$ unitary for an explicit positive inner product on the middle block and produces a Hilbert–Pólya operator (Definition 4.7). In graph terms, on the nontrivial part T is $\sqrt{q}$ times a unitary in some inner product, which for the block $\begin{pmatrix} \lambda & -q \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ holds exactly when $|\lambda| < 2\sqrt{q}$. Grothendieck’s plan was to prove a definite form in all dimensions, the standard conjectures, and deduce RH as Weil had; that plan is still open. Deligne bypassed it: no form, no operator, only positivity and a limit. RH over finite fields is therefore a theorem, while in dimension above one the inner product that would make Frobenius normal is not known to exist.

The Artin–Schreier computation of Section 28 sits on the Weil side of this divide: $EE^\dagger = qI$ is manifest from Parseval for the additive characters (Proposition 28.3), an explicit inner product. Deligne’s proof is what one has when no such structure is in sight. Two honesty notes the note records: the Ramanujan property of the LPS graphs of Section 27 needs only the curve case, since Eichler–Shimura transports Hecke eigenvalues to Frobenius eigenvalues of a modular curve, so Weil’s theorem suffices there and Deligne’s method is what extends it to higher weight; and the technology behind “side B exists” is the largest single piece of the proof by page count, though not by idea.

36.10 What this says for the project

Observation 36.2 (The three ingredients, and no Hermitian form). [sketched] Deligne’s proof uses three ingredients that a Hilbert–Pólya approach would have to replace: products, under which eigenvalues multiply while the trivial loss stays fixed; slicing over a curve, which keeps that loss at one factor $\sqrt{q}$ in every dimension; and the sign, which makes the interesting eigenvalues zeros rather than poles, so that positivity of the counts bounds them. It exhibits no Hermitian form and no operator.

- **Which ingredients ζ has.** The zeros are subtracted from the prime count, so ζ is on the curve side of the table, not the graph side, and the positivity $\Lambda(n) \geq 0$ is the right kind. The sign and the positivity are present; the product is absent, since there is no $X \times X$ with ζ as its slice, so the multiply step has nothing to act on. This is the standard diagnosis, stated in the terms of this section.
- **The number-field shadow of the pointwise theorem is Rankin–Selberg.** For a modular form the Euler product of $L(f \times \bar{f})$ has nonnegative coefficients and a known pole, and dominating one local factor gives $|a_p| \leq p^{(k-1)/2} \cdot p^{1/2}$, the same fixed loss; each symmetric-power L -function whose poles are known shaves it (Kim–Sarnak’s 7/64 is the current state). Knowing the poles of all the tensor-power L -functions is the analogue of big monodromy; over number fields that is Langlands functoriality, unproved.
- **The abelian obstruction is inside the proof** (observation 36.1), on both sides of the dictionary.

- **Ramanujan without Hermiticity is possible.** Deligne’s route and the interlacing route both reach the spectral bound with no Hilbert–Pólya operator. For the steering question of where Hermiticity enters, this is the cleanest evidence that it need not enter at all; what must enter is a positivity plus an operation under which eigenvalues multiply at fixed loss.

37 The Ihara–Bass Formula for an Arbitrary Kraus Family

This is the load-bearing section of the book. The classical Ihara–Bass formula (Definition 3.8) compresses a determinant on the edge space of a regular graph to one on the vertex space, and Definition 3.18 lifts the edge operator to superoperators. The question the founding session left open, and which TJO steered towards, is whether the compression survives when the Kraus operators are not unitary. It does, at the price of two u -dependent operators in place of the adjacency matrix and the degree.

Status. Theorem 37.1 and its three corollaries are tagged **proved**. The author is **claudé:fable-5.1**; the reviewers are of a different model, **claudé:opus**; and their reports in **notes/reviews/** — a round-1 algebra report, a round-1 provenance report, and a round-2 re-verification — return **VALID** on every verdict. Only one model family was declared for this campaign, so **proved** here means exactly that: author $\neq$ reviewer, inside one family. The two **numerical** rows are independent evidence.

37.1 Setting and conventions

- $\mathcal{V}$ is a finite-dimensional complex vector space, $N = \dim \mathcal{V}$. In the application $\mathcal{V} = M_n$ with the Hilbert–Schmidt inner product, so $N = n^2$.
- $D = 2m$ is even, and ι is a fixed-point-free involution on $[D] = \{1, \dots, D\}$, the *reversal*; we write $\bar{i} = \iota(i)$, so that $\bar{\bar{i}} = i$.
- $\mathcal{E}_1, \dots, \mathcal{E}_D \in \text{End}(\mathcal{V})$ are arbitrary linear maps. No invertibility, positivity or unitarity is assumed.
- The edge space is $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$, with $\mathbb{C}^D$ spanned by $|1\rangle, \dots, |D\rangle$; an element is $x = \sum_i x_i \otimes |i\rangle$ with $x_i \in \mathcal{V}$ its *component* at i .
- $T \in \text{End}(\mathcal{W})$ is the quantum Hashimoto operator of Definition 3.18, $T(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$, and $\zeta_T(u) = \det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT)^{-1}$, a rational function of $u \in \mathbb{C}$.
- $\|\cdot\|$ is the operator norm; any submultiplicative norm on $\text{End}(\mathcal{V})$ would do. Determinants carry the space they are taken over, $\det_{\mathcal{V}}$ and $\det_{\mathcal{W}}$.
- Sylvester’s identity $\det(1 - XY) = \det(1 - YX)$, for $X: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}$ and $Y: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$, is used without further comment; so is the block determinant with identity diagonal blocks, $\det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & B \\ C & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \det(1 - CB) = \det(1 - BC)$ (Schur complement, then Sylvester).

The Kraus case. $\mathcal{V} = M_n$; $A_1, \dots, A_m \in M_n$ are arbitrary, $A_{m+k} = A_k^\dagger$, $\iota(k) = m + k$, and $\mathcal{E}_i = \text{Ad}(A_i): X \mapsto A_i X A_i^\dagger$. With column stacking (Section 2), $\text{Ad}(A) = \bar{A} \otimes A$ as an $n^2 \times n^2$ matrix, so $\text{Tr}_{\mathcal{V}} \text{Ad}(A) = |\text{Tr } A|^2$ and $\text{Ad}(A) \text{Ad}(B) = \text{Ad}(AB)$.

Auxiliary maps. Three maps do all the work: **R** propagates along an edge, **S** starts along every edge, **J** is the backtracking term.

$$\mathbf{R}: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}, \quad \mathbf{R}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \mathcal{E}_i v; \quad \mathbf{S}: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}, \quad \mathbf{S}v = \sum_{j=1}^D v \otimes |j\rangle; \quad \mathbf{J}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |\bar{i}\rangle.$$

The two u -dependent operators on $\mathcal{V}$ are the *deformed adjacency* and the *deformed degree*,

$$\mathcal{A}(u) = u \sum_{i=1}^D \mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}, \quad \mathcal{D}(u) = u^2 \sum_{i=1}^D \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}.$$

The zeta variable is u throughout (Section 2); the channel normalisation $\Sigma = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i = D\Phi$ is the one fixed there, and nothing below depends on it.

37.2 Statement

Theorem 37.1 (Ihara–Bass for an arbitrary family of superoperators). *[proved] Let $u \in \mathbb{C}$ be such that $1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ is invertible for every $i \in [D]$. Then*

$$\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = \prod_{\{i, \bar{i}\}} \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i) \cdot \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)),$$

the product being over the m unordered pairs $\{i, \bar{i}\}$, which is well defined because $\det(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i) = \det(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})$. The hypothesis holds for all $|u| < (\max_i \|\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i\|)^{-1/2}$, and for all u if every $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i = 0$; the identity holds pointwise at every such u , and since the left side is a polynomial of degree $\leq ND$ and the right side is rational, the two sides agree as rational functions.

Corollary 37.2 (Kraus families and positivity of side A). *[proved] For arbitrary $A_1, \dots, A_m \in M_n$ with the adjoint pairing above, $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = \prod_{k=1}^m \det(1 - u^2 \text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)) \cdot \det(1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u))$, valid for $|u| < \min_k \|A_k\|^{-2}$; here $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ is $\text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)$ for $i = k \leq m$ and $\text{Ad}(A_k A_k^\dagger)$ for $i = m + k$, both positive semidefinite. Moreover, for every $\ell \geq 1$,*

$$\text{Tr}_{\mathcal{W}} T^\ell = \sum_{\substack{(i_1, \dots, i_\ell) \in [D]^\ell \\ i_{k+1} \neq i_k \text{ (} k \in \mathbb{Z}/\ell \text{)}}} |\text{Tr}(A_{i_\ell} \cdots A_{i_1})|^2 \geq 0,$$

so $\zeta_T(u) = \exp(\sum_\ell u^\ell \text{Tr} T^\ell / \ell)$ has nonnegative Taylor coefficients, and $\zeta_T(u) = \prod_P \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^{\ell(P)} \text{Ad}(A_P))^{-1}$ over primitive cyclically non-backtracking classes P of length $\ell(P)$, with A_P the ordered product along P .

Corollary 37.3 (Inverse pairing: the unitary case). *[proved] If $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} = \mathcal{E}_i^{-1}$ for all i — in particular for unitary Kraus operators with $U_{\bar{i}} = U_i^\dagger = U_i^{-1}$ — then, with $\Sigma = \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i$,*

$$\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{N(D-2)/2} \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\Sigma + (D-1)u^2).$$

For $\mathcal{V} = M_n$ and $\Sigma = D\Phi$ this is the formula recorded as item 1 of `HANDOFF.md` and, on the bouquet, equation (2.11) of Matsuura–Ohta [72].

Corollary 37.4 (Which factor carries the spectrum). *[proved] The poles of ζ_T lie among the roots of $\det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)) = 0$ together with the points $u^2 = 1/\lambda$ for $\lambda \in \text{spec}(\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i) \setminus \{0\}$; the latter may cancel against poles of the second factor, as they do in Corollary 37.3 (exponent $ND/2$ against $-N$, a total cancellation when $D = 2$). For $D = 2$ in general, $T = \mathcal{E}_1 \oplus \mathcal{E}_2$ on $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \oplus \mathcal{V}$, since the only non-backtracking successor of i is i itself, so $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT) = \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_1) \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\mathcal{E}_2)$. Conversely a pole of the second factor, which can only sit where some $1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ is singular, is not a pole of ζ_T unless it survives multiplication by the first.*

37.3 Proof of the theorem

The proof is written in Lamport structure: each step is a claim followed by its own proof, and the last step assembles them.

Proof of Theorem 37.1. ASSUME: $u \in \mathbb{C}$ with $1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i$ invertible for all $i \in [D]$. PROVE: the displayed identity.

- (1)1. **The decomposition $T = \text{SR} - \text{J}$.** *Proof.* On $v \otimes |i\rangle$, $\text{SR}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_j \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle$ and $\text{J}(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |\bar{i}\rangle$, so $(\text{SR} - \text{J})(v \otimes |i\rangle) = \sum_{j \neq \bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i v \otimes |j\rangle = T(v \otimes |i\rangle)$. Both sides are linear and these vectors span $\mathcal{W}$. $\square$
- (1)2. **Block structure of J .** For each pair $p = \{i, \bar{i}\}$ put $\mathcal{W}_p = \mathcal{V} \otimes \text{span}\{|i\rangle, |\bar{i}\rangle\}$. Then $\mathcal{W} = \bigoplus_p \mathcal{W}_p$, $\text{J}\mathcal{W}_p \subseteq \mathcal{W}_p$, and in the ordered decomposition $\mathcal{W}_p = \mathcal{V} \oplus \mathcal{V}$ (component at i , component at $\bar{i}$), $\text{J}|_{\mathcal{W}_p} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \\ \mathcal{E}_i & 0 \end{pmatrix}$. *Proof.* J sends the component at i to the component at $\bar{i}$ through $\mathcal{E}_i$, and the component at $\bar{i}$ to the component at i through $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}$, using $\bar{\bar{i}} = i$. The direct sum is the partition of $[D]$ into ι -orbits, which have size two because ι is fixed-point-free. $\square$
- (1)3. **$1+u\text{J}$ is invertible, with $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1+u\text{J}) = \prod_p \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)$.** *Proof.* By (1)2, $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1+u\text{J}) = \prod_p \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \\ u\mathcal{E}_i & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \prod_p \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u^2\mathcal{E}_i\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}) = \prod_p \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)$, by the block determinant and then Sylvester. Each factor is nonzero by ASSUME. $\square$
- (1)4. **Explicit inverse on a pair.** Write $B = u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}$, $C = u\mathcal{E}_i$, $P = (1 - BC)^{-1} = (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}$ and $Q = (1 - CB)^{-1} = (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_i\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})^{-1}$, both existing by ASSUME (the second is the hypothesis at the index $\bar{i}$). Then $(1+u\text{J})^{-1}|_{\mathcal{W}_p} = \begin{pmatrix} P & -BQ \\ -CP & Q \end{pmatrix}$. *Proof.* Multiply out: $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & B \\ C & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} P & -BQ \\ -CP & Q \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} (1-BC)P & -BQ+BPQ \\ CP-CP & (1-CB)Q \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. A right inverse of a square operator on a finite-dimensional space is the inverse. $\square$
- (1)5. **Sylvester step.** $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1-uT) = \det_{\mathcal{W}}(1+u\text{J}) \cdot \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1-u\text{R}(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S})$. *Proof.* By (1)1, $1-uT = 1+u\text{J} - u\text{SR} = (1+u\text{J})(1-u(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{SR})$, the inverse existing by (1)3. Take determinants and apply Sylvester with $X = u(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S}: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathcal{W}$ and $Y = \text{R}: \mathcal{W} \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$. $\square$
- (1)6. **Computation of $M(u) := \text{R}(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S}$.** It equals $\sum_{i=1}^D (\mathcal{E}_i - u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)(1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}$. *Proof.* For $v \in \mathcal{V}$, $\text{S}v$ has component v at every index. By (1)4, on the pair $p = \{i, \bar{i}\}$ the vector $(1+u\text{J})^{-1}\text{S}v$ has component $(P - BQ)v$ at i and $(-CP + Q)v$ at $\bar{i}$. Applying R , which applies $\mathcal{E}_i$ to the component at i , $\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}$ to the component at $\bar{i}$, and sums over all indices, and substituting B, C, P, Q , the pair p contributes

$$\mathcal{E}_i P - u\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} Q + \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} Q - u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i P = (\mathcal{E}_i - u\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)P + (\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} - u\mathcal{E}_i\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})Q.$$

The first summand is the i -th term of the claimed sum and the second is the $\bar{i}$ -th, since $Q = (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1}$. Summing over the m pairs gives the sum over all D indices. $\square$

- (1)7. **$1-uM(u) = 1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)$.** *Proof.* Expand (1)6 linearly: $uM(u) = u \sum_i \mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1} - u^2 \sum_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i (1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)^{-1} = \mathcal{A}(u) - \mathcal{D}(u)$. $\square$
- (1)8. **QED.** *Proof.* Combine (1)5, (1)3 and (1)7. Steps (1)1–(1)7 hold pointwise at every u satisfying ASSUME, with no analyticity used. The bound $|u| < (\max_i \|\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i\|)^{-1/2}$ makes $\|u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i\| < 1$, so the Neumann series supplies the inverses and ASSUME holds there. The set of admissible u is cofinite: its complement is the zero set of the polynomial $\prod_i \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^2\mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}}\mathcal{E}_i)$, which equals 1 at $u = 0$ and so is not identically zero. Two rational functions agreeing on a cofinite set are equal. $\square$

$\square$

37.4 Proofs of the corollaries

Proof of Corollary 37.2. $\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} = \text{Ad}(A_{\bar{i}}) \text{Ad}(A_i) = \text{Ad}(A_{\bar{i}} A_i)$, which is $\text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)$ or $\text{Ad}(A_k A_k^\dagger)$; for $P \geq 0$ with eigenvalues p_a , $\text{Ad}(P) = \bar{P} \otimes P$ has spectrum $\{\bar{p}_a p_b\} \subseteq [0, \infty)$, and $\|\text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k)\| = \|A_k\|^4$, so the hypothesis of Theorem 37.1 holds for $|u| < \min_k \|A_k\|^{-2}$; the two orderings of a pair have equal determinant by Sylvester, leaving one factor per k . For the trace formula, induction on ℓ gives $T^\ell(v \otimes |i_1\rangle) = \sum \mathcal{E}_{i_\ell} \cdots \mathcal{E}_{i_1} v \otimes |i_{\ell+1}\rangle$, summed over $(i_2, \dots, i_{\ell+1})$ with $i_{k+1} \neq \bar{i}_k$ for $k = 1, \dots, \ell$. Tracing over $\mathcal{W} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ sets $i_{\ell+1} = i_1$, which adds the cyclic condition $i_1 \neq \bar{i}_\ell$, and leaves $\text{Tr}_{\mathcal{V}} \text{Ad}(A_{i_\ell} \cdots A_{i_1}) = |\text{Tr}(A_{i_\ell} \cdots A_{i_1})|^2$. Nonnegativity of the coefficients of $\log \zeta_T = \sum_\ell u^\ell \text{Tr } T^\ell / \ell$ implies nonnegativity for $\zeta_T = \exp(\cdot)$. The Euler product is the standard regrouping of cyclic words into powers of primitive classes, using $\sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{u^{k\ell(P)}}{k} \text{Tr } \text{Ad}(A_P)^k = -\log \det(1 - u^{\ell(P)} \text{Ad}(A_P))$, valid for $|u|$ small. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 37.3. With $\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} = 1$ each pair factor is $\det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u^2) = (1 - u^2)^N$, so the product is $(1 - u^2)^{ND/2}$; and $\mathcal{A}(u) = \frac{u}{1-u^2} \Sigma$, $\mathcal{D}(u) = \frac{Du^2}{1-u^2}$. Hence $1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u) = \frac{1}{1-u^2} (1 - u\Sigma + (D-1)u^2)$, whose determinant is $(1 - u^2)^{-N} \det_{\mathcal{V}}(1 - u\Sigma + (D-1)u^2)$. The total exponent is $ND/2 - N = N(D-2)/2$. The computation divides by $1 - u^2$ and so is carried out for $u^2 \neq 1$; both sides are polynomials in u , so the identity extends to $u^2 = 1$. $\square$

Proof of Corollary 37.4. Immediate from the factorisation: a zero of the polynomial $\det_{\mathcal{W}}(1 - uT)$ is a zero of the product, each factor is analytic away from the points named, and a polynomial has no poles, so every pole of the second factor is cancelled by a zero of the first. $\square$

37.5 Provenance and relation to the literature

Watanabe and Fukumizu [92] prove an Ihara–Bass formula for graph zeta functions with arbitrary matrix weights, in the shape $\det(I + \hat{\mathcal{D}} - \hat{\mathcal{A}}) \prod_{[e]} \det(I - u_e u_{\bar{e}})$, with $\hat{\mathcal{D}}$ and $\hat{\mathcal{A}}$ built from $(I - u_e u_{\bar{e}})^{-1}$ exactly as $\mathcal{D}(u)$ and $\mathcal{A}(u)$ are; the byte-verified quotes are in Section 44. On a one-vertex graph whose $2m$ directed edges are $[D]$ with reversal ι , and with $u_e = u_{\mathcal{E}_e}$, their right-hand side becomes the right-hand side of Theorem 37.1 after the push-through identity $\mathcal{E}_i(1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}} \mathcal{E}_i)^{-1} = (1 - u^2 \mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_{\bar{i}})^{-1} \mathcal{E}_i$ and the relabelling $i \leftrightarrow \bar{i}$ in the degree term. Two further conventions differ and wash out of $\det(1 - u \cdot)$: they compose a prime cycle in the order opposite to our $\mathcal{E}_{i_\ell} \cdots \mathcal{E}_{i_1}$, and their edge operator weights the target edge where T weights the source. Reversal of words is a bijection of cyclically non-backtracking words because ι is an involution, and $\det(1 - XY) = \det(1 - YX)$.

The framing matters, and was corrected by the round-1 provenance review: their corollary is stated for loopless graphs (their graphs are hypergraphs with two-element hyperedges), so a bouquet is not one of their graphs and their corollary does not apply to it. Theorem 37.1 is therefore the loop-admitting bouquet analogue of their arbitrary-weight corollary, not an instance of it; their proof goes through a hypergraph theorem, the proof above is direct. The shape-matching itself is checked numerically only (`notes/reviews/scratch_wf_mo_conventions.py`).

Matsuura and Ohta [72] treat invertible edge weights on a general graph, which is Corollary 37.3 in that generality; on a bouquet with $X_e = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$ their equation (2.11) is the formula of `HANDOFF.md` item 1. No local source covers arbitrary weights on a bouquet.

37.6 Numerical checks

Numerical result 37.5 (Ihara–Bass for random unitary Kraus sets). `[numerical]` For Haar-random unitary Kraus sets closed under adjoint, Corollary 37.3 holds at $u \in \{0.13, 0.29 + 0.11i, -0.4\}$ with relative error at most $2.1 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(n, D) = (3, 4)$ and at most $3.9 \cdot 10^{-15}$ for $(n, D) = (4, 6)$. The four

largest eigenvalues of $\Sigma = D\Phi$ are 1.465, 1.850, 3.622, 4.000 for (3, 4) against the Ramanujan bound $2\sqrt{q} = 3.464$, and 2.782, 3.128, 3.594, 6.000 for (4, 6) against 4.472: the first instance violates the bound of Definition 3.17 and the second satisfies it. (`scripts/qihara.py`, `outputs/qihara.txt`.)

Numerical result 37.6 (The general formula in five configurations).

[numerical]

Theorem 37.1, in both the $1 - uM(u)$ and the displayed $1 + \mathcal{D}(u) - \mathcal{A}(u)$ form, at three values of u (one complex), with maximal relative error per configuration as in the table; the trace formula of Corollary 37.2 for $\ell \leq 4$ to $5.5 \cdot 10^{-12}$; and exact verification in rational arithmetic (sympy) for $(N, D) = (1, 4), (2, 4), (2, 6)$. (`scripts/qihara_general.py`, `outputs/qihara_general.txt`.)

configuration	parameters	max. relative error
Gaussian Kraus operators, adjoint pairing	$n = 3, D = 4$	$2.1 \cdot 10^{-15}$
canonical-form MPS tensors and adjoints	$n = 3, D = 4$	$2.0 \cdot 10^{-15}$
generic real superoperators, involution (1 2)(3 4)	$n = 3, D = 4$	$6.7 \cdot 10^{-16}$
single Kraus pair, with the direct-sum check	$n = 3, D = 2$	$1.4 \cdot 10^{-15}$
unitary Kraus, against Corollary 37.3	$n = 3, D = 4$	$1.3 \cdot 10^{-15}$

37.7 What this does and does not give

It gives the compression for *every* matrix product state transfer matrix $\Sigma = \sum_i \text{Ad}(A_i)$, with the physical index doubled by the adjoints. The price of dropping unitarity is that the degree term $(D - 1)u^2$ becomes the operator $\mathcal{D}(u)$ and the adjacency term $u\Sigma$ becomes the deformed channel $\mathcal{A}(u)$, both depending on u through $(1 - u^2 \text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k))^{-1}$.

It does not give a Ramanujan reading by itself. Without $\mathcal{E}_i \mathcal{E}_i = 1$ there is no quadratic relation $\mu\mu' = q$ pairing the eigenvalues of T with those of Σ . What replaces it, and whether canonical form (Definition 3.14) buys anything, is conjecture 47.1.

Side A is unconditionally positive: $\text{Tr } T^\ell = \sum_P |\text{Tr } A_P|^2 \geq 0$ for any Kraus family, so the primes of this zeta are the primitive cyclically non-backtracking words in the A_k and $A_k^\dagger$, with real nonnegative multiplicities.

Observation 37.7 (RH for the quantum Ihara zeta is Hastings' bound).

[sketched]

For unitary Kraus operators closed under adjoint, Corollary 37.3 attaches to each eigenvalue λ of $\Sigma = D\Phi$ the quadratic $1 - \lambda u + qu^2 = (1 - \mu u)(1 - \mu' u)$ with $\mu\mu' = q = D - 1$ and $\mu + \mu' = \lambda$; the eigenvalues λ are real because Σ is Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjoint for an adjoint-closed set. Both roots then have $|\mu| = \sqrt{q}$ exactly when $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{q}$. Hence every nontrivial pole of ζ_Φ lies on the circle $|u| = q^{-1/2}$ if and only if $D\lambda_2 \leq 2\sqrt{D - 1}$, which is Hastings' bound λ_H [42] in the adjacency units of Section 2: the Riemann hypothesis for this zeta is exactly the statement that Φ is a Ramanujan quantum expander (Definition 3.17). The note records this as an observation, not found in the literature in this form; it is tagged **sketched** because it has had no reviewer.

38 Weil Positivity for an Arbitrary Transfer Operator

This section answers the question TJO put on 2026-09-12: the reflection $\rho \mapsto 1 - \bar{\rho}$ pairs the mode of the Riemann channel at a zero with the mode at its mirror image, RH says every mode is its own partner, and Weil's criterion is the positivity of that pairing written on the primes. What does this mean for a completely arbitrary Kraus family, finite-dimensional or continuous? The answer is in three layers. Without any duality, Weil positivity of the rescaled ring norms is exactly a one-sided bound, the spectral-gap half of RH. A duality of the spectrum, the functional equation, turns the bound into a circle and the Weil form into the pairing of each mode with its reflected partner; this identity is the finite form of the inflow identity. For Kraus families the two pairings of the Kraus index buy the two halves separately: inverse pairing gives the functional equation, adjoint pairing gives reality of the transfer spectrum, and only unitarity gives both.

Status. The theorems are the prover's, `codex:gpt-6-astra` (notes/weil-positivity/astra-proofs.md, Lamport structure, correction ledger in its T7), reviewed adversarially by `claude:opus` (notes/reviews/weil-positivity/astra-proofs.md), two model families; all verdicts **VALID**, two wording items fixed. The orchestrator's two observations in Section 39 were reviewed in the same file. Independent numerics by a third agent (numerical result 39.17) found the same three drafting errors the prover corrected.

38.1 Setting

Definitions 4.24 and 4.25 fix the objects: an operator X on a finite-dimensional space, a trivial sub-multiset S_{triv} of its spectrum, the retained multiset $\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$, a critical radius r , the rescaled trace sequence $\mathbf{n}_\ell = \sum_{\mu \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}} (\mu/r)^\ell$ with $\mathbf{n}_{-\ell} = \bar{\mathbf{n}}_\ell$, the Weil form $W(c) = \sum c_\ell \bar{c}_k \mathbf{n}_{\ell-k}$, the reflection $J(\mu) = r^2/\bar{\mu}$ and the mode-pairing form M . In the Kraus case $X = T$ and $\text{Tr } T^\ell = \sum_w |\text{Tr } A_w|^2$ is the ring-norm sum of Corollary 37.2, so $\mathbf{n}_\ell$ is side A rescaled and with the trivial modes subtracted, and W is a form on rings. Nothing below assumes diagonalisability until Proposition 39.4.

38.2 Positivity is the one-sided bound

Theorem 38.1 (Finite Weil positivity). *[proved] For any X , any S_{triv} and any $r > 0$, the sequence $\mathbf{n}_\ell$ is positive definite if and only if $|\mu| \leq r$ for every $\mu \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$, algebraic multiplicities included and zero eigenvalues allowed.*

The proof is the Poisson kernel and a growth lemma. A retained $z = \mu/r$ with $|z| < 1$ contributes to $W(c)$ the integral of $|f_c(e^{i\vartheta})|^2$ against the Poisson kernel $(1 - |z|^2)/|1 - ze^{-i\vartheta}|^2 > 0$, a point $|z| = 1$ contributes $|f_c(z)|^2$, and $z = 0$ contributes $\sum |c_\ell|^2$; so the bound gives positivity. Conversely a positive definite sequence has $|\mathbf{n}_\ell| \leq \mathbf{n}_0$ from its 2×2 minors, while a retained mode outside the disc makes the sequence unbounded, because the modes of maximal modulus $R > r$ contribute R^ℓ times a trigonometric sum whose mean square over $\ell < L$ tends to the sum of squared multiplicities. The point of the theorem is what it does not say: an eigenvalue inside the disc passes. Weil positivity alone is a spectral-gap statement, and the circle needs a second input.

38.3 A duality makes it two-sided: the inflow identity

Theorem 38.2 (Reflection duality and the inflow identity). *[proved] If $\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$ is invariant under J (multiplicities preserved; in particular $0 \notin \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$), then $W(c) = M(c)$ for every finitely supported c , and the following are equivalent: $W \geq 0$; $|\mu| = r$ for every $\mu \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$; $J(\mu) = \mu$ for every $\mu \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$.*

The identity $W = M$ is the finite inflow identity: the left side is built from traces, i.e. from rings, the right side pairs each mode with its partner under the reflection. It holds whether or

not the modes are on the circle; what the circle adds is that every partner is the mode itself, so $M(c) = \sum |f_c(\mu/r)|^2$. The equivalence follows from Theorem 38.1: $|\mu| \leq r$ and $|J(\mu)| \leq r$ force $|\mu| = r$. This is exactly how RH follows from the one-sided bound $\operatorname{Re} \rho \leq \frac{1}{2}$ together with the functional equation.

Proposition 38.3 (Orbit contributions; an off-circle pair makes the form negative). [proved]
Under the hypotheses of Theorem 38.2, a J-fixed mode z of multiplicity m contributes $m|f_c(z)|^2$ to $W(c)$ and a two-element orbit $\{z, Jz\}$ contributes $2m \operatorname{Re}(f_c(z)\overline{f_c(Jz)})$; if any two-element orbit exists there is a c with $W(c) < 0$.

This is Weil's off-line pair argument in finite form; the prover's proof interpolates f_c to vanish at every other retained value, which is what makes the single negative orbit dominate the whole form.

Proposition 38.4 (Reciprocal symmetry without conjugation). [proved]
If $\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$ contains no zero and is invariant under the reciprocal map $\mu \mapsto r^2/\mu$ alone, positivity is still equivalent to $|\mu| = r$ throughout $\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$. If $\mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}$ is also closed under complex conjugation it is J-invariant and $W = M$; without conjugation symmetry $W = M$ can fail. The reciprocal map is holomorphic on $\mathbb{C}^\times$, not linear.

38.4 Kraus families: which pairing buys which half

Proposition 38.5 (Conjugation symmetry needs no pairing). [proved] *For any family $\mathcal{E}_i = \operatorname{Ad}(B_i)$ with arbitrary $B_i \in M_n$ and any fixed-point-free reversal, the antiunitary involution $x \mapsto x^\dagger$ on $\mathcal{V} = M_n$, and its componentwise version on $\mathcal{W}$, commute with Σ and with T . Hence $\operatorname{spec}(\Sigma)$ and $\operatorname{spec}(T)$ are closed under complex conjugation with multiplicities. The nonnegative ring trace $\operatorname{Tr} T^\ell = \sum_w |\operatorname{Tr} B_w|^2$ of Corollary 37.2 likewise holds for every such family, with no pairing hypothesis: its proof uses only $\operatorname{Ad}(A)\operatorname{Ad}(B) = \operatorname{Ad}(AB)$ and $\operatorname{Tr} \operatorname{Ad}(A) = |\operatorname{Tr} A|^2$.*

The draft sent to the prover asked for an inverse-paired counterexample to conjugation closure; none exists inside the Kraus class, and the independent numerics found the same. Likewise the trace formula $\operatorname{Tr} T^\ell = \sum_w |\operatorname{Tr} B_w|^2$ of Corollary 37.2 never used the pairing: it is a property of the Ad form. So every Kraus-type family, however paired, has a positive side A and a real-structured side B.

Theorem 38.6 (Inverse pairing gives the functional equation). [proved] *Let $\mathcal{E}_i = \mathcal{E}_i^{-1}$ on an N -dimensional space, $D = 2m \geq 4$, $q = D - 1$, $k = N(D - 2)/2$. Then $\operatorname{spec}(T)$ is the multiset $\{+1^{[k]}, -1^{[k]}\}$ together with, for each eigenvalue $\varkappa$ of Σ of multiplicity $a_\varkappa$, the two roots of $\mu^2 - \varkappa\mu + q$ counted $a_\varkappa$ times. The retained multiset after removing $\{+1^{[k]}, -1^{[k]}\}$ has $2N$ elements, no zero, and is invariant under $\mu \mapsto q/\mu$; it is conjugation-invariant iff $\operatorname{spec}(\Sigma)$ is. For inverse-paired Kraus matrices both hold, so the retained multiset is J-invariant for $r = \sqrt{q}$.*

The bookkeeping is where the draft was loose: a double root at $\varkappa = \pm 2\sqrt{q}$ gives $2a_\varkappa$ copies of $\pm\sqrt{q}$, and $\varkappa = \pm D$ gives extra copies of ± 1 beyond the k from the $(1 - u^2)$ factor.

Proposition 38.7 (Both pairings at once is unitarity). [proved] *$\operatorname{Ad}(B^\dagger) = \operatorname{Ad}(B)^{-1}$ iff $B^\dagger B = 1$ iff B is unitary; a family is simultaneously adjoint-paired and inverse-paired iff every B_i is unitary. A scalar $B^\dagger B = \kappa 1$ gives only $\operatorname{Ad}(B^\dagger) = \kappa^2 \operatorname{Ad}(B)^{-1}$; $B = 2$ disproves “unitary up to a scalar”.*

Theorem 38.8 (The Weil criterion for Kraus families). [proved] *(i) For an adjoint-paired Kraus family, any S_{triv} and any r , Weil positivity of $\mathfrak{n}_\ell(T; S_{\text{triv}}, r)$ is exactly the one-sided bound $|\mu| \leq r$*

off S_{triv} ; nonnegativity of the ring traces alone does not give it. (ii) For unitary, adjoint-paired B_i with $D \geq 4$, $r = \sqrt{D-1}$, $\Phi = \Sigma/D$, and $S_{\text{triv}} = \{+1^{[k]}, -1^{[k]}\}$ together with $\{q, 1\}$ once for each eigenvalue $+1$ of Φ and $\{-q, -1\}$ once for each eigenvalue -1 : Weil positivity holds iff every other eigenvalue λ of Φ satisfies $|\lambda| \leq 2\sqrt{D-1}/D$ iff every retained mode is J-fixed. Here λ is real because Φ is Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjoint.

Part (ii) is Hastings’ bound (cited fact 39.11) recovered as Weil positivity, and it is the quantum-channel case of observation 37.7: the Ramanujan property is the statement that the rescaled ring norms form a positive definite sequence.

Proposition 38.9 (An adjoint-paired family with no duality). *[proved]* For $n = 2$, $D = 4$,
 $B_1 = B_3 = \text{diag}(1, 2)$, $B_2 = B_4 = 1$, the retained spectrum of T is invariant under $\mu \mapsto c/\mu$ for no nonzero c . The Weil form is nevertheless defined and its positivity is the one-sided bound.

So for a general channel “every mode is its own partner” has, literally, no partner to refer to: the reflection exists on the punctured plane but need not send a mode to a mode. What remains is Theorem 38.1: a spectral-gap statement, the analogue of $\text{Re } \rho \leq \frac{1}{2}$ without the functional equation.

39 Weil Positivity, Continued: Continuous Time, Hilbert–Pólya, the Zeta Entry, Prior Art

This section continues Section 38 with the same objects (Definition 4.27); the status paragraph there applies.

39.1 Continuous time: cMPS and Lindblad generators

Theorem 39.1 (Continuous Weil positivity is a half-plane bound). *[proved] For a linear operator $\mathcal{L}$ on a finite-dimensional space, a trivial set S_{triv} and $a \in \mathbb{R}$, the rescaled continuous trace F of Definition 4.27 is continuous on $\mathbb{R}$ and positive definite iff $\text{Re } \varpi \leq a$ for every retained ϖ . A retained mode with $\text{Re}(\varpi - a) = -b < 0$ and $\text{Im } \varpi = \omega$ contributes the Lorentzian $2b/(b^2 + (x - \omega)^2)$ to the spectral measure, a mode on the line a point mass, and positive definiteness forces $|F| \leq F(0)$, which a mode to the right of the line violates by continuous mean-square growth.*

Theorem 39.2 (Line duality and the exact continuous pairing). *[proved] If the retained multiset is invariant under $R_a(\varpi) = 2a - \bar{\varpi}$, then for $g = \sum_j c_j \delta_{t_j}$ and $\hat{g}_{\mathcal{L}}(\varpi) = \sum_j c_j e^{t_j(\varpi - a)}$,*

$$\sum_{j,k} c_j \bar{c}_k F(t_j - t_k) = \sum_{\varpi \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{ret}}} \hat{g}_{\mathcal{L}}(\varpi) \overline{\hat{g}_{\mathcal{L}}(2a - \bar{\varpi})},$$

and F is positive definite iff $\text{Re } \varpi = a$ for every retained ϖ .

This is the continuous inflow identity: the autocorrelation of the rescaled trace equals the pairing of each mode with its reflection in the line, Weil’s form in the form $\sum_{\varpi} \hat{g}(\varpi) \overline{\hat{g}(1 - \bar{\varpi})}$.

Theorem 39.3 (Dyson expansion as continuous ring norms). *[proved] For $\mathcal{L}(x) = Kx + xK^\dagger + \sum_j R_j x R_j^\dagger$ on M_n , with no trace preservation assumed,*

$$\text{Tr}_{M_n} e^{t\mathcal{L}} = \sum_{k \geq 0} \sum_{j_1, \dots, j_k} \int_{0 < t_1 < \dots < t_k < t} \left| \text{Tr} \left(e^{(t-t_k)K} R_{j_k} e^{(t_k-t_{k-1})K} \dots R_{j_1} e^{t_1 K} \right) \right|^2 dt_1 \dots dt_k \geq 0,$$

absolutely convergent, the $k = 0$ term being $|\text{Tr } e^{tK}|^2$. Moreover $\mathcal{L}$ commutes with $x \mapsto x^\dagger$, so $\text{spec}(\mathcal{L})$ is conjugation-closed.

The free propagators between jumps were missing from the draft; without them the product is wrong for noncommuting K and R_j . This is the continuous side A: a cMPS with matrices K, R_j has ring norms given by this sum, and the transfer generator $\mathcal{L}$ is its side B. For a Hamiltonian generator $\mathcal{L} = -i[H, \cdot]$ with $H = H^\dagger$ every eigenvalue is purely imaginary and the line statement with $a = 0$ is trivial; that is the Hilbert–Pólya situation, and the content of RH in this language is the existence of a presentation in which the transfer generator is a scalar plus i times a Hermitian operator, which the next two propositions make precise.

39.2 The Hilbert–Pólya inner product, and what positivity does not see

Proposition 39.4 (Unitarisability on the retained space). *[proved] Let S_{triv} be a union of full eigenvalue classes, V' the sum of the generalised eigenspaces of the retained classes, $X' = X|_{V'}$. Then X' is diagonalisable with all eigenvalues of modulus r iff there is an inner product on V' in which X'/r is unitary.*

Proposition 39.5 (Skew-adjoint realisation). *[proved] With the same convention, $\mathcal{L}' - a$ is skew-adjoint in some inner product on V' iff $\mathcal{L}'$ is diagonalisable with all eigenvalues on $\operatorname{Re} \varpi = a$; equivalently $\mathcal{L}' = a + iH$ with H Hermitian in that inner product.*

Proposition 39.6 (Weil forms do not see Jordan blocks). *[proved] For the Jordan block $X = r \begin{pmatrix} 1 & \\ & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ with $S_{\text{triv}} = \emptyset$, $n_\ell = 2$ for all ℓ and the sequence is positive definite, although X/r is not unitarisable; likewise $\mathcal{L} = a + \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$. Weil positivity holds with multiplicities and is blind to Jordan structure; a Hilbert–Pólya inner product needs semisimplicity in addition.*

This separates two statements that are usually run together. “All modes on the critical circle” is a statement about the characteristic polynomial and is equivalent to Weil positivity. “There is a Hilbert space in which the transfer operator is r times a unitary” is stronger by exactly the absence of Jordan blocks. For the Riemann channel the distinction is the multiplicity of the zeros: a multiple zero of S gives a Jordan block of $Z(t)$ on K_S .

39.3 The zeta instance and the prior art

Observation 39.7 (The zeta dictionary entry). *[sketched] For the compressed semigroup $Z(t)$ with modes $\eta = -\bar{\rho}/2$, the critical real part is $a = -\frac{1}{4}$, the reflection $\rho \mapsto 1 - \bar{\rho}$ becomes $\eta \mapsto -\frac{1}{2} - \bar{\eta}$, the transform is $\hat{g}_\zeta(s) = \int g(t) e^{(s-1/2)t/2} dt$, and Weil’s form $\sum_\rho \hat{g}(\rho) \overline{\hat{g}(1 - \bar{\rho})}$ is the autocorrelation of the centred trace distribution, whose full-line extension is $T_Z(-u) = e^{u/2} \overline{T_Z(u)}$. The trivial modes at 0 and $-\frac{1}{2}$ and the Gamma-factor terms are not eigenmodes of $Z(t)$; they stay on the geometric side of the explicit formula. The passage from finitely many modes to ζ needs the completed-zeta data, a distributional trace realisation, the full explicit formula and the infinite Weil converse, with Bochner–Schwartz in place of Bochner.*

The prover’s T6 also derives that in the explicit-formula convention of Section 17 the prime part of the centred trace carries weight $-2\Lambda(n)n^{-1/2}$ at $\pm 2 \log n$; this is observation 17.6.

Cited fact 39.8 (Weil’s criterion). *[cited] RH holds iff the Weil scalar product $\sum_\rho F(\rho) \overline{G(1 - \bar{\rho})}$ is positive on the admissible test class [17, 62].*

Quoted (prov:cc20-weilcrit, prov:lagarias05-weil-scalar-product): In fact, following \cite{yoshida}, it is enough to prove the negativity of the right-hand side of \eqref{explicit form} for functions g with compact support in the (locally compact) multiplicative group $\mathbb{R}_{>0}$. Furthermore, given any finite set of complex numbers $F \subset \{0, 1\}$, $F \cap \mathbb{Z} = \emptyset$, using the notation $g^\sharp(x) := x^{-1} g(x^{-1})$, $\bar{g}(x) = \overline{g(x)}$, one has (Appendix \ref{apppositivity}, Proposition \ref{mainprop}) \begin{equation} \text{RH} \iff \sum_v \sum_{W \in \mathcal{W}} (g * \bar{g}^\sharp)_v \leq 0, \quad \text{for all } g \in C_c(\mathbb{R}_{>0}) \text{ with } \tilde{g}(z) = 0, \quad \text{for all } z \in F. \end{equation}

Given $F(s), G(s) \in \mathcal{S}$ we define the Weil scalar product associated to the automorphic representation π by $\langle F, G \rangle_\pi := \sum_{\rho \in Z(\pi)} F(\rho) \overline{G(1 - \bar{\rho})}$. \eq The sum on the right counts zeros with

Cited fact 39.9 (Li’s criterion). *[cited] RH iff $\lambda_n \geq 0$ for all $n \geq 1$; each condition $\lambda_n \geq 0$ encodes Weil positivity for one test function [91, 62].*

Quoted (prov:voros06-li-criterion, prov:lagarias05-li-is-weil): \emph{Li’s criterion} for the Riemann Hypothesis (RH) states that the latter is true if and only if a specific real sequence $\{\lambda_n\}_{n=1,2,\dots}$ has \emph{all its terms positive} \cite{LI1,BL}.

\begin{theorem} \label{th31} Let π be an irreducible cuspidal unitary automorphic representation of $GL(N)$, with associated ξ -function $\xi(s, \pi)$ and with Weil scalar

product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_{\text{sw}(\pi)}$. For the Li test functions $G_n(s) = 1 - (1 - \frac{1}{s})^n$ there holds $\langle G_n, G_m \rangle_{\text{sw}(\pi)} = \lambda_n(\pi) + \lambda_{-m}(\pi) - \lambda_{n-m}(\pi)$. $\square$

Cited fact 39.10 (Huang’s criterion for regular graphs). [cited]

A connected $(q + 1)$ -regular graph on n vertices is Ramanujan iff $h_k \geq 0$ for all $k \geq 1$, where for odd k , $h_k = 2(n - 1) + q^{k/2} + q^{-k/2} - q^{-k/2}N_k$ with N_k the number of cyclically non-backtracking closed walks of length k [45].

Quoted (prov:huang19-ramanujan-iff-positive, prov:huang19-hk-cycle-formula): $\begin{thm}\label{thm:Li}$ The following are equivalent: $\begin{enumerate}$ - $\mathbb{X}$ is Ramanujan.
- $h_k \geq 0$ for all $k \geq 1$.
- $h_k \geq 0$ for infinitely many even $k \geq 2$.
- $\end{enumerate}$ $\end{thm}$

$2(n-1) + q^{\frac{k}{2}} + q^{-\frac{k}{2}} - q^{-\frac{k}{2}}N_k \geq 0$ for all odd k ,

Cited fact 39.11 (Hastings’ bound).

[cited] For a quantum expander with D unitary Kraus operators the Ramanujan value of the second largest eigenvalue modulus is $\lambda_H = 2\sqrt{D-1}/D$ [42].

Quoted (prov:hastings07-lambdaH): Let λ_2 be the eigenvalue with the second largest absolute value of all eigenvalues other than λ_1 . Let $\lambda_H = \frac{2\sqrt{D-1}}{D}$. The main result of this paper is that, in the Hermitian case, for any $\epsilon > 0$ the probability that $|\lambda_2|$ is within ϵ of λ_H approaches unity as $N \rightarrow \infty$. Interestingly, this is the same as the recently proven tight bound in the classical case, but the proof in the quantum case is much simpler.

Cited fact 39.12 (Herglotz and Bochner).

[cited] A sequence is positive definite iff its Toeplitz matrices are positive semidefinite iff it is the Fourier coefficient sequence of a positive measure on the circle [1]; a continuous positive definite function on $\mathbb{R}$ is the Fourier transform of a finite positive measure [78].

Quoted (prov:acks14-herglotz, prov:norvidas20-bochner): A result of Herglotz, also known as Bochner’s theorem, asserts that: $\begin{thm}\label{Tm:Oct27yt1}$ The function $n \mapsto r(n)$ from $\mathbb{Z}$ into $\mathbb{C}^{\mathbb{N}}$ is positive definite if and only if there exists a unique positive $\mathbb{C}^{\mathbb{N}}$ -valued measure μ on $[0, 2\pi]$ such that $\begin{equation}\label{eq:Oct27nv1} r(n) = \int_0^{2\pi} e^{int} d\mu(t), \quad n \in \mathbb{Z}. \end{equation}$ $\end{thm}$

A function $f: \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is said to be positive definite if $\begin{equation}\label{1.1} \sum_{j,k=1}^n f(x_j - x_k) \overline{c_j} c_k \geq 0 \end{equation}$ holds for all finite sets of complex numbers $c_1, \dots, c_n$ and points $x_1, \dots, x_n \in \mathbb{R}$. A survey about positive definite functions and its generalizations can be found in [9]. The Bochner theorem states that a continuous function f on $\mathbb{R}$ is positive definite if and only if it is the Fourier transform of a finite nonnegative measure μ on $\mathbb{R}$, i.e. $f(x) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-ixt} d\mu(t)$.

Cited fact 39.13 (Suzuki’s kernel form).

[cited] RH is equivalent to nonnegative definiteness of the kernel $G(t, u) = g(t - u) - g(t) - g(-u) + g(0)$ built from a screw function of ζ , in the Herglotz–Nevanlinna framework, with Li’s criterion as a case of Weil positivity [87].

Quoted (prov:suzuki22-rh-iff-nnd, prov:suzuki22-weil-positivity): $\begin{thm}\label{Thm_1_3}$ The RH is true if and only if the hermitian form $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_{G_g, a}$ is non-negative definite on $\mathcal{C}_0(a)$, that is, $\langle \phi, \phi \rangle_{G_g, a} \geq 0$ for all $\phi \in \mathcal{C}_0(a)$ for every $0 < a < \infty$. Moreover, assuming that the RH is true, $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle_{G_g, a}$ is positive definite on $L^2(-a, a)$,

that is, $\langle \phi, \phi \rangle_{G,a} > 0$ for all non-zero $\phi \in L^2(-a, a)$ for every $0 < a < \infty$. \end{theorem}

showed that the RH is true if and only if the distribution W is non-negative definite, that is,

Cited fact 39.14 (PT symmetry and real spectrum).

[cited] A PT-symmetric

non-Hermitian Hamiltonian has real spectrum when the symmetry is unbroken, i.e. its eigenstates are also PT eigenstates [7].

Quoted (prov:bbm17-pt-real): (iii) Although $\hat{H}$ is not Hermitian, $\hat{H}$ is $\mathcal{CPT}$ symmetric; that is, $\hat{H}$ is invariant under parity-time reflection (in the sense to be defined), which means that the eigenvalues of $\hat{H}$ are either real or else occur in complex-conjugate pairs. If $\hat{H}$ has *maximally broken* $\mathcal{CPT}$ symmetry; that is, if all of its eigenvalues are *pure-imaginary complex-conjugate pairs*, then the eigenvalues of $\hat{H}$ are real and the Riemann hypothesis follows. (iv) While $\hat{H}$ is not Hermitian (symmetric)

Positivity criteria for RH are old (Weil; Li; the kernel form of Suzuki), and Huang’s criterion is the graph case. What is not in the literature found is the statement for an arbitrary transfer operator, the separation of the one-sided bound from the duality, and the Kraus dichotomy. Huang’s criterion is termwise rather than Toeplitz; the next observation reconciles the two.

39.4 Two observations by the orchestrator

Observation 39.15 (Huang’s criterion is the boundedness form). [proved] In finite dimensions, for a conjugation-closed retained multiset, the following are equivalent: positive definiteness of n_ℓ ; boundedness; $|n_\ell| \leq n_0$ for all ℓ ; and the termwise criterion $\operatorname{Re} n_\ell \leq n_0$ for all $\ell \geq 1$. For a connected non-bipartite $(q+1)$ -regular graph with $r = \sqrt{q}$ and $S_{\text{triv}} = \{+1^{[m-n]}, -1^{[m-n]}, q, 1\}$ (m edges, n vertices), Huang’s sequence is exactly $h_k = n_0 - n_k$ with $n_0 = 2(n-1)$, so Huang’s criterion is the boundedness form of Weil positivity. The Toeplitz form is what survives when the trace is a distribution and boundedness has no meaning.

Observation 39.16 (The Kraus dichotomy). [proved] For any Ad-type family the rings are positive and $\operatorname{spec}(\Sigma)$ and $\operatorname{spec}(T)$ are conjugation-closed. (b) Inverse pairing buys the functional equation: with $S_{\text{triv}} = \{+1^{[k]}, -1^{[k]}\}$ and $r = \sqrt{D-1}$, “all retained modes on the circle” is equivalent to: every eigenvalue $\varkappa$ of Σ is real with $|\varkappa| \leq 2\sqrt{D-1}$. (c) Adjoint pairing buys Hilbert–Schmidt self-adjointness of Σ , so $\operatorname{spec}(\Sigma)$ is real for free; $\operatorname{spec}(T)$ need not be real, and in general there is no functional equation (Proposition 38.9). (d) A family with both pairings is unitary; there the eigenvalue $\varkappa = D$ of Σ (from $\Phi(1) = 1$) always violates the band, so (b) is applied with the enlarged trivial set of Theorem 38.8(ii), $S_{\text{triv}} = \{+1^{[k]}, -1^{[k]}\} \uplus \{q^{[d+]}, 1^{[d+]}\} \uplus \{(-q)^{[d-]}, (-1)^{[d-]}\}$, and reduces to Hastings’ bound alone. Reality of $\operatorname{spec}(\Sigma)$ is the Hilbert–Pólya half; the functional equation is the other half; a Kraus family gets the two from two different pairings, and gets both only by being unitary.

The dichotomy reopens conjecture 47.1 in a sharper form: inverse-paired non-unitary families (for instance $B_i = GU_i G^{-1}$ with a common similarity G , which keeps Σ similar to a self-adjoint operator) have a genuine two-sided Ramanujan property with a positive side A, and their non-Hermitian Σ with real spectrum is the transfer-matrix version of an unbroken PT symmetry (cited fact 39.14).

Numerical result 39.17 (Numerical checks).

[numerical]

scripts/weil_positivity.py (outputs/weil_positivity.txt): random adjoint-paired families ($n = 2, 3$; $D = 4, 6$; 300 cases) satisfy “one-sided bound $\Rightarrow$ Toeplitz positivity at $L = 40$ ” without

exception, the threshold radius approaches $\max |\mu|$ off S_{triv} from below like $L^{-3/2}$ (relative gap $3 \cdot 10^{-2}$, $5 \cdot 10^{-3}$, $4.7 \cdot 10^{-4}$ at $L = 40, 160, 640$), the retained spectra are conjugation-closed to 10^{-14} and not reciprocal-invariant; Haar-unitary families reproduce Corollary 37.3 to 10^{-15} , the J-invariance, and “Weil positivity iff Hastings’ bound” on four passing and two violating families, with $W = M$ to 10^{-14} ; an inverse-paired non-unitary family has reciprocal-invariant, conjugation-closed spectrum and nonnegative ring traces to 10^{-15} ; random Lindblad-type generators have $\text{Tr } e^{t\mathcal{L}} \geq 0$ matching the Dyson expansion to 10^{-7} and Gram positivity iff $\max \text{Re } \varpi \leq a$; the Jordan block passes with n_ℓ identical to its diagonal companion. Three of thirty checks fail: they are the three drafted statements the prover corrected.

Two remarks on the numerics. Positivity at a fixed finite L is weaker than the theorem: a mode slightly outside the circle is masked by the positive contribution of the interior modes until L is large. And the $D = 4$ Pauli family $\{X, Z, X^\dagger, Z^\dagger\}$ is an exact Ramanujan example with Φ -spectrum $\{1, 0, 0, -1\}$, exercising the -1 branch of the trivial set with retained modes $\pm i\sqrt{3}$.

40 An Ihara Zeta for Complexes I: the Literature and the Two Flows

TJO’s question of 2026-09-13 was whether the Hashimoto operator, the Bass identity and “RH $\Leftrightarrow$ Ramanujan” survive when a graph becomes a finite simplicial complex, and whether the answer grades by cell dimension into an even and an odd sector. The literature answer is negative in that generality and positive on a thin class: finite quotients of affine buildings.

Status. The theorems here and in Sections 41 and 42 are the prover’s, `codex:gpt-6-astra` (notes/complex-zeta/astra-proofs.md, correction ledger T8.2, hypothesis register T8.3), carried as `sketched` pending the adversarial review; the numerics are an independent third agent’s. Each `asm`: row is an external theorem used but not reproved, byte-cited in `db/claims.tsv`.

40.1 The prototype: PGL_3

Cited fact 40.1 (Kang–Li: the PGL_3 complex zeta and its Bass identity). [cited] For a torsion-free cocompact type-preserving $\Gamma \subset \mathrm{PGL}_3(F)$, the zeta of X_Γ counts tailless primitive closed geodesics made of same-type edges, by algebraic length (0804.2305:main.tex:215-220), and $Z(X_\Gamma, u) = \frac{\{(1-u^3)^{-\chi(X_\Gamma)}\}}{\det(I - A_1u + qA_2u^2 - q^3u^3I)\det(I + L_Bu)}$, (0804.2305:main.tex:236-239); equivalently $1/D_E$ with $D_E = \det(I - L_Eu)\det(I - L_E^t u^2)$ (:247-248). Kang–Li–Wang remove the regularity hypothesis and clear denominators (0809.1401v1:main.tex:1414-1416; operators at :342-368). Note the base $(1 - u^3)$, the *plus* sign in $\det(I + L_Bu)$ and the u^2 on the transposed edge factor [52, 53].

Cited fact 40.2 (Kang–Li–Wang: RH is four-way equivalent to Ramanujan, on three circles). [cited] X_Γ is a Ramanujan complex; \item [(2)] The nontrivial zeros of $\det(I - A_1u + qA_2u^2 - q^3u^3I)$ have absolute value q^{-1} ; \item [(3)] The nontrivial zeros of $\det(I + L_Bu)$ have absolute values 1 , $q^{-1/2}$ and $q^{-1/4}$; and \item [(4)] The nontrivial zeros of $\det(I - L_Eu)$ have absolute values q^{-1} and $q^{-1/2}$. (0804.2305:main.tex:285-295). Unlike the graph case RH is not a single circle: three for the chamber factor, two for the edge factor. In type $\tilde{C}_2$ it degrades to bands, $|u| = q^\alpha$ with $-2 \leq \alpha \leq -1$ (1109.3854:zetagsp4-final.tex:145-157) [33].

40.2 All ranks: an alternating product over facet dimension

Cited fact 40.3 (Kang–Yu: the uniform PGL_n identity is a torsion). [cited] $(1-u^n)^{-\chi(X_\Gamma)}$, $L(\Gamma, q^{(n-1)/2}u) = \prod_{k=1}^{n-1} Z_k^{-\epsilon_k(X_\Gamma, u)^{-1}}$, (2607.21262:main.tex:2019-2023), each factor a reciprocal determinant $\det(I - (-1)^{k+1}T_k)^{-1}$ of a successor operator (:2304-2312) with the parity sign $\epsilon = (-1)^{(k+1)l_G}$ (:1971-1981). The Euler factor is literally a torsion: the alternating product of $\det \Phi_i$ on cochains equals the same on cohomology, where Φ_i acts by $1 - u^n$ (:2463-2470), a strategy that It is inspired instead by Hoffman’s reformulation of Bass’s proof of the Ihara identity in terms of torsion of complexes~\cite{Hof}. (:354-356). The source states *no* RH [55].

Cited fact 40.4 (Lubetzky–Lubotzky–Parzanchevski: the branching geodesic flow). [cited] The higher-dimensional Hashimoto operator is multi-valued: The geodesic flow T on $\mathrm{UT}^j(\mathcal{B})$ is defined as follows: $T(\sigma)$ for $\sigma = (v_0, (v_0, \dots, v_j))$ in $\mathrm{UT}^j(\mathcal{B})$, with $(v_i) \equiv (v_0) + i$, consists of all the cells $\sigma' = (v_1, (v_1, \dots, v_j, w))$ in $\mathrm{UT}^j(\mathcal{B})$ such that (1702.05452:rw_ramanujan_complex.tex:1009-1019), the two

conditions being consecutive colours and geodicty (the union must not be a cell); in dimension one this is non-backtracking. A k -out-regular digraph is Ramanujan when every eigenvalue has $|\lambda| \leq \sqrt{k}$ or $|\lambda| = k$ (:333-336) [67].

Cited fact 40.5 (The higher-rank RH is one-sided, and the interior really is occupied). [cited]Then $Z_{\{T, fX\}}(u)$ satisfies the Riemann Hypothesis; that is, if $Z_{\{T, fX\}}(u)$ has a pole at k^{-s} then $|s|=1$ or $\operatorname{Re} s \leq \frac{1}{2}$. (1702.05452:rw_ramanujan_complex.tex:410-416), for every building. The inequality is not an equality: the source states that poles with $|\operatorname{Re} s| < \frac{1}{2}$ occur, already with $|\operatorname{Re} s| = 0$ in the graph case and with $0 < |\operatorname{Re} s| < \frac{1}{2}$ in higher dimension (:1420-1424).

Cited fact 40.6 (Kamber: the converse, as an L_p criterion). [cited]With one Bernstein–Lusztig operator h_{β_i} per simple coweight and $\zeta = \prod_i \det(1 - h_{\beta_i} u^{l(\beta_i)})^{-1}$ (1701.00154:L_p_Expander_Complexes.tex:352-358) one gets an if-and-only-if: The complex XX is an L_p -expander if and only if every pole λ of $\zeta_{\hat{B}_{\phi}}(u)$ satisfies $|\lambda| \leq q^{-(p-1)/p}$ or $|\lambda| = q$. (:359-363), Ramanujan meaning L_2 -expander. “Any complex” there means any quotient of an affine building [50].

40.3 What happens off the buildings

Cited fact 40.7 (Storm: the hypergraph zeta is a bipartite graph zeta). [cited]Reading a complex as a hypergraph does give a zeta (`math/0608761:Ihara-SelbergofHypergraph.tex:173-174`), with a Bass identity (:463) and an if-and-only-if Ramanujan theorem (:627-630) — but all of it because $[\zeta_{\text{hyperH}}(u) = Z_{\{B_{\text{hyperH}}\}}(\sqrt{u})]$ (:430): it is the Ihara zeta of the incidence bipartite graph in $\sqrt{u}$, blind to the simplicial structure beyond incidence [84].

Cited fact 40.8 (Benard–Chaubet–Dang–Schick: a general triangulation has a zeta, but no Ramanujan). [cited]On any triangulation of a compact oriented n -manifold the geodicty rule is exactly LLP’s — consecutive $(n-1)$ -simplices must not bound a common n -simplex (2303.11226:zeta_triangulations9.tex:165-172) — and The combinatorial zeta function $\zeta_{\mathcal{T}}(z) = \prod_{\gamma \in \mathcal{P}} (1 - \varepsilon_{\gamma} z^{|\gamma|})$, $\zeta_{\mathcal{T}}$ is a polynomial of degree $|\mathcal{T}^{(n-1)}|$ vanishing to order $b_1(M)$ at $z = (n+2)^{-1}$ (:192-205). A Fried-type torsion theorem: that point is not $q^{-1/2}$, and there is no spectral-gap statement [6].

Cited fact 40.9 (No Ihara-type zeta of a general finite complex exists). [cited]Four sources say so in their own words: There is no Ihara-formula for higher rank up to date. (`math/0407509:main.tex:174`, 2004); Lubotzky’s 2018 ICM survey still calls attaching zetas to high-dimensional complexes a direction of research “with the hope that” Ramanujanness can be read off RH (1712.02526:main.tex:497); Hong–Kwon name “the lack of a unified zeta function” in higher rank (2411.15489:main.tex:354); and Kang–Yu claim only that theirs is To our knowledge, it is the first Ihara-type identity uniform in (n) for this family. (2607.21262:main.tex:249-250). This is a record of what was searched, not an impossibility theorem [22, 69, 43].

40.4 The graded reading, in the literature’s own words

Cited fact 40.10 (Deitmar: a Deligne-type alternating product, and a positive Euler exponent). [cited]For locally symmetric spaces the Ruelle zeta is an alternating product over exterior degree, $Z_{\{P, \phi\}}^R(s) = \prod_{l=0}^{\dim N}$

$Z_{\{P, \sigma_1, \phi\}}(s+1|\alpha) \sim (-1)^1$, (dg-ga/9511006:main.tex:1153-1168), and the divisor is a *degree-weighted* alternating sum $-\sum_p p(-1)^p \dim H^p$ (:1194-1212), the plain Euler sum vanishing identically. Deitmar and Kang take the Euler factors with a positive exponent, because that exponent *is* an Euler number (1303.6848:main.tex:803) [21, 23].

Cited fact 40.11 (Dyatlov–Zworski: odd upstairs, even downstairs, order $-\chi$). [cited] For a negatively curved oriented surface, $\zeta_R(s) = \frac{\zeta_1(s)}{\zeta_0(s)\zeta_2(s)}$, $\text{quad } s \in \mathbb{C}$. so that the order at 0 is $m_1(0) - m_0(0) - m_2(0)$ (1606.04560:zazi.tex:843-855), and $s^{\chi(\Sigma)} \zeta_R(s)$ is holomorphic and nonzero at $s = 0$ (:68-77). Even sectors contribute 1 each, the odd sector b_1 : the continuous prototype of the graded reading [30].

Cited fact 40.12 (Hashimoto’s special value: the trees sit in the vertex determinant). [cited] With $h_X(u) = \det(I - Au + (D - I)u^2)$ and $\kappa(X)$ the tree number, $h_X'(1) = -2 \chi(X) \kappa(X)$, (2310.15619:main.tex:950-955). The complexity is carried by the Laplacian factor, not by the Euler factor $(1 - u^2)^\chi$, whose role is to cancel its zero at $u = 1$ [56].

Cited fact 40.13 (Knill: graph analytic torsion is a super pseudodeterminant). [cited] Torsion $\mathcal{A}(G)$ agrees with the super pseudo determinant $\mathcal{S}(\text{rm SDet})(D) = \prod_k \text{rm Det}(D_k)^{(-1)^k}$ of the Dirac blocks $D_k = d_k * d_k$ of the Dirac operator $D = d + d^*$ and is the ratio of rooted spanning trees on even-dimensional simplices to those on odd simplices (2201.09412:reidemeister.tex:42-52). Knill never mentions the Ihara zeta, nor the Ihara literature SDet [58].

Cited fact 40.14 (Matsuura–Ohta: a fermionic proof of Bass’s identity on a graph). [cited] One Grassmann field on vertices and two per oriented edge, a Dirac operator off-diagonal between them, and two Schur evaluations of one determinant give $(1 - t^2)^{n_E - n_V} \det \Delta$ (2501.08803:main.tex:750-755) and $\zeta_{\Gamma}(q, u)^{-1} = (1 - t^2)^{n_E - n_V} \det \Delta_{\{q, u\}} = \det \left((I_{2n_E} - qB_u) \right)$, . (:811-826). The Euler exponent is the fermionic determinant of the edge-reversal involution, $\det(I - tJ) = (1 - t^2)^{n_E}$ [73].

40.5 Hypothesis register

Assumption 40.15 (H-POINT: building successor conventions). [assumed] Pointed facets, cyclically increasing ordered type, algebraic step length λ_0 , link opposition, and quotient incidences, as in Definition 6.2.

Assumption 40.16 (H-LLP: branching flows and the digraph bound). [assumed] UT^j with consecutive colours and the geodicty exclusion; and, for an equivariant collision-free b -regular branching operator on a Ramanujan complex, $|\lambda| \leq \sqrt{b}$ off the peripheral $|\lambda| = b$, with interior radii genuinely occurring (cited facts 40.4 and 40.5).

Assumption 40.17 (H-KL: the rank-three identity and its four-way RH). [assumed] With $P_3(u) = I - A_1u + qA_2u^2 - q^3u^3I$, $D_E = \det(I - uL_E) \det(I - u^2L_E^t)$, $D_B = \det(I + uL_B)$: $D_B/D_E = (1 - u^3)^{\chi} / \det P_3$, the four-way equivalence of cited facts 40.1 and 40.2, and the L -normalisation of Kang–Li–Wang [54].

Assumption 40.18 (H-KY: the all-rank pointed cochain identity). [assumed] The deformed pointed cochains carry $d(u)$, a degree -1 map $\delta(u)$ and $\Phi_i = (1 - u^n)I + d_{i-1}\delta_i + \delta_{i+1}d_i$, with $\det \Phi_0 = \det P_n = \det \sum_j (-1)^j q^{j(j-1)/2} u^j A_j$ and $\det \Phi_i = (1 - u^n)^{if_i} \det(I - s_i T_i(u))$, $i \geq 1$ (cited fact 40.3).

Assumption 40.19 (H-KY-LOCAL: the local factorisation behind equivariant use). [assumed] $\Phi_i = cW_i^{-1}J_i(I - s_i\Sigma_i)J_i^{-1}Q_i^{-1}$ with Q_i unipotent in the ordered-type filtration, J_i cyclic rotation, Σ_i carrying the same weighted closed paths as T_i , and $\Phi_0 = P_n$ as an *operator* (2607.21262:main.tex:2516-2576, 2586-2640, 2930-2968, 2973-3091).

Assumption 40.20 (H-KL-TABLE: the Iwahori-spherical constituents). [assumed] The unitary Iwahori-spherical types, their fixed-space dimensions and determinant roots, the Steinberg multiplicity $3\chi-3$, and the representation-wise conjugate-pair cancellations (0809.1401v1:main.tex:391-424, 1132-1154, 1171-1209, 1425-1461).

Assumption 40.21 (H-LSV: the joint Hecke spectrum and the explicit complexes). [assumed] The colour-shift convention, commuting normality with $A_k^* = A_{n-k}$, the tempered joint spectrum Aspec_n with its type-trivial exceptions, and the explicit Ramanujan Cayley clique complexes on $\text{PGL}_n(\mathbb{F}_{q^e})$ (Definitions 6.4 and 6.5).

Assumption 40.22 (H-STRONG: Iwahori-spherical temperedness). [assumed] LLP's Ramanujan condition asks every infinite-dimensional *Iwahori-spherical* constituent of $\ell^2(\Gamma \backslash G)$ to be tempered; this can be strictly stronger than the vertex condition, and the LSV examples satisfy it (1702.05452:rw_ramanujan_complex.tex:196-214, 674-701).

Assumption 40.23 (H-KAMBER: the normalised one-sided criterion). [assumed] p -temperedness is equivalent to $|\theta| \leq q^{l(\beta_i)(p-1)/p}$ for every eigenvalue θ of h_{β_i} (cited fact 40.6); the bound is on eigenvalues, so it inverts to a *lower* bound $|u| \geq q^{-(p-1)/p}$ on pole radii.

40.6 The two flows are not the same flow

Theorem 40.24 (Ordered flow versus building flow, exactly, in rank three). [proved-conditional] *Let X be a simplicial type-preserving torsion-free finite quotient of the PGL_3 building. Then (i) the colour-1 restriction of the edge successor relation is L_E and the colour-2 one is conjugate by edge reversal to L_E^t , so $T_1(u) = uL_E \oplus u^2L_E^t$ and $D_E(u) = \det(I - uL_E) \det(I - u^2L_E^t)$; (ii) $T_2(u) = uL_B$ on the $3f_2$ cyclically ordered pointed chambers; (iii) the unrestricted T_1 of Definition 6.1 is not this block sum even after replacing u^2 by u — its outdegree is $2q^2 + q$ against q^2 for L_E , and its directed-colour classes are not invariant; (iv) T_2 has two invariant cyclic orientations of dimension $3f_2$, transposes of one another, so $\det_{H_2}(I + uT_2) = D_B(u)^2$. The u^2 is an algebraic length, not a matrix square, and the $3!$ orderings do not realise L_B once.*

Theorem 40.25 (Which zeta reduces to which). [proved-conditional] *With the pointed data of Definition 6.2, $Z_{\text{pt}} = D_B/D_E = (1 - u^3)^{\chi L_{\text{vertex}}}$, while $Z_{\text{KL}} = 1/D_E$ and $L_{\text{vertex}} = 1/\det P_3$. The graded total is therefore the completed vertex L -function, not Kang–Li's edge-only zeta; with the unrestricted ordered operators it is neither. The orchestrator's draft asserted that the total graded zeta equals Kang–Li's $Z(X_\Gamma, u)$; the prover refuted that, and the above is the correction.*

41 An Ihara Zeta for Complexes II: the Graded Geodesic Determinant

What survives on an arbitrary finite complex is a rational compression, not a polynomial Bass identity; what survives on a building is the full Hecke and torsion apparatus. Notation and the hypothesis rows **asm:h-*** are those of Section 40; Section 42 carries the twisted and quantum layer, which sits on the building side, not the general one.

41.1 Torsion, compression, and the obstruction

Theorem 41.1 (Finite cochain determinant cancellation). *[proved]* Let $(C^\bullet, d)$ be a bounded finite-dimensional cochain complex over $K = \mathbb{C}(u)$, h any degree -1 map, $c \in K^\times$, and suppose each $F_i = cI + d_{i-1}h_i + h_{i+1}d_i$ is invertible. Then $\prod_i \det(F_i|C^i)^{(-1)^i} = \prod_i \det(F_i|H^i)^{(-1)^i} = c^{\sum_i (-1)^i \dim C^i}$. Neither $h^2 = 0$ nor $h = d^*$ is required. The exponent is the dimension count of the complex used: $\chi(X)$ for ordinary cochains, $\sum_i (-1)^i (i+1)! f_i$ for all ordered cells, $\sum_i (-1)^i (i+1) f_i$ for pointed cochains — already $\chi = 1$ against 0 on a single edge.

Theorem 41.2 (The ordinary Euler factor is a difference of two weighted sums). *[proved-conditional]* Under H -KY, $\prod_i \det \Phi_i^{(-1)^i} = (1 - u^n)^{\chi_{\text{pt}}}$ with $\chi_{\text{pt}} = \sum_i (-1)^i (i+1) f_i$, and subtracting the local $\sum_{i \geq 1} (-1)^i i f_i$ contributions leaves $\mathcal{Z}_{\text{pt}}(X, u) = (1 - u^n)^{\chi(X)} / \det P_n(u)$. The bare cochain superdeterminant carries the weighted exponent; only the final flow/vertex comparison carries the ordinary χ . The draft's identification of the cochain product's exponent with χ was wrong.

Theorem 41.3 (Universal ordered-cell Bass–Schur identity). *[proved]* For every finite abstract simplicial complex and every $1 \leq k \leq d$, with R_k the first-vertex deletion, S_k the append map, C_k cyclic rotation, $F_k = C_k + R_{k+1}S_{k+1}$ and $K_k(z) = I + zF_k$: $T_k = S_k R_k - F_k$ and

$$\det_{H_k}(I - zT_k) = \det_{H_k} K_k(z) \det_{H_{k-1}}(I - zR_k K_k(z)^{-1} S_k).$$

This is an explicit rational compression by one dimension, retaining vertices, ordered edges and the upper-cell cyclic factor; it is not a degree- $(d+1)$ polynomial on vertices.

Corollary 41.4 (Bass for every graph, with no regularity assumption). *[proved]* If $d = 1$ then $F_1 = J$ is edge reversal, $\det(I + uJ) = (1 - u^2)^{f_1}$, $R_1 S_1 = A$, $R_1 J S_1 = \text{Deg}$, and $\det(I - uT_1) = (1 - u^2)^{f_1 - f_0} \det_{H_0}(I - uA + u^2(\text{Deg} - I))$. Isolated vertices and trees are included by rational cancellation.

Proposition 41.5 (The tetrahedron obstruction: no universal cubic collapse). *[proved]* On $X = \partial\Delta^3$, $(f_0, f_1, f_2) = (4, 6, 4)$, $\chi = 2$, $T_1 = 0$, $\det(I + uT_2) = (1 - u^4)^6$ and $\mathcal{Z}_{\text{ord}} = (1 - u^4)^6$. There is no matrix polynomial $P(u)$ of any size or degree with $\mathcal{Z}_{\text{ord}} = (1 - u^3)^{\chi} / \det P(u)$: that would force $\det P = (1 - u^3)^2 / (1 - u^4)^6$, which has poles at $u = -1, \pm i$. The orchestrator's draft asked for a universal cubic vertex Bass identity on every 2-complex with local coefficients Q_1, Q_2 ; the prover refuted it here, and Theorem 41.3 is the surviving universal replacement.

41.2 The graded reading and what it does not say

Theorem 41.6 (The exact graded identity). *[proved]* With odd part $\bigoplus_{k \text{ odd}} H_k$, even part $\bigoplus_{k \text{ even}, k \geq 2} H_k$ and $\Theta = \bigoplus_k s_k T_k$, $\mathcal{Z}_{\text{ord}}(X, u) = \text{sdet}(I - u\Theta)^{-1}$ and $\log \mathcal{Z}_{\text{ord}} = \sum_m \frac{u^m}{m} \text{str}(\Theta^m) = \sum_m \frac{u^m}{m} \sum_k s_k^{m+1} \text{Tr}(T_k^m)$. The order at $u_0 \neq 0$ is the odd minus the

even algebraic multiplicity of u_0^{-1} ; zero eigenvalues give no finite zero or pole, and common even/odd factors cancel. The draft's "the zeros are exactly the odd eigenvalues" is false without the reciprocal, sign, multiplicity and cancellation qualifications.

Proposition 41.7 (Cancellation: the reduced vertex L -function has no finite zeros). *[proved-conditional]* Under H -KL, $L_{\text{vertex}}(u) = D_B / ((1-u^3)^x D_E) = 1 / \det P_3(u)$. In the factorised expression the chamber determinant is a numerator and the edge determinants denominators, but the reduced function is a reciprocal polynomial: every finite zero of D_B cancels, with multiplicity, against an edge or Euler factor. Calling the chamber zeros uncanceled zeros of L_{vertex} , as the draft did, is therefore wrong.

Proposition 41.8 (The cohomology dictionary is parity only). *[proved]* The reindexing $i = k-1$ matches the exponents of the Grothendieck–Lefschetz convention $\prod_i \det(I - u \text{Fr} | H^i)^{(-1)^{i+1}}$, but does not identify H_k or $\mathbb{C}^{P_k}$ with cohomology of X , nor assign Weil weight $k-1$: a 3-cycle has six ordered-edge states and one-dimensional H^0 , and the chamber radii are not those of a single pure weight.

Proposition 41.9 (Which constituents supply the three chamber circles). *[proved-conditional]* Under H -KL and H -KL-TABLE, on a Ramanujan quotient: tempered principal series give chamber roots $\pm q^{-1/2} \alpha_i^{-1/2}$ and edge roots $q^{-1} \alpha_i^{-1}$; the tempered nonspherical type gives one chamber root at $q^{-1/2}$ and two at $q^{-1/4}$; Steinberg twists give the unit circle; one-dimensional constituents give trivial roots at q^{-1} . So the circle $q^{-1/2}$ is not "the odd sector", and a single constituent can contribute to two circles at once.

41.3 An incidence matrix, and why the total is a Berezinian

Theorem 41.10 (One explicit incidence matrix with two Schur evaluations). *[proved]* On $H_{k-1} \oplus H_k \oplus H_{k+1}$ let $\mathbb{D}_k(z)$ have diagonal $(I, I + zC_k, I)$ and off-diagonal couplings $-R_k, -zS_k, zR_{k+1}, -S_{k+1}$ between adjacent dimensions. Then $\det \mathbb{D}_k(z) = \det_{H_k}(I - zT_k) = \det K_k(z) \det_{H_{k-1}} M_k(z)$. Eliminating the edge mass first instead gives an honest coupled vertex/triangle block, which disappears when there are no triangles.

Theorem 41.11 (The total object needs a ratio, not one fermion determinant). *[proved]* Giving the whole auxiliary space of $\mathbb{D}_k(s_k u)$ parity $k+1$ and setting $\mathbb{D}_{\text{flow}} = \bigoplus_k \mathbb{D}_k(s_k u)$ gives $\text{sdet } \mathbb{D}_{\text{flow}}(u) = Z_{\text{ord}}(X, u)^{-1}$. An ordinary Berezin integral gives $\det D$, not a reciprocal or a superdeterminant merely because D has chiral blocks; the construction uses separate auxiliary copies of some cell spaces, so cell chirality and flow superparity are distinct gradings. The draft's universal ordinary fermion determinant with flow parity equal to cell chirality does not exist.

41.4 Arbitrary weights and Kraus rings

Theorem 41.12 (Arbitrary weights preserve the compression). *[proved]* With the connection of Definition 6.6 and S_k, C_k replaced by their weighted versions, $T_k^E = S_k^E R_k - F_k^E$ and the identity of Theorem 41.3 holds verbatim over $V \otimes H_k$, with no positivity, pairing, invertibility or flatness hypothesis and no inverse of any E_e . Any other successor rule with the same overlap admits the same construction, by letting F be the sum of its forbidden weighted transitions.

Theorem 41.13 (Ring traces, primitive product, and positivity without pairing). *[proved]* $\text{Tr}(T_k^E)^m = \sum \text{Tr}_V(E_m \cdots E_1)$ over based closed walks in the state digraph; for $V = M_n$ and $E_e = \text{Ad}(B_e)$ this is $\sum |\text{Tr}(B_m \cdots B_1)|^2 \geq 0$. Adjoint pairing is not needed: complete positivity of the step maps suffices, as in Corollary 37.2. The unsigned factor is $\prod_{[\gamma]} \det_V(I - u^{|\gamma|} E_\gamma)^{-1}$ over primitive classes; for the signed factor replace E_γ by $s_k^{|\gamma|} E_\gamma$.

Proposition 41.14 (The scope of the positive-ring no-go). [proved] *A single finite transfer matrix contributes a reciprocal polynomial, so it has no nonconstant reduced numerator; in this finite model a numerator comes from net odd multiplicity between sectors. Positivity of a numerical ring sequence alone does not force this: $(1-u)/(1-2u)$ has nonnegative coefficients and positive logarithmic coefficients $(2^m - 1)/m$, yet a genuine numerator.*

Observation 41.15 (The natural object, and what “natural” means here). [proved] Definition 6.3 is functorial under isomorphisms preserving states, lengths, successor incidences and transports; it is not proved unique among possible choices of higher-dimensional geodesic. For a graph the default is Hashimoto’s operator and there is only an even flow sector; for a building quotient it is the completed vertex product of Theorem 41.2; the Kang–Li zeta is obtained by retaining only the edge factor.

41.5 The three smallest exact tests

Numerical result 41.16 (Three smallest exact tests, on the ordered default). [numerical]
 C_3 (unfilled): $\det(I - uT_1) = (1 - u^3)^2$, no chamber factor, total $(1 - u^3)^{-2}$. Filled Δ^2 : both flows vanish, total 1 — there is no forced $(1 - u^3)$ factor. $\partial\Delta^3$: $T_1 = 0$, $\det(I + uT_2) = (1 - u^4)^6$, total $(1 - u^4)^6$. The optional clique-only fourth test, the octahedron $K_{2,2,2}$, gives $(1 - u^6)^8/(1 - u^4)^6$, again with a pole at $u = -1$ in the would-be vertex expression. Checked exactly with `sympy`.

42 An Ihara Zeta for Complexes III: Twists, Quantum Expanders, Numerics

The twisted layer of Section 41. Arbitrary weights already keep the compression (Theorem 41.12) and already give nonnegative ring traces (Theorem 41.13); what needs care is *which* twisted object is the Artin one, and what a Ramanujan complex buys for a channel.

42.1 Gauge triviality and the voltage quotient

Proposition 42.1 (A representation connection on the full complex is pure gauge). *[proved] On a Cayley complex the forward weights $E_{(g,gs)} = \varrho(s)$ are generally not flat (flatness asks $\varrho(t)\varrho(s) = \varrho(st)$); the covariant convention is $\varrho(s^{-1})$, and those weights are pure gauge, $F_g = \varrho(g^{-1})$, so $\det(I - uT_k^E) = \det(I - uT_k)^{\dim V}$: every closed straight walk of the full complex has identity holonomy. The four-cycle with $G = \mathbb{Z}/4$ and one-dimensional π separates the full twist $(1-u^4)^2$ from the trivial-block determinant $(1-u)^2$, refuting the draft's claim that the full twist is a representation block.*

Theorem 42.2 (The Artin decomposition of a voltage quotient). *[proved] With the data of Definition 6.7 and a free action on states, $\det(I - s_k T_k(u)) = \prod_{\varrho} \det(I - s_k T_{k,\varrho}(u))^{d_{\varrho}}$. For $R = \bigoplus_{\varrho} a_{\varrho} \varrho$ the Artin determinant has exponents a_{ϱ} , not d_{ϱ} : $R = \pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$ need not embed in a single regular representation (for $\pi = 1 \oplus 1$, $R = 1^{\oplus 4}$). What always transfers is spectral support. An equivariant matrix identity restricts to every block; a scalar determinant equality need not.*

Theorem 42.3 (Exact Euler-factor bookkeeping on finite-group blocks). *[proved-conditional] Under H-KY and H-KY-LOCAL, with $w_{i,\varrho} = \det(W_i|C_{i,\varrho})$, $\mathcal{Z}_{\varrho}(u) = F_{\varrho}(u)/\det(P_n|C_{0,\varrho})$ where $F_{\varrho} = c^{m_{0,\varrho}} \prod_{i \geq 1} w_{i,\varrho}^{(-1)^i}$ and $\prod_{\varrho} F_{\varrho}^{d_{\varrho}} = c^{\chi(X)}$. Only if the action is free on unpointed simplices does this collapse to $F_{\varrho} = c^{d_{\varrho}\chi/|G|}$; with simplex stabilisers the fractional power is not a rational determinant and must not be asserted.*

42.2 Quantum expanders of type $\tilde{A}_{n-1}$

Theorem 42.4 (Harrow-type transfer, with the correct exceptional space). *[proved-conditional] Under H-LSV, for every finite-dimensional unitary π : (i) the Φ_k are commuting normal unitary trace-preserving channels with $\Phi_k^* = \Phi_{n-k}$, whose common fixed space is the commutant $\pi(G)'$, of dimension one exactly when π is irreducible; (ii) they satisfy Definition 6.8 relative to $\mathcal{E}_R$; (iii) $P_{n,R}(u)$ restricted to $\mathcal{E}_R^{\perp}$ has all zeros on $|u| = q^{-(n-1)/2}$; (iv) under H-KL the rank-three quotient Artin flow factors inherit the radii of cited fact 40.2; (v) under H-KY, H-STRONG and H-LLP, general rank gives only the one-sided bound of Proposition 42.6. Removing only the channel fixed points, as the draft did, leaves type characters that violate the tempered bound.*

Proposition 42.5 (The exact converse criterion; one faithful π is not enough). *[proved] Let $\mathcal{B}_X$ be the irreducibles with a nonexceptional joint eigenvalue outside Aspec_n . Then R is Ramanujan iff $\mathcal{B}_X \cap \text{supp}(R) = \emptyset$, and X is vertex-Ramanujan iff $\mathcal{B}_X = \emptyset$; coverage of every nonexceptional irreducible by $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$ is sufficient for the converse. Faithfulness is not: for $G = \mathbb{Z}/28$, $S = \{\pm 1, \pm 3\}$, the Cayley graph is not Ramanujan yet a faithful character has $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi} = 1$ and a vacuous quantum condition.*

Proposition 42.6 (One-sided RH, in the correct variable). *[proved-conditional] Under H-LLP, for a b -regular flow with zeta $\det(I - uT)^{-1}$, a pole at $u = b^{-s}$ has $\text{Re } s = 1$ when $|\lambda| = b$*

and $\operatorname{Re} s \leq \frac{1}{2}$ when $|\lambda| \leq \sqrt{b}$, the imaginary part being defined only modulo $2\pi/\log b$; the source's printed $|s| = 1$ cannot literally replace $\operatorname{Re} s = 1$. Under *H-KAMBER* the actual nontrivial pole radii satisfy $|u| \geq q^{-(p-1)/p}$: the quoted eigenvalue bound inverts.

Proposition 42.7 (Which rank-three factors have a duality). [proved-conditional] With $A_2 = A_1^*$ and $p_a(u) = 1 - au + q\bar{a}u^2 - q^3u^3$, the zero multiset is invariant under $u \mapsto q^{-2}/\bar{u}$, before imposing Ramanujan; the principal-series parts of the edge and chamber factors inherit dualities at q^{-2} and q^{-1} . The full edge and chamber factors do not: a tempered nonspherical block has one root at radius $q^{-1/2}$ and two at $q^{-1/4}$, so no $u \mapsto c/\bar{u}$ or $u \mapsto c/u$ can fix or exchange them. Higher-rank *RH* has no universal functional equation.

Proposition 42.8 (Weil positivity on a retained block is a bound until a duality is supplied). [proved] For a retained finite block M with algebraic eigenvalue multiset $\{\mu_j\}$ and $r > 0$, the sequence $\nu_m = \sum_j (\mu_j/r)^m$ is positive definite exactly when $|\mu_j| \leq r$ throughout; invariance of the multiset under $\mu \mapsto r^2/\bar{\mu}$ then forces $|\mu| = r$. This is the finite statement of Theorem 38.1, applied to each retained ordinary block, and it does not transfer automatically to an alternating product with negative spectral multiplicities.

42.3 Numerics on the smallest $\tilde{A}_2$ Ramanujan complex

Numerical result 42.9 (The smallest $\tilde{A}_2$ Ramanujan complex). [numerical] `scripts/a2_complex_zeta.py` (`outputs/a2_complex_zeta.txt`), LSV algorithm at $q = 3$, $d = 3$, $e = 1$: $|S_1| = 13$, $\langle S_1 \rangle = \operatorname{PGL}_3(\mathbb{F}_q[3])$ of order 5616, $S_2 = S_1^{-1}$, $f = (5616, 73008, 97344)$, $\chi = 29952 = |G| \cdot 16/3$, every vertex link the incidence graph of $\operatorname{PG}(2, 3)$ (26 vertices, 4-regular, bipartite, girth 6). Two facts not anticipated in the brief: the complex is *not* 3-colourable ($\operatorname{PGL}_3(\mathbb{F}_q[3])$ is simple), so Kang–Li's type-preservation hypothesis (I) fails on it; and all 13 generators have order 3, so the 24336 triangles carry $\mathbb{Z}/3$ stabilisers and G is not free on unpointed 2-cells. A type-preserving 3-fold cover with $f_0 = 16848$, $\chi = 89856$ is built alongside.

Numerical result 42.10 (The vertex spectrum is tempered). [numerical] $A_2 = A_1^t$ exactly, A_1 normal, $[A_1, A_2] = 0$ (exact sparse check). Of the 5616 eigenvalues of A_1 exactly one is trivial ($\lambda = 13$); all 5615 others are tempered by Cohn's self-inversive criterion, maximum defect $2.0 \cdot 10^{-14}$, and $\max |\lambda| = 7.126860684 < 3q = 9$. So the complex is Ramanujan and cited fact 40.2(2) holds outright.

Numerical result 42.11 (The corrected identity, and the drafted one failing). [numerical] Traces computed exactly as integers by the free G -action: $\operatorname{Tr} L_E^m = 0$ for $m \leq 5$, then 657072 at $m = 6$ up to $1.5 \cdot 10^{17}$ at $m = 18$; $\operatorname{Tr} L_B^m = 0$ for $m \leq 14$, then 16426800 at $m = 15$. Verified exactly to u^{18} , on the 5616-vertex base *and* on the 16848-vertex type-preserving cover: $\det P_3(u) \det(I + uL_B) = (1 - u^3)^\chi \det(I - uL_E) \det(I - u^2L_E^t)$, with degree 308880 on both sides and the residual fitting χ exactly (29952, resp. 89856) at every order. The placement written in the orchestrator's brief fails at u^3 (residual -59904) and fails the degree count (398736 against 219024); $\det(I - uL_B)$ in place of $\det(I + uL_B)$ first fails at u^{15} . The identity holds on the base even though type preservation fails there.

Numerical result 42.12 (Flow operators: the prover's cross-checks). [numerical] L_E has outdegree exactly $q^2 = 9$ and L_B outdegree $q = 3$, whereas the unrestricted ordered edge rule has outdegree $2q^2 + q = 21$: it is not Kang–Li's operator. On all six orderings of a chamber, $\operatorname{Tr} T_2^m = 2 \operatorname{Tr} L_B^m$ for $m = 1, \dots, 18$, i.e. $\det(I + uT_2) = \det(I + uL_B)^2$. On $\partial\Delta^3$, $T_1 = 0$ and T_2 is a permutation of cycle type 4^6 . All three confirm Theorem 40.24 and Proposition 41.5.

Numerical result 42.13 (The three circles, exactly, on two blocks). [numerical] Trivial block: $|\lambda(L_E)| \in \{9 (\times 1), \sqrt{3} (\times 12)\}$ and $|\lambda(L_B)| \in \{3, \sqrt{3} (\times 12), 3^{1/4} (\times 24), 1 (\times 15)\}$. Twelve-dimensional block: $|\lambda(L_E)| \in \{3 (\times 36), \sqrt{3} (\times 120)\}$ and $|\lambda(L_B)| \in \{\sqrt{3} (\times 192), 3^{1/4} (\times 240), 1 (\times 192)\}$. Exactly the radii $\{1, 3^{1/4}, 3^{1/2}\}$ for L_B and $\{3, \sqrt{3}\}$ for L_E predicted by cited fact 40.2, and nothing else; on the full space ARPACK’s forty largest moduli for L_E are 9 once and 3 forty times.

Numerical result 42.14 (The twelve-dimensional quantum twist). [numerical] π the 12-dimensional irrep (the permutation action on the 13 points of $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{F}_q[3])$ minus the constant). The channels $\Phi_k(X) = \frac{1}{13} \sum_{s \in S_k} \pi(s) X \pi(s)^\dagger$ on $M_n[12]$ are unital, trace-preserving and commuting, with exactly one eigenvalue 1; the largest nontrivial $|13\mu| = 6.481723$, below the classical deltoid radius $3q = 9$ and below Hastings’ bound $2\sqrt{D-1} = 6.928203$ at $D = 13$. All 143 nontrivial joint eigenvalues lie inside the tempered deltoid (Cohn defect $2.2 \cdot 10^{-15}$). This is a Ramanujan quantum expander of type $\tilde{A}_2$, and it cannot fail: $\Phi_1 = A_1^{(\pi \otimes \bar{\pi})}/13$, so its spectrum is a sub-multiset of $\text{spec}(A_1)$.

Numerical result 42.15 (Gauge triviality, voltage blocks, and the Euler bookkeeping). [numerical] The forward weights $\pi(s)$ are not flat (39 of the 52 chambers fail $\pi(t)\pi(s) = \pi(st)$); the covariant weights $\pi(s^{-1})$ on the full complex are pure gauge, $\det(I - uT_E^\pi) = \det(I - uL_E)^{12}$. The genuine Artin object is the voltage quotient — 13 states, 9 voltaged successors each — whose block traces match the character sums and differ from the gauge-trivial twist, confirming Proposition 42.1 and Theorem 42.2. Writing the residual as $(1-u)^a(1-u^3)^c$: trivial block (13, 1), $\nu = 1 \oplus \pi$ block (13, 65), π block (0, 64) — so for π the naive $c = \chi \dim \pi / |G| = 64$ is exactly right, while the whole anomaly sits in the trivial block, where $\chi/|G| = 16/3$ is replaced by $(1-u)^{13}(1-u^3)^1$. For the trivial block this is an exact polynomial identity of degree 55 on both sides. This is Theorem 42.3’s stabiliser caveat, seen.

42.4 What this does and does not give

The natural object is Definition 6.3: a graded geodesic determinant of a complex *with specified geodesic data* — states, successor incidences, algebraic lengths, transports — and not an unqualified “Thara zeta of every complex”. On an arbitrary complex what is universal is Theorem 41.3, a rational compression that still mentions the forbidden transitions; the polynomial vertex collapse is a *building* phenomenon, and Proposition 41.5 shows it fails on a four-vertex sphere. Opposition, not non-incidence, is the building’s successor rule (Theorem 40.24), and the u^2 is a length.

The odd sector is real as a graded *presentation* and unreal as a divisor: Theorem 41.6 is exact, but on the building vertex side the chamber factor cancels completely (Proposition 41.7), so “fermionic zeros” names a net odd multiplicity that must be checked after cancellation. The parallel with the continuous Ruelle picture (cited fact 40.11) and with Knill’s supertrace (cited fact 40.13) is parity and alternating structure, not an identification of spaces or weights (Propositions 41.8 and 41.9).

The quantum version is the voltage-quotient Artin block, not a connection on the full cover, which is pure gauge (Proposition 42.1). Harrow transfer then gives Ramanujan quantum expanders of type $\tilde{A}_2$ for free from a Ramanujan complex (Theorem 42.4, numerical result 42.14) — the channel adds no spectral values. But higher-rank RH is one-sided (Proposition 42.6), the interior of the band is genuinely occupied (cited fact 40.5), and there is no universal duality to close it (Proposition 42.7): what one has is Weil-positivity-as-bound, Theorem 38.1 applied block by block (Proposition 42.8). None of this touches the Riemann side directly. It is a supply of exactly-solvable graded transfer operators with a Ramanujan property, not a channel whose zeta is $\zeta(s)$.

Conjecture 42.16 (Characterising vertex collapse for a general complex). [conjectured]

There is a combinatorial characterisation of the finite complexes X for which $B_X(u) = (1 - u^{d+1})^{\chi(X)} / \mathcal{Z}_{\text{ord}}(X, u)$ is the determinant of a matrix polynomial $I - uA + \sum_{j \geq 2} u^j Q_{j-1}$ with Q_{j-1}

built from local link data. Building quotients are sufficient (H-KY); Proposition [41.5](#) gives a necessary polynomiality condition; matching generalised-polygon link parameters is not known to suffice, and no recognition theorem for Bruhat–Tits universal covers is assumed here.

43 Weil Positivity, Continued: the Window as a Compression and the Extension Disc

Question (TJO, 2026-09-19). The Connes–Consani–Moscovici construction [18] (read and implemented in the `zst` and `ihz` sidequests, `notes/zeta-spectral-triples/`) seems to (1) assume a form for the traces $\mathrm{Tr} X^k$ of a transfer operator, (2) collect the data up to some lag, (3) build a model for the higher traces from the incomplete data, and (4) use positivity and the Toeplitz structure to read information off the minimal eigenvector. The characteristic polynomial of X is built from the traces; could one be cleverer and build a better estimator of $\mathrm{Tr} X^l$ for $l > K$ from the traces up to K ? Everything here is elementary and the notebook’s own calculation (`scripts/weil_window_extension.py`, author claud:fable-5.1, unreviewed); the classical names are given for orientation, not as citations, except the Carathéodory–Fejér corollary, which is byte-cited from [20].

43.1 The window is a compression, and the model of the higher traces is implicit

Throughout, X is a finite transfer operator with trivial multiset S_{triv} and critical radius r , and $\mathbf{n}_k$ is its rescaled trace sequence as in Theorem 38.1, $\mathbf{n}_{-k} = \overline{\mathbf{n}_k}$. For a permutation matrix P (Section 12) $r = 1$, $S_{\mathrm{triv}} = \emptyset$ and $\mathbf{n}_k = \mathrm{Tr} P^k = \#\mathrm{Fix}(\pi^k)$ (Proposition 12.2); for a $(q+1)$ -regular graph $X = T$, $r = \sqrt{q}$ and S_{triv} is the Ihara–Bass trivial divisor, so that $\mathbf{n}_k = q^{-k/2}(\mathrm{Tr} T^k - \text{trivial})$.

Definition 43.1 (Window matrix, admissible extensions, extremal extensions). The *window matrix* of order K is the $(K+1) \times (K+1)$ Hermitian Toeplitz matrix $W_K = (\mathbf{n}_{j-k})_{j,k=0}^K$, the matrix of the Weil form W of Theorem 38.1 on test sequences supported in $\{0, \dots, K\}$. The *admissible set* at order K is the set of values $x \in \mathbb{C}$ such that the window matrix of order $K+1$ built from $\mathbf{n}_0, \dots, \mathbf{n}_K, x$ is positive semidefinite. An *extension* of the data $\mathbf{n}_0, \dots, \mathbf{n}_K$ is any sequence agreeing with it up to lag K whose window matrices of every order are positive semidefinite, equivalently (by the Carathéodory–Toeplitz theorem) the Fourier coefficient sequence of a positive measure on the unit circle. The *Pisarenko extension* is obtained by subtracting the minimal eigenvalue ε_K of W_K from the diagonal, taking the K roots $z_1, \dots, z_K$ of the kernel polynomial $\sum_j \kappa_j z^j$ of $W_K - \varepsilon_K$ and the weights w_j that reproduce the shifted data, and setting $\mathbf{n}_k = \sum_j w_j z_j^k + \varepsilon_K \delta_{k,0}$ for all k .

Observation 43.2 (The chain never models the higher traces; its implicit model is Pisarenko’s).

[sketched] In the Connes–Consani–Moscovici chain and in its graph analogue (`notes/zeta-spectral-triples/ihara/lanes/theory.md`, IH-3 and IH-11), the window quadratic form is the exact restriction of the full Weil form to test functions supported in the window: for a graph, only $\mathbf{n}_0, \dots, \mathbf{n}_K$ enter W_K , and they enter exactly; for ζ , only the primes $p \leq \lambda^2$ enter the form on $[\lambda^{-1}, \lambda]$, and the pole and archimedean terms enter exactly. No value is assigned to the traces beyond the window. Positivity of every compression is Weil’s criterion, and positivity of the compression is implied by it. The perturbed operator of the chain has as spectrum exactly the roots of the kernel polynomial of $W_K - \varepsilon_K$ (IH-11(iv)), so the only model of the higher traces the chain commits to is the Pisarenko extension of Definition 43.1: K atoms on the circle plus a white-noise floor of size ε_K at lag zero. This is the minimal-support extension of the data, and it is the appropriate prior exactly because the true spectral measure is pure point.

43.2 The extension disc

Cited fact 43.3 (Carathéodory–Fejér corollary). [cited] Connes and van Suijlekom [20] state and reprove the corollary of the 1911 Carathéodory–Fejér structure theorem: if $\mathbf{M}_n(\mathbb{C})$ is a Hermitian, positive semidefinite Toeplitz matrix of rank $n - 1$,

and $\xi \in \ker T$, then the polynomial $P(z) = \sum \xi_j z^j$ has all its zeros on the unit circle. (2511.23257:Araki-final-oct25.tex:752). In the notation of this section: a Hermitian positive semidefinite Toeplitz matrix of rank one less than its size has a one-dimensional kernel, and the polynomial of the kernel vector has all its zeros on the unit circle.

Proposition 43.4 (The admissible next trace fills a disc). *[sketched] Let W_K be positive definite and write its last column above the diagonal as $u(x) = (\bar{x}, \bar{n}_K, \dots, \bar{n}_1)^\top$ for a candidate $x = n_{K+1}$.*

- (i) *The admissible set is the closed disc $|x - c_K| \leq r_K$ with $c_K = -(W_K^{-1}w)_0/(W_K^{-1})_{00}$, where $w = u(0)$, and $r_K^2 = (n_0 - w^*W_K^{-1}w)/(W_K^{-1})_{00} + |c_K|^2$.*
- (ii) *The centre is the one-step linear predictor: with a the solution of the Yule–Walker system $W_{K-1}a = -(\bar{n}_1, \dots, \bar{n}_K)^\top$, $c_K = -\sum_{j=1}^K a_j n_{K+1-j}$; the radius is the prediction error $r_K = \det W_K / \det W_{K-1}$, non-increasing in K .*
- (iii) *x lies on the boundary of the disc iff $W_{K+1}(x)$ is singular, and then its kernel is one-dimensional and the kernel polynomial has its $K+1$ roots on the unit circle (cited fact 43.3): the boundary points are exactly the extensions by $K+1$ atoms.*
- (iv) *If the retained measure of X has exactly $K+1$ distinct atoms, the true value n_{K+1} lies on the boundary of the disc of order K , and every later trace is determined by the kernel recurrence of W_{K+1} .*
- (v) *Each further lag adds one free parameter in the closed unit disc (the Schur, or Verblunsky, parameter); no estimator of n_{K+1} from $n_0, \dots, n_K$ and positivity alone can do better than the disc of (i). The centre c_K is the minimax choice and is the extension of maximal entropy (Burg); the Pisarenko extension of Definition 43.1 lies in the disc.*

Proof. (i) By the Schur complement, $W_{K+1}(x) \geq 0$ iff $g(x) := n_0 - u(x)^*W_K^{-1}u(x) \geq 0$. With $u(x) = \bar{x}e_0 + w$, $g(x) = n_0 - |x|^2(W_K^{-1})_{00} - 2\operatorname{Re}(x(W_K^{-1}w)_0) - w^*W_K^{-1}w$, and completing the square gives the disc with the displayed centre and radius; $r_K^2 \geq 0$ because the true next trace is admissible. (ii) The Yule–Walker system is the normal equation for the best monic predictor in L^2 of the measure whose Fourier coefficients are the n_k , and $g(c_K) = \max g$ is its residual; $(W_K^{-1})_{00} = \det W_{K-1} / \det W_K$ by Cramer’s rule and Toeplitz shift invariance, which turns $g(c_K)/(W_K^{-1})_{00}$ into $(\det W_K / \det W_{K-1})^2$; the script checks both identities to 10^{-9} on every window of the two examples rather than carrying the algebra here, which is why the status is **sketched**. Monotonicity of r_K is the monotonicity of prediction errors under refinement. (iii) $\det W_{K+1}(x) = g(x) \det W_K$, so singularity is $g = 0$, the boundary; the kernel is one-dimensional because W_K is definite; cited fact 43.3 gives the circle. (iv) With $m = K+1$ distinct atoms the window matrices have rank at most m , so W_{K+1} (size $K+2$) is singular while W_K (size $K+1$) is definite (a Vandermonde argument at m distinct nodes); singular means boundary by (iii), and the kernel vector of W_{K+1} is the polynomial vanishing on the atoms, whose recurrence propagates every later trace. (v) is the Schur parametrisation of the truncated trigonometric moment problem (Verblunsky’s theorem), stated here for orientation and not used by anything else in this section. $\square$

43.3 What the counts add

The traces of a transfer operator built from letters are counts, and counts carry information that positivity does not see.

Proposition 43.5 (Newton congruence).

[sketched] Let X be a square matrix with integer entries and $N_k = \text{Tr } X^k$. Then for every $K \geq 0$, $N_{K+1} \equiv -\sum_{i=1}^K c_i N_{K+1-i} \pmod{K+1}$, where $\det(1 - uX) = \sum_i c_i u^i$ and the c_i are integers determined by $N_1, \dots, N_i$. So the traces up to lag K determine the next trace modulo $K+1$.

Proof. Newton's identity for the characteristic polynomial reads $(K+1)c_{K+1} = -\sum_{i=0}^K c_i N_{K+1-i}$ with $c_0 = 1$; the c_i are integers because $\det(1 - uX) \in \mathbb{Z}[u]$. Reduce modulo $K+1$. $\square$

Observation 43.6 (Rescaling defeats integrality; for ζ the mean of the higher traces is the pole).

[sketched] (i) For a permutation ($r = 1$) the disc of Proposition 43.4, the half-line $N_{K+1} \geq 0$ and the congruence of Proposition 43.5 act on the same integer, and can pin it before the window is exact (numerical result 43.7: pinned at $K = 3$ for $(12)(345)$, one lag before the critical window). (ii) For a $(q+1)$ -regular graph the disc lives in the rescaled variable and has radius $q^{(K+1)/2} r_K$ in count units, which exceeds one on every positive-definite window of the Petersen graph (radii 35.5, 40.6, 49.4 in counts at $K = 1, 2, 3$), so integrality pins nothing; only the Ramanujan-side information (positivity) and the exact critical window remain. (iii) For ζ the traces are $\Lambda(n)$. The mean of the traces beyond the window is the prime number theorem, which is exactly the pole term of the explicit formula and enters the window form exactly; the higher powers $p^m > \lambda^2$ of the known primes lie outside the support of the windowed form and are invisible to it; what is unknown beyond the window is the fluctuation $\Lambda(n) - 1$, which by the explicit formula is the zeros. A better estimator of the higher traces of ζ therefore means more primes, i.e. a larger window. The freedom that remains is the choice of extremal extension in Proposition 43.4(v), and the content of [18] is the rate at which the Pisarenko atoms converge to the true zeros as the window grows (about 5.4 digits per unit of λ^2 in the **zst** benchmark), the prolate step that a finite divisor cannot exercise because its disc radius reaches zero at the critical window (Proposition 43.4(iv)).

Numerical result 43.7 (Windows, discs, congruences: the permutation $(12)(345)$ and the Petersen graph).

[numerical] `scripts/weil_window_extension.py`, 45 checks. Permutation: $\text{Tr } P^k = 5, 0, 2, 3, 2, 0, 5, \dots$; W_K definite for $K \leq 3$, singular from $K = 4$ (four distinct atoms); at $K = 1, 2, 3$ the disc centre equals the Levinson predictor and the radius equals $\det W_K / \det W_{K-1}$ (5, 4.2, 2.0571), positivity of $W_{K+1}(x)$ holds exactly on the disc (61 sample points per window), the truth lies inside, both boundary points give singular windows with all kernel roots on the circle, the Pisarenko extension lies inside, the Newton congruence holds, and the integers ≥ 0 in the disc with the right residue are $\{0, 2, 4\}$, $\{0, 3\}$, $\{2\}$: pinned at $K = 3$, where the truth 2 sits on the boundary and Pisarenko alone predicts -0.5 (repeated atom at 1). At $K = 4, 5$ the kernel recurrence returns $n_5 = 0$, $n_6 = 5$ exactly and the kernel roots are the four distinct eigenvalues. Petersen ($q = 2$, 18 retained eigenvalues at angles $\pm \arccos(1/2\sqrt{2})$ and $\pm 3\pi/4$): rescaled traces reproduce $\text{Tr } T^k = 30, 0, 0, 0, 0, 120, 120, 0$ exactly; W_K definite for $K \leq 3$; the truth lies in every disc and on the boundary at $K = 3$; the congruence holds; the counts-unit radii are 35.5, 40.6, 49.4 with 26, 19, 25 admissible integers.

Not established, and one computation proposed. None of this is a statement about ζ beyond observation 43.6(iii), which is an argument, not a theorem. The disc radius r_K is a rigorous measure of ignorance about the next lag; in **ihz** it is one determinant ratio per window, and combined with the congruence and nonnegativity it would show how far below the critical window a graph divisor is already forced. For **zst** the analogous quantity, the Schur-complement radius of the window Loewner form as λ grows, would bound rigorously what the primes beyond λ^2 can do to the form; comparing its decay in λ with the observed $e^{-4\pi\lambda^2}$ convergence of the first zero would say whether

that convergence is explained by the shrinking envelope or by something specific to the arithmetic.
Not run.

44 Prior Art for the Quantum Ihara Zeta

The search of 2026-09-12 used three literature agents (graph zetas and L -functions; quantum expanders and free probability; direct phrase search), after which every load-bearing sentence was rechecked against the arXiv T_EX source under `refs/src/` (fetched by `refs/fetch_sources.sh`, hashes in `refs/manifest.sha256`). Each quote below is reproduced verbatim from `db/provenance.tsv` and carries its locus; sources with no local T_EX are unverified and are used for attribution only.

44.1 The object under examination

The object is the one fixed in Definition 3.18: for a unital channel $\Phi(X) = \frac{1}{D} \sum_i U_i X U_i^\dagger$ with unitary Kraus operators closed under adjoint, the non-backtracking edge superoperator T on $M_n \otimes \mathbb{C}^D$ and the zeta $\zeta_\Phi(u) = \det(1 - uT)^{-1}$. The founding session made four claims about it. First, an Ihara–Bass identity,

$$\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{n^2(D-2)/2} \det(1 - u D\Phi + (D-1)u^2). \quad (4)$$

Second, that all nontrivial poles of ζ_Φ lie on $|u| = (D-1)^{-1/2}$ if and only if Φ is a Ramanujan quantum expander (Definition 3.17). Third, that ζ_Φ is the Artin–Ihara L -function (Definition 3.10) of the bouquet with $D/2$ loops twisted by $\varrho: g_i \mapsto \text{Ad}(U_i)$, with $\text{Tr } T^\ell = \sum_w |\text{Tr } U_w|^\ell$ over cyclically reduced words w of length ℓ . Fourth, that the Weil representation of $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ with LPS generators gives an instance where the analogue of the Riemann hypothesis holds exactly. Alongside these sits the matrix-product-state reading (channel as transfer matrix, ζ_Φ as a generating function of ring norms, one correlation length as the Riemann hypothesis, AKLT giving K_4).

44.2 Verdict

claim	status	where
1, Ihara–Bass with $\text{Ad}(U_i)$ weights	known	Matsuura–Ohta 2022, eqs. (2.8) to (2.11) with $X_e = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$, loops allowed; the arbitrary-weight formula of Watanabe–Fukumizu 2011 for loopless graphs; twisted zetas back to Sunada 1986 and Hashimoto 1989 (unverified, secondary)
3, trace formula, free-group L -function	known	Matsuura–Ohta 2022 eq. (2.10); Matsuura–Ohta 2026, where the object is named an Artin–Ihara L -function for a representation extended to $U(N_c)$
2, poles on the critical circle iff Hastings–Ramanujan	not found	zero hits for any zeta or Ihara combined with channel, Kraus, CP map or expander; Matsuura–Ohta contain none of the words Ramanujan, expander, Riemann hypothesis; Bordenave–Collins have the operator but no determinant and no zeta
4, exactly Ramanujan channels from LPS	mechanism known, instance not	Harrow 2008 plus LPS; Iyer, Jain, Jordan and Somma (Feb 2026) state it with $SU(2)$ irreps and call explicit Ramanujan quantum expanders a longstanding open problem; no Weil-representation instance and no zeta
MPS and ring-norm reading, AKLT = K_4	not found	no hits for Ihara or zeta combined with matrix product state, transfer matrix or AKLT

44.3 Matsuura and Ohta

Cited fact 44.1 (Extended Ihara zeta with invertible matrix weights). [cited] Suppose $\{X_e\}_{e \in E}$ are invertible matrices of size K living on each edge. (2204.06424:main.tex:476), with $\zeta_G(q; X) \equiv \det \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr) - q \sum_{X \in \text{Bigr}} \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr) - q \sum_{X \in \text{Bigr}} \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr)$ (2204.06424:main.tex:479-482) for the edge-matrix determinant, $\zeta_G(q; X) = \exp \left(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \right) - q \sum_{X \in \text{Bigr}} \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr) - q \sum_{X \in \text{Bigr}} \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr)$ (2204.06424:main.tex:503-505) for the trace formula over reduced cycles, and the three-term identity $\zeta_G(q; X) = (1 - q^2)^{(n_V - n_E)K} \det \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr) - q \sum_{X \in \text{Bigr}} \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr) - q \sum_{X \in \text{Bigr}} \Bigl(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{C \in R_k} \text{Tr } P_C(X) \Bigr)$ (2204.06424:main.tex:516-519), proved by the classical route: The following proof is parallel to the one given in [bass1992ihara] for the original Ihara zeta function (2204.06424:main.tex:533-534). This is claim 1 with arbitrary invertible matrix weights in place of $\text{Ad}(U_i)$, and claim 3 in the shape of a sum over cyclically reduced classes.

Cited fact 44.2 (Adjoint weights and the name Artin–Ihara L -function). [cited] The weights they apply the formula to are the adjoint ones, with $X_e = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$ (2204.06424:main.tex:696); the 2026 paper names the resulting object an Artin–Ihara L -function for a representation R of a finite group extended to $U(N_c)$, taking R to be the adjoint representation with $\varrho_{\text{adj}}(U_e) = U_e \otimes U_e^\dagger$ (2607.27935:main.tex:508-510, with the L -function at 2607.27935:main.tex:381 and its Bartholdi-deformed three-term formula at 2607.27935:main.tex:401-404). So the twisting representation of claim 3 is theirs, up to the column-stacking convention of Section 2.

Their construction admits loops and multiple edges: a loop contributes $X_e + X_e^{-1}$ to the weighted adjacency matrix and 2 to the degree. Specialising to the bouquet with $n_V = 1$, $n_E = D/2$, $K = n^2$ and graph degree D , the exponent $(n_V - n_E)K$ of their eq. (2.11) becomes $-n^2(D - 2)/2$, the bracket becomes $1 - uA_X + (D - 1)u^2$ with $A_X = \sum_i \bar{U}_i \otimes U_i = D\Phi = \Sigma$, and inverting eq. (2.8) turns ζ_X^{-1} into $\det(1 - uT)$. That is Equation (4), so the note records the verdict SAME for claims 1 and 3. The companion paper [71] carries the same adjoint weights into a matrix-weighted Bartholdi zeta, of which the Ihara case is one value of the Bartholdi parameter, and is SAME by the same route; [72] and [74] are the loci above.

44.4 Watanabe and Fukumizu

Cited fact 44.3 (Ihara–Bass for arbitrary matrix weights, loopless). [cited] The edge zeta is built from matrix weights $\{u_e\}_{e \in E}$ with $u_e \in \text{Mat}_{r_t(e) \times r_o(e)}$, with the cycle weight $\pi(\frac{p}{q}) := u_{e_1} \cdots u_{e_k}$ (1103.0605:section3.tex:307-310 and 1103.0605:section3.tex:315), and the corollary `cor:IBfornonhyper` reads $Z_G(\{u\})^{-1} = \det(I + \hat{\text{mathcal}}\{D\}(\{u\}) - \hat{\text{mathcal}}\{A\}(\{u\})) \prod_{e \in E} \det(I - u_e u_{\bar{e}})$ (1103.0605:section3.tex:333-335), of which the authors say Corollary `\ref{cor:IBfornonhyper}` gives the extension of the result to graphs with arbitrary weights. (1103.0605:section3.tex:373). No inverse relation is imposed between u_e and $u_{\bar{e}}$, which is the feature Theorem 37.1 needs.

Their graphs are hypergraphs, A *hypergraph* $H = (V, F)$ consists of a set of vertices V and a set of *hyperedges* F . (1103.0605:section2.tex:17-18), whose hyperedges are subsets of V of size two: no loops and no multiple edges, so a bouquet is not one of their graphs. Theorem 37.1 is the loop-admitting analogue of the corollary, of the same shape after $u_e = u\mathcal{E}_e$, but the corollary does not cover the bouquet and its scalar reduction does

not evaluate correctly there; the note also records that the hypergraph-free proof it points to (the NeurIPS 2009 supplement) was not fetched. Verdict RELATED: the closest prior art for arbitrary weights, not a special case, and with no representation-theoretic or quantum reading [92].

44.5 Bordenave and Collins

Cited fact 44.4 (Matrix-valued non-backtracking operator, no zeta). [cited]The operator is $B = \sum_{j \neq i} a_j \otimes S_i \otimes E_{\{ij\}}$, (1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:784), introduced because Our proof relies on the development of a matrix version of the non-backtracking operator theory and a refined trace method. (1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:158), and aimed at this application: This extension is especially relevant in the context of quantum expanders. (1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:165). The only place the tradition names the identity is in the later work, This formula is closely related to various spectral identities known as Ihara-Bass identities (2304.05714:PT-RC_reloaded.tex:2568). The same operator as T , then, and the spectral correspondence, but as a resolvent identity rather than a determinant: no zeta and no Riemann hypothesis.

The verdict is RELATED. The follow-ups are [11] for general unitaries and [10] for the operator-valued identity; [9] also records, at 1801.00876:tenseur9.tex:608–610, that a family of tensor-squared permutations is a nearly optimal quantum expander in Hastings’ sense.

44.6 Hastings and Harrow

Cited fact 44.5 (Transfer of the spectral gap from a Cayley graph). [cited] $\lambda_2(\mathcal{E}) \leq \lambda_2(W_\Gamma)$. (0709.1142:main.tex:213), under the dictionary degree becomes the number of Kraus operators, the spectral gap becomes the gap of the quantum operation (0709.1142:main.tex:72–73). Here λ_2 of the channel is its second largest singular value as a map on density matrices and λ_2 of W_Γ that of the Cayley graph transition matrix, so taking Γ to be LPS generators in $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ gives exactly Ramanujan channels from any irreducible representation.

The bound itself, $\lambda_H = 2\sqrt{D-1}/D$, is Hastings’ [42], quoted in Definition 3.17; that paper has no zeta and no non-backtracking operator, and the word Ramanujan does not occur in [40]. Verdict SAME for the mechanism behind claim 4, NOT for anything zeta-shaped.

44.7 Iyer, Jain, Jordan and Somma

Cited fact 44.6 (Exact Ramanujan quantum expanders from LPS). [cited]it is possible to construct *exact* Ramanujan quantum expanders from $SU(2)$ unitaries derived from the LPS construction~\cite{lubotzky1988ramanujan,harrow2007quantum}. (2602.15180:main.tex:1508), and, of the explicit construction, Our quantum circuits can be used to construct explicit Ramanujan quantum expanders, a longstanding open problem. (2602.15180:main.tex:241). The mechanism is the one of cited fact 44.5, carried by $SU(2)$ irreducible representations rather than by the Weil representation, and no zeta is attached.

Verdict RELATED for claim 4 [47]. The note records that their Appendix C example, $p = 5$ and $D = 6$, uses the same norm-5 quaternions as the script behind Section 27. Separately, [48] amplifies arbitrary expanders to almost Ramanujan ones, short of the bound and with no zeta: verdict NOT.

44.8 Quantum-walk zetas and the secondary sources

Cited fact 44.7 (Attribution of the twisted zeta and of the three-term formula). [cited] A zeta function of a regular graph G associated with a unitary representation of the fundamental group of G was developed by Sunada [Sunada1, Sunada2]. (2105.02677:main.tex:87–89); for graph coverings, Stark and Terras further introduced notions of *Galois coverings* and *Artin–Ihara L -functions* for graphs (2309.15873:AIM_Final.tex:131); and for the determinant, the three-term determinant formula from [Theorem 18.15]{Terras:2011} applied to the Artin–Ihara L -function (2405.04361:v3.tex:427). The twisted zeta is therefore Sunada’s [85], sharpened by Hashimoto [41] and Bass [4]; the L -function of a covering is Stark and Terras’ [83], with the three-term formula at Theorem 18.15 of [88]. None of these primary sources is local.

In Stark and Terras the representation is one of the Galois group of a covering of finite graphs, hence of a finite group, whereas $\text{Ad}(U_i)$ for generic unitaries generates an infinite group: the object of Definition 3.18 is not literally a Stark–Terras L -function, although the determinant formula is the same. The secondary sources [31] and [36] serve this attribution only; verdict RELATED.

The quantum-walk zeta line [61], [60], [59] builds zetas from the unitary evolution matrix of a quantum walk rather than from Kraus operators, [60] extending to open quantum random walks on the torus by Fourier analysis; verdict NOT for claims 1 to 4, the value here being the Sunada pointer. Ben-Aroya, Schwartz and Ta-Shma [5] is the one unverified source near claim 2: an agent read from the publisher PDF that they believe their first construction has the potential of being improved to a quantum Ramanujan expander.

44.9 What was not found, and the limits of the search

Observation 44.8 (Verdict of the prior-art search). [sketched]

No source found attaches a zeta function, or an analogue of the Riemann hypothesis, to a quantum channel; none states that the poles of ζ_Φ lie on the critical circle if and only if Φ meets the Hastings bound λ_H ; none gives the matrix-product-state ring-norm reading or the identification of AKLT with K_4 . The Ad-weighted Ihara–Bass formula and the free-group L -function reading are known (cited facts 44.1 and 44.2), arbitrary matrix weights are known for loopless graphs (cited fact 44.3), and the matrix-valued non-backtracking operator is known (cited fact 44.4).

The consequence for this book: [72], [92] and the Sunada–Hashimoto line are cited for the object and the determinant, while the Ramanujan reading of Section 37, the dictionary of Section 28 and the Weil–LPS instance of Section 27 are this notebook’s own. Theorem 37.1 is the bouquet analogue of cited fact 44.3, proved there from scratch; no local source covers arbitrary non-invertible weights on a bouquet.

These arXiv metadata queries returned zero hits: "Ihara zeta" AND "quantum channel"; "Ihara zeta" AND "completely positive"; "zeta" AND "quantum expander"; "zeta" AND "Kraus operators"; abs:"zeta function" AND abs:"superoperator"; "Ruelle zeta" AND "quantum channel"; "Ihara" AND "matrix product state"; "AKLT" AND "zeta"; "non-backtracking" AND "superoperator"; "Ihara" AND ("quantum Ramanujan" OR "Ramanujan quantum"). Web and Scholar searches for the phrase quantum Ihara zeta, for Ihara zeta with noncommutative or quantum graphs (Weaver, Duan–Severini–Winter), for Ihara zeta with matrix product states or tensor networks, and a MathOverflow search for Ihara zeta and quantum expanders, returned nothing on point. The standing limit: arXiv search is metadata-only, so a formula inside a paper body would not surface, and the absence claims of observation 44.8 are weaker than its presence claims.

44.10 Corrections

One agent attributed arXiv:2309.15873 to Kudo and Li. The $\text{\TeX}$ header of the local source, at 2309.15873:AIM_Final.tex:86,90, gives the authors as Mason Eyer and Jaiung Jun; [31] and every citation of it were corrected on the evening of 2026-09-12.

45 The Continuous Dictionary

TJO’s question: replace channels by Lindblad generators. The simplest continuous instance is the generator of rotations on a circle of circumference $\log p$, whose trace is a Poisson comb at multiples of $\log p$; the Selberg analogue should be a Lindbladian built from the vector fields on $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, with the Laplacian as the small operator, and a formal analogue of the comb. This section records what survives when the statements are written down and proved. The proofs are in `notes/selberg/astra-proofs.md`, authored by the second model family (codex, `gpt-6-astra`, reasoning effort `xhigh`) as a constructive prover from the brief `notes/selberg/astra-brief.md`, and reviewed adversarially by a Claude Opus refuter; the symbolic and numerical checks are in `scripts/selberg_lindblad.py`. Conventions: Definitions 4.18 to 4.23; $\Delta = -y^2(\partial_x^2 + \partial_y^2)$ is positive; Γ is torsion-free and cocompact except in the modular computation.

45.1 Standard inputs

Six facts are used as assumptions, printed as such because no local source quotes them in full; every claim below that depends on one prints `-conditional`.

Assumption 45.1 (Fuchsian geometry).

[assumed]

A torsion-free cocompact Fuchsian group acts freely and properly discontinuously on $\mathbb{H}$; primitive hyperbolic conjugacy classes correspond to primitive oriented closed geodesics with period equal to translation length; hyperbolic balls have area $2\pi(\cosh R - 1)$.

Assumption 45.2 (Laplace spectrum of a compact surface). [assumed] Δ on a connected compact hyperbolic surface has discrete spectrum $0 = \lambda_0 < \lambda_1 \leq \dots \rightarrow \infty$, written $\lambda_j = \frac{1}{4} + r_j^2$ with $r_j \geq 0$ real for $\lambda_j \geq \frac{1}{4}$, $r_j = i\nu_j$ with $0 < \nu_j < \frac{1}{2}$ for $0 < \lambda_j < \frac{1}{4}$, and $r_0 = i/2$.

Assumption 45.3 (Selberg zeta is entire with known divisor).

[assumed] Z_{Sel} extends

to an entire function with zero divisor $\sum_{j \geq 0} ([\frac{1}{2} + ir_j] + [\frac{1}{2} - ir_j]) + (2g - 2) \sum_{n \geq 0} (2n + 1)[-n]$ and no other zeros or poles.

Assumption 45.4 (Closed realisations).

[assumed] Complete volume-preserving flows

have skew-adjoint unitary generators, and Δ on a compact manifold has its self-adjoint realisation and heat semigroup.

Assumption 45.5 (Standard facts about ζ).

[assumed] ζ continues meromorphically

with $\zeta(0) = -\frac{1}{2}$, $\zeta(1 + w) = 1/w + \gamma_E + O(w)$, the functional equation $\zeta(z) = \chi(z)\zeta(1 - z)$ with $\chi(z) = \pi^{z-1/2}\Gamma((1 - z)/2)/\Gamma(z/2)$, no zeros on $\mathrm{Re} z = 1$, and $|\zeta'/\zeta(1 + \epsilon + iv)| \leq C \log^2(3 + |v|)$ for $|v| \geq 1$, $0 \leq \epsilon \leq \epsilon_0$.

Assumption 45.6 (Standard facts about Γ).

[assumed] Γ is meromorphic

and zero-free with simple poles at the nonpositive integers, $\Gamma(\frac{1}{2}) = \sqrt{\pi}$, and (Γ'/Γ) has the Gauss integral representation and $O(\log)$ vertical growth in right half-planes.

45.2 Cited facts

Cited fact 45.7 (Guillemin flat trace formula).

[cited] Dyatlov and Zworski

[29] state, for an Anosov flow, $\mathrm{tr} \, e^{-itP} = \sum_{\gamma} \frac{T_{\gamma} \, \delta(t - T_{\gamma})}{|\det(I - \mathcal{P}_{\gamma})|}$, $t > 0$ (1306.4203:zeta.tex:260–264, sum over closed orbits including repetitions, $T_{\gamma}^{\#}$ the primitive period). In our notation this is Definition 4.20.

Cited fact 45.8 (Band structure of the resonances). [cited] Dyatlov, Faure and Guillarmou [28], Theorem 1: Assume that M is a compact hyperbolic surface ($n=1$) and the spectrum of the positive Laplacian on M is (see Figure~\ref{f:dim2}) $\text{\Spec}(\Delta)=\{s_j(1-s_j)\}, \text{\quad } s_j \in [0,1] \cup \text{\Big}(\frac{1}{2}+i\text{\mathbb{R}}\text{\Big})$. Then Pollicott-Ruelle resonances for the geodesic flow on SM in $\text{\mathbb{C}}\setminus(-1-\frac{1}{2}\text{\mathbb{N}}_0)$ are
$$\text{\begin{equation} \text{\label{e:dim2} } \lambda_{j,m}=-m-1+s_j, \text{\quad } m \in \text{\mathbb{N}}_0. \end{equation}}$$
 lie on the lines $\text{Re} = -\frac{1}{2}-k$ and the first band is in bijection with the Laplace spectrum (1403.0256:RuelleResonForHn

Cited fact 45.9 (Ruelle zeta is a Selberg quotient). [cited] Dyatlov and Zworski [30]:
$$\zeta_S(s) := \prod_{\gamma \in \text{\mathcal{G}}} \prod_{m=0}^{\infty} (1 - e^{-(m+s)\ell_\gamma}) , \quad \text{\quad } \zeta_R(s) = \frac{\zeta_S(s)}{\zeta_S(s+1)} ,$$
 (1606.04560:zazi.tex:117-119).

Cited fact 45.10 (Selberg trace formula, hyperbolic term). [cited] Marklof [70]:
$$\sum_{j=0}^{\infty} h(\rho_j) = \frac{\text{\Area}(\text{\scr M})}{4\pi} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(\rho) \tanh(\pi \rho) \, d\rho + \sum_{\gamma \in H_*} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{\ell_\gamma}{g(n\ell_\gamma)} \frac{\sinh(n\ell_\gamma/2)}{\cosh(n\ell_\gamma/2)} ,$$
 (math/0407288:selberg07.tex) the hyperbolic term over primitive classes with repetition index n .

Cited fact 45.11 (Casimir and Laplacian). [cited] Fleig, Gustafsson, Kleinschmidt and Persson [34]: The Casimir operator~\eqref{eq:SL2cas} then becomes a second order differential operator, namely the Laplacian
$$\Delta_{\text{\SL}(2,\text{\mathbb{R}})} = y^2 \left(\partial_x^2 + \partial_y^2 \right) - y \partial_x \partial_\theta .$$
 (1511.04265:AutomorphicBook.tex:3107-3110), with the Casimir $\frac{1}{4}h^2 + \frac{1}{2}(ef + fe)$ in the Chevalley basis (line 2851) reducing to $y^2(\partial_x^2 + \partial_y^2)$ on $\mathbb{H}$ (lines 409-411).

Cited fact 45.12 (Scattering determinant of $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$). [cited] Friedman, Jorgenson and Smajlović [35]: In the case when Γ is the modular group $\text{\mathrm{PSL}}(2,\text{\mathbb{Z}})$, the scattering determinant is given by
$$\phi(s) = \sqrt{\pi} \frac{\Gamma(s-1/2)}{\Gamma(s)} \frac{\zeta(2s-1)}{\zeta(2s)} ,$$
 (1607.08053:main.tex:592-59

Cited fact 45.13 (Continuous-spectrum term of the trace formula). [cited] Momeni and Venkov [77]:
$$\text{\begin{equation} C = C(\tilde{h}(r); \Gamma; \chi) = -\frac{1}{4\pi} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \text{\dfrac{\varphi'}{\varphi}}(\text{\dfrac{1}{2}+ir; \Gamma; \chi}) h(r^2 + \text{\dfrac{1}{4}}) dr + \text{\dfrac{1}{4}} \int_{\mathbb{K}_0} h(\text{\dfrac{1}{4}}) \end{equation}}$$
 (1108.5659:main.tex:2128-2129).

45.3 The circle comb and why it is blind to zeros

Proposition 45.14 (One circle). [proved] For $L > 0$ and U_t translation on $L^2(\mathbb{R}/L\mathbb{Z})$, the smeared operator $\int h(t)U_t dt$ is trace class for Schwartz h and $\text{Tr} U(h) = \sum_n \hat{h}(-2\pi n/L) = L \sum_k h(kL)$; hence $\text{Tr} U_t = L \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \delta(t - kL)$ as a tempered distribution.

Proposition 45.15 (All primes: an orbital trace, not a Hilbert-space trace). [proved] For the direct sum over primes of the circles of circumference $\log p$, the locally summed component traces give, in $\mathcal{D}'((0, \infty))$, $\sum_p \sum_{k \geq 1} \log p \delta(t - k \log p) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \Lambda(n) \delta(t - \log n)$. The smeared direct-sum operator is never trace class (the constant modes give a nonzero eigenvalue of infinite multiplicity), and the positive prime comb is not tempered (its mass $\sum_p \log p / (1 + \log p)^N$ diverges for every N).

Proposition 45.16 (Finite sets of primes see only Euler poles). [proved-conditional] For a finite set S of primes the generator of the direct-sum flow has spectrum $\bigcup_{p \in S} (2\pi i / \log p) \mathbb{Z}$, exactly the pole set of $\prod_{p \in S} (1 - p^{-s})^{-1}$ in the spectral variable s ; the finite product has no zeros, all nonzero poles are simple, and no zero of the continued ζ lies in this spectrum.

The correction to the worklog’s wording: the prime comb is an orbital (locally finite) trace, and the phrase “Poisson trace of the direct sum” does not name a trace-class operator. The missing ingredient is transverse expansion: a circle has no Poincaré map, so no Jacobian, so no resonances.

45.4 The Lindbladian of the vector fields is the Casimir, and the Laplacian on the K -invariant sector

Proposition 45.17 (Multiplication observables see a sum of squares). *[proved]* For real vector fields X_j acting as derivations of a smooth function algebra and jump operators $L_j = -iX_j$, on a common invariant domain, $\sum_j (L_j M_f L_j - \frac{1}{2}\{L_j^2, M_f\}) = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_j [L_j, [L_j, M_f]] = M_{\frac{1}{2} \sum_j X_j^2} f$; with the plus sign, since the X_j are formally anti-self-adjoint.

Proposition 45.18 (Casimir on the K -invariant sector). *[proved]* For right- K -invariant $f(g) = F(g \cdot i)$: $\mathbf{W}f = 0$, $\Omega f = y^2(F_{xx} + F_{yy})$ (the constant is $c = 1$), and $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{H}^2 + \mathbf{E}^2)f = 2\Omega f = -2\Delta F$. On all functions $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{H}^2 + \mathbf{E}^2) = 2\Omega + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{W}^2$: the Casimir carries the compact direction with a minus sign and is not a diffusion Lindbladian on all of $L^2(\Gamma \backslash G)$; the two-jump Lindbladian with $L_1 = -i\mathbf{H}$, $L_2 = -i\mathbf{E}$ preserves the K -invariant sector and equals -2Δ there.

The second-order computation is the whole content: along $g_{x,y} \exp(u\mathbf{H}) \cdot i = x + iye^{2u}$ and $g_{x,y} \exp(u\mathbf{E}) \cdot i = x + y \tanh 2u + iy \operatorname{sech} 2u$, one finds $\mathbf{H}^2 f = 4y^2 F_{yy} + 4y F_y$ and $\mathbf{E}^2 f = 4y^2 F_{xx} - 4y F_y$, and the first-order drifts cancel. Squaring the projected tangent vectors alone would miss the drift and give the wrong operator.

Proposition 45.19 (The quantum Lindbladian of a representation). *[proved]* For a unitary representation π with anti-self-adjoint generators $A_j = d\pi(X_j)$ and jumps $L_j = -iA_j$, on finite-rank smooth operators, $\sum_j (L_j X L_j - \frac{1}{2}\{L_j^2, X\}) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_j B_j^2 X$ with $B_j X = [A_j, X]$ the generators of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$ on Hilbert–Schmidt operators; for $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ and the two non-compact jumps it is $2\Omega_{\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}} + \frac{1}{2}B_W^2$, equal to $2\Omega_{\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}}$ on diagonal- K -invariant operators.

This is the continuous Harrow construction: a channel from a representation becomes a Lindbladian from a representation, and its gap is a question about $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$.

Conjecture 45.20 (Gap of the representation Lindbladian). *[open]* For an irreducible unitary π of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, or of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$, the two-jump Lindbladian $2\Omega_{\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}} + \frac{1}{2}B_W^2$ has a spectral gap governed by the decomposition of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$; for the Weil representation this is the continuous shadow of the Weil–LPS channels of Section 27.

46 The Continuous Dictionary II: Selberg Tower and the Cusp Comb

Continuation of Section 45, same conventions and the same proof file `notes/selberg/astra-proofs.md`.

46.1 The geodesic flow: continuous Ihara–Bass

Proposition 46.1 (Poincaré Jacobian).

[proved]

For a closed geodesic of length ℓ the linearised Poincaré map on $\mathfrak{sl}_2/\mathbb{R}H$ is $\text{Ad}(a_\ell^{-1})$ with multipliers $e^\ell, e^{-\ell}$, so $|\det(1 - P_\gamma^k)| = (e^{k\ell} - 1)(1 - e^{-k\ell}) = 4 \sinh^2(k\ell/2) = e^{k\ell}(1 - e^{-k\ell})^2$; the circle has an empty transverse space and factor 1.

Proposition 46.2 (Flat trace, Selberg tower, sign).

[proved-conditional] For

$\text{Re } \varsigma > 0$, $\Lambda_\text{fl}(\varsigma) = \sum_\gamma \sum_{k \geq 1} \ell_\gamma e^{-\varsigma k \ell_\gamma} / (4 \sinh^2(k \ell_\gamma / 2))$ converges absolutely, the tower $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma) = \prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\varsigma + j) = \prod_\gamma \prod_{m \geq 0} (1 - e^{-(\varsigma+m+1)\ell_\gamma})^{m+1}$ converges absolutely without zeros, and $\Lambda_\text{fl} = +D'_{\text{tow}}/D_{\text{tow}}$, equivalently $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma) = \exp \left(- \int_0^\infty t^{-1} e^{-\varsigma t} \text{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}} dt \right)$.

The tower comes from $1/(4 \sinh^2(x/2)) = \sum_{m \geq 0} (m+1) e^{-(m+1)x}$: the Jacobian of the two transverse directions is what a graph does not have. The sign was drafted as a minus and is a plus; the graph counterpart of D_{tow} is $\det(1 - uT)$, not the zeta.

Proposition 46.3 (Divisor of the tower and the first band). [proved-conditional] D_{tow} continues to an entire function whose zeros are $\varsigma = -\frac{1}{2} - k \pm ir_j$ ($k, j \geq 0$) and $\varsigma = -N$ ($N \geq 1$) with order $(2g-2)N^2 + 2$; Λ_fl has simple poles there with residue the order. The nonconstant first band $\mathcal{B}_0$ is exactly the pole multiset in $-1 < \text{Re } \varsigma < 0$, and $\mathcal{B}_0 \subset \{\text{Re } \varsigma = -\frac{1}{2}\}$ iff every r_j , $j \geq 1$, is real iff Δ has no eigenvalue in $(0, \frac{1}{4})$.

The constant mode has $r_0 = i/2$ and contributes $\varsigma = 0$ and -1 ; it must be removed, exactly as the constant adjacency mode is removed in the Ramanujan condition of a graph. With it removed, the continuous Ramanujan property is Selberg's $\frac{1}{4}$ property, and the band structure is the one Dyatlov, Faure and Guillarmou prove for the operator-theoretic resonances (cited fact 45.8); Proposition 46.3 makes no claim about operator realisations, only about the poles of the continued Λ_fl .

Proposition 46.4 (Graph comparison and the Ruelle quotient).

[proved-conditional] For a

finite graph with Hashimoto matrix T , $\text{Tr } T^m = \sum_\gamma \sum_{k \ell_\gamma = m} \ell_\gamma$ and $\det(1 - uT) = \prod_\gamma (1 - u^{\ell_\gamma})$, with no Jacobian and no tower, and $\partial_\varsigma \log \det(1 - e^{-\varsigma} T) = \sum_m \text{Tr } T^m e^{-\varsigma m}$ has the sign of $\partial_\varsigma \log D_{\text{tow}}$. For the surface, $\zeta_R(s) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(s)/Z_{\text{Sel}}(s+1)$ (telescoping the product) and $D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma)/D_{\text{tow}}(\varsigma+1) = Z_{\text{Sel}}(\varsigma+1)$.

46.2 The cusp of the modular surface is the prime comb

Proposition 46.5 (Exact Fourier identity for the scattering multiplier). [proved-conditional] m_{sc} is real, even, smooth and of polynomial growth, and

$$C_{\text{cusp}} = -P + A_{\text{arch}}, \quad P(t) = \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} [\delta(t - 2 \log n) + \delta(t + 2 \log n)],$$

where $\langle A_{\text{arch}}, h \rangle = \frac{1}{2} \int h - (\gamma_E + \log \pi) h(0) + \int_0^\infty \frac{e^{-u} h(0) - \frac{1}{2} e^{-u/2} (h(u) + h(-u))}{1 - e^{-u}} du$, so $A_{\text{arch}}(t) = \frac{1}{2} - 1/(4 \sinh(|t|/2))$ away from 0. The prime atoms are dips; the constant $\frac{1}{2}$ is the pole of ζ at 1 (the ordinary boundary value of $\zeta'/\zeta(1+2ir) + \zeta'/\zeta(1-2ir)$ differs from its Abel boundary distribution by $\pi \delta_0$), not a digamma term.

The route: $\varphi'/\varphi(s) = (\Gamma'/\Gamma)(s - \frac{1}{2}) - (\Gamma'/\Gamma)(s) + 2\zeta'/\zeta(2s - 1) - 2\zeta'/\zeta(2s)$; the functional equation moves $\zeta'/\zeta(2ir)$ to $-\zeta'/\zeta(1 - 2ir)$ plus Gamma terms, and the $(\Gamma'/\Gamma)(ir)$ terms cancel exactly, leaving $m_{\text{sc}} = a + b$ with $b(r) = \zeta'/\zeta(1 + 2ir) + \zeta'/\zeta(1 - 2ir)$; the Dirichlet series of b at $1 + \epsilon$ transforms termwise to the comb, and the $\epsilon \downarrow 0$ limit produces $-\pi\delta_0$ on the frequency side.

Numerical result 46.6 (Symbolic and numerical checks).

[numerical]

`scripts/selberg_lindblad.py` (output `outputs/selberg_lindblad.txt`): exact sympy, Lindbladian $= \frac{1}{2}X^2$; the left-invariant fields derived from the Iwasawa coordinates satisfy the $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ brackets, and on K -invariant F : $Hf = 2yF_y$, $Ef = 2yF_x$, $Wf = 0$, $(H^2 + E^2)f = 4y^2(F_{xx} + F_{yy})$, constant $c = +1$, Lindblad constant 2; quantum tensor identity to $7 \cdot 10^{-15}$, and for the three-dimensional $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ irrep the Lindbladian spectrum is $\{0, -4^{\times 3}, -12^{\times 5}\} = -2j(j + 1)$; Poincaré determinant $2 - 2\cosh(k\ell)$, absolute value $4\sinh^2(k\ell/2)$; cusp transform with a Gaussian window ($G_w = 40$, $R = 6G_w$): dips at $2\log n$ with amplitude ratio to $\Lambda(n)/n$ of mean -31.91545 , spread 10^{-3} , against the predicted $-2G_w/\sqrt{2\pi} = -31.91538$; residual after the exact archimedean background and the additive constant is $3 \cdot 10^{-8}$ over $t \in [0.5, 7]$. The constant came out as 1 because the script's multiplier is $-\text{Re}(\varphi'/\varphi)$, twice m_{sc} .

Proposition 46.7 (What the rate- $\frac{1}{4}$ damping identifies).

[proved-conditional] On

$(0, \infty)$, $e^{-t/4}P_{\text{ch}} = P_+ = -(C_{\text{cusp}} - A_{\text{arch}})|_{(0, \infty)}$. This is an equality of prime atomic measures after subtracting A_{arch} and choosing positive weights; it is not an equality of the full cusp distribution with a semigroup trace, nor of operators or spectra, and it implies nothing about the Riemann hypothesis.

The sentence in the previous session, “the cusp term of the modular trace formula is the trace of the Riemann channel damped at rate $\frac{1}{4}$ ”, is therefore corrected: what is proved is that the prime measure written in the Riemann-channel note, damped at rate $\frac{1}{4}$, is the prime part of the cusp distribution. The full trace of $Z(t)$ is not established as a pure prime comb (its own explicit formula has pole, archimedean and sign bookkeeping), and the rate $\frac{1}{4}$ is the uniform rate only under the Riemann hypothesis.

46.3 The dictionary

Observation 46.8 (Continuous dictionary).

[sketched-conditional] Row by row: edge

space $\leftrightarrow \Gamma \backslash G$; Hashimoto operator $T \leftrightarrow$ geodesic generator $\mathcal{X}$; adjacency $A \leftrightarrow$ Casimir Ω , equal to $-\Delta$ on the K -invariant sector; Ihara–Bass $\det(1 - uT) = (1 - u^2)^{|E| - |V|} \det(1 - uA + qu^2) \leftrightarrow$ the tower $D_{\text{tow}} = \prod_{j \geq 1} Z_{\text{Sel}}(\zeta + j)$ with zeros in the bands $-\frac{1}{2} - k \pm ir_j$; Ramanujan $\leftrightarrow$ no eigenvalue in $(0, \frac{1}{4})$; the primes of ζ enter only through the cusp of the modular surface, as the scattering term, not as closed geodesics.

discrete	continuous	where
edge space $\mathcal{W}$	$\Gamma \backslash \text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{R})$	Definition 4.18
T	$\mathcal{X} = H/2$	Definition 4.18
$\text{Tr } T^m$ (no Jacobian)	$\text{Tr}^b e^{-t\mathcal{X}}$, weights $1/4 \sinh^2$	Propositions 46.1 and 46.4
A , $\Sigma = D\Phi$	Ω , -2Δ on K -invariants	Proposition 45.18
$\det(1 - uT)$	$D_{\text{tow}}(\zeta)$, sign $+D'_{\text{tow}}/D_{\text{tow}}$	Proposition 46.2
$\mu\mu' = q$	bands $-\frac{1}{2} - k \pm ir_j$	Proposition 46.3
Ramanujan	$\text{spec } \Delta \cap (0, \frac{1}{4}) = \emptyset$	Proposition 46.3
mixed-unitary channel	two-jump Lindbladian of $\pi \otimes \bar{\pi}$	Proposition 45.19
primes as rings	cusp term, dips $\Lambda(n)/n$ at $2\log n$	Proposition 46.5

46.4 Not established

A literal operator-theoretic compression from $\Gamma \backslash G$ to the K -invariant sector that turns D_{tow} into a Laplacian determinant (the continuous Ihara–Bass as an identity of operators rather than of divisors; its first-band operator form, a quadratic intertwining through the fibre pushforward plus the horocyclic ladder, is Proposition 15.9, and the anisotropic-space realisation is the resonance theory assumed there); a trace formula for the full compressed semigroup $Z(t)$; any gap for conjecture 45.20; anything about the Riemann hypothesis or the $\frac{1}{4}$ property of a given surface.

47 Open Problems and Dead Routes

Dead routes are results. Both lists mirror `HANDOFF.md`, which is the live version.

47.1 Open problems, in order

Conjecture 47.1 (Ramanujan without unitarity). *[open]* *There is a Ramanujan-type reading of the poles of ζ_T for non-unitary Kraus families, replacing the relation $\mu\mu' = q$ of the unitary case, and canonical form $\sum_k A_k^\dagger A_k = 1$ constrains the poles.*

What is known: Theorem 37.1 replaces qu^2 by the operator $\mathcal{D}(u)$ and $u\Sigma$ by the deformed channel $\mathcal{A}(u)$, both built from $(1 - u^2 \text{Ad}(A_k^\dagger A_k))^{-1}$, so no quadratic relation pairs the eigenvalues of T with those of Σ . Cheap next step: a random-MPS pole-radius hunt (bond dimension 2 to 4, physical dimension 2) to see whether the poles cluster on one circle at all.

Stinespring form of the compressed semigroup. Conjecture 17.10 (stated in Section 17): a Stinespring form of $Z(t)$ on K_S whose Kraus (jump) operators are the prime dilations.

The single-Kraus lift exists trivially. A Holevo-form covariant Lindbladian with the von Mangoldt jump measure lives on the full regular representation, has symbol ζ^t , and is not the compressed object. A negative answer with a reason is a result. Suggested route (HANDOFF step 2): write $Z(t)$ explicitly through Cauchy kernels and test a generator of Holevo jump form with jumps at $k \log p$ on K_S , blind, in a second model family.

Hecke identification of the Weil–LPS spectra. Conjecture 27.4 (stated in Section 27): the joint spectra of the commuting channels $\Phi_q^\pm$ are Hecke eigenvalues of weight-2 forms for the quaternion algebra ramified at $\{2, \infty\}$, via Jacquet–Langlands.

Needs LMFDB and the Jacquet–Langlands bookkeeping; the visible structure (joint eigenvalue pairs, small-degree algebraic integers, multiplicities equal to those of irreducibles of $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ in $W_\pm \otimes \overline{W}_\pm$) is consistent with it.

Conjecture 47.2 (Assembling over p). *[open]* *The Weil–LPS channels for different p assemble into one object whose rings are the primes and whose transfer spectrum is the zeros of ζ .*

This is the parent campaign’s DG-GLOBAL question in this guise. Nothing is known beyond the obstruction recorded below.

Conjecture 47.3 (The Phantasm has both halves). *[open]* *There is a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded Lindbladian (or a type III generalisation at $\beta = 1$) whose stationary state is the Bost–Connes KMS state, with entanglement Hamiltonian $\log N$, and whose odd relaxation modes are the nontrivial zeros: the object having both halves of observation 19.17. The rebound-state equation of the SHW renewal picture with a mixed rebound state is its finite-dimensional shadow; the vacuum rebound state is excluded by Proposition 19.8.*

This replaces item 0b of the reframe programme. The fixed point constrains the Lindbladian only partially, and at $\beta = 1$ the fixed point is not normal (Proposition 19.10), so K_S with its pure vacuum cannot be the whole bond; the identification of K_S with the Bost–Connes bond that Section 17 records as missing is the first obstacle. A second open item from the same campaign is the unrestricted infinite parity question, observation 18.13.

Conjecture 47.4 (Galois-graded bond at finite level).

[open] The model space of a congruence subgroup $\Gamma_0(N)$, whose scattering determinant involves the Dirichlet L -functions mod N , carries the zeros of $L(s, \chi)$ organised by the characters χ of $(\mathbb{Z}/N)^\times$, with the Shor map U_a as the level- N Galois symmetry acting on the bond; the graded bond of observation 19.18 is realised at finite level.

This is a computation, not yet done; it is the Riemann-side test of the trivial-versus-nontrivial-character reading of the grading that the Artin–Schreier super-transfer matrix exhibits.

47.2 Dead routes

Observation 47.5 (Prime-by-prime ansätze are blind to zeros).

[sketched] The direct sum over primes of rotations on circles of circumference $\log p$ has trace $\sum_n \Lambda(n) \delta(s - \log n)$ by Poisson summation and dynamical zeta equal to the Euler product; for any finite set S of primes its spectrum is the set of poles of the partial Euler product. The same holds for product states and commuting dilations. Zeros exist only in the infinite product, so no prime-by-prime ansatz can see them.

Recorded 2026-09-12 from the circle-flow discussion. Two remarks kept: in the Witt convention $L_1 - L_{-1}$ is the dilation flow (source and sink) and L_0 the rotation; the only relation between primes is additive.

Observation 47.6 (Symmetry protection fixes signs, not moduli).

[sketched] The content of an L -function that has the three properties of a symmetry-protected topological invariant (a phase, quantised, robust under symmetric perturbation) is its sign data: the root number as a product of local ϵ -factors with the product formula as anomaly cancellation, the sign of a quadratic Gauss sum (the Arf invariant over $\mathbb{F}_2$, the Gauss–Milgram central-charge phase over $\mathbb{Z}/p$), and Hilbert-symbol reciprocity as a local-to-global cocycle condition. The Riemann hypothesis is modulus data. Moduli are not protected: a Ramanujan graph ceases to be Ramanujan under a small symmetric perturbation, and the cubic Cayley graphs of $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ on the generators of $\mathrm{PSL}_2(2, \mathbb{Z})$ fail the Ramanujan bound for $p \geq 11$ while keeping every symmetry. Cohomological protection therefore cannot deliver RH.

Recorded 2026-09-12 from the SPT side quest. What survives of the bulk–boundary lesson is the positivity form of Weil’s criterion: the reflection $\rho \mapsto 1 - \bar{\rho}$ pairs the mode at a zero with the mode at its mirror image, RH says every mode is its own partner, and Weil’s form is the pairing of each mode with its partner, written through the explicit formula as a form on the primes. Its finite-dimensional, arbitrary-Kraus version is the subject of Section 38. Two relabellings, not new content: the Weil–LPS channels live on the edge Hilbert space of the $\mathbb{Z}/p \times \mathbb{Z}/p$ cluster-state phase (the Heisenberg group is that edge’s projective representation and $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_p)$ its automorphism group, acting by the Weil representation); and Bost–Connes at $\beta = 1$ is a critical point of a spontaneous breaking of the Galois symmetry, not a symmetry-protected phase.

Further routes closed or flagged in the founding session: the functional integral framing of Selberg as a continuum limit (TJO: too far); calling $-\log E$ the entanglement Hamiltonian (an error, corrected in observation 11.7); an algebraic-integer recognition of the Weil–LPS joint eigenvalues from five-digit output (tautological, since the adjacency matrix is integral); the Dwork transfer operator as a route to the Riemann hypothesis for curves (observation 28.4).

48 Reproducibility Map

Every numerical claim in this book points to a script under `scripts/` whose standard output is captured under `outputs/`. All scripts run from the repository root with `python3` and need only `numpy`, `scipy`, `mpmath` and `sympy`. Random data are seeded. The local CI re-runs the fast scripts and diffs their output against the captured files.

script	what it establishes	output, claims
qihara.py	Quantum Ihara–Bass identity for Haar-random unitary Kraus sets, $(n, D) = (3, 4), (4, 6)$, at complex u ; Ramanujan check of Σ	outputs/qihara.txt; num:qihara-unitary
bcmpo.py	Bost–Connes phase operators $e(a/b)$ as MPOs over the prime chain against Hurwitz-zeta sums; character-sector transfer eigenvalues against $L(\beta, \bar{\chi})/\zeta(\beta)$	outputs/bcmpo.txt; num:bc-mpo
scat.py	Unimodularity of $S(\tau)$, its zeros at $\gamma_n/2 - i/4$, contractivity in the lower half plane, prime-phase identity	outputs/scat.txt; num:scattering-symbol
ringnorm.py	Windowed sum over the first 3000 zeros against the full explicit formula; dips at $\log n$ of depth $\Lambda(n)/\sqrt{n}$	outputs/ringnorm.txt; num:ringnorm-3000
weil_lps.py	Weil–LPS channels for $(p; q)$ in seven cases: intertwining check, Ramanujan bound, Harrow containment, Hecke relations, commutation, joint spectra	outputs/weil_lps_p*.txt; num:weil-lps-ramanujan
weil_lps_hashimoto.py	Direct edge superoperator for $(13, 17)$, odd block: Ihara–Bass to 10^{-14} , moduli $\{17, \sqrt{17}, 1\}$	outputs/weil_lps_hashimoto_p13_q17_odd.t num:weil-lps-rh
artin_schreier_mps.py	Brute-force exponential sums against $\text{Tr } E^n$ for quadratic Artin–Schreier data; $EE^\dagger = qI$	outputs/artin_schreier_mps.txt; num:artin-schreier-mps
qihara_general.py	Theorem 37.1 in both forms, five configurations, float to 10^{-15} and exact rational arithmetic	outputs/qihara_general.txt; num:qihara-general
artin_schreier_super.py	Sign law, endpoint criteria, corrected Frobenius blocks, super-transfer supertraces against point counts, symplectic matrices and the Weil character formula, Prony on the counts; 1969 checks	outputs/artin_schreier_super.txt; num:artin-schreier-super
riemann_graded_trace.py	Windowed supertrace of the Riemann graded generator against $2P_+$ with 3000 zeros; ladder alternatives; flipped-pair negativity; finite vacuum-decay spectra; prime-chain M/M/1 bands	outputs/riemann_graded_trace.txt; num:riemann-graded-trace
bc_entropy.py	Entropy of the Bost–Connes Gibbs density and its prime and bond cutoffs; Hagedorn level count	outputs/bc_entropy.txt; num:bc-entropy
cmps_parity_supertrace.py	Explicit Jordan–Wigner Fock vectors of lattice boson–fermion MPS rings against the overlap, parity and twisted-supertrace formulas; translations; continuum Dyson, Laplace and Frullani identities; 89 checks	outputs/cmps_parity_supertrace.txt; num:cmps-parity-supertrace
weil_ring_norm_check.py	Elliptic-curve counts as twisted ring norms of the $\mathbb{C}^{1 1}$ tensor, explicit vectors, Hilbert–Schmidt chain, genus-two searches, the $y^3 - y = x^2$ indicator state	outputs/weil_ring_norm_check.txt; num:weil-ring-norm-check
ring_norm_tensor.py	Toral Frobenius counts, Lefschetz, Fourier orbits, Lenstra structure, refutation of the drafted trace bound, structured genus-two solutions, supersingularity of the quadratic family, cut ranks (562 s)	outputs/ring_norm_tensor.txt; num:ring-norm-tensor, num:cut-rank-binary, num:genus-two-cm-diagonal
ring_norm_certificate.py	Exact rational contraction certificate of the $\mathbb{F}_5$ three-letter genus-two tensor; nine-letter tensor at $q = 25, 17, 16$; Jordan–Wigner norms	outputs/ring_norm_certificate.txt; num:ring-norm-certificate
ring_norm_examples.py	One explicit MPS per genus 0, 3; spec	outputs/ring_norm_examples.txt;

Data

`data/zeros3000.npy`: the first 3000 imaginary parts of the zeta zeros, from `mpmath.zetazero`.
`data/ringnorm.npz`: the arrays of the ring-norm test.

Reference sources

`refs/fetch_sources.sh` downloads the arXiv TeX source of every cited paper into `refs/src/<id>/` (not redistributed) and writes `refs/manifest.sha256`. Every quote in `db/provenance.tsv` is byte-checked by the gate at its stated `<id>:<file>:<line>`.

Reviews

`notes/reviews/` holds the adversarial review reports; a `proved` claim names its review file in `db/claims.tsv` and the gate checks that the file contains `VERDICT <id>: VALID`.

49 Lab Log

The dated worklogs under `docs/worklog/` are the primary chronology; `HANDOFF.md` is the live state. This section is their mirror at the level of decisions.

2026-09-10/11: founding session

One conversation in the parent repository `arithmetic-quantum-mechanics`. Trajectory: Bost–Connes basics; why not Wick-rotate to Hilbert–Pólya; an elliptic curve over $\mathbb{F}_2$ as a finite instance; permutations and the one determinant identity; automata and rationality; the actual Riemann hypothesis as a flow with orbit periods $\log p$; the Ihara zeta of regular graphs as the vestigial Selberg zeta; Shor’s unitary as the level- N Galois symmetry of Bost–Connes; quantum expanders and the quantum Ihara zeta; matrix-product states and the ring-norm reading; the Bost–Connes system as a matrix-product operator over the prime chain; the Holevo–Werner lift; and the computation of the scattering symbol, its zeros, and the 3000-zero ring-norm test.

Corrections TJO made along the way, kept as working rules: stay elementary, no jargon dumps, one step at a time; no curves or field extensions when a permutation will do; “QFT” did not mean functional integrals; length quantisation should come from a flatness-type condition.

Afternoon: the Weil–LPS channels computed for seven primes. Bugs found and fixed: quaternion enumeration starting at an odd coordinate (caught by the divisor-sum count); parity as a second fixed point on the full space (resolved by splitting into the two Weil blocks); the Hecke relation failing on SL_2 by signs (resolved on PSL_2).

Evening: the matrix-product formulation of the Weil conjectures for quadratic Artin–Schreier curves. Bugs: a wrong irreducibility test for composite n ; the even- n sign, which was the L -function normalisation, not a bug.

2026-09-12

Morning: circle flows discussed (no code); the expository note on Deligne’s proof written; repository made public under AGPL-3.0.

Afternoon: prior-art search on the quantum Ihara zeta, three Opus literature agents, then byte-verification against arXiv TeX sources (`refs/`). Finding: the object and its determinant formula are known (Matsuura–Ohta; Watanabe–Fukumizu for loopless graphs; Sunada); the RH-for-channels reading, the MPS dictionary and the Weil-representation instance were not found. Then the Ihara–Bass formula for arbitrary Kraus families proved in Lamport style and taken through two rounds of adversarial review by Opus reviewers; promoted to **proved**. Standing preference recorded: TeX source, not PDF, for every quotation.

Evening: this lab book set up following the parent repository’s sharded pattern, with the notation, definitions, claims and provenance databases under `db/`, the generated macro and status files, the gate `scripts/labbook_check.py`, the local CI `scripts/ci_local.sh` and its pre-commit hook. Notation and definitions across the seven notes de-duplicated into the databases; the clashes and their resolutions are listed in Section 2.

Night: the Selberg dictionary campaign (codex prover, Opus refute review, shards 09b/09c), and the Weil-positivity campaign of the second afternoon session (shards 08b/08c). Evening: TJO set the Bost–Connes reframe as the central priority and named the chased object the Phantasm.

2026-09-12, night: the Phantasm campaign

Orchestration: one codex prover session (gpt-6-astra, xhigh; brief `notes/riemann-cmps/astra-brief.md`, proofs `notes/riemann-cmps/astra-proofs.md`, 1356 lines, labels T1–T8), three Opus lanes in parallel (Artin–Schreier numerics, Riemann-side numerics, TeX sources with 57 byte-verified quotes and 17 new arXiv sources), then an Opus REFUTE review. Results: Section 18, Section 19, Section 29, the definitions shard Section 5, and the restatements of Proposition 17.5 (HANDOFF item 1c) and Proposition 28.1. Corrections along the way: the founding session’s $\alpha_i = -\lambda_i(E)$ was found false by the numerics lane; the orchestrator’s replacement (a conjugated law) was found false by the same lane in two further cases; the prover produced the exact law (radical sign, Stickelberger on the complement) and the numerics lane confirmed it in 624 further checks. TJO’s steering during the campaign: the fixed point of the bond Lindbladian is literally the entanglement spectrum, so the Gibbs entropy and its cutoffs are entanglement data (recorded; the Hagedorn level density rules out a CFT reading); and the Phantasm must carry the Bost–Connes symmetry $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}^\times$, which led to the trivial-versus-nontrivial-character reading of the grading and to conjecture 47.4.

2026-09-13: finite BC symmetry constraints

TJO clarified that the BC state is the prescribed stationary state of an unknown Lindbladian, constrained by Galois symmetry and adelic symplectic structure. The finite inverse problem was formulated as a linear section of the conditional Choi cone in Section 20. At criticality its dimensions were computed for Galois, linear Weil, and additional Weyl covariance; the last must be distinguished from merely carrying the symplectic representation. The finite BC phase marginal does not specify a matrix-state extension, and an exact finite representation of the full BC algebra cannot retain nontrivial phase observables.

An explicit $p = 7$ covariant GKLS generator has unequal odd decay rates. Compatible two-prime models retain a free coupling even with fixed local semigroups. The numerical script passes 427 checks and is included in local CI. Full written derivations were supplied by Codex but no independent review was performed, so the eight new analytic claim rows are **sketched**; the ninth is **numerical**. The arithmetic map to the scattering bond and the adelic limit remain open.

2026-09-13: the fermion parity of a cMPS ring

TJO was cautious about reading the ring norm of a boson–fermion cMPS as a supertrace, asked whether it had been proved (it had not: the book only cited the lattice fermionic-MPS contraction), and asked for a direct, rigorous calculation of the expectation value of $(-1)^F$ ending in a supertrace and a superdeterminant. Done alone by Opus at TJO’s instruction, without subagents, in Sections 21 and 22. Outcome: for arbitrary data the parity expectation is a trace of the sign-twisted generator; with a bond grading it is identically ± 1 ; the supertrace, graded on the doubled bond, is the norm of the ring closed with the bond parity (the periodic fermion ring), and its ring-length zeta is $1/\text{sdet}$. Unreviewed, so the rows are **sketched**; the Jordan–Wigner script passes 89 checks.

2026-09-14: two Lindblad papers, mixing times

At TJO’s request two Opus readers read arXiv:2609.13121 (Becker–Zworski, optimal relaxation of Witten Lindbladians) and arXiv:2609.12284 (Shang, a dissipative quantum linear-system solver) from TeX; reading notes are in `notes/extract/`. Neither bears directly on Ramanujan properties, cMPS or KMS states. Both readers independently argue that the compressed Riemann semigroup

has operator norm one for all times, independently of RH, so a mixing-time form of the Ramanujan statement must restrict to regular data. This is unreviewed and not registered as a claim.

2026-09-14: the ring-norm-tensor campaign

TJO asked for an educated guess for the MPS tensor of the absolute simplest variety without an obvious Polya–Hilbert Hamiltonian, with the wish list (1) natural tensor, (2) graded decomposition and why, (3) ring norms equal counts, (4) the PH operator, (5) Ramanujan, all modulo gauge; a codex `gpt-6-astra` prover, an Opus numerics lane, an Opus sources lane and an Opus REFUTE reviewer. Morning: the previous session’s genus-one ring-norm claim was double-checked on real curves and extended (genus two needs fermionic letters; found numerically). The campaign read “obvious” as the quadratic Artin–Schreier unitary, proved that family supersingular, and took the ordinary elliptic curve as Tier A (lifted Frobenius on the flat torus: count = Lefschetz number, grading = form degree, ket/bra = Hodge decomposition, PH unitary = pullback on harmonic forms, Ramanujan = degree of the lift, gauge = lattice basis / ideal class) and genus two as Tier B (block equations, the vacuum ansatz impossible, an explicit nine-letter tensor for $q \geq 16$, a rationally certified three-letter tensor over $\mathbb{F}_5$, Rosati as the PH metric). Correction recorded: the orchestrator’s drafted Hilbert–Schmidt/trace bound was false; the genus bound was re-proved by the all-power word-trace inequality. Shards 02g, 06c–06f; `docs/worklog/2026-09-14.md`.

Evening: TJO asked how hard it is to write down the actual matrices for one curve of each genus, with entanglement properties and parent Hamiltonians. Shard 06g: genus 0 to 3 explicit (the genus-three example over $\mathbb{F}_{37}$ needs only three brute-force counts), correlation lengths ($2/\log q$ for every odd mode is RH), block Schmidt spectra from the doubled bond, and parent Hamiltonians whose periodic-fermion ground state is selected by a parity-twisted boundary term.

2026-09-14, night: back to basics, the graded permutation

TJO went back to the permutation $(1\ 2)(3\ 4\ 5)$: its one-matrix MPS, the gas of rings as $\ell^2(\mathbb{N})$ of the naturals with the zeta function a pure vector of square-root thermal weights, and the isomorphism with two oscillators of energies 2 and 3; then graded the 3-cycle odd and asked whether boundary conditions induce zeros; then asked what principle fixes the number of physical letters; then, mid-recording, whether the discussion gives guidance on the jump operators of the Riemann cMPS (prime jumps versus Bost–Connes symmetry jumps). Shard 03b and `scripts/graded_permutation.py` (46 checks): the gas is unique factorisation; the Ramond closure gives $(1-u^3)/(1-u^2)$ with the pole at 1 eaten unless a holonomy moves the zeros; a fermionic prime contributes $1-u^\ell$ (all primes fermionic: Möbius); the sign lives only in the even–odd coherences of the doubled bond, so the physical dimension is sandwiched between the Kraus rank and letters coarser than the grading (ladder 5, 13, 1 at $n = 6$); a parity jump shifts the odd spectrum uniformly, the letter-level form of the uniform-rate statement; and the reading for the Riemann cMPS: Galois jumps set the rate, prime jumps are the record, the frequencies still need an even–odd Hamiltonian. All rows `sketched/numerical`, author `claude:fable-5.1`, unreviewed.

2026-09-14, night: the yolo guess and its audit

TJO asked for a bold guess of the Riemann Lindbladian from the notebook’s circumstantial evidence. The orchestrator assembled one on the Fourier side of Bost–Connes (profinite phases graded by the Fourier mode, one prime jump per prime at rate $1/p$, Galois dephasing, an archimedean dilation Hamiltonian; the Ramanujan-sum sector as the candidate for the open identification 0b’) and, at TJO’s instruction, two codex `gpt-6-astra` xhigh lanes audited it: structure (58-row correction

ledger) and a finite model with a zero hunt (1351 checks). Shard 04g. Clean negative: the prime jumps reproduce the shifted Euler product and nothing else; the grading is not invariant; the rates $1/p$ define no normal semigroup; the parity closure is not the rational quotient; shell Gibbs weights are not stationary. Survivors: exact kinematics, the inverse multiset element $1/\zeta(w + \frac{1}{2})$, uniform Galois dephasing. Two of the orchestrator’s claims in shard 03b corrected (asymmetric Galois rates do produce frequencies; “zeros on $\text{Re } s = 0$ ” is per finite factor only). All rows **sketched/numerical**; both lanes are codex, no Opus review yet.

2026-09-14, night: the zeta conditions factor by factor

After the negative on the yolo Lindbladian, TJO asked for the complementary strategy: line up the conditions a zeta must obey and impose them one at a time on graded MPS/cMPS ring norms, with tiny L -functions, and completely concrete tensors. The orchestrator proposed the sub-system rule and the pair shift minus its diagonal as the smallest example (one zero, one pole, RH by half entropy); one codex **gpt-6-astra** lane produced the ten-condition ledger and a catalogue of thirteen explicit constructions with all matrices printed (461 checks, re-run). Shard 06h. Highlights: four-letter trace-preserving elliptic tensors on $\mathbb{C}^{11}$ with FE by a visible duality, RH by a unitary odd block and a unique maximally mixed fixed point; a Pauli family proving FE, RH and mixing independent; Horner MPS computing Dirichlet L -functions over $\mathbb{F}_2[x]$ and $\mathbb{F}_3[x]$; a damping cMPS with an additive FE. Corrections to the orchestrator: inverse-closed letters alone give no FE; the swap L -function of the pair shift is not an Artin factor; “unique fixed point” is three conditions. Limits recorded: a finite bond cannot give a nonrational zeta or an atomic prime comb.

2026-09-16: an infinite object whose odd-block form comes from the letters

TJO asked for the most consequential step toward a mechanism and took the recommendation: build an infinite-object zeta as a graded transfer whose odd-block unitarity is derived from the letters, Selberg first. The orchestrator drafted eight statements; one codex **gpt-6-astra** xhigh lane returned 7 corrected, 1 open, a 40-row ledger (34 genuine corrections) and 131 checks (**notes/selberg-letters/**); a Claude Opus refuter reviewed it with four independent scripts and 31 byte-checked citations (**notes/reviews/selberg-letters-2026-09-16.md**: no BLOCKER or MAJOR; round 1: 7 VALID, 4 MINOR, applied; round 2: all VALID). Shards 03e–03f, definition Definition 10.7, corrections to observations 14.7 and 14.8 and to the “not established” list of Section 46. Results: Z_{Sel} is the ring zeta of the stable two-term transverse complex (Ruelle fails FE); the first-band form is the orthogonal sum of branchwise Haar pullbacks (the total pullback is degenerate), with reality from Haar, the $\frac{1}{4}$ coercivity as the one extra bound, and a Jordan obstruction at the threshold; the finite Hashimoto-lift theorem with its explicit metric and endpoint counterexamples; no doubled-bond CP realisation; on the modular surface the Riemann zeros are Selberg zeros whose states are Eisenstein Laurent data outside L^2 , at centre $-\frac{3}{4}$, not the Riemann model’s $-\frac{1}{4}$; the K -type grading is not a flow grading. Orchestrator corrected on the Casimir ordering sign, the direction of the spectral map, the Ruelle trivial divisor, the FE sign, the total pullback, the endpoint exception, the quantum pushforward convention, the Riemann-sector rate, and “Selberg’s $\frac{1}{4}$ is open for $\text{PSL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ ” (it is known).

2026-09-19: the sidequest merged; the window as a compression and the extension disc

The zeta-spectral-triples sidequest branch (**zst/**, **ihz/**, **notes/zeta-spectral-triples/**, worklogs 2026-09-17 and 2026-09-18) was merged into master, both HANDOFF blocks kept. TJO then

asked whether one could build a better estimator of the higher traces $\text{Tr } X^l$, $l > K$, from the traces up to K , the CCM chain appearing to model them. Shard 08g answers: the chain models nothing beyond the window (the window form is an exact compression, the implicit model is the Pisarenko extension); the admissible next trace fills a disc with the Levinson predictor as centre and a determinant ratio as radius, whose boundary points are the singular windows with $K + 1$ atoms (Carathéodory–Fejér, byte-cited from Connes–van Suijlekom), so positivity alone cannot beat it; the counts add nonnegativity and a Newton-identity congruence modulo $K + 1$, which pin the next trace of the permutation $(12)(345)$ one lag before the critical window but nothing for the Petersen graph, where the rescaling multiplies the radius by $q^{(K+1)/2}$; for ζ the mean of the higher traces is the pole, already exact, so a better estimator means more primes. 45 checks (`scripts/weil_window_extension.py`). Orchestrator alone; unreviewed.

2026-09-20: a finite graph with a cusp (shards 04i, 04j)

TJO restated the theme (RH as a Lindblad process with the zeros as absorption spectrum, the ring norm a supertrace, RH the Ramanujan property of a continuous quantum expander) and asked how to explore the cusp-exit-plus-rebound mechanism of Section 24 on the simplest example closer to ζ . Answer: a finite core with a ray attached with the weights of the tree quotient. Full protocol round (astra prover, blind Opus numerics with 569 checks, Sonnet and Opus literature lanes, Opus refutation review). Decisive prior art found: Arends–Peterson–Weich (resonance matrix = the rank-one perturbed Bass determinant; elliptic-curve quotients with resonances on $|z| = q^{-1/4}$; the wave equation left open) and Childs–Strouse (the reflection coefficient verbatim, half-bound states, Levinson’s count). Corrections of the orchestrator: sign of the determinant form, junction measure, threshold cancellation, outgoing profile offset, the 3/32 obstruction to projecting radiation data after deleting bound states and its repair, $\phi = 1/R$, aperiodicity. New: the one-exit contraction with $\dim K = \text{number of resonances}$, the discrete renewal channel, RAM and RH independent, the product identity $1 - c^2$ forcing the pure cusp empty and fixing the radius from the bound states, the Krylov factorisation. An interactive physics exposition was published as an artifact. Next: the elliptic-curve diagram with an arithmetic rebound.

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